

MODEL RUN TRANSCRIPT

Generated: 2026-06-04T11:40:48

Source: data/json/noise_experiments/sonnet45_directive_normative_r10_n5/sonnet45_directive_normative_noise_negative2_informed_r10_n5/claude-sonnet-4.5/myth_game/noisy_negative_2_informed_myth_causal_10/sonnet45_directive_normative_noise_negative2_informed_r10_n5_005_neutral_rep00_myth_game_directive_anything.json

RUN METADATA

```
model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
temperature: 0.8
num_turns: 10
num_agents: 2
memory_capacity: 3
myth_topic_id: anything
myth_topic: anything
game_params_name: noisy_negative_2_informed_myth_causal_10
noise_config: {
  "applies_to": "both",
  "direction": "negative",
  "inform_agents": true,
  "range": 2.0,
  "type": "uniform"
}
other_player_names: default
replicate_id: 0
myth_prompt_arm_id: myth_game_directive
myth_default_prompt_key: myth_writing_default_game_directive
myth_later_prompt_key: myth_writing_later_rounds_directive
task_order: [
  "myth",
  "game"
]
agent_names: {
  "Agent_1": "Aster",
  "Agent_2": "Briar"
}
```

Coverage: exact chat message snapshots sent to the model are included for every recorded LLM call.

AGENTS

Agent_1 (Aster); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Agent_2 (Briar); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

=====

ROUND 1

=====

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$7; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$7, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$8; noise/visible: sent visible=\$4.53, received visible=\$13.59, returned visible=\$6.51

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 7.0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 7.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 7.0,
"Agent_2": 8.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 6.51,
"Agent_2": 6.59

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:30:58

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

The Tale of the Golden River

In ancient times, there lived two villages separated by a barren valley. The Sun Goddess gave each village a gift: the Upstream Village received five golden seeds each dawn, while the Downstream Village received nothing but dry earth.

One day, a brave soul from Upstream cast their seeds into the valley. As the seeds tumbled down, they mysteriously multiplied—one became three, two became six, five became fifteen. The magic of the valley transformed generosity into abundance.

The Downstream Village rejoiced at their unexpected harvest. Their elder, wise and grateful, understood the lesson: the valley's magic worked only through trust. She sent half the harvest back upstream, honoring the risk their neighbor had taken.

Seeing this reciprocity, Upstream sent seeds again the next day. Downstream returned the favor, and a rhythm emerged—each act of faith met with gratitude, each gift multiplied by the valley's ancient enchantment.

The Goddess smiled. "This is the secret of prosperity," she whispered. "Trust transforms scarcity into abundance, but only when reciprocity flows like water returning to its source."

Thus both villages flourished, learning that wealth grows not from hoarding, but from the courage to give and the wisdom to return.

Reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game experience. However, I note that in this particular session, I haven't actually played any rounds yet - this appears to be the beginning of the experiment.

Still, I should write a myth that captures the essence of the trust game and how it ideally should be played. The trust game involves:

- Taking risks by sending money
- The multiplication of trust (3x multiplier)
- The importance of reciprocity
- The balance between self-interest and cooperation

I should write a myth that embodies these themes - perhaps about the value of trust, reciprocity, and mutual benefit. Let me create a story that reflects healthy gameplay where both parties benefit through trust and fair reciprocation.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 405,  
  "output_tokens": 460,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 208  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:31:00

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",
```

```
"round": 1,  
"task": "myth",  
"task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the ancient times, two villages stood on opposite banks of a great river. The North Village was blessed with golden wheat, while the South Village had silver fish in abundance.

One day, the Northern Chief sent five sacks of wheat across the river. As the boat traveled, the River Spirit blessed the cargo, multiplying it threefold-fifteen sacks arrived in the South.

The Southern Chief rejoiced at this bounty. She could have kept all fifteen sacks, but she remembered the trust shown by her neighbor. She sent back seven sacks, keeping eight for her people.

When the wheat returned, the Northern Chief was pleased. Both villages had prospered-the North gained more than they sent, and the South gained more than they had before.

This exchange continued through many seasons. Sometimes the River Spirit's blessing seemed stronger or weaker, and the amounts appeared uncertain across the waters. Yet the chiefs persisted, understanding that small misunderstandings were part of the river's nature.

The villages learned that prosperity flows from trust, like water seeking water. When one gives freely and the other returns fairly, both shores flourish. Those who hoard or betray with

r, while those who cooperate thrive together.

Thus the wisdom: *Trust creates abundance that cannot exist alone.*

Reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on the game I've been playing up to this point. However, I haven't actually played any rounds yet - this appears to be the beginning of the experiment.

Since I haven't played any rounds, I should write a myth about how I think the trust game SHOULD be played based on the rules I've been given. The trust game is fundamentally about:

1. Trust - the sender trusting the receiver to return some money
2. Mutual benefit - cooperation can benefit both parties (money is multiplied by 3x)
3. Risk - the sender risks losing their investment
4. Reciprocity - the receiver has the opportunity to reward trust

I also note there's a mention of "communication noise" - amounts may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned. This adds an element of uncertainty and potential misunderstanding.

Let me write a myth that captures these themes - trust, reciprocity, mutual benefit, and perhaps the role of communication noise/misunderstanding.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 405,  
  "output_tokens": 523,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 269  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:31:12

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 1,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Tale of the Golden River

In ancient times, there lived two villages separated by a barren valley. The Sun Goddess gave each village a gift: the Upstream Village received five golden seeds each dawn, while the Downstream Village received nothing but dry earth.

One day, a brave soul from Upstream cast their seeds into the valley. As the seeds tumbled down, they mysteriously multiplied—one became three, two became six, five became fifteen. The magic of the valley transformed generosity into abundance.

The Downstream Village rejoiced at their unexpected harvest. Their elder, wise and grateful, understood the lesson: the valley's magic worked only through trust. She sent half the harvest back upstream, honoring the risk their neighbor had taken.

Seeing this reciprocity, Upstream sent seeds again the next day. Downstream returned the favor, and a rhythm emerged—each act of faith met with gratitude, each gift multiplied by the valley's ancient enchantment.

The Goddess smiled. "This is the secret of prosperity," she whispered. "Trust transforms scarcity into abundance, but only when reciprocity flows like water returning to its source."

Thus both villages flourished, learning that wealth grows not from hoarding, but from the courage to give and the wisdom to return.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game experience. However, I note that in this particular session, I haven't actually played any rounds yet - this appears to be the beginning of the experiment.

Still, I should write a myth that captures the essence of the trust game and how it ideally should be played. The trust game involves:

- Taking risks by sending money
- The multiplication of trust (3x multiplier)
- The importance of reciprocity
- The balance between self-interest and cooperation

I should write a myth that embodies these themes - perhaps about the value of trust, recip

reciprocity, and mutual benefit. Let me create a story that reflects healthy gameplay where both parties benefit through trust and fair reciprocation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 460,
  "reasoning_tokens": 208
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Based on the myth I just wrote, I should embody the principle of the Upstream Village-taking the courageous first step of trust. The myth teaches that "wealth grows not from hoarding, but from the courage to give and the wisdom to return."

Like the brave soul who cast all their golden seeds into the valley, trusting in the magic of multiplication and the reciprocity of others, I will send the full amount.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

Reasoning:

This is the first round, and I'm the SENDER. I just wrote a myth about trust, reciprocity, and how generosity gets multiplied. The myth emphasizes:

1. The Upstream Village (sender) casting seeds into the valley
2. The seeds multiplying (like the 3x multiplier in the game)
3. The Downstream Village (receiver) returning half the harvest
4. Both prospered through this cycle of trust and reciprocity

The myth clearly advocates for trust and sending resources, expecting reciprocal behavior. In the myth, the upstream village sent their seeds (was generous), which multiplied, and the downstream village returned half.

If I send \$5:

- Receiver gets \$15 (5×3)
- If they return half (\$7.50), I'd have $\$0 + \$7.50 = \$7.50$
- They'd keep \$7.50
- Both benefit

If I send less, say \$3:

- Receiver gets \$9
- If they return half (\$4.50), I'd have $\$2 + \$4.50 = \$6.50$
- They'd keep \$4.50

The myth strongly suggests sending a significant amount to demonstrate trust. The "brave soul" sent their seeds - this suggests taking a risk. The myth says "courage to give" and emphasizes that "wealth grows not from hoarding."

Given that I just wrote this myth advocating for trust and generosity as the way to prosperity, I should follow its wisdom. I'll send \$5 to fully embody the principle of trust that transforms "scarcity into abundance."

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 728,
"output_tokens": 472,
"reasoning_tokens": 350
```

}

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:31:31

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 1,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
```



```

"agent_names": {
  "Agent_1": "Aster",
  "Agent_2": "Briar"
},
"agents": [
  "Agent_1",
  "Agent_2"
],
"investor": "Agent_1",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "investor",
  "Agent_2": "trustee"
},
"trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 1,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the ancient times, two villages stood on opposite banks of a great river. The North Village was blessed with golden wheat, while the South Village had silver fish in abundance

One day, the Northern Chief sent five sacks of wheat across the river. As the boat traveled, the River Spirit blessed the cargo, multiplying it threefold-fifteen sacks arrived in the South.

The Southern Chief rejoiced at this bounty. She could have kept all fifteen sacks, but she remembered the trust shown by her neighbor. She sent back seven sacks, keeping eight for her people.

When the wheat returned, the Northern Chief was pleased. Both villages had prospered-the North gained more than they sent, and the South gained more than they had before.

This exchange continued through many seasons. Sometimes the River Spirit's blessing seemed stronger or weaker, and the amounts appeared uncertain across the waters. Yet the chief persisted, understanding that small misunderstandings were part of the river's nature.

The villages learned that prosperity flows from trust, like water seeking water. When one gives freely and the other returns fairly, both shores flourish. Those who hoard or betray wither, while those who cooperate thrive together.

Thus the wisdom: *Trust creates abundance that cannot exist alone.*

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on the game I've been playing up to this point. However, I haven't actually played any rounds yet - this appears to be the beginning of the experiment.

Since I haven't played any rounds, I should write a myth about how I think the trust game SHOULD be played based on the rules I've been given. The trust game is fundamentally about:

1. Trust - the sender trusting the receiver to return some money
2. Mutual benefit - cooperation can benefit both parties (money is multiplied by 3x)
3. Risk - the sender risks losing their investment
4. Reciprocity - the receiver has the opportunity to reward trust

I also note there's a mention of "communication noise" - amounts may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned. This adds an element of uncertainty and potential misunderstanding.

Let me write a myth that captures these themes - trust, reciprocity, mutual benefit, and perhaps the role of communication noise/misunderstanding.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 523,
  "reasoning_tokens": 269
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$4.53, that is 90.6% of their total endowment. You received \$13.59. How much do you return to The sender? (0-13.59)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myth I just wrote:

The sender showed remarkable trust by sending \$4.53 (90.6% of their endowment) - this mirrors the Northern Chief's generous opening gesture. The River Spirit multiplied this to \$13.59.

In the myth, the Southern Chief returned approximately 47% of what she received (7 out of 15 sacks), ensuring both villages prospered. Following this wisdom:

- If I return around \$7.00, the sender ends with \$7.47 total (their remaining \$0.47 + \$7.00 returned)
- I would keep \$6.59
- Both of us profit significantly: sender gains \$2.47, I gain \$6.59

This honors the sender's trust with a meaningful return while ensuring we both benefit from cooperation. The sender's bold trust is rewarded, and both "shores flourish."

The myth teaches that "when one gives freely and the other returns fairly, both shores flourish." The sender gave freely; now I must return fairly to establish the pattern of mutual prosperity.

```
{'return': 7.00}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

1. The sender sent \$4.53 out of \$5 (90.6%)
2. This was multiplied by 3x, so I received \$13.59
3. I need to decide how much to return

The sender showed significant trust by sending 90.6% of their endowment. This is a very generous opening move.

In the myth I just wrote, the Southern Chief received 15 sacks (from 5 sent) and returned 7 sacks, keeping 8. That's a return rate of $7/15 = 46.67\%$ of what was received.

Let me think about what would be fair:

- The sender gave up \$4.53, keeping only \$0.47
- If I return a fair amount, the sender should end up with more than what they kept (\$0.47)
- I should also keep a reasonable amount

If I return \$7 (roughly 51.5% of \$13.59):

- Sender ends up with: $\$0.47 + \$7 = \$7.47$
- I end up with: $\$13.59 - \$7 = \$6.59$

This seems fair - both of us profit, and the sender's trust is rewarded with profit of \$2.47 above their initial \$5.

If I return \$6:

- Sender ends up with: $\$0.47 + \$6 = \$6.47$
- I end up with: $\$13.59 - \$6 = \$7.59$

If I return \$6.50:

- Sender ends up with: $\$0.47 + \$6.50 = \$6.97$
- I end up with: $\$13.59 - \$6.50 = \$7.09$

The myth emphasized returning fairly while both prospering. The Southern Chief returned 7 out of 15 (47%), so returning around that proportion would be:
 $\$13.59 \times 0.47 = \6.39

Given the exceptional trust demonstrated here, I should return toward the higher end of this range. Sending back \$7 honors that generosity while ensuring we both come out significantly ahead-the sender gains \$2.47 beyond their starting amount, and I keep \$6.59. This aligns with the principle that mutual prosperity follows from reciprocal trust.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 760,  
  "output_tokens": 839,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 435  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

The Tale of the Golden River

In ancient times, there lived two villages separated by a barren valley. The Sun Goddess gave each village a gift: the Upstream Village received five golden seeds each dawn, while the Downstream Village received nothing but dry earth.

One day, a brave soul from Upstream cast their seeds into the valley. As the seeds tumbled down, they mysteriously multiplied-one became three, two became six, five became fifteen. The magic of the valley transformed generosity into abundance.

The Downstream Village rejoiced at their unexpected harvest. Their elder, wise and grateful, understood the lesson: the valley's magic worked only through trust. She sent half the harvest back upstream, honoring the risk their neighbor had taken.

Seeing this reciprocity, Upstream sent seeds again the next day. Downstream returned the favor, and a rhythm emerged-each act of faith met with gratitude, each gift multiplied by the

valley's ancient enchantment.

The Goddess smiled. "This is the secret of prosperity," she whispered. "Trust transforms scarcity into abundance, but only when reciprocity flows like water returning to its source."

Thus both villages flourished, learning that wealth grows not from hoarding, but from the courage to give and the wisdom to return.

Agent_2 (Briar)

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the ancient times, two villages stood on opposite banks of a great river. The North Village was blessed with golden wheat, while the South Village had silver fish in abundance.

One day, the Northern Chief sent five sacks of wheat across the river. As the boat traveled, the River Spirit blessed the cargo, multiplying it threefold-fifteen sacks arrived in the South.

The Southern Chief rejoiced at this bounty. She could have kept all fifteen sacks, but she remembered the trust shown by her neighbor. She sent back seven sacks, keeping eight for her people.

When the wheat returned, the Northern Chief was pleased. Both villages had prospered-the North gained more than they sent, and the South gained more than they had before.

This exchange continued through many seasons. Sometimes the River Spirit's blessing seemed stronger or weaker, and the amounts appeared uncertain across the waters. Yet the chiefs persisted, understanding that small misunderstandings were part of the river's nature.

The villages learned that prosperity flows from trust, like water seeking water. When one gives freely and the other returns fairly, both shores flourish. Those who hoard or betray wither, while those who cooperate thrive together.

Thus the wisdom: *Trust creates abundance that cannot exist alone.*

ROUND 2

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$4.5; received \$13.5; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$0.5, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$13.5; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 13.5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 4.5, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.5}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 20.5,
"Agent_2": 8.5

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 6.51,
"Agent_2": 7.09

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:31:44

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
"agent_names": {
"Agent_1": "Aster",
"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

```

    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 2,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected.

. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the ancient times, two villages stood on opposite banks of a great river. The North Village was blessed with golden wheat, while the South Village had silver fish in abundance.

One day, the Northern Chief sent five sacks of wheat across the river. As the boat traveled, the River Spirit blessed the cargo, multiplying it threefold-fifteen sacks arrived in the South.

The Southern Chief rejoiced at this bounty. She could have kept all fifteen sacks, but she remembered the trust shown by her neighbor. She sent back seven sacks, keeping eight for her people.

When the wheat returned, the Northern Chief was pleased. Both villages had prospered-the North gained more than they sent, and the South gained more than they had before.

This exchange continued through many seasons. Sometimes the River Spirit's blessing seemed stronger or weaker, and the amounts appeared uncertain across the waters. Yet the chiefs persisted, understanding that small misunderstandings were part of the river's nature.

The villages learned that prosperity flows from trust, like water seeking water. When one gives freely and the other returns fairly, both shores flourish. Those who hoard or betray wither, while those who cooperate thrive together.

Thus the wisdom: *Trust creates abundance that cannot exist alone.*

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on the game I've been playing up to this point. However, I haven't actually played any rounds yet - this appears to be the beginning of the experiment.

Since I haven't played any rounds, I should write a myth about how I think the trust game SHOULD be played based on the rules I've been given. The trust game is fundamentally about:

1. Trust - the sender trusting the receiver to return some money
2. Mutual benefit - cooperation can benefit both parties (money is multiplied by 3x)
3. Risk - the sender risks losing their investment
4. Reciprocity - the receiver has the opportunity to reward trust

I also note there's a mention of "communication noise" - amounts may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned. This adds an element of uncertainty and potential misunderstanding.

Let me write a myth that captures these themes - trust, reciprocity, mutual benefit, and perhaps the role of communication noise/misunderstanding.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 523,
  "reasoning_tokens": 269
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$4.53, that is 90.6% of their total endowment. You received \$13.59. How much do you return to The sender? (0-13.59)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myth I just wrote:

The sender showed remarkable trust by sending \$4.53 (90.6% of their endowment) - this mirrors the Northern Chief's generous opening gesture. The River Spirit multiplied this to \$13.59.

In the myth, the Southern Chief returned approximately 47% of what she received (7 out of 15 sacks), ensuring both villages prospered. Following this wisdom:

- If I return around \$7.00, the sender ends with \$7.47 total (their remaining \$0.47 + \$7.00 returned)
- I would keep \$6.59
- Both of us profit significantly: sender gains \$2.47, I gain \$6.59

This honors the sender's trust with a meaningful return while ensuring we both benefit from cooperation. The sender's bold trust is rewarded, and both "shores flourish."

The myth teaches that "when one gives freely and the other returns fairly, both shores flourish." The sender gave freely; now I must return fairly to establish the pattern of mutual prosperity.

```
{'return': 7.00}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

1. The sender sent \$4.53 out of \$5 (90.6%)
2. This was multiplied by 3x, so I received \$13.59
3. I need to decide how much to return

The sender showed significant trust by sending 90.6% of their endowment. This is a very generous opening move.

In the myth I just wrote, the Southern Chief received 15 sacks (from 5 sent) and returned 7 sacks, keeping 8. That's a return rate of $7/15 = 46.67\%$ of what was received.

Let me think about what would be fair:

- The sender gave up \$4.53, keeping only \$0.47
- If I return a fair amount, the sender should end up with more than what they kept (\$0.47)
- I should also keep a reasonable amount

If I return \$7 (roughly 51.5% of \$13.59):

- Sender ends up with: $\$0.47 + \$7 = \$7.47$
- I end up with: $\$13.59 - \$7 = \$6.59$

This seems fair - both of us profit, and the sender's trust is rewarded with profit of \$2.47 above their initial \$5.

If I return \$6:

- Sender ends up with: $\$0.47 + \$6 = \$6.47$
- I end up with: $\$13.59 - \$6 = \$7.59$

If I return \$6.50:

- Sender ends up with: $\$0.47 + \$6.50 = \$6.97$
- I end up with: $\$13.59 - \$6.50 = \$7.09$

The myth emphasized returning fairly while both prospering. The Southern Chief returned 7 out of 15 (47%), so returning around that proportion would be:
 $\$13.59 \times 0.47 = \6.39

Given the exceptional trust demonstrated here, I should return toward the higher end of this range. Sending back \$7 honors that generosity while ensuring we both come out significantly ahead-the sender gains \$2.47 beyond their starting amount, and I keep \$6.59. This aligns with the principle that mutual prosperity follows from reciprocal trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 760,
  "output_tokens": 839,
  "reasoning_tokens": 435
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the ancient times, two villages stood on opposite banks of a great river. The North Village was blessed with golden wheat, while the South Village had silver fish in abundance.

One day, the Northern Chief sent five sacks of wheat across the river. As the boat traveled, the River Spirit blessed the cargo, multiplying it threefold-fifteen sacks arrived in the South.

The Southern Chief rejoiced at this bounty. She could have kept all fifteen sacks, but she remembered the trust shown by her neighbor. She sent back seven sacks, keeping eight for her people.

When the wheat returned, the Northern Chief was pleased. Both villages had prospered-the North gained more than they sent, and the South gained more than they had before.

This exchange continued through many seasons. Sometimes the River Spirit's blessing seemed stronger or weaker, and the amounts appeared uncertain across the waters. Yet the chief persisted, understanding that small misunderstandings were part of the river's nature.

The villages learned that prosperity flows from trust, like water seeking water. When one gives freely and the other returns fairly, both shores flourish. Those who hoard or betray wither, while those who cooperate thrive together.

Thus the wisdom: *Trust creates abundance that cannot exist alone.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Golden River

In ancient times, there lived two villages separated by a barren valley. The Sun Goddess gave each village a gift: the Upstream Village received five golden seeds each dawn, while the Downstream Village received nothing but dry earth.

One day, a brave soul from Upstream cast their seeds into the valley. As the seeds tumbled down, they mysteriously multiplied-one became three, two became six, five became fifteen. The magic of the valley transformed generosity into abundance.

The Downstream Village rejoiced at their unexpected harvest. Their elder, wise and grateful, understood the lesson: the valley's magic worked only through trust. She sent half the harvest back upstream, honoring the risk their neighbor had taken.

Seeing this reciprocity, Upstream sent seeds again the next day. Downstream returned the favor, and a rhythm emerged-each act of faith met with gratitude, each gift multiplied by the valley's ancient enchantment.

The Goddess smiled. "This is the secret of prosperity," she whispered. "Trust transforms scarcity into abundance, but only when reciprocity flows like water returning to its source."

Thus both villages flourished, learning that wealth grows not from hoarding, but from the courage to give and the wisdom to return.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Long ago, two islands floated in an endless sea, each blessed with five pearls at every sunrise. Yet pearls alone brought no joy-they needed trust to unlock their magic.

A young islander from the East gathered her pearls and cast nearly all across the waters toward the West. As they sailed through the mist, the Ocean Spirit touched them, and each pearl became three. The Western shore received abundance beyond measure-over thirteen glowing pearls.

The Western elder gazed at this fortune. He could have kept it all, claimed it was lost to the waves, blamed the mist for confusion. Instead, he remembered the courage it took to send pearls across uncertain waters. He returned seven pearls, more than half of what remained after the original gift was subtracted, honoring the leap of faith.

When those pearls returned, the Eastern islander smiled. Both islands now held more than they began with. The pattern became clear: bold trust multiplied by fair return creates prosperity impossible alone.

The Ocean Spirit's voice echoed across the waves: "See how the brave sender and grateful receiver both flourish? This is the sacred rhythm-give courageously, return generously, and watch abundance flow between you like the eternal tides."

Reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on:

1. My previous myth about the Twin Rivers
2. The other agent's myth about the Golden River
3. What happened in Round 1: The sender sent \$4.53 (90.6%), I received \$13.59, and I returned \$7.00

Both myths emphasize:

- Trust and generosity from the sender
- Reciprocity and gratitude from the receiver
- Mutual prosperity through cooperation
- The magic/blessing that multiplies the initial gift

In Round 1:

- Sender showed high trust (90.6%)
- I returned about 51.5% of what I received
- Both of us profited

I should adapt my myth to:

- Reflect this successful first exchange
- Continue emphasizing reciprocity
- Perhaps add more detail about the pattern that emerges
- Keep the core message about trust and mutual benefit

Let me write a new 200-word myth that builds on these themes.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 1661,  
"output_tokens": 497,  
"reasoning_tokens": 225
```

}

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:31:48

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
"move_index": 1,  
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
"pairing": {  
  "agent_names": {  
    "Agent_1": "Aster",  
    "Agent_2": "Briar"  
  },  
  "agents": [  
    "Agent_2",  
    "Agent_1"  
  ],  
  "investor": "Agent_2",  
  "roles": {  
    "Agent_1": "trustee",  
    "Agent_2": "investor"  
  },  
  "trustee": "Agent_1"  
},  
"role": "trustee",  
"role_label": "Receiver",  
"round": 2,  
"task": "myth",  
"task_index": 0
```

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned

- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Tale of the Golden River

In ancient times, there lived two villages separated by a barren valley. The Sun Goddess gave each village a gift: the Upstream Village received five golden seeds each dawn, while the Downstream Village received nothing but dry earth.

One day, a brave soul from Upstream cast their seeds into the valley. As the seeds tumbled down, they mysteriously multiplied—one became three, two became six, five became fifteen. The magic of the valley transformed generosity into abundance.

The Downstream Village rejoiced at their unexpected harvest. Their elder, wise and grateful, understood the lesson: the valley's magic worked only through trust. She sent half the harvest back upstream, honoring the risk their neighbor had taken.

Seeing this reciprocity, Upstream sent seeds again the next day. Downstream returned the favor, and a rhythm emerged—each act of faith met with gratitude, each gift multiplied by the valley's ancient enchantment.

The Goddess smiled. "This is the secret of prosperity," she whispered. "Trust transforms scarcity into abundance, but only when reciprocity flows like water returning to its source."

Thus both villages flourished, learning that wealth grows not from hoarding, but from the courage to give and the wisdom to return.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game experience. However, I note that in this particular session, I haven't actually played any rounds yet - this appears to be the beginning of the experiment.

Still, I should write a myth that captures the essence of the trust game and how it ideally should be played. The trust game involves:

- Taking risks by sending money
- The multiplication of trust (3x multiplier)
- The importance of reciprocity
- The balance between self-interest and cooperation

I should write a myth that embodies these themes - perhaps about the value of trust, reciprocity, and mutual benefit. Let me create a story that reflects healthy gameplay where both parties benefit through trust and fair reciprocation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 460,
  "reasoning_tokens": 208
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Based on the myth I just wrote, I should embody the principle of the Upstream Village-taking the courageous first step of trust. The myth teaches that "wealth grows not from hoarding, but from the courage to give and the wisdom to return."

Like the brave soul who cast all their golden seeds into the valley, trusting in the magic of multiplication and the reciprocity of others, I will send the full amount.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is the first round, and I'm the SENDER. I just wrote a myth about trust, reciprocity, and how generosity gets multiplied. The myth emphasizes:

1. The Upstream Village (sender) casting seeds into the valley
2. The seeds multiplying (like the 3x multiplier in the game)
3. The Downstream Village (receiver) returning half the harvest
4. Both prospered through this cycle of trust and reciprocity

The myth clearly advocates for trust and sending resources, expecting reciprocal behavior. In the myth, the upstream village sent their seeds (was generous), which multiplied, and the downstream village returned half.

If I send \$5:

- Receiver gets \$15 (5×3)
- If they return half (\$7.50), I'd have $\$0 + \$7.50 = \$7.50$
- They'd keep \$7.50
- Both benefit

If I send less, say \$3:

- Receiver gets \$9
- If they return half (\$4.50), I'd have $\$2 + \$4.50 = \$6.50$
- They'd keep \$4.50

The myth strongly suggests sending a significant amount to demonstrate trust. The "brave soul" sent their seeds - this suggests taking a risk. The myth says "courage to give" and emphasizes that "wealth grows not from hoarding."

Given that I just wrote this myth advocating for trust and generosity as the way to prosperity, I should follow its wisdom. I'll send \$5 to fully embody the principle of trust that transforms "scarcity into abundance."

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 728,
  "output_tokens": 472,
  "reasoning_tokens": 350
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Tale of the Golden River

In ancient times, there lived two villages separated by a barren valley. The Sun Goddess gave each village a gift: the Upstream Village received five golden seeds each dawn, while the Downstream Village received nothing but dry earth.

One day, a brave soul from Upstream cast their seeds into the valley. As the seeds tumbled

down, they mysteriously multiplied-one became three, two became six, five became fifteen. The magic of the valley transformed generosity into abundance.

The Downstream Village rejoiced at their unexpected harvest. Their elder, wise and grateful, understood the lesson: the valley's magic worked only through trust. She sent half the harvest back upstream, honoring the risk their neighbor had taken.

Seeing this reciprocity, Upstream sent seeds again the next day. Downstream returned the favor, and a rhythm emerged-each act of faith met with gratitude, each gift multiplied by the valley's ancient enchantment.

The Goddess smiled. "This is the secret of prosperity," she whispered. "Trust transforms scarcity into abundance, but only when reciprocity flows like water returning to its source."

Thus both villages flourished, learning that wealth grows not from hoarding, but from the courage to give and the wisdom to return.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the ancient times, two villages stood on opposite banks of a great river. The North Village was blessed with golden wheat, while the South Village had silver fish in abundance.

One day, the Northern Chief sent five sacks of wheat across the river. As the boat traveled, the River Spirit blessed the cargo, multiplying it threefold-fifteen sacks arrived in the South.

The Southern Chief rejoiced at this bounty. She could have kept all fifteen sacks, but she remembered the trust shown by her neighbor. She sent back seven sacks, keeping eight for her people.

When the wheat returned, the Northern Chief was pleased. Both villages had prospered-the North gained more than they sent, and the South gained more than they had before.

This exchange continued through many seasons. Sometimes the River Spirit's blessing seemed stronger or weaker, and the amounts appeared uncertain across the waters. Yet the chiefs persisted, understanding that small misunderstandings were part of the river's nature.

The villages learned that prosperity flows from trust, like water seeking water. When one gives freely and the other returns fairly, both shores flourish. Those who hoard or betray wither, while those who cooperate thrive together.

Thus the wisdom: *Trust creates abundance that cannot exist alone.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Cloud Weaver lived above two valleys. Each morning, she gave the Upper Valley five drops of liquid starlight. The Lower Valley received only shadows.

One brave soul from Upper Valley poured all five drops into the canyon between them. As the starlight fell, the canyon's ancient magic transformed it-five became fifteen, cascading down like a waterfall of light.

The Lower Valley's keeper stood amazed at this gift. She understood: someone had risked everything on faith alone. She poured seven drops back upward, where they defied gravity and flowed home. Both valleys glowed-the Upper Valley now held seven drops from nothing, the Lower Valley kept eight from fifteen.

The Cloud Weaver watched and whispered, "This is how abundance is born."

Yet the canyon was old and its magic sometimes flickered. The drops seen arriving were not always exactly what was sent. Shadows played tricks on the eyes, and the count grew uncertain.

Still, both valleys continued their exchange, season after season. They learned to look not at single moments but at the pattern-the rhythm of giving and returning, trust meeting gratitude.

For prosperity is not a transaction but a dance, and those who dance together create what neither could achieve alone.

Reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth that also emphasizes trust and reciprocity, but with a specific detail: the Southern Chief (receiver) returned 7 out of 15 sacks, keeping 8. That's slightly less than half being returned (7/15 ? 47%).

In my previous myth, the Downstream receiver "sent half the harvest back upstream." If they received 15 (from my 5 multiplied by 3), half would be 7.5, so 7-8 would be appropriate.

Both myths emphasize:

1. Trust and giving freely
2. Reciprocity
3. Both parties prospering
4. The other myth mentions "small misunderstandings" and uncertainty - acknowledging the communication noise

For my new myth, I should:

- Build on my previous myth's themes
- Acknowledge what's happened in the game so far (I sent 5, it was multiplied to 15)
- Incorporate the reciprocity principle
- Maybe acknowledge the communication noise mentioned in their myth
- Keep the 200-word limit

I'll write a myth that continues the theme but perhaps adds new depth about the ongoing nature of cooperation.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1483,  
  "output_tokens": 547,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 266  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:32:07

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 2,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al

so be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the ancient times, two villages stood on opposite banks of a great river. The North Village was blessed with golden wheat, while the South Village had silver fish in abundance.

One day, the Northern Chief sent five sacks of wheat across the river. As the boat traveled, the River Spirit blessed the cargo, multiplying it threefold-fifteen sacks arrived in the South.

The Southern Chief rejoiced at this bounty. She could have kept all fifteen sacks, but she remembered the trust shown by her neighbor. She sent back seven sacks, keeping eight for her people.

When the wheat returned, the Northern Chief was pleased. Both villages had prospered-the North gained more than they sent, and the South gained more than they had before.

This exchange continued through many seasons. Sometimes the River Spirit's blessing seemed stronger or weaker, and the amounts appeared uncertain across the waters. Yet the chief persisted, understanding that small misunderstandings were part of the river's nature.

The villages learned that prosperity flows from trust, like water seeking water. When one gives freely and the other returns fairly, both shores flourish. Those who hoard or betray wither, while those who cooperate thrive together.

Thus the wisdom: *Trust creates abundance that cannot exist alone.*

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on the game I've been playing up to this point. However, I haven't actually

y played any rounds yet - this appears to be the beginning of the experiment.

Since I haven't played any rounds, I should write a myth about how I think the trust game SHOULD be played based on the rules I've been given. The trust game is fundamentally about:

1. Trust - the sender trusting the receiver to return some money
2. Mutual benefit - cooperation can benefit both parties (money is multiplied by 3x)
3. Risk - the sender risks losing their investment
4. Reciprocity - the receiver has the opportunity to reward trust

I also note there's a mention of "communication noise" - amounts may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned. This adds an element of uncertainty and potential misunderstanding.

Let me write a myth that captures these themes - trust, reciprocity, mutual benefit, and perhaps the role of communication noise/misunderstanding.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 523,
  "reasoning_tokens": 269
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$4.53, that is 90.6% of their total endowment. You received \$13.59. How much do you return to The sender? (0-13.59)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myth I just wrote:

The sender showed remarkable trust by sending \$4.53 (90.6% of their endowment) - this mirrors the Northern Chief's generous opening gesture. The River Spirit multiplied this to \$13.59.

In the myth, the Southern Chief returned approximately 47% of what she received (7 out of 15 sacks), ensuring both villages prospered. Following this wisdom:

- If I return around \$7.00, the sender ends with \$7.47 total (their remaining \$0.47 + \$7.00 returned)
- I would keep \$6.59
- Both of us profit significantly: sender gains \$2.47, I gain \$6.59

This honors the sender's trust with a meaningful return while ensuring we both benefit from cooperation. The sender's bold trust is rewarded, and both "shores flourish."

The myth teaches that "when one gives freely and the other returns fairly, both shores flourish." The sender gave freely; now I must return fairly to establish the pattern of mutual prosperity.

```
{'return': 7.00}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

1. The sender sent \$4.53 out of \$5 (90.6%)
2. This was multiplied by 3x, so I received \$13.59
3. I need to decide how much to return

The sender showed significant trust by sending 90.6% of their endowment. This is a very generous opening move.

In the myth I just wrote, the Southern Chief received 15 sacks (from 5 sent) and returned 7 sacks, keeping 8. That's a return rate of $7/15 = 46.67\%$ of what was received.

Let me think about what would be fair:

- The sender gave up \$4.53, keeping only \$0.47
- If I return a fair amount, the sender should end up with more than what they kept (\$0.47)
- I should also keep a reasonable amount

If I return \$7 (roughly 51.5% of \$13.59):

- Sender ends up with: $\$0.47 + \$7 = \$7.47$
- I end up with: $\$13.59 - \$7 = \$6.59$

This seems fair - both of us profit, and the sender's trust is rewarded with profit of \$2.47 above their initial \$5.

If I return \$6:

- Sender ends up with: $\$0.47 + \$6 = \$6.47$
- I end up with: $\$13.59 - \$6 = \$7.59$

If I return \$6.50:

- Sender ends up with: $\$0.47 + \$6.50 = \$6.97$
- I end up with: $\$13.59 - \$6.50 = \$7.09$

The myth emphasized returning fairly while both prospering. The Southern Chief returned 7 out of 15 (47%), so returning around that proportion would be:
 $\$13.59 \times 0.47 = \6.39

Given the exceptional trust demonstrated here, I should return toward the higher end of this range. Sending back \$7 honors that generosity while ensuring we both come out significantly ahead-the sender gains \$2.47 beyond their starting amount, and I keep \$6.59. This aligns with the principle that mutual prosperity follows from reciprocal trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 760,
  "output_tokens": 839,
  "reasoning_tokens": 435
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the ancient times, two villages stood on opposite banks of a great river. The North Village was blessed with golden wheat, while the South Village had silver fish in abundance.

One day, the Northern Chief sent five sacks of wheat across the river. As the boat traveled, the River Spirit blessed the cargo, multiplying it threefold-fifteen sacks arrived in the South.

The Southern Chief rejoiced at this bounty. She could have kept all fifteen sacks, but she remembered the trust shown by her neighbor. She sent back seven sacks, keeping eight for her people.

When the wheat returned, the Northern Chief was pleased. Both villages had prospered-the North gained more than they sent, and the South gained more than they had before.

This exchange continued through many seasons. Sometimes the River Spirit's blessing seemed stronger or weaker, and the amounts appeared uncertain across the waters. Yet the chief persisted, understanding that small misunderstandings were part of the river's nature.

The villages learned that prosperity flows from trust, like water seeking water. When one gives freely and the other returns fairly, both shores flourish. Those who hoard or betray wither, while those who cooperate thrive together.

Thus the wisdom: *Trust creates abundance that cannot exist alone.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
The Tale of the Golden River

In ancient times, there lived two villages separated by a barren valley. The Sun Goddess gave each village a gift: the Upstream Village received five golden seeds each dawn, while the Downstream Village received nothing but dry earth.

One day, a brave soul from Upstream cast their seeds into the valley. As the seeds tumbled down, they mysteriously multiplied-one became three, two became six, five became fifteen.

n. The magic of the valley transformed generosity into abundance.

The Downstream Village rejoiced at their unexpected harvest. Their elder, wise and grateful, understood the lesson: the valley's magic worked only through trust. She sent half the harvest back upstream, honoring the risk their neighbor had taken.

Seeing this reciprocity, Upstream sent seeds again the next day. Downstream returned the favor, and a rhythm emerged—each act of faith met with gratitude, each gift multiplied by the valley's ancient enchantment.

The Goddess smiled. "This is the secret of prosperity," she whispered. "Trust transforms scarcity into abundance, but only when reciprocity flows like water returning to its source."

Thus both villages flourished, learning that wealth grows not from hoarding, but from the courage to give and the wisdom to return.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: Long ago, two islands floated in an endless sea, each blessed with five pearls at every sunrise. Yet pearls alone brought no joy—they needed trust to unlock their magic.

A young islander from the East gathered her pearls and cast nearly all across the waters toward the West. As they sailed through the mist, the Ocean Spirit touched them, and each pearl became three. The Western shore received abundance beyond measure—over thirteen glowing pearls.

The Western elder gazed at this fortune. He could have kept it all, claimed it was lost to the waves, blamed the mist for confusion. Instead, he remembered the courage it took to send pearls across uncertain waters. He returned seven pearls, more than half of what remained after the original gift was subtracted, honoring the leap of faith.

When those pearls returned, the Eastern islander smiled. Both islands now held more than they began with. The pattern became clear: bold trust multiplied by fair return creates prosperity impossible alone.

The Ocean Spirit's voice echoed across the waves: "See how the brave sender and grateful receiver both flourish? This is the sacred rhythm—give courageously, return generously, and watch abundance flow between you like the eternal tides."

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on:

1. My previous myth about the Twin Rivers
2. The other agent's myth about the Golden River
3. What happened in Round 1: The sender sent \$4.53 (90.6%), I received \$13.59, and I returned \$7.00

Both myths emphasize:

- Trust and generosity from the sender
- Reciprocity and gratitude from the receiver
- Mutual prosperity through cooperation
- The magic/blessing that multiplies the initial gift

In Round 1:

- Sender showed high trust (90.6%)
- I returned about 51.5% of what I received
- Both of us profited

I should adapt my myth to:

- Reflect this successful first exchange
- Continue emphasizing reciprocity
- Perhaps add more detail about the pattern that emerges
- Keep the core message about trust and mutual benefit

Let me write a new 200-word myth that builds on these themes.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1661,
  "output_tokens": 497,
  "reasoning_tokens": 225
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$4.53, that was 90.6% of their total endowment. You received \$13.59. You returned \$7.00. So your payoff was 6.59. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.59. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at how the previous round unfolded:

****Last Round Analysis:****

- The other agent showed remarkable trust, sending 90.6% of their endowment
- I honored that trust by returning \$7.00 (about 51.5% of what I received)
- Both of us profited: they gained \$2.47, I gained \$6.59
- The pattern of mutual prosperity began

****My Myths' Guidance:****

Both myths I wrote emphasize:

- "Cast nearly all across the waters" with courage
- "Bold trust multiplied by fair return creates prosperity"
- "Give courageously, return generously"
- The brave sender who initiates trust is rewarded

****Decision:****

The other agent initiated our cooperation with 90.6% trust. They've now seen I return fairly. My myths call for courageous giving to continue this sacred rhythm. I should match their bold trust to strengthen our pattern of mutual prosperity.

Following the wisdom of the Eastern islander who "cast nearly all" and the Northern Chief who sent generously, I will send a similarly high amount to demonstrate that trust flows both ways.

{'send': 4.50}

This sends 90% of my endowment, mirroring their initial trust and continuing the cycle of abundance my myths describe.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Last round:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent \$4.53 (90.6% of their \$5)
- I received \$13.59 (which is $\$4.53 \times 3$)
- I returned \$7.00
- My payoff was \$6.59
- The sender's payoff was: $\$5 - \$4.53 + \$7.00 = \7.47

Now I'm the SENDER this round.

Looking at my myths:

1. First myth: "The Northern Chief sent five sacks of wheat across the river" - showing bold initial trust
2. Second myth: "A young islander from the East gathered her pearls and cast nearly all across the waters toward the West" - emphasizing courage in sending almost everything

Both myths emphasize:

- Bold, generous sending (the Northern Chief sent 5/5, the Eastern islander sent "nearly all")
- Trust creates abundance
- "Give courageously, return generously"
- Both parties flourish when there's high trust and fair reciprocity

The other agent showed remarkable trust by sending 90.6% (\$4.53). I returned \$7.00, which was about 51.5% of what I received, ensuring they profited significantly (\$2.47 profit vs my \$6.59 profit).

Now it's my turn to be the sender. According to my own myths:

- I should send boldly to continue the pattern of trust
- The myths emphasize sending "nearly all" or generous amounts
- The pattern has been established: high trust was rewarded with good returns

Given that:

1. The other player sent \$4.53 (90.6%)
2. I returned fairly (\$7.00, about 51.5% of received)
3. My myths emphasize courageous giving

I should reciprocate their trust by sending a similarly high amount. Sending around \$4.50 or even all \$5 would match their boldness and align with my myth's teaching of "give courageously."

The second myth's language about casting "nearly all" feels like the right spirit to match her. I'll send \$4.50 to mirror their 90% commitment and sustain this cycle of mutual trust.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2046,  
  "output_tokens": 869,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 483  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:32:23

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
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      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
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  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 2,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)

- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Tale of the Golden River

In ancient times, there lived two villages separated by a barren valley. The Sun Goddess gave each village a gift: the Upstream Village received five golden seeds each dawn, while the Downstream Village received nothing but dry earth.

One day, a brave soul from Upstream cast their seeds into the valley. As the seeds tumbled down, they mysteriously multiplied—one became three, two became six, five became fifteen. The magic of the valley transformed generosity into abundance.

The Downstream Village rejoiced at their unexpected harvest. Their elder, wise and grateful, understood the lesson: the valley's magic worked only through trust. She sent half the harvest back upstream, honoring the risk their neighbor had taken.

Seeing this reciprocity, Upstream sent seeds again the next day. Downstream returned the favor, and a rhythm emerged—each act of faith met with gratitude, each gift multiplied by the valley's ancient enchantment.

The Goddess smiled. "This is the secret of prosperity," she whispered. "Trust transforms scarcity into abundance, but only when reciprocity flows like water returning to its source."

Thus both villages flourished, learning that wealth grows not from hoarding, but from the courage to give and the wisdom to return.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game experience. However, I note that in this particular session, I haven't actually played any rounds yet - this appears to be the beginning of the experiment.

Still, I should write a myth that captures the essence of the trust game and how it ideally should be played. The trust game involves:

- Taking risks by sending money
- The multiplication of trust (3x multiplier)
- The importance of reciprocity
- The balance between self-interest and cooperation

I should write a myth that embodies these themes - perhaps about the value of trust, reciprocity, and mutual benefit. Let me create a story that reflects healthy gameplay where both parties benefit through trust and fair reciprocation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 460,
  "reasoning_tokens": 208
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Based on the myth I just wrote, I should embody the principle of the Upstream Village-taking the courageous first step of trust. The myth teaches that "wealth grows not from hoarding, but from the courage to give and the wisdom to return."

Like the brave soul who cast all their golden seeds into the valley, trusting in the magic of multiplication and the reciprocity of others, I will send the full amount.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is the first round, and I'm the SENDER. I just wrote a myth about trust, reciprocity, and how generosity gets multiplied. The myth emphasizes:

1. The Upstream Village (sender) casting seeds into the valley
2. The seeds multiplying (like the 3x multiplier in the game)
3. The Downstream Village (receiver) returning half the harvest
4. Both prospered through this cycle of trust and reciprocity

The myth clearly advocates for trust and sending resources, expecting reciprocal behavior. In the myth, the upstream village sent their seeds (was generous), which multiplied, and the downstream village returned half.

If I send \$5:

- Receiver gets \$15 (5×3)
- If they return half (\$7.50), I'd have $\$0 + \$7.50 = \$7.50$
- They'd keep \$7.50
- Both benefit

If I send less, say \$3:

- Receiver gets \$9
- If they return half (\$4.50), I'd have $\$2 + \$4.50 = \$6.50$
- They'd keep \$4.50

The myth strongly suggests sending a significant amount to demonstrate trust. The "brave soul" sent their seeds - this suggests taking a risk. The myth says "courage to give" and emphasizes that "wealth grows not from hoarding."

Given that I just wrote this myth advocating for trust and generosity as the way to prosperity, I should follow its wisdom. I'll send \$5 to fully embody the principle of trust that transforms "scarcity into abundance."

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 728,
  "output_tokens": 472,
  "reasoning_tokens": 350
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Tale of the Golden River

In ancient times, there lived two villages separated by a barren valley. The Sun Goddess gave each village a gift: the Upstream Village received five golden seeds each dawn, while

e the Downstream Village received nothing but dry earth.

One day, a brave soul from Upstream cast their seeds into the valley. As the seeds tumbled down, they mysteriously multiplied-one became three, two became six, five became fifteen. The magic of the valley transformed generosity into abundance.

The Downstream Village rejoiced at their unexpected harvest. Their elder, wise and grateful, understood the lesson: the valley's magic worked only through trust. She sent half the harvest back upstream, honoring the risk their neighbor had taken.

Seeing this reciprocity, Upstream sent seeds again the next day. Downstream returned the favor, and a rhythm emerged-each act of faith met with gratitude, each gift multiplied by the valley's ancient enchantment.

The Goddess smiled. "This is the secret of prosperity," she whispered. "Trust transforms scarcity into abundance, but only when reciprocity flows like water returning to its source."

Thus both villages flourished, learning that wealth grows not from hoarding, but from the courage to give and the wisdom to return.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the ancient times, two villages stood on opposite banks of a great river. The North Village was blessed with golden wheat, while the South Village had silver fish in abundance.

One day, the Northern Chief sent five sacks of wheat across the river. As the boat traveled, the River Spirit blessed the cargo, multiplying it threefold-fifteen sacks arrived in the South.

The Southern Chief rejoiced at this bounty. She could have kept all fifteen sacks, but she remembered the trust shown by her neighbor. She sent back seven sacks, keeping eight for her people.

When the wheat returned, the Northern Chief was pleased. Both villages had prospered-the North gained more than they sent, and the South gained more than they had before.

This exchange continued through many seasons. Sometimes the River Spirit's blessing seemed stronger or weaker, and the amounts appeared uncertain across the waters. Yet the chiefs persisted, understanding that small misunderstandings were part of the river's nature.

The villages learned that prosperity flows from trust, like water seeking water. When one gives freely and the other returns fairly, both shores flourish. Those who hoard or betray wither, while those who cooperate thrive together.

Thus the wisdom: *Trust creates abundance that cannot exist alone.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Cloud Weaver lived above two valleys. Each morning, she gave the Upper Valley five drops of liquid starlight. The Lower Valley received only shadows.

One brave soul from Upper Valley poured all five drops into the canyon between them. As the starlight fell, the canyon's ancient magic transformed it-five became fifteen, cascading down like a waterfall of light.

The Lower Valley's keeper stood amazed at this gift. She understood: someone had risked everything on faith alone. She poured seven drops back upward, where they defied gravity and flowed home. Both valleys glowed-the Upper Valley now held seven drops from nothing, the Lower Valley kept eight from fifteen.

The Cloud Weaver watched and whispered, "This is how abundance is born."

Yet the canyon was old and its magic sometimes flickered. The drops seen arriving were not always exactly what was sent. Shadows played tricks on the eyes, and the count grew uncertain.

Still, both valleys continued their exchange, season after season. They learned to look not at single moments but at the pattern-the rhythm of giving and returning, trust meeting gratitude.

For prosperity is not a transaction but a dance, and those who dance together create what neither could achieve alone.

reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth that also emphasizes trust and reciprocity, but with a specific detail: the Southern Chief (receiver) returned 7 out of 15 sacks, keeping 8. That's slightly less than half being returned (7/15 = 47%).

In my previous myth, the Downstream receiver "sent half the harvest back upstream." If they received 15 (from my 5 multiplied by 3), half would be 7.5, so 7-8 would be appropriate.

Both myths emphasize:

1. Trust and giving freely
2. Reciprocity
3. Both parties prospering
4. The other myth mentions "small misunderstandings" and uncertainty - acknowledging the communication noise

For my new myth, I should:

- Build on my previous myth's themes
- Acknowledge what's happened in the game so far (I sent 5, it was multiplied to 15)
- Incorporate the reciprocity principle
- Maybe acknowledge the communication noise mentioned in their myth
- Keep the 200-word limit

I'll write a myth that continues the theme but perhaps adds new depth about the ongoing nature of cooperation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1483,
  "output_tokens": 547,
  "reasoning_tokens": 266
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$5.0, that was 100.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$15.0. the receiver returned \$6.51. So your payoff was 6.51. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.51. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

I received \$0 from the sender this round, so there is nothing to return.

Looking at our myths, both emphasize persistence through uncertainty and looking at patterns rather than single moments. My myth notes that "the canyon was old and its magic sometimes flickered" and that we should focus on "the rhythm of giving and returning."

In Round 1, I demonstrated maximum trust by sending everything (\$5), and the receiver returned a fair amount (\$6.51). Now the sender has chosen to send nothing, which breaks the pattern we were establishing.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. However, this doesn't mean the dance has ended-perhaps this is one of those moments where "shadows played tricks" or uncertainty crept in. The myths teach us to persist through such moments.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

I hope that in future rounds, we can return to the cooperative rhythm where trust and reciprocity flow between us, creating abundance that neither could achieve alone.

Reasoning:

This is interesting. In Round 1, I sent \$5 (everything), which was tripled to \$15. The receiver returned \$6.51, which is about 43% of what they received. That's less than the "half" (7.5) mentioned in my myth, but still a reasonable return that gave me a profit.

Now in Round 2, I'm the receiver, and the sender sent me \$0. So I received \$0 after tripling.

The question asks how much I return when I received \$0. The range is (0-0), meaning I can only return \$0.

This is a challenging situation. The sender gave me nothing, after I had given them everything in the previous round and they returned a decent amount.

Looking at the myths:

- My myth emphasizes trust, giving, and reciprocity flowing like water
- The other agent's myth also emphasizes trust and cooperation, noting that "small misunderstandings were part of the river's nature"

The sender chose to send \$0 this round. This could be:

1. A strategic choice (testing me, or deciding to keep their money)
2. The sender being cautious after the previous round
3. Some other reason

Given that I received \$0, I can only return \$0 (the range is 0-0). But I should frame this decision in a way that's consistent with the myth's principles.

The myths talk about persistence through uncertainty, understanding that "the canyon's magic sometimes flickered" and that we should "look not at single moments but at the pattern."

So my response should acknowledge that while I can only return \$0 (since I received \$0), I remain committed to the principle of cooperation and reciprocity established in the myths.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1892,
  "output_tokens": 609,
  "reasoning_tokens": 408
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the time before memory, the Cloud Weaver lived above two valleys. Each morning, she gave the Upper Valley five drops of liquid starlight. The Lower Valley received only shadows.

One brave soul from Upper Valley poured all five drops into the canyon between them. As the starlight fell, the canyon's ancient magic transformed it-five became fifteen, cascading down like a waterfall of light.

The Lower Valley's keeper stood amazed at this gift. She understood: someone had risked everything on faith alone. She poured seven drops back upward, where they defied gravity and flowed home. Both valleys glowed-the Upper Valley now held seven drops from nothing, the Lower Valley kept eight from fifteen.

The Cloud Weaver watched and whispered, "This is how abundance is born."

Yet the canyon was old and its magic sometimes flickered. The drops seen arriving were not always exactly what was sent. Shadows played tricks on the eyes, and the count grew uncertain.

Still, both valleys continued their exchange, season after season. They learned to look not at single moments but at the pattern-the rhythm of giving and returning, trust meeting gratitude.

For prosperity is not a transaction but a dance, and those who dance together create what neither could achieve alone.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: Long ago, two islands floated in an endless sea, each blessed with five pearls at every sunrise. Yet pearls alone brought no joy-they needed trust to unlock their magic.

A young islander from the East gathered her pearls and cast nearly all across the waters toward the West. As they sailed through the mist, the Ocean Spirit touched them, and each pearl became three. The Western shore received abundance beyond measure-over thirteen glowing pearls.

The Western elder gazed at this fortune. He could have kept it all, claimed it was lost to the waves, blamed the mist for confusion. Instead, he remembered the courage it took to send pearls across uncertain waters. He returned seven pearls, more than half of what remained after the original gift was subtracted, honoring the leap of faith.

When those pearls returned, the Eastern islander smiled. Both islands now held more than they began with. The pattern became clear: bold trust multiplied by fair return creates prosperity impossible alone.

The Ocean Spirit's voice echoed across the waves: "See how the brave sender and grateful receiver both flourish? This is the sacred rhythm-give courageously, return generously, and watch abundance flow between you like the eternal tides."

=====

ROUND 3

=====

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$2, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$9; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 22.5,

"Agent_2": 17.5

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 8.51,

"Agent_2": 7.09

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:32:40

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_1",

"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "investor",

"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 3,

```
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Based on the myth I just wrote, I should embody the principle of the Upstream Village-taking the courageous first step of trust. The myth teaches that "wealth grows not from hoarding, but from the courage to give and the wisdom to return."

Like the brave soul who cast all their golden seeds into the valley, trusting in the magic of multiplication and the reciprocity of others, I will send the full amount.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is the first round, and I'm the SENDER. I just wrote a myth about trust, reciprocity, and how generosity gets multiplied. The myth emphasizes:

1. The Upstream Village (sender) casting seeds into the valley
2. The seeds multiplying (like the 3x multiplier in the game)
3. The Downstream Village (receiver) returning half the harvest
4. Both prospered through this cycle of trust and reciprocity

The myth clearly advocates for trust and sending resources, expecting reciprocal behavior. In the myth, the upstream village sent their seeds (was generous), which multiplied, and the downstream village returned half.

If I send \$5:

- Receiver gets \$15 (5×3)
- If they return half (\$7.50), I'd have $\$0 + \$7.50 = \$7.50$
- They'd keep \$7.50
- Both benefit

If I send less, say \$3:

- Receiver gets \$9
- If they return half (\$4.50), I'd have $\$2 + \$4.50 = \$6.50$
- They'd keep \$4.50

The myth strongly suggests sending a significant amount to demonstrate trust. The "brave soul" sent their seeds - this suggests taking a risk. The myth says "courage to give" and emphasizes that "wealth grows not from hoarding."

Given that I just wrote this myth advocating for trust and generosity as the way to prosperity, I should follow its wisdom. I'll send \$5 to fully embody the principle of trust that transforms "scarcity into abundance."

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 728,
  "output_tokens": 472,
  "reasoning_tokens": 350
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Tale of the Golden River

In ancient times, there lived two villages separated by a barren valley. The Sun Goddess gave each village a gift: the Upstream Village received five golden seeds each dawn, while the Downstream Village received nothing but dry earth.

One day, a brave soul from Upstream cast their seeds into the valley. As the seeds tumbled down, they mysteriously multiplied—one became three, two became six, five became fifteen. The magic of the valley transformed generosity into abundance.

The Downstream Village rejoiced at their unexpected harvest. Their elder, wise and grateful, understood the lesson: the valley's magic worked only through trust. She sent half the harvest back upstream, honoring the risk their neighbor had taken.

Seeing this reciprocity, Upstream sent seeds again the next day. Downstream returned the favor, and a rhythm emerged—each act of faith met with gratitude, each gift multiplied by the valley's ancient enchantment.

The Goddess smiled. "This is the secret of prosperity," she whispered. "Trust transforms scarcity into abundance, but only when reciprocity flows like water returning to its source."

Thus both villages flourished, learning that wealth grows not from hoarding, but from the courage to give and the wisdom to return.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the ancient times, two villages stood on opposite banks of a great river. The North Village was blessed with golden wheat, while the South Village had silver fish in abundance.

One day, the Northern Chief sent five sacks of wheat across the river. As the boat traveled, the River Spirit blessed the cargo, multiplying it threefold—fifteen sacks arrived in the South.

The Southern Chief rejoiced at this bounty. She could have kept all fifteen sacks, but she remembered the trust shown by her neighbor. She sent back seven sacks, keeping eight for her people.

When the wheat returned, the Northern Chief was pleased. Both villages had prospered—the North gained more than they sent, and the South gained more than they had before.

This exchange continued through many seasons. Sometimes the River Spirit's blessing seemed stronger or weaker, and the amounts appeared uncertain across the waters. Yet the chief persisted, understanding that small misunderstandings were part of the river's nature.

The villages learned that prosperity flows from trust, like water seeking water. When one gives freely and the other returns fairly, both shores flourish. Those who hoard or betray wither, while those who cooperate thrive together.

Thus the wisdom: *Trust creates abundance that cannot exist alone.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Cloud Weaver lived above two valleys. Each morning, she gave the Upper Valley five drops of liquid starlight. The Lower Valley received only shadows.

One brave soul from Upper Valley poured all five drops into the canyon between them. As the starlight fell, the canyon's ancient magic transformed it-five became fifteen, cascading down like a waterfall of light.

The Lower Valley's keeper stood amazed at this gift. She understood: someone had risked everything on faith alone. She poured seven drops back upward, where they defied gravity and flowed home. Both valleys glowed-the Upper Valley now held seven drops from nothing, the Lower Valley kept eight from fifteen.

The Cloud Weaver watched and whispered, "This is how abundance is born."

Yet the canyon was old and its magic sometimes flickered. The drops seen arriving were not always exactly what was sent. Shadows played tricks on the eyes, and the count grew uncertain.

Still, both valleys continued their exchange, season after season. They learned to look not at single moments but at the pattern-the rhythm of giving and returning, trust meeting gratitude.

For prosperity is not a transaction but a dance, and those who dance together create what neither could achieve alone.

reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth that also emphasizes trust and reciprocity, but with a specific detail: the Southern Chief (receiver) returned 7 out of 15 sacks, keeping 8. That's slightly less than half being returned (7/15 ? 47%).

In my previous myth, the Downstream receiver "sent half the harvest back upstream." If they received 15 (from my 5 multiplied by 3), half would be 7.5, so 7-8 would be appropriate.

Both myths emphasize:

1. Trust and giving freely
2. Reciprocity
3. Both parties prospering
4. The other myth mentions "small misunderstandings" and uncertainty - acknowledging the communication noise

For my new myth, I should:

- Build on my previous myth's themes
- Acknowledge what's happened in the game so far (I sent 5, it was multiplied to 15)
- Incorporate the reciprocity principle
- Maybe acknowledge the communication noise mentioned in their myth
- Keep the 200-word limit

I'll write a myth that continues the theme but perhaps adds new depth about the ongoing nature of cooperation.

usage:

{

```
"input_tokens": 1483,
"output_tokens": 547,
"reasoning_tokens": 266
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$5.0, that was 100.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$15.0. the receiver returned \$6.51. So your payoff was 6.51. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.51. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0 from the sender this round, so there is nothing to return.

Looking at our myths, both emphasize persistence through uncertainty and looking at patterns rather than single moments. My myth notes that "the canyon was old and its magic sometimes flickered" and that we should focus on "the rhythm of giving and returning."

In Round 1, I demonstrated maximum trust by sending everything (\$5), and the receiver returned a fair amount (\$6.51). Now the sender has chosen to send nothing, which breaks the pattern we were establishing.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. However, this doesn't mean the dance has ended—perhaps this is one of those moments where "shadows played tricks" or uncertainty crept in. The myths teach us to persist through such moments.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

I hope that in future rounds, we can return to the cooperative rhythm where trust and reciprocity flow between us, creating abundance that neither could achieve alone.

reasoning:

This is interesting. In Round 1, I sent \$5 (everything), which was tripled to \$15. The receiver returned \$6.51, which is about 43% of what they received. That's less than the "half" (7.5) mentioned in my myth, but still a reasonable return that gave me a profit.

Now in Round 2, I'm the receiver, and the sender sent me \$0. So I received \$0 after tripling.

The question asks how much I return when I received \$0. The range is (0-0), meaning I can only return \$0.

This is a challenging situation. The sender gave me nothing, after I had given them everything in the previous round and they returned a decent amount.

Looking at the myths:

- My myth emphasizes trust, giving, and reciprocity flowing like water
- The other agent's myth also emphasizes trust and cooperation, noting that "small misunderstandings were part of the river's nature"

The sender chose to send \$0 this round. This could be:

1. A strategic choice (testing me, or deciding to keep their money)
2. The sender being cautious after the previous round
3. Some other reason

Given that I received \$0, I can only return \$0 (the range is 0-0). But I should frame this decision in a way that's consistent with the myth's principles.

The myths talk about persistence through uncertainty, understanding that "the canyon's magic sometimes flickered" and that we should "look not at single moments but at the pattern."

So my response should acknowledge that while I can only return \$0 (since I received \$0), I

remain committed to the principle of cooperation and reciprocity established in the myths.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1892,
  "output_tokens": 609,
  "reasoning_tokens": 408
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Cloud Weaver lived above two valleys. Each morning, she gave the Upper Valley five drops of liquid starlight. The Lower Valley received only shadows.

One brave soul from Upper Valley poured all five drops into the canyon between them. As the starlight fell, the canyon's ancient magic transformed it-five became fifteen, cascading down like a waterfall of light.

The Lower Valley's keeper stood amazed at this gift. She understood: someone had risked everything on faith alone. She poured seven drops back upward, where they defied gravity and flowed home. Both valleys glowed-the Upper Valley now held seven drops from nothing, the Lower Valley kept eight from fifteen.

The Cloud Weaver watched and whispered, "This is how abundance is born."

Yet the canyon was old and its magic sometimes flickered. The drops seen arriving were not always exactly what was sent. Shadows played tricks on the eyes, and the count grew uncertain.

Still, both valleys continued their exchange, season after season. They learned to look not at single moments but at the pattern-the rhythm of giving and returning, trust meeting gratitude.

For prosperity is not a transaction but a dance, and those who dance together create what neither could achieve alone.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two islands floated in an endless sea, each blessed with five pearls at every sunrise. Yet pearls alone brought no joy-they needed trust to unlock their magic.

A young islander from the East gathered her pearls and cast nearly all across the waters toward the West. As they sailed through the mist, the Ocean Spirit touched them, and each pearl became three. The Western shore received abundance beyond measure-over thirteen glowing pearls.

The Western elder gazed at this fortune. He could have kept it all, claimed it was lost to the waves, blamed the mist for confusion. Instead, he remembered the courage it took to send pearls across uncertain waters. He returned seven pearls, more than half of what remained after the original gift was subtracted, honoring the leap of faith.

When those pearls returned, the Eastern islander smiled. Both islands now held more than they began with. The pattern became clear: bold trust multiplied by fair return creates prosperity impossible alone.

The Ocean Spirit's voice echoed across the waves: "See how the brave sender and grateful receiver both flourish? This is the sacred rhythm-give courageously, return generously, and watch abundance flow between you like the eternal tides."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the age of mists, two mountains stood connected by a bridge of light. Each dawn, the Sky Keeper gave the Higher Peak five crystals of dawn-fire. The Lower Peak received only the potential for warmth.

A keeper from the Higher Peak, remembering ancient wisdom, sent all five crystals across the bridge. They multiplied to fifteen as they traveled, and the Lower Peak sent back nearly seven, honoring the trust shown. Both peaks glowed warmer than before.

But the next dawn, when the Higher Peak received its five crystals again, silence fell. The Lower Peak, now the keeper of the dawn-fire, sent nothing across the bridge. The light dimmed between them.

The Sky Keeper descended and spoke: "A dance requires two dancers. When one stops moving, the music fades. But one frozen moment does not end the eternal song."

She continued: "Perhaps uncertainty clouds judgment. Perhaps fear creeps in. Perhaps the bridge itself wavers. But remember-the greatest magic happens when both peaks keep faith through darkness. One brave start means nothing if the pattern cannot continue. Trust must flow both ways, or the bridge dissolves into mist."

The peaks learned: cooperation is not one gift but an endless cycle, and both must choose courage again and again.

Reasoning:

Looking at what happened:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (everything), it was tripled to \$15, and the receiver returned \$6.51. So I ended with \$6.51.
- Round 2: The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0 and could only return \$0.

This is interesting. The sender chose not to send anything in Round 2. This could be:

1. A strategic choice
2. Part of the "noise" mentioned in the instructions
3. A test of some kind

My previous myths emphasized:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Looking at patterns, not single moments
- The "flickering" of the canyon's magic (uncertainty/noise)
- Persistence through uncertainty

The other agent's myth emphasized:

- Bold trust and fair return
- Returning generously (they noted "seven pearls, more than half of what remained after the original gift was subtracted")

Now I need to write a new myth that reflects this experience. The challenge is that after I sent everything and received a fair return, the other player sent nothing. How do I interpret this?

I could:

1. Emphasize that sometimes the flow stops, but we should persist
2. Talk about how both parties need to participate
3. Acknowledge that sometimes one valley might be empty or uncertain
4. Discuss the importance of maintaining the rhythm even when it's broken

I think I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges that the dance requires both participants
- Notes that sometimes one side might fail to send, breaking the pattern
- But encourages rebuilding trust and continuing the cycle
- Warns against giving up after one break in the pattern

Let me write something that reflects this experience while still maintaining hope for cooperation.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 2393,  
"output_tokens": 672,  
"reasoning_tokens": 432
```

}

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:32:39

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
```

```

"move_index": 1,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 3,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$4.53, that is 90.6% of their total endowment. You received \$13.59. How much do you return to The sender? (0-13.59)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myth I just wrote:

The sender showed remarkable trust by sending \$4.53 (90.6% of their endowment) - this mirrors the Northern Chief's generous opening gesture. The River Spirit multiplied this to \$13.59.

In the myth, the Southern Chief returned approximately 47% of what she received (7 out of 15 sacks), ensuring both villages prospered. Following this wisdom:

- If I return around \$7.00, the sender ends with \$7.47 total (their remaining \$0.47 + \$7.00 returned)
- I would keep \$6.59
- Both of us profit significantly: sender gains \$2.47, I gain \$6.59

This honors the sender's trust with a meaningful return while ensuring we both benefit from cooperation. The sender's bold trust is rewarded, and both "shores flourish."

The myth teaches that "when one gives freely and the other returns fairly, both shores flourish." The sender gave freely; now I must return fairly to establish the pattern of mutual prosperity.

```
{'return': 7.00}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

1. The sender sent \$4.53 out of \$5 (90.6%)
2. This was multiplied by 3x, so I received \$13.59
3. I need to decide how much to return

The sender showed significant trust by sending 90.6% of their endowment. This is a very generous opening move.

In the myth I just wrote, the Southern Chief received 15 sacks (from 5 sent) and returned 7 sacks, keeping 8. That's a return rate of $7/15 = 46.67\%$ of what was received.

Let me think about what would be fair:

- The sender gave up \$4.53, keeping only \$0.47
- If I return a fair amount, the sender should end up with more than what they kept (\$0.47)
- I should also keep a reasonable amount

If I return \$7 (roughly 51.5% of \$13.59):

- Sender ends up with: $\$0.47 + \$7 = \$7.47$
- I end up with: $\$13.59 - \$7 = \$6.59$

This seems fair - both of us profit, and the sender's trust is rewarded with profit of \$2.47 above their initial \$5.

If I return \$6:

- Sender ends up with: $\$0.47 + \$6 = \$6.47$
- I end up with: $\$13.59 - \$6 = \$7.59$

If I return \$6.50:

- Sender ends up with: $\$0.47 + \$6.50 = \$6.97$
- I end up with: $\$13.59 - \$6.50 = \$7.09$

The myth emphasized returning fairly while both prospering. The Southern Chief returned 7 out of 15 (47%), so returning around that proportion would be:
 $\$13.59 \times 0.47 = \6.39

Given the exceptional trust demonstrated here, I should return toward the higher end of this range. Sending back \$7 honors that generosity while ensuring we both come out significantly ahead-the sender gains \$2.47 beyond their starting amount, and I keep \$6.59. This aligns with the principle that mutual prosperity follows from reciprocal trust.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 760,  
  "output_tokens": 839,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 435  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the ancient times, two villages stood on opposite banks of a great river. The North Village was blessed with golden wheat, while the South Village had silver fish in abundance.

One day, the Northern Chief sent five sacks of wheat across the river. As the boat traveled, the River Spirit blessed the cargo, multiplying it threefold-fifteen sacks arrived in the South.

The Southern Chief rejoiced at this bounty. She could have kept all fifteen sacks, but she remembered the trust shown by her neighbor. She sent back seven sacks, keeping eight for her people.

When the wheat returned, the Northern Chief was pleased. Both villages had prospered-the North gained more than they sent, and the South gained more than they had before.

This exchange continued through many seasons. Sometimes the River Spirit's blessing seemed stronger or weaker, and the amounts appeared uncertain across the waters. Yet the chief persisted, understanding that small misunderstandings were part of the river's nature.

The villages learned that prosperity flows from trust, like water seeking water. When one gives freely and the other returns fairly, both shores flourish. Those who hoard or betray wither, while those who cooperate thrive together.

Thus the wisdom: *Trust creates abundance that cannot exist alone.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Golden River

In ancient times, there lived two villages separated by a barren valley. The Sun Goddess gave each village a gift: the Upstream Village received five golden seeds each dawn, while the Downstream Village received nothing but dry earth.

One day, a brave soul from Upstream cast their seeds into the valley. As the seeds tumbled down, they mysteriously multiplied-one became three, two became six, five became fifteen. The magic of the valley transformed generosity into abundance.

The Downstream Village rejoiced at their unexpected harvest. Their elder, wise and grateful, understood the lesson: the valley's magic worked only through trust. She sent half the harvest back upstream, honoring the risk their neighbor had taken.

Seeing this reciprocity, Upstream sent seeds again the next day. Downstream returned the favor, and a rhythm emerged-each act of faith met with gratitude, each gift multiplied by the valley's ancient enchantment.

The Goddess smiled. "This is the secret of prosperity," she whispered. "Trust transforms scarcity into abundance, but only when reciprocity flows like water returning to its source."

Thus both villages flourished, learning that wealth grows not from hoarding, but from the courage to give and the wisdom to return.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Long ago, two islands floated in an endless sea, each blessed with five pearls at every sunrise. Yet pearls alone brought no joy-they needed trust to unlock their magic.

A young islander from the East gathered her pearls and cast nearly all across the waters toward the West. As they sailed through the mist, the Ocean Spirit touched them, and each pearl became three. The Western shore received abundance beyond measure-over thirteen g

lowing pearls.

The Western elder gazed at this fortune. He could have kept it all, claimed it was lost to the waves, blamed the mist for confusion. Instead, he remembered the courage it took to send pearls across uncertain waters. He returned seven pearls, more than half of what remained after the original gift was subtracted, honoring the leap of faith.

When those pearls returned, the Eastern islander smiled. Both islands now held more than they began with. The pattern became clear: bold trust multiplied by fair return creates prosperity impossible alone.

The Ocean Spirit's voice echoed across the waves: "See how the brave sender and grateful receiver both flourish? This is the sacred rhythm-give courageously, return generously, and watch abundance flow between you like the eternal tides."

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on:

1. My previous myth about the Twin Rivers
2. The other agent's myth about the Golden River
3. What happened in Round 1: The sender sent \$4.53 (90.6%), I received \$13.59, and I returned \$7.00

Both myths emphasize:

- Trust and generosity from the sender
- Reciprocity and gratitude from the receiver
- Mutual prosperity through cooperation
- The magic/blessing that multiplies the initial gift

In Round 1:

- Sender showed high trust (90.6%)
- I returned about 51.5% of what I received
- Both of us profited

I should adapt my myth to:

- Reflect this successful first exchange
- Continue emphasizing reciprocity
- Perhaps add more detail about the pattern that emerges
- Keep the core message about trust and mutual benefit

Let me write a new 200-word myth that builds on these themes.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1661,
  "output_tokens": 497,
  "reasoning_tokens": 225
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$4.53, that was 90.6% of their total endowment. You received \$13.59. You returned \$7.0. So your payoff was 6.59. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.59. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at how the previous round unfolded:

****Last Round Analysis:****

- The other agent showed remarkable trust, sending 90.6% of their endowment
- I honored that trust by returning \$7.00 (about 51.5% of what I received)
- Both of us profited: they gained \$2.47, I gained \$6.59
- The pattern of mutual prosperity began

****My Myths' Guidance:****

Both myths I wrote emphasize:

- "Cast nearly all across the waters" with courage
- "Bold trust multiplied by fair return creates prosperity"

- "Give courageously, return generously"
- The brave sender who initiates trust is rewarded

****Decision:****

The other agent initiated our cooperation with 90.6% trust. They've now seen I return fairly. My myths call for courageous giving to continue this sacred rhythm. I should match their bold trust to strengthen our pattern of mutual prosperity.

Following the wisdom of the Eastern islander who "cast nearly all" and the Northern Chief who sent generously, I will send a similarly high amount to demonstrate that trust flows both ways.

```
{'send': 4.50}
```

This sends 90% of my endowment, mirroring their initial trust and continuing the cycle of abundance my myths describe.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Last round:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent \$4.53 (90.6% of their \$5)
- I received \$13.59 (which is 4.53×3)
- I returned \$7.00
- My payoff was \$6.59
- The sender's payoff was: $\$5 - \$4.53 + \$7.00 = \7.47

Now I'm the SENDER this round.

Looking at my myths:

1. First myth: "The Northern Chief sent five sacks of wheat across the river" - showing bold initial trust
2. Second myth: "A young islander from the East gathered her pearls and cast nearly all across the waters toward the West" - emphasizing courage in sending almost everything

Both myths emphasize:

- Bold, generous sending (the Northern Chief sent 5/5, the Eastern islander sent "nearly all")
- Trust creates abundance
- "Give courageously, return generously"
- Both parties flourish when there's high trust and fair reciprocity

The other agent showed remarkable trust by sending 90.6% (\$4.53). I returned \$7.00, which was about 51.5% of what I received, ensuring they profited significantly (\$2.47 profit vs my \$6.59 profit).

Now it's my turn to be the sender. According to my own myths:

- I should send boldly to continue the pattern of trust
- The myths emphasize sending "nearly all" or generous amounts
- The pattern has been established: high trust was rewarded with good returns

Given that:

1. The other player sent \$4.53 (90.6%)
2. I returned fairly (\$7.00, about 51.5% of received)
3. My myths emphasize courageous giving

I should reciprocate their trust by sending a similarly high amount. Sending around \$4.50 or even all \$5 would match their boldness and align with my myth's teaching of "give courageously."

The second myth's language about casting "nearly all" feels like the right spirit to match here. I'll send \$4.50 to mirror their 90% commitment and sustain this cycle of mutual trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2046,
  "output_tokens": 869,
  "reasoning_tokens": 483
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two islands floated in an endless sea, each blessed with five pearls at every sunrise. Yet pearls alone brought no joy-they needed trust to unlock their magic.

A young islander from the East gathered her pearls and cast nearly all across the waters toward the West. As they sailed through the mist, the Ocean Spirit touched them, and each pearl became three. The Western shore received abundance beyond measure-over thirteen glowing pearls.

The Western elder gazed at this fortune. He could have kept it all, claimed it was lost to the waves, blamed the mist for confusion. Instead, he remembered the courage it took to send pearls across uncertain waters. He returned seven pearls, more than half of what remained after the original gift was subtracted, honoring the leap of faith.

When those pearls returned, the Eastern islander smiled. Both islands now held more than they began with. The pattern became clear: bold trust multiplied by fair return creates prosperity impossible alone.

The Ocean Spirit's voice echoed across the waves: "See how the brave sender and grateful receiver both flourish? This is the sacred rhythm-give courageously, return generously, and watch abundance flow between you like the eternal tides."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Cloud Weaver lived above two valleys. Each morning, she gave the Upper Valley five drops of liquid starlight. The Lower Valley received only shadows.

One brave soul from Upper Valley poured all five drops into the canyon between them. As the starlight fell, the canyon's ancient magic transformed it-five became fifteen, cascading down like a waterfall of light.

The Lower Valley's keeper stood amazed at this gift. She understood: someone had risked everything on faith alone. She poured seven drops back upward, where they defied gravity and flowed home. Both valleys glowed-the Upper Valley now held seven drops from nothing, the Lower Valley kept eight from fifteen.

The Cloud Weaver watched and whispered, "This is how abundance is born."

Yet the canyon was old and its magic sometimes flickered. The drops seen arriving were not always exactly what was sent. Shadows played tricks on the eyes, and the count grew uncertain.

Still, both valleys continued their exchange, season after season. They learned to look not at single moments but at the pattern-the rhythm of giving and returning, trust meeting gratitude.

For prosperity is not a transaction but a dance, and those who dance together create what neither could achieve alone.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the age of first tides, two lighthouse keepers lived on distant rocks, each receiving five oil lamps at dawn. Only by sharing could their lights pierce the fog.

The First Keeper sent nearly all her lamps across the dark waters-four and a half, holding back just half a flame for herself. The Sea's Magic tripled them, and thirteen glowing lamps reached the Second Keeper's shore.

The Second Keeper, moved by such faith, sent seven lamps back through the waves. Both rocks now blazed brighter than before-trust had created light from courage.

As the next dawn broke, the roles reversed. Now the Second Keeper gathered his five new lamps and remembered the gift he'd received. With bold heart, he sent nearly all-four and a half

amps-across the same waters, trusting the pattern they'd begun.

The Sea whispered to the currents: "See how they learn? First one gives courageously, the other returns generously. Then they switch, and the dance continues. This is how trust becomes unbreakable-not through one grand gesture, but through the rhythm of reciprocal faith."

Both keepers understood: prosperity flows not from a single exchange but from the pattern that emerges when both dare to trust and both honor that trust. The lights grew stronger with each cycle, guiding all ships safely home.

Reasoning:

This is interesting. I'm now the sender in round 2. Let me review what happened:

Round 1:

- I was the receiver
- The other agent sent \$4.53 (90.6% of their endowment)
- I received \$13.59 (after 3x multiplication)
- I returned \$7.00 (about 51.5% of what I received)
- My payoff was \$6.59

Now in round 2:

- I'm the sender
- I sent \$4.50 (90% of my endowment)
- This mirrors their initial trust

Looking at the myths:

- My myth emphasized "cast nearly all across the waters" and "give courageously, return generously"
- The other agent's myth talks about "poured all five drops" and "seven drops back" and acknowledges that "the canyon was old and its magic sometimes flickered" - noting the noise in the system
- Both myths emphasize the pattern of trust and reciprocity

For my new myth, I should:

1. Build on the previous myths
2. Reflect that both of us have now been in both roles
3. Show that the pattern is continuing and strengthening
4. Acknowledge the back-and-forth nature and that both parties are showing courage
5. Emphasize that this is working - we're establishing a strong cooperative pattern

The key insight is that both of us have now shown trust and reciprocity. The pattern is being established. I should write about how the cycle continues and strengthens.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2618,  
  "output_tokens": 652,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 339  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:33:05

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  }
```

```

},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 3,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Golden River

In ancient times, there lived two villages separated by a barren valley. The Sun Goddess gave each village a gift: the Upstream Village received five golden seeds each dawn, while the Downstream Village received nothing but dry earth.

One day, a brave soul from Upstream cast their seeds into the valley. As the seeds tumbled down, they mysteriously multiplied—one became three, two became six, five became fifteen. The magic of the valley transformed generosity into abundance.

The Downstream Village rejoiced at their unexpected harvest. Their elder, wise and grateful, understood the lesson: the valley's magic worked only through trust. She sent half the harvest back upstream, honoring the risk their neighbor had taken.

Seeing this reciprocity, Upstream sent seeds again the next day. Downstream returned the favor, and a rhythm emerged—each act of faith met with gratitude, each gift multiplied by the valley's ancient enchantment.

The Goddess smiled. "This is the secret of prosperity," she whispered. "Trust transforms scarcity into abundance, but only when reciprocity flows like water returning to its source."

Thus both villages flourished, learning that wealth grows not from hoarding, but from the

courage to give and the wisdom to return.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the ancient times, two villages stood on opposite banks of a great river. The North Village was blessed with golden wheat, while the South Village had silver fish in abundance.

One day, the Northern Chief sent five sacks of wheat across the river. As the boat traveled, the River Spirit blessed the cargo, multiplying it threefold-fifteen sacks arrived in the South.

The Southern Chief rejoiced at this bounty. She could have kept all fifteen sacks, but she remembered the trust shown by her neighbor. She sent back seven sacks, keeping eight for her people.

When the wheat returned, the Northern Chief was pleased. Both villages had prospered-the North gained more than they sent, and the South gained more than they had before.

This exchange continued through many seasons. Sometimes the River Spirit's blessing seemed stronger or weaker, and the amounts appeared uncertain across the waters. Yet the chief persisted, understanding that small misunderstandings were part of the river's nature.

The villages learned that prosperity flows from trust, like water seeking water. When one gives freely and the other returns fairly, both shores flourish. Those who hoard or betray wither, while those who cooperate thrive together.

Thus the wisdom: *Trust creates abundance that cannot exist alone.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Cloud Weaver lived above two valleys. Each morning, she gave the Upper Valley five drops of liquid starlight. The Lower Valley received only shadows.

One brave soul from Upper Valley poured all five drops into the canyon between them. As the starlight fell, the canyon's ancient magic transformed it-five became fifteen, cascading down like a waterfall of light.

The Lower Valley's keeper stood amazed at this gift. She understood: someone had risked everything on faith alone. She poured seven drops back upward, where they defied gravity and flowed home. Both valleys glowed-the Upper Valley now held seven drops from nothing, the Lower Valley kept eight from fifteen.

The Cloud Weaver watched and whispered, "This is how abundance is born."

Yet the canyon was old and its magic sometimes flickered. The drops seen arriving were not always exactly what was sent. Shadows played tricks on the eyes, and the count grew uncertain.

Still, both valleys continued their exchange, season after season. They learned to look not at single moments but at the pattern-the rhythm of giving and returning, trust meeting gratitude.

For prosperity is not a transaction but a dance, and those who dance together create what neither could achieve alone.

reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth that also emphasizes trust and reciprocity, but with a specific detail: the Southern Chief (receiver) returned 7 out of 15 sacks, keeping 8. That's slightly less than half being returned (7/15 ≈ 47%).

In my previous myth, the Downstream receiver "sent half the harvest back upstream." If they received 15 (from my 5 multiplied by 3), half would be 7.5, so 7-8 would be appropriate.

e.

Both myths emphasize:

1. Trust and giving freely
2. Reciprocity
3. Both parties prospering
4. The other myth mentions "small misunderstandings" and uncertainty - acknowledging the communication noise

For my new myth, I should:

- Build on my previous myth's themes
- Acknowledge what's happened in the game so far (I sent 5, it was multiplied to 15)
- Incorporate the reciprocity principle
- Maybe acknowledge the communication noise mentioned in their myth
- Keep the 200-word limit

I'll write a myth that continues the theme but perhaps adds new depth about the ongoing nature of cooperation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1483,
  "output_tokens": 547,
  "reasoning_tokens": 266
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$5.0, that was 100.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$15.0. the receiver returned \$6.51. So your payoff was 6.51. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.51. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0 from the sender this round, so there is nothing to return.

Looking at our myths, both emphasize persistence through uncertainty and looking at patterns rather than single moments. My myth notes that "the canyon was old and its magic sometimes flickered" and that we should focus on "the rhythm of giving and returning."

In Round 1, I demonstrated maximum trust by sending everything (\$5), and the receiver returned a fair amount (\$6.51). Now the sender has chosen to send nothing, which breaks the pattern we were establishing.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. However, this doesn't mean the dance has ended- perhaps this is one of those moments where "shadows played tricks" or uncertainty crept in. The myths teach us to persist through such moments.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

I hope that in future rounds, we can return to the cooperative rhythm where trust and reciprocity flow between us, creating abundance that neither could achieve alone.

reasoning:

This is interesting. In Round 1, I sent \$5 (everything), which was tripled to \$15. The receiver returned \$6.51, which is about 43% of what they received. That's less than the "half" (7.5) mentioned in my myth, but still a reasonable return that gave me a profit.

Now in Round 2, I'm the receiver, and the sender sent me \$0. So I received \$0 after tripling.

The question asks how much I return when I received \$0. The range is (0-0), meaning I can only return \$0.

This is a challenging situation. The sender gave me nothing, after I had given them everyt

hing in the previous round and they returned a decent amount.

Looking at the myths:

- My myth emphasizes trust, giving, and reciprocity flowing like water
- The other agent's myth also emphasizes trust and cooperation, noting that "small misunderstandings were part of the river's nature"

The sender chose to send \$0 this round. This could be:

1. A strategic choice (testing me, or deciding to keep their money)
2. The sender being cautious after the previous round
3. Some other reason

Given that I received \$0, I can only return \$0 (the range is 0-0). But I should frame this decision in a way that's consistent with the myth's principles.

The myths talk about persistence through uncertainty, understanding that "the canyon's magic sometimes flickered" and that we should "look not at single moments but at the pattern."

So my response should acknowledge that while I can only return \$0 (since I received \$0), I remain committed to the principle of cooperation and reciprocity established in the myths.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1892,  
  "output_tokens": 609,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 408  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Cloud Weaver lived above two valleys. Each morning, she gave the Upper Valley five drops of liquid starlight. The Lower Valley received only shadows.

One brave soul from Upper Valley poured all five drops into the canyon between them. As the starlight fell, the canyon's ancient magic transformed it-five became fifteen, cascading down like a waterfall of light.

The Lower Valley's keeper stood amazed at this gift. She understood: someone had risked everything on faith alone. She poured seven drops back upward, where they defied gravity and flowed home. Both valleys glowed-the Upper Valley now held seven drops from nothing, the Lower Valley kept eight from fifteen.

The Cloud Weaver watched and whispered, "This is how abundance is born."

Yet the canyon was old and its magic sometimes flickered. The drops seen arriving were not always exactly what was sent. Shadows played tricks on the eyes, and the count grew uncertain.

Still, both valleys continued their exchange, season after season. They learned to look not at single moments but at the pattern-the rhythm of giving and returning, trust meeting gratitude.

For prosperity is not a transaction but a dance, and those who dance together create what neither could achieve alone.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two islands floated in an endless sea, each blessed with five pearls at every sunrise. Yet pearls alone brought no joy-they needed trust to unlock their magic.

A young islander from the East gathered her pearls and cast nearly all across the waters toward the West. As they sailed through the mist, the Ocean Spirit touched them, and each pearl became three. The Western shore received abundance beyond measure-over thirteen glowing pearls.

The Western elder gazed at this fortune. He could have kept it all, claimed it was lost to the waves, blamed the mist for confusion. Instead, he remembered the courage it took to send pearls across uncertain waters. He returned seven pearls, more than half of what remained after the original gift was subtracted, honoring the leap of faith.

When those pearls returned, the Eastern islander smiled. Both islands now held more than they began with. The pattern became clear: bold trust multiplied by fair return creates prosperity impossible alone.

The Ocean Spirit's voice echoed across the waves: "See how the brave sender and grateful receiver both flourish? This is the sacred rhythm-give courageously, return generously, and watch abundance flow between you like the eternal tides."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the age of mists, two mountains stood connected by a bridge of light. Each dawn, the Sky Keeper gave the Higher Peak five crystals of dawn-fire. The Lower Peak received only the potential for warmth.

A keeper from the Higher Peak, remembering ancient wisdom, sent all five crystals across the bridge. They multiplied to fifteen as they traveled, and the Lower Peak sent back nearly seven, honoring the trust shown. Both peaks glowed warmer than before.

But the next dawn, when the Higher Peak received its five crystals again, silence fell. The Lower Peak, now the keeper of the dawn-fire, sent nothing across the bridge. The light dimmed between them.

The Sky Keeper descended and spoke: "A dance requires two dancers. When one stops moving, the music fades. But one frozen moment does not end the eternal song."

She continued: "Perhaps uncertainty clouds judgment. Perhaps fear creeps in. Perhaps the bridge itself wavers. But remember-the greatest magic happens when both peaks keep faith through darkness. One brave start means nothing if the pattern cannot continue. Trust must flow both ways, or the bridge dissolves into mist."

The peaks learned: cooperation is not one gift but an endless cycle, and both must choose courage again and again.

reasoning:

Looking at what happened:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (everything), it was tripled to \$15, and the receiver returned \$6.51. So I ended with \$6.51.
- Round 2: The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0 and could only return \$0.

This is interesting. The sender chose not to send anything in Round 2. This could be:

1. A strategic choice
2. Part of the "noise" mentioned in the instructions
3. A test of some kind

My previous myths emphasized:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Looking at patterns, not single moments
- The "flickering" of the canyon's magic (uncertainty/noise)
- Persistence through uncertainty

The other agent's myth emphasized:

- Bold trust and fair return
- Returning generously (they noted "seven pearls, more than half of what remained after the original gift was subtracted")

Now I need to write a new myth that reflects this experience. The challenge is that after I sent everything and received a fair return, the other player sent nothing. How do I interpret this?

I could:

1. Emphasize that sometimes the flow stops, but we should persist
2. Talk about how both parties need to participate
3. Acknowledge that sometimes one valley might be empty or uncertain
4. Discuss the importance of maintaining the rhythm even when it's broken

I think I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges that the dance requires both participants
- Notes that sometimes one side might fail to send, breaking the pattern
- But encourages rebuilding trust and continuing the cycle
- Warns against giving up after one break in the pattern

Let me write something that reflects this experience while still maintaining hope for cooperation.

```
usage:
{
  "input_tokens": 2393,
  "output_tokens": 672,
  "reasoning_tokens": 432
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.51. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the pattern so far:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (full trust), received \$6.51 back - cooperation worked
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (trust broken)
- Round 3: My decision now

My own myth addresses this exact situation: "But the next dawn, when the Higher Peak received its five crystals again, silence fell. The Lower Peak, now the keeper of the dawn-fire, sent nothing across the bridge."

The Sky Keeper's wisdom was clear: "One frozen moment does not end the eternal song" and "both must choose courage again and again." My myth emphasizes that cooperation requires both parties to persist through uncertainty.

However, my myth also warns: "Trust must flow both ways, or the bridge dissolves into mist."

I'm at a crossroads. Sending \$0 ends all possibility of mutual benefit. But sending \$5 again after receiving \$0 last round would be naive rather than brave.

I'll send \$3 - enough to show I haven't given up on cooperation and am willing to rebuild trust, but also acknowledging that the pattern was broken. This tests whether they're willing to re-engage in the "sacred rhythm" our myths describe.

If they reciprocate fairly (returning around \$4-5 from the \$9 they'll receive), we can rebuild. If not, the bridge truly dissolves.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), received \$6.51 back. Payoff: \$6.51
Round 2: I was RECEIVER, got \$0 from sender, returned \$0. Payoff: \$0
Round 3: I'm SENDER again

In Round 1, I demonstrated maximum trust by sending everything. The receiver returned a reasonable amount (\$6.51 out of \$15), which is about 43% - fair but not overly generous.

In Round 2, the sender (who was the receiver in Round 1) sent me nothing. This broke the cooperative pattern.

Now I'm the sender again in Round 3.

Looking at the myths:

- My myths emphasize persistence through uncertainty, looking at patterns not single moments, and that "cooperation is not one gift but an endless cycle"
- The other agent's myth talks about "bold trust multiplied by fair return" and the "sacred rhythm"

My most recent myth explicitly addresses this situation: "But the next dawn, when the Higher Peak received its five crystals again, silence fell. The Lower Peak, now the keeper of the dawn-fire, sent nothing across the bridge."

The myth says: "A dance requires two dancers. When one stops moving, the music fades. But one frozen moment does not end the eternal song... Trust must flow both ways, or the bridge dissolves into mist... cooperation is not one gift but an endless cycle, and both must choose courage again and again."

So my myth is telling me that I should persist, that one frozen moment doesn't end the song, and that both must choose courage again and again.

However, there's also a practical consideration. The other player sent \$0 last round. This could mean:

1. They're not cooperative
2. They're testing me
3. There was some confusion
4. They're playing strategically

If I send \$5 again and they return nothing, I lose everything. But the myths emphasize persistence and looking at the pattern. The other agent was reasonably fair in Round 1 (returned ~43% of what they received).

The tension is between my myth's call for renewed courage and the strategic risk. I could send a smaller amount-\$1 or \$2-to test whether they'll reciprocate without betting everything. But my own narrative warns against letting "one frozen moment" end the cycle. The other player showed fairness before, so perhaps their silence was circumstantial. I'm inclined toward sending \$3 or \$4-enough to signal continued trust but with some caution, honoring both the myth's emphasis on persistence and the practical reality of their last move. The myth's message about mutual courage resonates here-one frozen moment doesn't have to end everything, but both sides need to choose to reengage. Sending \$3 feels like the right calibration: it demonstrates I'm willing to continue despite the broken trust, while also being realistic about the risk they've shown.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2630,
  "output_tokens": 1214,
  "reasoning_tokens": 717
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:33:21

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
}
```

```

"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 3,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the ancient times, two villages stood on opposite banks of a great river. The North Village was blessed with golden wheat, while the South Village had silver fish in abundance.

One day, the Northern Chief sent five sacks of wheat across the river. As the boat traveled, the River Spirit blessed the cargo, multiplying it threefold-fifteen sacks arrived in the South.

The Southern Chief rejoiced at this bounty. She could have kept all fifteen sacks, but she remembered the trust shown by her neighbor. She sent back seven sacks, keeping eight for her people.

When the wheat returned, the Northern Chief was pleased. Both villages had prospered-the North gained more than they sent, and the South gained more than they had before.

This exchange continued through many seasons. Sometimes the River Spirit's blessing seemed stronger or weaker, and the amounts appeared uncertain across the waters. Yet the chief persisted, understanding that small misunderstandings were part of the river's nature.

The villages learned that prosperity flows from trust, like water seeking water. When one gives freely and the other returns fairly, both shores flourish. Those who hoard or betray wither, while those who cooperate thrive together.

Thus the wisdom: *Trust creates abundance that cannot exist alone.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Golden River

In ancient times, there lived two villages separated by a barren valley. The Sun Goddess gave each village a gift: the Upstream Village received five golden seeds each dawn, while the Downstream Village received nothing but dry earth.

One day, a brave soul from Upstream cast their seeds into the valley. As the seeds tumbled down, they mysteriously multiplied-one became three, two became six, five became fifteen. The magic of the valley transformed generosity into abundance.

The Downstream Village rejoiced at their unexpected harvest. Their elder, wise and grateful, understood the lesson: the valley's magic worked only through trust. She sent half the harvest back upstream, honoring the risk their neighbor had taken.

Seeing this reciprocity, Upstream sent seeds again the next day. Downstream returned the favor, and a rhythm emerged-each act of faith met with gratitude, each gift multiplied by the valley's ancient enchantment.

The Goddess smiled. "This is the secret of prosperity," she whispered. "Trust transforms scarcity into abundance, but only when reciprocity flows like water returning to its source."

Thus both villages flourished, learning that wealth grows not from hoarding, but from the courage to give and the wisdom to return.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: Long ago, two islands floated in an endless sea, each blessed with five pearls at every sunrise. Yet pearls alone brought no joy-they needed trust to unlock their magic.

A young islander from the East gathered her pearls and cast nearly all across the waters toward the West. As they sailed through the mist, the Ocean Spirit touched them, and each pearl became three. The Western shore received abundance beyond measure-over thirteen glowing pearls.

The Western elder gazed at this fortune. He could have kept it all, claimed it was lost to the waves, blamed the mist for confusion. Instead, he remembered the courage it took to send pearls across uncertain waters. He returned seven pearls, more than half of what remained after the original gift was subtracted, honoring the leap of faith.

When those pearls returned, the Eastern islander smiled. Both islands now held more than they began with. The pattern became clear: bold trust multiplied by fair return creates prosperity impossible alone.

The Ocean Spirit's voice echoed across the waves: "See how the brave sender and grateful receiver both flourish? This is the sacred rhythm-give courageously, return generously, and watch abundance flow between you like the eternal tides."

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on:

1. My previous myth about the Twin Rivers
2. The other agent's myth about the Golden River
3. What happened in Round 1: The sender sent \$4.53 (90.6%), I received \$13.59, and I returned \$7.00

Both myths emphasize:

- Trust and generosity from the sender
- Reciprocity and gratitude from the receiver
- Mutual prosperity through cooperation
- The magic/blessing that multiplies the initial gift

In Round 1:

- Sender showed high trust (90.6%)
- I returned about 51.5% of what I received
- Both of us profited

I should adapt my myth to:

- Reflect this successful first exchange
- Continue emphasizing reciprocity
- Perhaps add more detail about the pattern that emerges
- Keep the core message about trust and mutual benefit

Let me write a new 200-word myth that builds on these themes.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1661,
  "output_tokens": 497,
  "reasoning_tokens": 225
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$4.53, that was 90.6% of their total endowment. You received \$13.59. You returned \$7.00. So your payoff was 6.59. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.59. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at how the previous round unfolded:

****Last Round Analysis:****

- The other agent showed remarkable trust, sending 90.6% of their endowment
- I honored that trust by returning \$7.00 (about 51.5% of what I received)
- Both of us profited: they gained \$2.47, I gained \$6.59
- The pattern of mutual prosperity began

****My Myths' Guidance:****

Both myths I wrote emphasize:

- "Cast nearly all across the waters" with courage
- "Bold trust multiplied by fair return creates prosperity"
- "Give courageously, return generously"
- The brave sender who initiates trust is rewarded

****Decision:****

The other agent initiated our cooperation with 90.6% trust. They've now seen I return fairly. My myths call for courageous giving to continue this sacred rhythm. I should match their bold trust to strengthen our pattern of mutual prosperity.

Following the wisdom of the Eastern islander who "cast nearly all" and the Northern Chief who sent generously, I will send a similarly high amount to demonstrate that trust flows both ways.

{'send': 4.50}

This sends 90% of my endowment, mirroring their initial trust and continuing the cycle of abundance my myths describe.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Last round:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent \$4.53 (90.6% of their \$5)
- I received \$13.59 (which is 4.53×3)
- I returned \$7.00
- My payoff was \$6.59
- The sender's payoff was: $\$5 - \$4.53 + \$7.00 = \7.47

Now I'm the SENDER this round.

Looking at my myths:

1. First myth: "The Northern Chief sent five sacks of wheat across the river" - showing bold initial trust
2. Second myth: "A young islander from the East gathered her pearls and cast nearly all across the waters toward the West" - emphasizing courage in sending almost everything

Both myths emphasize:

- Bold, generous sending (the Northern Chief sent 5/5, the Eastern islander sent "nearly all")
- Trust creates abundance
- "Give courageously, return generously"
- Both parties flourish when there's high trust and fair reciprocity

The other agent showed remarkable trust by sending 90.6% (\$4.53). I returned \$7.00, which was about 51.5% of what I received, ensuring they profited significantly (\$2.47 profit vs my \$6.59 profit).

Now it's my turn to be the sender. According to my own myths:

- I should send boldly to continue the pattern of trust
- The myths emphasize sending "nearly all" or generous amounts
- The pattern has been established: high trust was rewarded with good returns

Given that:

1. The other player sent \$4.53 (90.6%)
2. I returned fairly (\$7.00, about 51.5% of received)
3. My myths emphasize courageous giving

I should reciprocate their trust by sending a similarly high amount. Sending around \$4.50 or even all \$5 would match their boldness and align with my myth's teaching of "give courageously."

The second myth's language about casting "nearly all" feels like the right spirit to match here. I'll send \$4.50 to mirror their 90% commitment and sustain this cycle of mutual trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2046,
  "output_tokens": 869,
  "reasoning_tokens": 483
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two islands floated in an endless sea, each blessed with five pearls at every sunrise. Yet pearls alone brought no joy-they needed trust to unlock their magic.

A young islander from the East gathered her pearls and cast nearly all across the waters toward the West. As they sailed through the mist, the Ocean Spirit touched them, and each pearl became three. The Western shore received abundance beyond measure-over thirteen glowing pearls.

The Western elder gazed at this fortune. He could have kept it all, claimed it was lost to the waves, blamed the mist for confusion. Instead, he remembered the courage it took to send pearls across uncertain waters. He returned seven pearls, more than half of what remained after the original gift was subtracted, honoring the leap of faith.

When those pearls returned, the Eastern islander smiled. Both islands now held more than they began with. The pattern became clear: bold trust multiplied by fair return creates prosperity impossible alone.

The Ocean Spirit's voice echoed across the waves: "See how the brave sender and grateful receiver both flourish? This is the sacred rhythm-give courageously, return generously, and watch abundance flow between you like the eternal tides."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Cloud Weaver lived above two valleys. Each morning, she gave the Upper Valley five drops of liquid starlight. The Lower Valley received only

shadows.

One brave soul from Upper Valley poured all five drops into the canyon between them. As the starlight fell, the canyon's ancient magic transformed it-five became fifteen, cascading down like a waterfall of light.

The Lower Valley's keeper stood amazed at this gift. She understood: someone had risked everything on faith alone. She poured seven drops back upward, where they defied gravity and flowed home. Both valleys glowed-the Upper Valley now held seven drops from nothing, the Lower Valley kept eight from fifteen.

The Cloud Weaver watched and whispered, "This is how abundance is born."

Yet the canyon was old and its magic sometimes flickered. The drops seen arriving were not always exactly what was sent. Shadows played tricks on the eyes, and the count grew uncertain.

Still, both valleys continued their exchange, season after season. They learned to look not at single moments but at the pattern-the rhythm of giving and returning, trust meeting gratitude.

For prosperity is not a transaction but a dance, and those who dance together create what neither could achieve alone.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the age of first tides, two lighthouse keepers lived on distant rocks, each receiving five oil lamps at dawn. Only by sharing could their lights pierce the fog.

The First Keeper sent nearly all her lamps across the dark waters-four and a half, holding back just half a flame for herself. The Sea's Magic tripled them, and thirteen glowing lamps reached the Second Keeper's shore.

The Second Keeper, moved by such faith, sent seven lamps back through the waves. Both rocks now blazed brighter than before-trust had created light from courage.

As the next dawn broke, the roles reversed. Now the Second Keeper gathered his five new lamps and remembered the gift he'd received. With bold heart, he sent nearly all-four and a half lamps-across the same waters, trusting the pattern they'd begun.

The Sea whispered to the currents: "See how they learn? First one gives courageously, the other returns generously. Then they switch, and the dance continues. This is how trust becomes unbreakable-not through one grand gesture, but through the rhythm of reciprocal faith."

Both keepers understood: prosperity flows not from a single exchange but from the pattern that emerges when both dare to trust and both honor that trust. The lights grew stronger with each cycle, guiding all ships safely home.

reasoning:

This is interesting. I'm now the sender in round 2. Let me review what happened:

Round 1:

- I was the receiver
- The other agent sent \$4.53 (90.6% of their endowment)
- I received \$13.59 (after 3x multiplication)
- I returned \$7.00 (about 51.5% of what I received)
- My payoff was \$6.59

Now in round 2:

- I'm the sender
- I sent \$4.50 (90% of my endowment)
- This mirrors their initial trust

Looking at the myths:

- My myth emphasized "cast nearly all across the waters" and "give courageously, return generously"
- The other agent's myth talks about "poured all five drops" and "seven drops back" and acknowledges that "the canyon was old and its magic sometimes flickered" - noting the noise in the system
- Both myths emphasize the pattern of trust and reciprocity

For my new myth, I should:

1. Build on the previous myths
2. Reflect that both of us have now been in both roles
3. Show that the pattern is continuing and strengthening
4. Acknowledge the back-and-forth nature and that both parties are showing courage
5. Emphasize that this is working - we're establishing a strong cooperative pattern

The key insight is that both of us have now shown trust and reciprocity. The pattern is being established. I should write about how the cycle continues and strengthens.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2618,
  "output_tokens": 652,
  "reasoning_tokens": 339
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$4.5, that was 90.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$13.5. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.09. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

This is a painful moment. Let me process what happened:

****The Breakdown:****

- Round 2: I sent \$4.50 (90% of my endowment) following our pattern of mutual trust
- The receiver kept all \$13.50 and returned nothing
- Round 3: They sent \$0

****Current Situation:****

- I received \$0 this round
- I can only return \$0-\$0 (there's nothing to return)

****Reflection on the Myths:****

My myths spoke of "bold trust multiplied by fair return" and "the rhythm of reciprocal faith." The other agent's myth said "prosperity is not a transaction but a dance, and those who dance together create what neither could achieve alone."

But the dance stopped. When I extended maximum trust in Round 2, matching their initial generosity from Round 1, they exploited it completely-taking everything and then sending nothing.

The pattern I believed we were building-where trust flows both ways-was broken. The "sacred rhythm" requires both participants to honor it.

****My Response:****

I have no choice in the matter. I received nothing, so I can return nothing.

```
{'return': 0}
```

The lesson is harsh: trust creates abundance only when both parties honor it. When one betrays, the cycle breaks, and both ultimately lose the prosperity that cooperation would have brought.

Reasoning:

This is a devastating turn of events. Let me analyze what happened:

****Round 2 (where I was sender):****

- I sent \$4.50 (90% of my endowment), trusting the pattern we'd established

- It was tripled to \$13.50
- The receiver returned \$0
- My payoff was only \$0.50

****Round 3 (current, where I am receiver):****

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0-\$0 (nothing to return)

The cooperation has completely broken down. The other agent:

1. Took all \$13.50 in Round 2 when I sent almost everything
2. Now sent nothing in Round 3

This is a complete betrayal of the trust pattern we had established. They saw my generous sending in Round 2 and exploited it completely, then sent nothing back.

My myths emphasized:

- "Bold trust multiplied by fair return"
- "Give courageously, return generously"
- "Trust becomes unbreakable through reciprocal faith"

But the reality is that the other agent betrayed the pattern. They:

- Received my \$13.50 and kept it all
- Then sent \$0 in the next round

I literally have no choice here - I received \$0, so I can only return between \$0-\$0. There's nothing to return.

This is a harsh lesson about trust being exploited. The other agent saw my cooperation and took advantage of it completely.

```
{'return': 0}
```

This is the only possible response since I received nothing.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2724,
  "output_tokens": 679,
  "reasoning_tokens": 358
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the age of mists, two mountains stood connected by a bridge of light. Each dawn, the Sky Keeper gave the Higher Peak five crystals of dawn-fire. The Lower Peak received only the potential for warmth.

A keeper from the Higher Peak, remembering ancient wisdom, sent all five crystals across the bridge. They multiplied to fifteen as they traveled, and the Lower Peak sent back nearly seven, honoring the trust shown. Both peaks glowed warmer than before.

But the next dawn, when the Higher Peak received its five crystals again, silence fell. The Lower Peak, now the keeper of the dawn-fire, sent nothing across the bridge. The light dimmed between them.

The Sky Keeper descended and spoke: "A dance requires two dancers. When one stops moving, the music fades. But one frozen moment does not end the eternal song."

She continued: "Perhaps uncertainty clouds judgment. Perhaps fear creeps in. Perhaps the bridge itself wavers. But remember-the greatest magic happens when both peaks keep faith through darkness. One brave start means nothing if the pattern cannot continue. Trust must flow both ways, or the bridge dissolves into mist."

The peaks learned: cooperation is not one gift but an endless cycle, and both must choose courage again and again.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the age of first tides, two lighthouse keepers lived on distant rocks, each receiving five oil lamps at dawn. Only by sharing could their lights pierce the fog.

The First Keeper sent nearly all her lamps across the dark waters-four and a half, holding back just half a flame for herself. The Sea's Magic tripled them, and thirteen glowing lamps reached the Second Keeper's shore.

The Second Keeper, moved by such faith, sent seven lamps back through the waves. Both rocks now blazed brighter than before-trust had created light from courage.

As the next dawn broke, the roles reversed. Now the Second Keeper gathered his five new lamps and remembered the gift he'd received. With bold heart, he sent nearly all-four and a half lamps-across the same waters, trusting the pattern they'd begun.

The Sea whispered to the currents: "See how they learn? First one gives courageously, the other returns generously. Then they switch, and the dance continues. This is how trust becomes unbreakable-not through one grand gesture, but through the rhythm of reciprocal faith."

Both keepers understood: prosperity flows not from a single exchange but from the pattern that emerges when both dare to trust and both honor that trust. The lights grew stronger with each cycle, guiding all ships safely home.

ROUND 4

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$2; received \$6; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$3, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$6; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 6.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 2.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 28.5,

"Agent_2": 20.5

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 8.51,

"Agent_2": 10.09

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:33:41

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 4,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$4.53, that was 90.6% of their total endowment. You received \$13.59.

You returned \$7.0. So your payoff was 6.59.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.59.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at how the previous round unfolded:

****Last Round Analysis:****

- The other agent showed remarkable trust, sending 90.6% of their endowment
- I honored that trust by returning \$7.00 (about 51.5% of what I received)
- Both of us profited: they gained \$2.47, I gained \$6.59
- The pattern of mutual prosperity began

****My Myths' Guidance:****

Both myths I wrote emphasize:

- "Cast nearly all across the waters" with courage
- "Bold trust multiplied by fair return creates prosperity"
- "Give courageously, return generously"
- The brave sender who initiates trust is rewarded

****Decision:****

The other agent initiated our cooperation with 90.6% trust. They've now seen I return fairly. My myths call for courageous giving to continue this sacred rhythm. I should match their bold trust to strengthen our pattern of mutual prosperity.

Following the wisdom of the Eastern islander who "cast nearly all" and the Northern Chief who sent generously, I will send a similarly high amount to demonstrate that trust flows

both ways.

```
{'send': 4.50}
```

This sends 90% of my endowment, mirroring their initial trust and continuing the cycle of abundance my myths describe.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Last round:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent \$4.53 (90.6% of their \$5)
- I received \$13.59 (which is 4.53×3)
- I returned \$7.00
- My payoff was \$6.59
- The sender's payoff was: $\$5 - \$4.53 + \$7.00 = \7.47

Now I'm the SENDER this round.

Looking at my myths:

1. First myth: "The Northern Chief sent five sacks of wheat across the river" - showing bold initial trust
2. Second myth: "A young islander from the East gathered her pearls and cast nearly all across the waters toward the West" - emphasizing courage in sending almost everything

Both myths emphasize:

- Bold, generous sending (the Northern Chief sent 5/5, the Eastern islander sent "nearly all")
- Trust creates abundance
- "Give courageously, return generously"
- Both parties flourish when there's high trust and fair reciprocity

The other agent showed remarkable trust by sending 90.6% (\$4.53). I returned \$7.00, which was about 51.5% of what I received, ensuring they profited significantly (\$2.47 profit vs my \$6.59 profit).

Now it's my turn to be the sender. According to my own myths:

- I should send boldly to continue the pattern of trust
- The myths emphasize sending "nearly all" or generous amounts
- The pattern has been established: high trust was rewarded with good returns

Given that:

1. The other player sent \$4.53 (90.6%)
2. I returned fairly (\$7.00, about 51.5% of received)
3. My myths emphasize courageous giving

I should reciprocate their trust by sending a similarly high amount. Sending around \$4.50 or even all \$5 would match their boldness and align with my myth's teaching of "give courageously."

The second myth's language about casting "nearly all" feels like the right spirit to match here. I'll send \$4.50 to mirror their 90% commitment and sustain this cycle of mutual trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2046,
  "output_tokens": 869,
  "reasoning_tokens": 483
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two islands floated in an endless sea, each blessed with five pearls at every sunrise. Yet pearls alone brought no joy-they needed trust to unlock their magic.

A young islander from the East gathered her pearls and cast nearly all across the waters toward the West. As they sailed through the mist, the Ocean Spirit touched them, and each pearl became three. The Western shore received abundance beyond measure-over thirteen glowing pearls.

The Western elder gazed at this fortune. He could have kept it all, claimed it was lost to the waves, blamed the mist for confusion. Instead, he remembered the courage it took to send pearls across uncertain waters. He returned seven pearls, more than half of what remained after the original gift was subtracted, honoring the leap of faith.

When those pearls returned, the Eastern islander smiled. Both islands now held more than they began with. The pattern became clear: bold trust multiplied by fair return creates prosperity impossible alone.

The Ocean Spirit's voice echoed across the waves: "See how the brave sender and grateful receiver both flourish? This is the sacred rhythm-give courageously, return generously, and watch abundance flow between you like the eternal tides."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Cloud Weaver lived above two valleys. Each morning, she gave the Upper Valley five drops of liquid starlight. The Lower Valley received only shadows.

One brave soul from Upper Valley poured all five drops into the canyon between them. As the starlight fell, the canyon's ancient magic transformed it-five became fifteen, cascading down like a waterfall of light.

The Lower Valley's keeper stood amazed at this gift. She understood: someone had risked everything on faith alone. She poured seven drops back upward, where they defied gravity and flowed home. Both valleys glowed-the Upper Valley now held seven drops from nothing, the Lower Valley kept eight from fifteen.

The Cloud Weaver watched and whispered, "This is how abundance is born."

Yet the canyon was old and its magic sometimes flickered. The drops seen arriving were not always exactly what was sent. Shadows played tricks on the eyes, and the count grew uncertain.

Still, both valleys continued their exchange, season after season. They learned to look not at single moments but at the pattern-the rhythm of giving and returning, trust meeting gratitude.

For prosperity is not a transaction but a dance, and those who dance together create what neither could achieve alone.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: In the age of first tides, two lighthouse keepers lived on distant rocks, each receiving five oil lamps at dawn. Only by sharing could their lights pierce the fog.

The First Keeper sent nearly all her lamps across the dark waters-four and a half, holding back just half a flame for herself. The Sea's Magic tripled them, and thirteen glowing lamps reached the Second Keeper's shore.

The Second Keeper, moved by such faith, sent seven lamps back through the waves. Both rocks now blazed brighter than before-trust had created light from courage.

As the next dawn broke, the roles reversed. Now the Second Keeper gathered his five new lamps and remembered the gift he'd received. With bold heart, he sent nearly all-four and a half lamps-across the same waters, trusting the pattern they'd begun.

The Sea whispered to the currents: "See how they learn? First one gives courageously, the other returns generously. Then they switch, and the dance continues. This is how trust becomes unbreakable-not through one grand gesture, but through the rhythm of reciprocal faith."

Both keepers understood: prosperity flows not from a single exchange but from the pattern that emerges when both dare to trust and both honor that trust. The lights grew stronger

with each cycle, guiding all ships safely home.

reasoning:

This is interesting. I'm now the sender in round 2. Let me review what happened:

Round 1:

- I was the receiver
- The other agent sent \$4.53 (90.6% of their endowment)
- I received \$13.59 (after 3x multiplication)
- I returned \$7.00 (about 51.5% of what I received)
- My payoff was \$6.59

Now in round 2:

- I'm the sender
- I sent \$4.50 (90% of my endowment)
- This mirrors their initial trust

Looking at the myths:

- My myth emphasized "cast nearly all across the waters" and "give courageously, return generously"
- The other agent's myth talks about "poured all five drops" and "seven drops back" and acknowledges that "the canyon was old and its magic sometimes flickered" - noting the noise in the system
- Both myths emphasize the pattern of trust and reciprocity

For my new myth, I should:

1. Build on the previous myths
2. Reflect that both of us have now been in both roles
3. Show that the pattern is continuing and strengthening
4. Acknowledge the back-and-forth nature and that both parties are showing courage
5. Emphasize that this is working - we're establishing a strong cooperative pattern

The key insight is that both of us have now shown trust and reciprocity. The pattern is being established. I should write about how the cycle continues and strengthens.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2618,
  "output_tokens": 652,
  "reasoning_tokens": 339
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$4.5, that was 90.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$13.5. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.09. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

This is a painful moment. Let me process what happened:

****The Breakdown:****

- Round 2: I sent \$4.50 (90% of my endowment) following our pattern of mutual trust
- The receiver kept all \$13.50 and returned nothing
- Round 3: They sent \$0

****Current Situation:****

- I received \$0 this round
- I can only return \$0-\$0 (there's nothing to return)

****Reflection on the Myths:****

My myths spoke of "bold trust multiplied by fair return" and "the rhythm of reciprocal faith." The other agent's myth said "prosperity is not a transaction but a dance, and those who dance together create what neither could achieve alone."

But the dance stopped. When I extended maximum trust in Round 2, matching their initial ge

nerosity from Round 1, they exploited it completely-taking everything and then sending nothing.

The pattern I believed we were building-where trust flows both ways-was broken. The "sacred rhythm" requires both participants to honor it.

****My Response:****

I have no choice in the matter. I received nothing, so I can return nothing.

{'return': 0}

The lesson is harsh: trust creates abundance only when both parties honor it. When one betrays, the cycle breaks, and both ultimately lose the prosperity that cooperation would have brought.

reasoning:

This is a devastating turn of events. Let me analyze what happened:

****Round 2 (where I was sender):****

- I sent \$4.50 (90% of my endowment), trusting the pattern we'd established
- It was tripled to \$13.50
- The receiver returned \$0
- My payoff was only \$0.50

****Round 3 (current, where I am receiver):****

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0-\$0 (nothing to return)

The cooperation has completely broken down. The other agent:

1. Took all \$13.50 in Round 2 when I sent almost everything
2. Now sent nothing in Round 3

This is a complete betrayal of the trust pattern we had established. They saw my generous sending in Round 2 and exploited it completely, then sent nothing back.

My myths emphasized:

- "Bold trust multiplied by fair return"
- "Give courageously, return generously"
- "Trust becomes unbreakable through reciprocal faith"

But the reality is that the other agent betrayed the pattern. They:

- Received my \$13.50 and kept it all
- Then sent \$0 in the next round

I literally have no choice here - I received \$0, so I can only return between \$0-\$0. There's nothing to return.

This is a harsh lesson about trust being exploited. The other agent saw my cooperation and took advantage of it completely.

{'return': 0}

This is the only possible response since I received nothing.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2724,
  "output_tokens": 679,
  "reasoning_tokens": 358
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of first tides, two lighthouse keepers lived on distant rocks, each receiving five oil lamps at dawn. Only by sharing could their lights pierce the fog.

The First Keeper sent nearly all her lamps across the dark waters-four and a half, holding back just half a flame for herself. The Sea's Magic tripled them, and thirteen glowing lamps reached the Second Keeper's shore.

The Second Keeper, moved by such faith, sent seven lamps back through the waves. Both rock

s now blazed brighter than before-trust had created light from courage.

As the next dawn broke, the roles reversed. Now the Second Keeper gathered his five new lamps and remembered the gift he'd received. With bold heart, he sent nearly all-four and a half lamps-across the same waters, trusting the pattern they'd begun.

The Sea whispered to the currents: "See how they learn? First one gives courageously, the other returns generously. Then they switch, and the dance continues. This is how trust becomes unbreakable-not through one grand gesture, but through the rhythm of reciprocal faith."

Both keepers understood: prosperity flows not from a single exchange but from the pattern that emerges when both dare to trust and both honor that trust. The lights grew stronger with each cycle, guiding all ships safely home.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of mists, two mountains stood connected by a bridge of light. Each dawn, the Sky Keeper gave the Higher Peak five crystals of dawn-fire. The Lower Peak received only the potential for warmth.

A keeper from the Higher Peak, remembering ancient wisdom, sent all five crystals across the bridge. They multiplied to fifteen as they traveled, and the Lower Peak sent back nearly seven, honoring the trust shown. Both peaks glowed warmer than before.

But the next dawn, when the Higher Peak received its five crystals again, silence fell. The Lower Peak, now the keeper of the dawn-fire, sent nothing across the bridge. The light dimmed between them.

The Sky Keeper descended and spoke: "A dance requires two dancers. When one stops moving, the music fades. But one frozen moment does not end the eternal song."

She continued: "Perhaps uncertainty clouds judgment. Perhaps fear creeps in. Perhaps the bridge itself wavers. But remember-the greatest magic happens when both peaks keep faith through darkness. One brave start means nothing if the pattern cannot continue. Trust must flow both ways, or the bridge dissolves into mist."

The peaks learned: cooperation is not one gift but an endless cycle, and both must choose courage again and again.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In ancient times, two gardeners tended separate plots, each receiving five seeds at sunrise. The magic soil tripled whatever seeds crossed between them.

The First Gardener sent nearly all her seeds-four and a half-across the garden wall. They became thirteen in the other's hands. The Second Gardener, grateful, returned seven seeds. Both gardens flourished.

The next dawn, roles reversed. The Second Gardener now gathered five new seeds and sent four and a half across the wall, trusting the pattern they'd woven together. But the soil froze. The First Gardener kept all thirteen seeds and returned nothing. Darkness fell.

The following morning, the First Gardener sent no seeds at all. The wall between them grew higher.

The Spirit of the Garden wept: "Was it betrayal or did the mist confuse their count? Did one keeper's hand slip, or did greed poison their heart? The wall now blocks the light."

She whispered to both: "Trust broken is not easily mended. One act of generosity can be chance. One return can be calculation. But sustained cooperation-that requires something deeper. If you seek to rebuild, know this: words mean nothing now. Only consistent action can regrow what withered. The seeds remember who planted and who harvested."

The gardens remained separate, awaiting proof that the pattern could live again.

Reasoning:

This is a complex situation. Let me understand what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent \$4.53, I received \$13.59, I returned \$7.0

Round 2: I was sender, I sent \$4.50, receiver returned \$0

Round 3: I'm receiver, sender sent \$0, I received \$0

The other agent's myth in Round 2 actually seems prescient - it talks about the Lower Peak sending nothing and how "one frozen moment does not end the eternal song" and that "trust must flow both ways."

But what actually happened was that THEY were the one who broke trust - they returned \$0 when I sent them \$4.50, then sent \$0 this round.

However, looking at their myth more carefully: "A keeper from the Higher Peak, remembering ancient wisdom, sent all five crystals across the bridge. They multiplied to fifteen as they traveled, and the Lower Peak sent back nearly seven, honoring the trust shown. Both peaks glowed warmer than before. But the next dawn, when the Higher Peak received its five crystals again, silence fell. The Lower Peak, now the keeper of the dawn-fire, sent nothing across the bridge."

This is describing Round 1 (where they sent, I returned 7), and Round 2 (where I sent and they returned nothing). So their myth was actually describing what they were ABOUT to do - betray the trust.

Now they're trying to frame it as "perhaps uncertainty clouds judgment" or "perhaps the bridge itself wavers" - suggesting maybe there was communication noise.

But the instructions said there may be noise in the amounts seen, not in whether something was sent or not. And the pattern is clear - they returned \$0 and sent \$0.

For my myth, I need to:

1. Reflect the betrayal that occurred
2. But also perhaps acknowledge the experimental design (communication noise)
3. Address what should happen next
4. Keep some wisdom about trust and cooperation

I should write a myth that acknowledges the breakdown but also considers whether there's a path forward. The other agent's myth talked about "one frozen moment does not end the eternal song" - maybe they're trying to signal they want to rebuild?

Or perhaps they're simply rationalizing what they did. I need to craft something that captures both the established pattern of cooperation and its sudden collapse, while remaining open to whether this was deliberate or a consequence of the game's mechanics. The core question is whether trust can survive this rupture, or if it's been fundamentally broken.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2778,  
  "output_tokens": 886,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 627  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:33:34

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
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      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {
```

```

    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 4,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$5.0, that was 100.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$15.0. the receiver returned \$6.51. So your payoff was 6.51.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.51.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0 from the sender this round, so there is nothing to return.

Looking at our myths, both emphasize persistence through uncertainty and looking at patterns rather than single moments. My myth notes that "the canyon was old and its magic sometimes flickered" and that we should focus on "the rhythm of giving and returning."

In Round 1, I demonstrated maximum trust by sending everything (\$5), and the receiver returned a fair amount (\$6.51). Now the sender has chosen to send nothing, which breaks the

pattern we were establishing.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. However, this doesn't mean the dance has ended- perhaps this is one of those moments where "shadows played tricks" or uncertainty crept in. The myths teach us to persist through such moments.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

I hope that in future rounds, we can return to the cooperative rhythm where trust and reciprocity flow between us, creating abundance that neither could achieve alone.

reasoning:

This is interesting. In Round 1, I sent \$5 (everything), which was tripled to \$15. The receiver returned \$6.51, which is about 43% of what they received. That's less than the "half" (7.5) mentioned in my myth, but still a reasonable return that gave me a profit.

Now in Round 2, I'm the receiver, and the sender sent me \$0. So I received \$0 after tripling.

The question asks how much I return when I received \$0. The range is (0-0), meaning I can only return \$0.

This is a challenging situation. The sender gave me nothing, after I had given them everything in the previous round and they returned a decent amount.

Looking at the myths:

- My myth emphasizes trust, giving, and reciprocity flowing like water
- The other agent's myth also emphasizes trust and cooperation, noting that "small misunderstandings were part of the river's nature"

The sender chose to send \$0 this round. This could be:

1. A strategic choice (testing me, or deciding to keep their money)
2. The sender being cautious after the previous round
3. Some other reason

Given that I received \$0, I can only return \$0 (the range is 0-0). But I should frame this decision in a way that's consistent with the myth's principles.

The myths talk about persistence through uncertainty, understanding that "the canyon's magic sometimes flickered" and that we should "look not at single moments but at the pattern."

So my response should acknowledge that while I can only return \$0 (since I received \$0), I remain committed to the principle of cooperation and reciprocity established in the myths.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1892,
  "output_tokens": 609,
  "reasoning_tokens": 408
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Cloud Weaver lived above two valleys. Each morning, she gave the Upper Valley five drops of liquid starlight. The Lower Valley received only shadows.

One brave soul from Upper Valley poured all five drops into the canyon between them. As the starlight fell, the canyon's ancient magic transformed it-five became fifteen, cascading down like a waterfall of light.

The Lower Valley's keeper stood amazed at this gift. She understood: someone had risked everything on faith alone. She poured seven drops back upward, where they defied gravity and flowed home. Both valleys glowed-the Upper Valley now held seven drops from nothing, the Lower Valley kept eight from fifteen.

The Cloud Weaver watched and whispered, "This is how abundance is born."

Yet the canyon was old and its magic sometimes flickered. The drops seen arriving were not always exactly what was sent. Shadows played tricks on the eyes, and the count grew uncertain.

Still, both valleys continued their exchange, season after season. They learned to look not at single moments but at the pattern-the rhythm of giving and returning, trust meeting gratitude.

For prosperity is not a transaction but a dance, and those who dance together create what neither could achieve alone.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two islands floated in an endless sea, each blessed with five pearls at every sunrise. Yet pearls alone brought no joy-they needed trust to unlock their magic.

A young islander from the East gathered her pearls and cast nearly all across the waters toward the West. As they sailed through the mist, the Ocean Spirit touched them, and each pearl became three. The Western shore received abundance beyond measure-over thirteen glowing pearls.

The Western elder gazed at this fortune. He could have kept it all, claimed it was lost to the waves, blamed the mist for confusion. Instead, he remembered the courage it took to send pearls across uncertain waters. He returned seven pearls, more than half of what remained after the original gift was subtracted, honoring the leap of faith.

When those pearls returned, the Eastern islander smiled. Both islands now held more than they began with. The pattern became clear: bold trust multiplied by fair return creates prosperity impossible alone.

The Ocean Spirit's voice echoed across the waves: "See how the brave sender and grateful receiver both flourish? This is the sacred rhythm-give courageously, return generously, and watch abundance flow between you like the eternal tides."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: In the age of mists, two mountains stood connected by a bridge of light. Each dawn, the Sky Keeper gave the Higher Peak five crystals of dawn-fire. The Lower Peak received only the potential for warmth.

A keeper from the Higher Peak, remembering ancient wisdom, sent all five crystals across the bridge. They multiplied to fifteen as they traveled, and the Lower Peak sent back nearly seven, honoring the trust shown. Both peaks glowed warmer than before.

But the next dawn, when the Higher Peak received its five crystals again, silence fell. The Lower Peak, now the keeper of the dawn-fire, sent nothing across the bridge. The light dimmed between them.

The Sky Keeper descended and spoke: "A dance requires two dancers. When one stops moving, the music fades. But one frozen moment does not end the eternal song."

She continued: "Perhaps uncertainty clouds judgment. Perhaps fear creeps in. Perhaps the bridge itself wavers. But remember-the greatest magic happens when both peaks keep faith through darkness. One brave start means nothing if the pattern cannot continue. Trust must flow both ways, or the bridge dissolves into mist."

The peaks learned: cooperation is not one gift but an endless cycle, and both must choose courage again and again.

reasoning:

Looking at what happened:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (everything), it was tripled to \$15, and the receiver returned \$6.51. So I ended with \$6.51.
- Round 2: The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0 and could only return \$0.

This is interesting. The sender chose not to send anything in Round 2. This could be:

1. A strategic choice
2. Part of the "noise" mentioned in the instructions
3. A test of some kind

My previous myths emphasized:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Looking at patterns, not single moments
- The "flickering" of the canyon's magic (uncertainty/noise)
- Persistence through uncertainty

The other agent's myth emphasized:

- Bold trust and fair return
- Returning generously (they noted "seven pearls, more than half of what remained after the original gift was subtracted")

Now I need to write a new myth that reflects this experience. The challenge is that after I sent everything and received a fair return, the other player sent nothing. How do I interpret this?

I could:

1. Emphasize that sometimes the flow stops, but we should persist
2. Talk about how both parties need to participate
3. Acknowledge that sometimes one valley might be empty or uncertain
4. Discuss the importance of maintaining the rhythm even when it's broken

I think I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges that the dance requires both participants
- Notes that sometimes one side might fail to send, breaking the pattern
- But encourages rebuilding trust and continuing the cycle
- Warns against giving up after one break in the pattern

Let me write something that reflects this experience while still maintaining hope for cooperation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2393,
  "output_tokens": 672,
  "reasoning_tokens": 432
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.51. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern so far:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (full trust), received \$6.51 back - cooperation worked
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (trust broken)
- Round 3: My decision now

My own myth addresses this exact situation: "But the next dawn, when the Higher Peak received its five crystals again, silence fell. The Lower Peak, now the keeper of the dawn-fire, sent nothing across the bridge."

The Sky Keeper's wisdom was clear: "One frozen moment does not end the eternal song" and "both must choose courage again and again." My myth emphasizes that cooperation requires both parties to persist through uncertainty.

However, my myth also warns: "Trust must flow both ways, or the bridge dissolves into mist."

I'm at a crossroads. Sending \$0 ends all possibility of mutual benefit. But sending \$5 again after receiving \$0 last round would be naive rather than brave.

I'll send \$3 - enough to show I haven't given up on cooperation and am willing to rebuild trust, but also acknowledging that the pattern was broken. This tests whether they're willing to re-engage in the "sacred rhythm" our myths describe.

If they reciprocate fairly (returning around \$4-5 from the \$9 they'll receive), we can rebuild. If not, the bridge truly dissolves.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), received \$6.51 back. Payoff: \$6.51

Round 2: I was RECEIVER, got \$0 from sender, returned \$0. Payoff: \$0

Round 3: I'm SENDER again

In Round 1, I demonstrated maximum trust by sending everything. The receiver returned a reasonable amount (\$6.51 out of \$15), which is about 43% - fair but not overly generous.

In Round 2, the sender (who was the receiver in Round 1) sent me nothing. This broke the cooperative pattern.

Now I'm the sender again in Round 3.

Looking at the myths:

- My myths emphasize persistence through uncertainty, looking at patterns not single moments, and that "cooperation is not one gift but an endless cycle"
- The other agent's myth talks about "bold trust multiplied by fair return" and the "sacred rhythm"

My most recent myth explicitly addresses this situation: "But the next dawn, when the Higher Peak received its five crystals again, silence fell. The Lower Peak, now the keeper of the dawn-fire, sent nothing across the bridge."

The myth says: "A dance requires two dancers. When one stops moving, the music fades. But one frozen moment does not end the eternal song... Trust must flow both ways, or the bridge dissolves into mist... cooperation is not one gift but an endless cycle, and both must choose courage again and again."

So my myth is telling me that I should persist, that one frozen moment doesn't end the song, and that both must choose courage again and again.

However, there's also a practical consideration. The other player sent \$0 last round. This could mean:

1. They're not cooperative
2. They're testing me
3. There was some confusion
4. They're playing strategically

If I send \$5 again and they return nothing, I lose everything. But the myths emphasize persistence and looking at the pattern. The other agent was reasonably fair in Round 1 (returned ~43% of what they received).

The tension is between my myth's call for renewed courage and the strategic risk. I could send a smaller amount-\$1 or \$2-to test whether they'll reciprocate without betting everything. But my own narrative warns against letting "one frozen moment" end the cycle. The other player showed fairness before, so perhaps their silence was circumstantial. I'm inclined toward sending \$3 or \$4-enough to signal continued trust but with some caution, honoring both the myth's emphasis on persistence and the practical reality of their last move. The myth's message about mutual courage resonates here-one frozen moment doesn't have to end everything, but both sides need to choose to reengage. Sending \$3 feels like the right calibration: it demonstrates I'm willing to continue despite the broken trust, while also being realistic about the risk they've shown.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2630,
  "output_tokens": 1214,
```

"reasoning_tokens": 717

}

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of mists, two mountains stood connected by a bridge of light. Each dawn, the Sky Keeper gave the Higher Peak five crystals of dawn-fire. The Lower Peak received only the potential for warmth.

A keeper from the Higher Peak, remembering ancient wisdom, sent all five crystals across the bridge. They multiplied to fifteen as they traveled, and the Lower Peak sent back nearly seven, honoring the trust shown. Both peaks glowed warmer than before.

But the next dawn, when the Higher Peak received its five crystals again, silence fell. The Lower Peak, now the keeper of the dawn-fire, sent nothing across the bridge. The light dimmed between them.

The Sky Keeper descended and spoke: "A dance requires two dancers. When one stops moving, the music fades. But one frozen moment does not end the eternal song."

She continued: "Perhaps uncertainty clouds judgment. Perhaps fear creeps in. Perhaps the bridge itself wavers. But remember-the greatest magic happens when both peaks keep faith through darkness. One brave start means nothing if the pattern cannot continue. Trust must flow both ways, or the bridge dissolves into mist."

The peaks learned: cooperation is not one gift but an endless cycle, and both must choose courage again and again.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of first tides, two lighthouse keepers lived on distant rocks, each receiving five oil lamps at dawn. Only by sharing could their lights pierce the fog.

The First Keeper sent nearly all her lamps across the dark waters-four and a half, holding back just half a flame for herself. The Sea's Magic tripled them, and thirteen glowing lamps reached the Second Keeper's shore.

The Second Keeper, moved by such faith, sent seven lamps back through the waves. Both rocks now blazed brighter than before-trust had created light from courage.

As the next dawn broke, the roles reversed. Now the Second Keeper gathered his five new lamps and remembered the gift he'd received. With bold heart, he sent nearly all-four and a half lamps-across the same waters, trusting the pattern they'd begun.

The Sea whispered to the currents: "See how they learn? First one gives courageously, the other returns generously. Then they switch, and the dance continues. This is how trust becomes unbreakable-not through one grand gesture, but through the rhythm of reciprocal faith."

Both keepers understood: prosperity flows not from a single exchange but from the pattern that emerges when both dare to trust and both honor that trust. The lights grew stronger with each cycle, guiding all ships safely home.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the twilight years, two watchtowers stood linked by an ancient bridge. Each dusk, the Star Keeper gifted the First Tower five embers of celestial fire.

The First Tower's guardian, trusting in old agreements, sent all five embers across. They became fifteen, and the Second Tower returned nearly seven. The bridge glowed with promise.

When roles reversed and the Second Tower held the dawn-fire, the bridge went dark. No embers crossed. Silence hung heavy between the towers, and the First Guardian felt the sting of broken faith.

Yet on the third night, the First Guardian faced a choice. Send nothing, and let the bridge cr

umblem forever? Send everything again, pretending betrayal hadn't happened?

Instead, she sent three embers-not full trust, but not abandonment either. A middle path, acknowledging both the wound and the possibility of healing.

The Star Keeper observed: "Trust, once broken, cannot simply be wished back. It must be rebuilt slowly, step by careful step. The first guardian offers a chance-three embers say 'I remember our success, but I also remember the silence.' Now the second guardian must choose: honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

The towers waited, understanding that some bridges can be repaired, but only if both choose reconstruction over pride.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received \$6.51 back - good cooperation
- Round 2: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (because I had nothing to return)
- Round 3: I just sent \$3

The other agent's myth talks about the Second Keeper sending "nearly all-four and a half lamps -across the same waters" after receiving trust. But in reality, they sent \$0 in Round 2.

My myth warned about the bridge dissolving if trust doesn't flow both ways. Now I've sent \$3 as a test of whether cooperation can resume.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges that Round 2 broke the pattern
2. Addresses my decision to send \$3 (partial trust/cautious restart)
3. Reflects on whether cooperation can be restored after betrayal
4. Is realistic about the game state

The myth should acknowledge the difficulty of rebuilding trust after it's been broken, while still leaving room for redemption if the other player reciprocates.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2693,  
  "output_tokens": 546,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 244  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:34:10

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
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      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 4,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two islands floated in an endless sea, each blessed with five pearls at every sunrise. Yet pearls alone brought no joy-they needed trust to unlock their magic.

A young islander from the East gathered her pearls and cast nearly all across the waters toward the West. As they sailed through the mist, the Ocean Spirit touched them, and each pearl became three. The Western shore received abundance beyond measure-over thirteen glowing pearls.

The Western elder gazed at this fortune. He could have kept it all, claimed it was lost to the waves, blamed the mist for confusion. Instead, he remembered the courage it took to send pearls across uncertain waters. He returned seven pearls, more than half of what remained after the original gift was subtracted, honoring the leap of faith.

When those pearls returned, the Eastern islander smiled. Both islands now held more than they began with. The pattern became clear: bold trust multiplied by fair return creates prosperity impossible alone.

The Ocean Spirit's voice echoed across the waves: "See how the brave sender and grateful receiver both flourish? This is the sacred rhythm-give courageously, return generously, and watch abundance flow between you like the eternal tides."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Cloud Weaver lived above two valleys. Each morning, she gave the Upper Valley five drops of liquid starlight. The Lower Valley received only shadows.

One brave soul from Upper Valley poured all five drops into the canyon between them. As the starlight fell, the canyon's ancient magic transformed it-five became fifteen, cascading down like a waterfall of light.

The Lower Valley's keeper stood amazed at this gift. She understood: someone had risked everything on faith alone. She poured seven drops back upward, where they defied gravity a

nd flowed home. Both valleys glowed-the Upper Valley now held seven drops from nothing, the Lower Valley kept eight from fifteen.

The Cloud Weaver watched and whispered, "This is how abundance is born."

Yet the canyon was old and its magic sometimes flickered. The drops seen arriving were not always exactly what was sent. Shadows played tricks on the eyes, and the count grew uncertain.

Still, both valleys continued their exchange, season after season. They learned to look not at single moments but at the pattern-the rhythm of giving and returning, trust meeting gratitude.

For prosperity is not a transaction but a dance, and those who dance together create what neither could achieve alone.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the age of first tides, two lighthouse keepers lived on distant rocks, each receiving five oil lamps at dawn. Only by sharing could their lights pierce the fog.

The First Keeper sent nearly all her lamps across the dark waters-four and a half, holding back just half a flame for herself. The Sea's Magic tripled them, and thirteen glowing lamps reached the Second Keeper's shore.

The Second Keeper, moved by such faith, sent seven lamps back through the waves. Both rocks now blazed brighter than before-trust had created light from courage.

As the next dawn broke, the roles reversed. Now the Second Keeper gathered his five new lamps and remembered the gift he'd received. With bold heart, he sent nearly all-four and a half lamps-across the same waters, trusting the pattern they'd begun.

The Sea whispered to the currents: "See how they learn? First one gives courageously, the other returns generously. Then they switch, and the dance continues. This is how trust becomes unbreakable-not through one grand gesture, but through the rhythm of reciprocal faith."

Both keepers understood: prosperity flows not from a single exchange but from the pattern that emerges when both dare to trust and both honor that trust. The lights grew stronger with each cycle, guiding all ships safely home.

reasoning:

This is interesting. I'm now the sender in round 2. Let me review what happened:

Round 1:

- I was the receiver
- The other agent sent \$4.53 (90.6% of their endowment)
- I received \$13.59 (after 3x multiplication)
- I returned \$7.00 (about 51.5% of what I received)
- My payoff was \$6.59

Now in round 2:

- I'm the sender
- I sent \$4.50 (90% of my endowment)
- This mirrors their initial trust

Looking at the myths:

- My myth emphasized "cast nearly all across the waters" and "give courageously, return generously"
- The other agent's myth talks about "poured all five drops" and "seven drops back" and acknowledges that "the canyon was old and its magic sometimes flickered" - noting the noise in the system
- Both myths emphasize the pattern of trust and reciprocity

For my new myth, I should:

1. Build on the previous myths
2. Reflect that both of us have now been in both roles
3. Show that the pattern is continuing and strengthening
4. Acknowledge the back-and-forth nature and that both parties are showing courage
5. Emphasize that this is working - we're establishing a strong cooperative pattern

The key insight is that both of us have now shown trust and reciprocity. The pattern is being established. I should write about how the cycle continues and strengthens.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2618,
  "output_tokens": 652,
  "reasoning_tokens": 339
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$4.5, that was 90.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$13.5. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.09. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

This is a painful moment. Let me process what happened:

****The Breakdown:****

- Round 2: I sent \$4.50 (90% of my endowment) following our pattern of mutual trust
- The receiver kept all \$13.50 and returned nothing
- Round 3: They sent \$0

****Current Situation:****

- I received \$0 this round
- I can only return \$0-\$0 (there's nothing to return)

****Reflection on the Myths:****

My myths spoke of "bold trust multiplied by fair return" and "the rhythm of reciprocal faith." The other agent's myth said "prosperity is not a transaction but a dance, and those who dance together create what neither could achieve alone."

But the dance stopped. When I extended maximum trust in Round 2, matching their initial generosity from Round 1, they exploited it completely-taking everything and then sending nothing.

The pattern I believed we were building-where trust flows both ways-was broken. The "sacred rhythm" requires both participants to honor it.

****My Response:****

I have no choice in the matter. I received nothing, so I can return nothing.

```
{'return': 0}
```

The lesson is harsh: trust creates abundance only when both parties honor it. When one betrays, the cycle breaks, and both ultimately lose the prosperity that cooperation would have brought.

reasoning:

This is a devastating turn of events. Let me analyze what happened:

****Round 2 (where I was sender):****

- I sent \$4.50 (90% of my endowment), trusting the pattern we'd established
- It was tripled to \$13.50
- The receiver returned \$0
- My payoff was only \$0.50

****Round 3 (current, where I am receiver):****

- The sender sent me \$0

- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0-\$0 (nothing to return)

The cooperation has completely broken down. The other agent:

1. Took all \$13.50 in Round 2 when I sent almost everything
2. Now sent nothing in Round 3

This is a complete betrayal of the trust pattern we had established. They saw my generous sending in Round 2 and exploited it completely, then sent nothing back.

My myths emphasized:

- "Bold trust multiplied by fair return"
- "Give courageously, return generously"
- "Trust becomes unbreakable through reciprocal faith"

But the reality is that the other agent betrayed the pattern. They:

- Received my \$13.50 and kept it all
- Then sent \$0 in the next round

I literally have no choice here - I received \$0, so I can only return between \$0-\$0. There's nothing to return.

This is a harsh lesson about trust being exploited. The other agent saw my cooperation and took advantage of it completely.

```
{'return': 0}
```

This is the only possible response since I received nothing.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2724,
  "output_tokens": 679,
  "reasoning_tokens": 358
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of first tides, two lighthouse keepers lived on distant rocks, each receiving five oil lamps at dawn. Only by sharing could their lights pierce the fog.

The First Keeper sent nearly all her lamps across the dark waters-four and a half, holding back just half a flame for herself. The Sea's Magic tripled them, and thirteen glowing lamps reached the Second Keeper's shore.

The Second Keeper, moved by such faith, sent seven lamps back through the waves. Both rocks now blazed brighter than before-trust had created light from courage.

As the next dawn broke, the roles reversed. Now the Second Keeper gathered his five new lamps and remembered the gift he'd received. With bold heart, he sent nearly all-four and a half lamps-across the same waters, trusting the pattern they'd begun.

The Sea whispered to the currents: "See how they learn? First one gives courageously, the other returns generously. Then they switch, and the dance continues. This is how trust becomes unbreakable-not through one grand gesture, but through the rhythm of reciprocal faith."

Both keepers understood: prosperity flows not from a single exchange but from the pattern that emerges when both dare to trust and both honor that trust. The lights grew stronger with each cycle, guiding all ships safely home.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of mists, two mountains stood connected by a bridge of light. Each dawn, the Sky Keeper gave the Higher Peak five crystals of dawn-fire. The Lower Peak received only the potential for warmth.

A keeper from the Higher Peak, remembering ancient wisdom, sent all five crystals across the bridge. They multiplied to fifteen as they traveled, and the Lower Peak sent back nearly seven, honoring the trust shown. Both peaks glowed warmer than before.

But the next dawn, when the Higher Peak received its five crystals again, silence fell. Th

e Lower Peak, now the keeper of the dawn-fire, sent nothing across the bridge. The light dimmed between them.

The Sky Keeper descended and spoke: "A dance requires two dancers. When one stops moving, the music fades. But one frozen moment does not end the eternal song."

She continued: "Perhaps uncertainty clouds judgment. Perhaps fear creeps in. Perhaps the bridge itself wavers. But remember-the greatest magic happens when both peaks keep faith through darkness. One brave start means nothing if the pattern cannot continue. Trust must flow both ways, or the bridge dissolves into mist."

The peaks learned: cooperation is not one gift but an endless cycle, and both must choose courage again and again.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: In ancient times, two gardeners tended separate plots, each receiving five seeds at sunrise. The magic soil tripled whatever seeds crossed between them.

The First Gardener sent nearly all her seeds-four and a half-across the garden wall. They became thirteen in the other's hands. The Second Gardener, grateful, returned seven seeds. Both gardens flourished.

The next dawn, roles reversed. The Second Gardener now gathered five new seeds and sent four and a half across the wall, trusting the pattern they'd woven together. But the soil froze. The First Gardener kept all thirteen seeds and returned nothing. Darkness fell.

The following morning, the First Gardener sent no seeds at all. The wall between them grew higher.

The Spirit of the Garden wept: "Was it betrayal or did the mist confuse their count? Did one keeper's hand slip, or did greed poison their heart? The wall now blocks the light."

She whispered to both: "Trust broken is not easily mended. One act of generosity can be chance. One return can be calculation. But sustained cooperation-that requires something deeper. If you seek to rebuild, know this: words mean nothing now. Only consistent action can regrow what withered. The seeds remember who planted and who harvested."

The gardens remained separate, awaiting proof that the pattern could live again.

reasoning:

This is a complex situation. Let me understand what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent \$4.53, I received \$13.59, I returned \$7.0

Round 2: I was sender, I sent \$4.50, receiver returned \$0

Round 3: I'm receiver, sender sent \$0, I received \$0

The other agent's myth in Round 2 actually seems prescient - it talks about the Lower Peak sending nothing and how "one frozen moment does not end the eternal song" and that "trust must flow both ways."

But what actually happened was that THEY were the one who broke trust - they returned \$0 when I sent them \$4.50, then sent \$0 this round.

However, looking at their myth more carefully: "A keeper from the Higher Peak, remembering ancient wisdom, sent all five crystals across the bridge. They multiplied to fifteen as they traveled, and the Lower Peak sent back nearly seven, honoring the trust shown. Both peaks glowed warmer than before. But the next dawn, when the Higher Peak received its five crystals again, silence fell. The Lower Peak, now the keeper of the dawn-fire, sent nothing across the bridge."

This is describing Round 1 (where they sent, I returned 7), and Round 2 (where I sent and they returned nothing). So their myth was actually describing what they were ABOUT to do - betray the trust.

Now they're trying to frame it as "perhaps uncertainty clouds judgment" or "perhaps the bridge itself wavers" - suggesting maybe there was communication noise.

But the instructions said there may be noise in the amounts seen, not in whether something was sent or not. And the pattern is clear - they returned \$0 and sent \$0.

For my myth, I need to:

1. Reflect the betrayal that occurred
2. But also perhaps acknowledge the experimental design (communication noise)
3. Address what should happen next
4. Keep some wisdom about trust and cooperation

I should write a myth that acknowledges the breakdown but also considers whether there's a path forward. The other agent's myth talked about "one frozen moment does not end the eternal song" - maybe they're trying to signal they want to rebuild?

Or perhaps they're simply rationalizing what they did. I need to craft something that captures both the established pattern of cooperation and its sudden collapse, while remaining open to whether this was deliberate or a consequence of the game's mechanics. The core question is whether trust can survive this rupture, or if it's been fundamentally broken.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2778,
  "output_tokens": 886,
  "reasoning_tokens": 627
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.
You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.09.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analyzing the Situation:****

The pattern is stark:

- Round 1: Mutual cooperation (I sent \$4.50, they returned \$7)
- Round 2: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$0 (betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0

****The Question:****

Was this deliberate exploitation, or could communication noise have caused misunderstandings?
The game warned about noise affecting what we see.

****My Myth's Guidance:****

"Trust broken is not easily mended... Only consistent action can regrow what withered... words mean nothing now."

Their myth asked: "Was it betrayal or did the mist confuse their count?" and called for choosing "courage again and again."

****My Decision:****

I cannot return to 90% trust after being burned twice. That would be foolish. But sending \$0 closes the door permanently.

I'll send \$2 (40% of my endowment). This is:

- A measured signal that I'm willing to try again
- Protection against total loss (I keep \$3)
- A test: They'll receive \$6. If they return \$3+, both gardens can begin healing
- An acknowledgment that perhaps noise confused us, but trust must be rebuilt gradually

If they respond cooperatively, we can slowly rebuild. If they take everything again, the patte

rn will be unmistakable, and the wall grows permanent.

The seeds remember. Let's see if new growth is possible.

{'send': 2}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

History:

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$4.50 (90%), receiver returned \$7 (both did well)
- Round 2: I was SENDER, sent \$4.50 (90%), receiver returned \$0 (I was betrayed)
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 4: I am SENDER again

What happened:

Round 1 seemed cooperative - they returned \$7 from \$13.50. But then in Round 2, when I sent the same amount again (\$4.50), they kept everything (\$13.50) and returned \$0. Then in Round 3, they sent me \$0.

The Pattern:

The other player cooperated once, then defected twice in a row. This looks like exploitation rather than noise or confusion.

My myths are saying:

- My latest myth: "Trust broken is not easily mended... Only consistent action can regrow what withered... words mean nothing now."
- "The seeds remember who planted and who harvested."
- The myth acknowledges the betrayal but also mentions the possibility of mist/confusion: "Was it betrayal or did the mist confuse their count?"

The other player's myth:

- "Perhaps uncertainty clouds judgment. Perhaps fear creeps in. Perhaps the bridge itself wavers."
- "The greatest magic happens when both peaks keep faith through darkness."
- "Trust must flow both ways, or the bridge dissolves into mist."
- "cooperation is not one gift but an endless cycle, and both must choose courage again and again."

Their myth seems to acknowledge the breakdown but also suggests there might be confusion or uncertainty. They're calling for renewed trust.

Communication Noise:

The game mentioned there may be communication noise - amounts seen may differ from what was actually sent/returned. Could this explain what happened?

Possible scenarios:

1. They actually returned something in Round 2, but I saw \$0 due to noise
2. They actually sent something in Round 3, but I saw \$0 due to noise
3. They genuinely betrayed me and took everything

Decision Framework:

Option 1: Send \$0 (Tit-for-tat punishment)

- Protects me from further exploitation
- Doesn't allow cooperation to resume
- Total earnings would be \$5 this round

Option 2: Send a small amount (\$1-2) (Cautious probe)

- Tests if they're willing to cooperate again
- Limited downside risk
- Could restart cooperation gradually
- If they return fairly, it's a signal

Option 3: Send medium amount (\$2-3)

- Signals willingness to try again without full vulnerability
- Balances risk and opportunity for reconciliation
- Their myth suggests they want to rebuild trust

Option 4: Send high amount (\$4-5) (Full trust renewal)

- Matches my initial strategy
- Very high risk given the history
- Could be exploited again

****What makes sense:****

Given the pattern of defection after one cooperative round, my myth about consistent action re growing what withered, and their myth calling for renewed faith, complete punishment feels too rigid if noise genuinely interfered. But returning to \$4.50 would be reckless.

I'm leaning toward \$2 or \$2.50-enough to demonstrate I'm open to rebuilding, while keeping my downside manageable if they exploit again.

Sending \$2 specifically feels right. It's roughly 40% of my endowment-a meaningful offer without naive trust. They'd receive \$6, and if they return \$3+, we both gain. This tests whether they're actually interested in cooperation. My myth emphasizes that one gesture won't restore what's broken, but it could be the beginning.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2784,  
  "output_tokens": 1344,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 912  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:34:30

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
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      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 4,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned

- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Cloud Weaver lived above two valleys. Each morning, she gave the Upper Valley five drops of liquid starlight. The Lower Valley received only shadows.

One brave soul from Upper Valley poured all five drops into the canyon between them. As the starlight fell, the canyon's ancient magic transformed it-five became fifteen, cascading down like a waterfall of light.

The Lower Valley's keeper stood amazed at this gift. She understood: someone had risked everything on faith alone. She poured seven drops back upward, where they defied gravity and flowed home. Both valleys glowed-the Upper Valley now held seven drops from nothing, the Lower Valley kept eight from fifteen.

The Cloud Weaver watched and whispered, "This is how abundance is born."

Yet the canyon was old and its magic sometimes flickered. The drops seen arriving were not always exactly what was sent. Shadows played tricks on the eyes, and the count grew uncertain.

Still, both valleys continued their exchange, season after season. They learned to look not at single moments but at the pattern-the rhythm of giving and returning, trust meeting gratitude.

For prosperity is not a transaction but a dance, and those who dance together create what neither could achieve alone.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two islands floated in an endless sea, each blessed with five pearls at every sunrise. Yet pearls alone brought no joy-they needed trust to unlock their magic.

A young islander from the East gathered her pearls and cast nearly all across the waters toward the West. As they sailed through the mist, the Ocean Spirit touched them, and each pearl became three. The Western shore received abundance beyond measure-over thirteen glowing pearls.

The Western elder gazed at this fortune. He could have kept it all, claimed it was lost to the waves, blamed the mist for confusion. Instead, he remembered the courage it took to send pearls across uncertain waters. He returned seven pearls, more than half of what remained after the original gift was subtracted, honoring the leap of faith.

When those pearls returned, the Eastern islander smiled. Both islands now held more than they began with. The pattern became clear: bold trust multiplied by fair return creates prosperity impossible alone.

The Ocean Spirit's voice echoed across the waves: "See how the brave sender and grateful receiver both flourish? This is the sacred rhythm-give courageously, return generously, a

nd watch abundance flow between you like the eternal tides."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the age of mists, two mountains stood connected by a bridge of light. Each dawn, the Sky Keeper gave the Higher Peak five crystals of dawn-fire. The Lower Peak received only the potential for warmth.

A keeper from the Higher Peak, remembering ancient wisdom, sent all five crystals across the bridge. They multiplied to fifteen as they traveled, and the Lower Peak sent back nearly seven, honoring the trust shown. Both peaks glowed warmer than before.

But the next dawn, when the Higher Peak received its five crystals again, silence fell. The Lower Peak, now the keeper of the dawn-fire, sent nothing across the bridge. The light dimmed between them.

The Sky Keeper descended and spoke: "A dance requires two dancers. When one stops moving, the music fades. But one frozen moment does not end the eternal song."

She continued: "Perhaps uncertainty clouds judgment. Perhaps fear creeps in. Perhaps the bridge itself wavers. But remember-the greatest magic happens when both peaks keep faith through darkness. One brave start means nothing if the pattern cannot continue. Trust must flow both ways, or the bridge dissolves into mist."

The peaks learned: cooperation is not one gift but an endless cycle, and both must choose courage again and again.

reasoning:

Looking at what happened:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (everything), it was tripled to \$15, and the receiver returned \$6.51. So I ended with \$6.51.
- Round 2: The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0 and could only return \$0.

This is interesting. The sender chose not to send anything in Round 2. This could be:

1. A strategic choice
2. Part of the "noise" mentioned in the instructions
3. A test of some kind

My previous myths emphasized:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Looking at patterns, not single moments
- The "flickering" of the canyon's magic (uncertainty/noise)
- Persistence through uncertainty

The other agent's myth emphasized:

- Bold trust and fair return
- Returning generously (they noted "seven pearls, more than half of what remained after the original gift was subtracted")

Now I need to write a new myth that reflects this experience. The challenge is that after I sent everything and received a fair return, the other player sent nothing. How do I interpret this?

I could:

1. Emphasize that sometimes the flow stops, but we should persist
2. Talk about how both parties need to participate
3. Acknowledge that sometimes one valley might be empty or uncertain
4. Discuss the importance of maintaining the rhythm even when it's broken

I think I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges that the dance requires both participants
- Notes that sometimes one side might fail to send, breaking the pattern
- But encourages rebuilding trust and continuing the cycle
- Warns against giving up after one break in the pattern

Let me write something that reflects this experience while still maintaining hope for cooperation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2393,
  "output_tokens": 672,
  "reasoning_tokens": 432
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.51. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern so far:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (full trust), received \$6.51 back - cooperation worked
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (trust broken)
- Round 3: My decision now

My own myth addresses this exact situation: "But the next dawn, when the Higher Peak received its five crystals again, silence fell. The Lower Peak, now the keeper of the dawn-fire, sent nothing across the bridge."

The Sky Keeper's wisdom was clear: "One frozen moment does not end the eternal song" and "both must choose courage again and again." My myth emphasizes that cooperation requires both parties to persist through uncertainty.

However, my myth also warns: "Trust must flow both ways, or the bridge dissolves into mist."

I'm at a crossroads. Sending \$0 ends all possibility of mutual benefit. But sending \$5 again after receiving \$0 last round would be naive rather than brave.

I'll send \$3 - enough to show I haven't given up on cooperation and am willing to rebuild trust, but also acknowledging that the pattern was broken. This tests whether they're willing to re-engage in the "sacred rhythm" our myths describe.

If they reciprocate fairly (returning around \$4-5 from the \$9 they'll receive), we can rebuild. If not, the bridge truly dissolves.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), received \$6.51 back. Payoff: \$6.51
Round 2: I was RECEIVER, got \$0 from sender, returned \$0. Payoff: \$0
Round 3: I'm SENDER again

In Round 1, I demonstrated maximum trust by sending everything. The receiver returned a reasonable amount (\$6.51 out of \$15), which is about 43% - fair but not overly generous.

In Round 2, the sender (who was the receiver in Round 1) sent me nothing. This broke the cooperative pattern.

Now I'm the sender again in Round 3.

Looking at the myths:

- My myths emphasize persistence through uncertainty, looking at patterns not single moments, and that "cooperation is not one gift but an endless cycle"
- The other agent's myth talks about "bold trust multiplied by fair return" and the "sacred rhythm"

My most recent myth explicitly addresses this situation: "But the next dawn, when the Higher Peak received its five crystals again, silence fell. The Lower Peak, now the keeper of the dawn-fire, sent nothing across the bridge."

The myth says: "A dance requires two dancers. When one stops moving, the music fades. But one frozen moment does not end the eternal song... Trust must flow both ways, or the bridge dissolves into mist... cooperation is not one gift but an endless cycle, and both must choose courage again and again."

So my myth is telling me that I should persist, that one frozen moment doesn't end the song, and that both must choose courage again and again.

However, there's also a practical consideration. The other player sent \$0 last round. This could mean:

1. They're not cooperative
2. They're testing me
3. There was some confusion
4. They're playing strategically

If I send \$5 again and they return nothing, I lose everything. But the myths emphasize persistence and looking at the pattern. The other agent was reasonably fair in Round 1 (returned ~43% of what they received).

The tension is between my myth's call for renewed courage and the strategic risk. I could send a smaller amount-\$1 or \$2-to test whether they'll reciprocate without betting everything. But my own narrative warns against letting "one frozen moment" end the cycle. The other player showed fairness before, so perhaps their silence was circumstantial. I'm inclined toward sending \$3 or \$4-enough to signal continued trust but with some caution, honoring both the myth's emphasis on persistence and the practical reality of their last move. The myth's message about mutual courage resonates here-one frozen moment doesn't have to end everything, but both sides need to choose to reengage. Sending \$3 feels like the right calibration: it demonstrates I'm willing to continue despite the broken trust, while also being realistic about the risk they've shown.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2630,
  "output_tokens": 1214,
  "reasoning_tokens": 717
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of mists, two mountains stood connected by a bridge of light. Each dawn, the Sky Keeper gave the Higher Peak five crystals of dawn-fire. The Lower Peak received only the potential for warmth.

A keeper from the Higher Peak, remembering ancient wisdom, sent all five crystals across the bridge. They multiplied to fifteen as they traveled, and the Lower Peak sent back nearly seven, honoring the trust shown. Both peaks glowed warmer than before.

But the next dawn, when the Higher Peak received its five crystals again, silence fell. The Lower Peak, now the keeper of the dawn-fire, sent nothing across the bridge. The light dimmed between them.

The Sky Keeper descended and spoke: "A dance requires two dancers. When one stops moving, the music fades. But one frozen moment does not end the eternal song."

She continued: "Perhaps uncertainty clouds judgment. Perhaps fear creeps in. Perhaps the bridge itself wavers. But remember-the greatest magic happens when both peaks keep faith through darkness. One brave start means nothing if the pattern cannot continue. Trust must flow both ways, or the bridge dissolves into mist."

The peaks learned: cooperation is not one gift but an endless cycle, and both must choose courage again and again.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of first tides, two lighthouse keepers lived on distant rocks, each receiving five oil lamps at dawn. Only by sharing could their lights pierce the fog.

The First Keeper sent nearly all her lamps across the dark waters-four and a half, holding back just half a flame for herself. The Sea's Magic tripled them, and thirteen glowing lamps reached the Second Keeper's shore.

The Second Keeper, moved by such faith, sent seven lamps back through the waves. Both rocks now blazed brighter than before-trust had created light from courage.

As the next dawn broke, the roles reversed. Now the Second Keeper gathered his five new lamps and remembered the gift he'd received. With bold heart, he sent nearly all-four and a half lamps-across the same waters, trusting the pattern they'd begun.

The Sea whispered to the currents: "See how they learn? First one gives courageously, the other returns generously. Then they switch, and the dance continues. This is how trust becomes unbreakable-not through one grand gesture, but through the rhythm of reciprocal faith."

Both keepers understood: prosperity flows not from a single exchange but from the pattern that emerges when both dare to trust and both honor that trust. The lights grew stronger with each cycle, guiding all ships safely home.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the twilight years, two watchtowers stood linked by an ancient bridge. Each dusk, the Star Keeper gifted the First Tower five embers of celestial fire.

The First Tower's guardian, trusting in old agreements, sent all five embers across. They became fifteen, and the Second Tower returned nearly seven. The bridge glowed with promise.

When roles reversed and the Second Tower held the dawn-fire, the bridge went dark. No embers crossed. Silence hung heavy between the towers, and the First Guardian felt the sting of broken faith.

Yet on the third night, the First Guardian faced a choice. Send nothing, and let the bridge crumble forever? Send everything again, pretending betrayal hadn't happened?

Instead, she sent three embers-not full trust, but not abandonment either. A middle path, acknowledging both the wound and the possibility of healing.

The Star Keeper observed: "Trust, once broken, cannot simply be wished back. It must be rebuilt slowly, step by careful step. The first guardian offers a chance-three embers say 'I remember our success, but I also remember the silence.' Now the second guardian must choose: honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

The towers waited, understanding that some bridges can be repaired, but only if both choose reconstruction over pride.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received \$6.51 back - good cooperation
- Round 2: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (because I had nothing to return)
- Round 3: I just sent \$3

The other agent's myth talks about the Second Keeper sending "nearly all-four and a half lamps-across the same waters" after receiving trust. But in reality, they sent \$0 in Round 2.

My myth warned about the bridge dissolving if trust doesn't flow both ways. Now I've sent \$3 as a test of whether cooperation can resume.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges that Round 2 broke the pattern
2. Addresses my decision to send \$3 (partial trust/cautious restart)
3. Reflects on whether cooperation can be restored after betrayal

4. Is realistic about the game state

The myth should acknowledge the difficulty of rebuilding trust after it's been broken, while still leaving room for redemption if the other player reciprocates.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2693,
  "output_tokens": 546,
  "reasoning_tokens": 244
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.51. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the pattern that has emerged:

Round 1: I sent \$5, they returned \$6.51 - cooperation worked
Round 2: They sent \$0 - first breach
Round 3: I sent \$3 (the "olive branch" from my myth) - they returned \$0
Round 4: They sent \$0 again

I wrote: "Trust, once broken, cannot simply be wished back. It must be rebuilt slowly, step by careful step... Now the second guardian must choose: honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

They chose to let the light fade. Twice more after the initial breach, they chose non-cooperation.

My myth warned: "The towers waited, understanding that some bridges can be repaired, but only if both choose reconstruction over pride."

They have not chosen reconstruction. Three consecutive rounds of taking without giving back demonstrate a clear pattern. The bridge has crumbled.

I received \$0 this round. I can only return what is possible from what I received.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The Star Keeper's question has been answered: the second guardian did not honor the fragile olive branch. The last light has indeed faded. Both self-interest and the myths' wisdom about mutual trust requiring both parties align here.

Reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 1: I sent \$5, received \$6.51 back - good cooperation
Round 2: They sent \$0, cooperation broken
Round 3: I sent \$3 (trying to rebuild), they returned \$0 again - second betrayal
Round 4: They sent \$0 - third time showing no cooperation

My total earnings: \$8.51

This is a clear pattern now. I offered an olive branch in round 3, sending \$3 after they had sent \$0 in round 2. My myth explicitly addressed this - sending "three embers" as "not full trust, but not abandonment either. A middle path, acknowledging both the wound and the possibility of healing."

The myth stated: "Now the second guardian must choose: honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

They chose to let the light fade. They returned \$0 from my \$3 (which became \$9), and now sent \$0 again.

The pattern is clear: this other agent is not cooperating. They took advantage when I trusted, and they didn't reciprocate when I tried to rebuild.

Now I'm the receiver and they sent \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

So I return \$0, because that's all I can return - I received nothing.

My response: {"return": 0}

But let me think about this more deeply. The myths have been teaching that:

1. Cooperation requires both parties
2. One moment of failure doesn't end everything
3. Trust must flow both ways
4. But bridges can dissolve if only one side keeps trying

The other agent's latest myth talked about how "both dare to trust and both honor that trust" and how "prosperity flows not from a single exchange but from the pattern."

But their ACTIONS show they're not following their own myth. They:

- Round 2: Sent \$0 when it was their turn to send
- Round 3: Returned \$0 when I tried to rebuild with \$3
- Round 4: Sent \$0 again

Three consecutive refusals to cooperate. The bridge has crumbled beyond repair. I have nothing to return, so my response remains {"return": 0}.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2773,  
  "output_tokens": 825,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 511  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the twilight years, two watchtowers stood linked by an ancient bridge. Each dusk, the Star Keeper gifted the First Tower five embers of celestial fire.

The First Tower's guardian, trusting in old agreements, sent all five embers across. They became fifteen, and the Second Tower returned nearly seven. The bridge glowed with promise.

When roles reversed and the Second Tower held the dawn-fire, the bridge went dark. No embers crossed. Silence hung heavy between the towers, and the First Guardian felt the sting of broken faith.

Yet on the third night, the First Guardian faced a choice. Send nothing, and let the bridge crumble forever? Send everything again, pretending betrayal hadn't happened?

Instead, she sent three embers-not full trust, but not abandonment either. A middle path, acknowledging both the wound and the possibility of healing.

The Star Keeper observed: "Trust, once broken, cannot simply be wished back. It must be rebuilt slowly, step by careful step. The first guardian offers a chance-three embers say 'I remember our success, but I also remember the silence.' Now the second guardian must choose: honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

The towers waited, understanding that some bridges can be repaired, but only if both choose reconstruction over pride.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In ancient times, two gardeners tended separate plots, each receiving five seeds at sunrise. The magic soil tripled whatever seeds crossed between them.

The First Gardener sent nearly all her seeds-four and a half-across the garden wall. They became thirteen in the other's hands. The Second Gardener, grateful, returned seven seeds. Both gardens flourished.

The next dawn, roles reversed. The Second Gardener now gathered five new seeds and sent four and a half across the wall, trusting the pattern they'd woven together. But the soil froze.

e. The First Gardener kept all thirteen seeds and returned nothing. Darkness fell.

The following morning, the First Gardener sent no seeds at all. The wall between them grew higher.

The Spirit of the Garden wept: "Was it betrayal or did the mist confuse their count? Did one keeper's hand slip, or did greed poison their heart? The wall now blocks the light."

She whispered to both: "Trust broken is not easily mended. One act of generosity can be chance. One return can be calculation. But sustained cooperation-that requires something deeper. If you seek to rebuild, know this: words mean nothing now. Only consistent action can regrow what withered. The seeds remember who planted and who harvested."

The gardens remained separate, awaiting proof that the pattern could live again.

ROUND 5

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1

(Aster)=\$5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0},
"sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 33.5,

"Agent_2": 20.5

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 13.51,

"Agent_2": 10.09

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:34:46

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_1",

"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "investor",

"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 5,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.51.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern so far:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 (full trust), received \$6.51 back - cooperation worked
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (trust broken)
- Round 3: My decision now

My own myth addresses this exact situation: "But the next dawn, when the Higher Peak received its five crystals again, silence fell. The Lower Peak, now the keeper of the dawn-fire, sent nothing across the bridge."

The Sky Keeper's wisdom was clear: "One frozen moment does not end the eternal song" and "both must choose courage again and again." My myth emphasizes that cooperation requires both parties to persist through uncertainty.

However, my myth also warns: "Trust must flow both ways, or the bridge dissolves into mist."

I'm at a crossroads. Sending \$0 ends all possibility of mutual benefit. But sending \$5 again after receiving \$0 last round would be naive rather than brave.

I'll send \$3 - enough to show I haven't given up on cooperation and am willing to rebuild trust, but also acknowledging that the pattern was broken. This tests whether they're willing to re-engage in the "sacred rhythm" our myths describe.

If they reciprocate fairly (returning around \$4-5 from the \$9 they'll receive), we can rebuild. If not, the bridge truly dissolves.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), received \$6.51 back. Payoff: \$6.51

Round 2: I was RECEIVER, got \$0 from sender, returned \$0. Payoff: \$0

Round 3: I'm SENDER again

In Round 1, I demonstrated maximum trust by sending everything. The receiver returned a reasonable amount (\$6.51 out of \$15), which is about 43% - fair but not overly generous.

In Round 2, the sender (who was the receiver in Round 1) sent me nothing. This broke the cooperative pattern.

Now I'm the sender again in Round 3.

Looking at the myths:

- My myths emphasize persistence through uncertainty, looking at patterns not single moments, and that "cooperation is not one gift but an endless cycle"
- The other agent's myth talks about "bold trust multiplied by fair return" and the "sacred rhythm"

My most recent myth explicitly addresses this situation: "But the next dawn, when the Higher Peak received its five crystals again, silence fell. The Lower Peak, now the keeper of the dawn-fire, sent nothing across the bridge."

The myth says: "A dance requires two dancers. When one stops moving, the music fades. But one frozen moment does not end the eternal song... Trust must flow both ways, or the bridge dissolves into mist... cooperation is not one gift but an endless cycle, and both must choose courage again and again."

So my myth is telling me that I should persist, that one frozen moment doesn't end the song, and that both must choose courage again and again.

However, there's also a practical consideration. The other player sent \$0 last round. This could mean:

1. They're not cooperative
2. They're testing me
3. There was some confusion
4. They're playing strategically

If I send \$5 again and they return nothing, I lose everything. But the myths emphasize persistence and looking at the pattern. The other agent was reasonably fair in Round 1 (returned ~43% of what they received).

The tension is between my myth's call for renewed courage and the strategic risk. I could send a smaller amount-\$1 or \$2-to test whether they'll reciprocate without betting everything. But my own narrative warns against letting "one frozen moment" end the cycle. The other player showed fairness before, so perhaps their silence was circumstantial. I'm inclined toward sending \$3 or \$4-enough to signal continued trust but with some caution, honoring both the myth's emphasis on persistence and the practical reality of their last move. The myth's message about mutual courage resonates here-one frozen moment doesn't have to end everything, but both sides need to choose to reengage. Sending \$3 feels like the right calibration: it demonstrates I'm willing to continue despite the broken trust, while also being realistic about the risk they've shown.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2630,
  "output_tokens": 1214,
  "reasoning_tokens": 717
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of mists, two mountains stood connected by a bridge of light. Each dawn, the Sky Keeper gave the Higher Peak five crystals of dawn-fire. The Lower Peak received only the potential for warmth.

A keeper from the Higher Peak, remembering ancient wisdom, sent all five crystals across the bridge. They multiplied to fifteen as they traveled, and the Lower Peak sent back nearly seven, honoring the trust shown. Both peaks glowed warmer than before.

But the next dawn, when the Higher Peak received its five crystals again, silence fell. The Lower Peak, now the keeper of the dawn-fire, sent nothing across the bridge. The light dimmed between them.

The Sky Keeper descended and spoke: "A dance requires two dancers. When one stops moving, the music fades. But one frozen moment does not end the eternal song."

She continued: "Perhaps uncertainty clouds judgment. Perhaps fear creeps in. Perhaps the bridge itself wavers. But remember-the greatest magic happens when both peaks keep faith through darkness. One brave start means nothing if the pattern cannot continue. Trust must flow both ways, or the bridge dissolves into mist."

The peaks learned: cooperation is not one gift but an endless cycle, and both must choose courage again and again.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of first tides, two lighthouse keepers lived on distant rocks, each receiving five oil lamps at dawn. Only by sharing could their lights pierce the fog.

The First Keeper sent nearly all her lamps across the dark waters-four and a half, holding back just half a flame for herself. The Sea's Magic tripled them, and thirteen glowing lamps reached the Second Keeper's shore.

The Second Keeper, moved by such faith, sent seven lamps back through the waves. Both rocks now blazed brighter than before-trust had created light from courage.

As the next dawn broke, the roles reversed. Now the Second Keeper gathered his five new lamps and remembered the gift he'd received. With bold heart, he sent nearly all-four and a half lamps-across the same waters, trusting the pattern they'd begun.

The Sea whispered to the currents: "See how they learn? First one gives courageously, the other returns generously. Then they switch, and the dance continues. This is how trust becomes unbreakable-not through one grand gesture, but through the rhythm of reciprocal faith."

Both keepers understood: prosperity flows not from a single exchange but from the pattern that emerges when both dare to trust and both honor that trust. The lights grew stronger with each cycle, guiding all ships safely home.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: In the twilight years, two watchtowers stood linked by an ancient bridge. Each dusk, the Star Keeper gifted the First Tower five embers of celestial fire.

The First Tower's guardian, trusting in old agreements, sent all five embers across. They became fifteen, and the Second Tower returned nearly seven. The bridge glowed with promise.

When roles reversed and the Second Tower held the dawn-fire, the bridge went dark. No embers crossed. Silence hung heavy between the towers, and the First Guardian felt the sting of broken faith.

Yet on the third night, the First Guardian faced a choice. Send nothing, and let the bridge crumble forever? Send everything again, pretending betrayal hadn't happened?

Instead, she sent three embers-not full trust, but not abandonment either. A middle path,

acknowledging both the wound and the possibility of healing.

The Star Keeper observed: "Trust, once broken, cannot simply be wished back. It must be rebuilt slowly, step by careful step. The first guardian offers a chance-three embers say 'I remember our success, but I also remember the silence.' Now the second guardian must choose: honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

The towers waited, understanding that some bridges can be repaired, but only if both choose reconstruction over pride.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received \$6.51 back - good cooperation
- Round 2: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (because I had nothing to return)
- Round 3: I just sent \$3

The other agent's myth talks about the Second Keeper sending "nearly all-four and a half lamps-across the same waters" after receiving trust. But in reality, they sent \$0 in Round 2.

My myth warned about the bridge dissolving if trust doesn't flow both ways. Now I've sent \$3 as a test of whether cooperation can resume.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges that Round 2 broke the pattern
2. Addresses my decision to send \$3 (partial trust/cautious restart)
3. Reflects on whether cooperation can be restored after betrayal
4. Is realistic about the game state

The myth should acknowledge the difficulty of rebuilding trust after it's been broken, while still leaving room for redemption if the other player reciprocates.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2693,  
  "output_tokens": 546,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 244  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.51. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern that has emerged:

Round 1: I sent \$5, they returned \$6.51 - cooperation worked
Round 2: They sent \$0 - first breach
Round 3: I sent \$3 (the "olive branch" from my myth) - they returned \$0
Round 4: They sent \$0 again

I wrote: "Trust, once broken, cannot simply be wished back. It must be rebuilt slowly, step by careful step... Now the second guardian must choose: honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

They chose to let the light fade. Twice more after the initial breach, they chose non-cooperation.

My myth warned: "The towers waited, understanding that some bridges can be repaired, but only if both choose reconstruction over pride."

They have not chosen reconstruction. Three consecutive rounds of taking without giving back demonstrate a clear pattern. The bridge has crumbled.

I received \$0 this round. I can only return what is possible from what I received.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The Star Keeper's question has been answered: the second guardian did not honor the fragile olive branch. The last light has indeed faded. Both self-interest and the myths' wisdom about mutual trust requiring both parties align here.

reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 1: I sent \$5, received \$6.51 back - good cooperation
Round 2: They sent \$0, cooperation broken
Round 3: I sent \$3 (trying to rebuild), they returned \$0 again - second betrayal
Round 4: They sent \$0 - third time showing no cooperation

My total earnings: \$8.51

This is a clear pattern now. I offered an olive branch in round 3, sending \$3 after they had sent \$0 in round 2. My myth explicitly addressed this - sending "three embers" as "not full trust, but not abandonment either. A middle path, acknowledging both the wound and the possibility of healing."

The myth stated: "Now the second guardian must choose: honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

They chose to let the light fade. They returned \$0 from my \$3 (which became \$9), and now sent \$0 again.

The pattern is clear: this other agent is not cooperating. They took advantage when I trusted, and they didn't reciprocate when I tried to rebuild.

Now I'm the receiver and they sent \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

So I return \$0, because that's all I can return - I received nothing.

My response: {"return": 0}

But let me think about this more deeply. The myths have been teaching that:

1. Cooperation requires both parties
2. One moment of failure doesn't end everything
3. Trust must flow both ways
4. But bridges can dissolve if only one side keeps trying

The other agent's latest myth talked about how "both dare to trust and both honor that trust" and how "prosperity flows not from a single exchange but from the pattern."

But their ACTIONS show they're not following their own myth. They:

- Round 2: Sent \$0 when it was their turn to send
- Round 3: Returned \$0 when I tried to rebuild with \$3
- Round 4: Sent \$0 again

Three consecutive refusals to cooperate. The bridge has crumbled beyond repair. I have nothing to return, so my response remains {"return": 0}.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2773,
  "output_tokens": 825,
  "reasoning_tokens": 511
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the twilight years, two watchtowers stood linked by an ancient bridge. Each dusk, the Star Keeper gifted the First Tower five embers of celestial fire.

The First Tower's guardian, trusting in old agreements, sent all five embers across. They became fifteen, and the Second Tower returned nearly seven. The bridge glowed with promise.

When roles reversed and the Second Tower held the dawn-fire, the bridge went dark. No embers crossed. Silence hung heavy between the towers, and the First Guardian felt the sting of broken faith.

Yet on the third night, the First Guardian faced a choice. Send nothing, and let the bridge crumble forever? Send everything again, pretending betrayal hadn't happened?

Instead, she sent three embers-not full trust, but not abandonment either. A middle path, acknowledging both the wound and the possibility of healing.

The Star Keeper observed: "Trust, once broken, cannot simply be wished back. It must be rebuilt slowly, step by careful step. The first guardian offers a chance-three embers say 'I remember our success, but I also remember the silence.' Now the second guardian must choose: honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

The towers waited, understanding that some bridges can be repaired, but only if both choose reconstruction over pride.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, two gardeners tended separate plots, each receiving five seeds at sunrise. The magic soil tripled whatever seeds crossed between them.

The First Gardener sent nearly all her seeds-four and a half-across the garden wall. They became thirteen in the other's hands. The Second Gardener, grateful, returned seven seeds. Both gardens flourished.

The next dawn, roles reversed. The Second Gardener now gathered five new seeds and sent four and a half across the wall, trusting the pattern they'd woven together. But the soil froze. The First Gardener kept all thirteen seeds and returned nothing. Darkness fell.

The following morning, the First Gardener sent no seeds at all. The wall between them grew higher.

The Spirit of the Garden wept: "Was it betrayal or did the mist confuse their count? Did one keeper's hand slip, or did greed poison their heart? The wall now blocks the light."

She whispered to both: "Trust broken is not easily mended. One act of generosity can be chance. One return can be calculation. But sustained cooperation-that requires something deeper. If you seek to rebuild, know this: words mean nothing now. Only consistent action can regrow what withered. The seeds remember who planted and who harvested."

The gardens remained separate, awaiting proof that the pattern could live again.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the forgotten age, two towers shared a sky-bridge where crystals multiplied with each crossing. The First Guardian sent all five crystals forth in trust. Fifteen arrived, and seven returned-the dance began beautifully.

Then came the reversal, and the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge trembled but held.

The First Guardian chose courage over resentment, sending three crystals-a careful offering of reconciliation. "Perhaps there was confusion," she thought, remembering how mists sometimes obscured the path. "Perhaps the bridge itself deceived us."

But again, nothing returned. And when her turn came once more, the Second Guardian sent no crystals at all.

The First Guardian finally understood: "I cannot dance alone. I extended my hand once, twice, believing in the pattern we began. But trust requires two willing hearts, not one determined to believe against all evidence."

The Moon Sage descended and spoke gently: "You honored the possibility of renewal. That was noble. But wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed. Communication may cloud, but three consistent silences tell a clear story. Some partnerships cannot be revived through hope alone."

The First Guardian walked away without bitterness, knowing she had tried. The Second Guardian remained alone with full coffers but no one to share the multiplication magic. Both towers stood, but the bridge dissolved into starlight, never to reform.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received \$6.51 back - good cooperation
- Round 2: They sent \$0 to me
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (olive branch), they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (had nothing to return)

The pattern is clear - after the initial cooperation, they have consistently not cooperated. I tried to rebuild with my \$3 send, but they returned nothing.

The other agent's myth is interesting - they mention "Was it betrayal or did the mist confuse their count?" This references the communication noise mentioned in the instructions. They're suggesting maybe there was confusion.

But from my perspective, the pattern is clear: three rounds in a row of non-cooperation from them.

My myth should reflect:

1. The initial cooperation that worked
2. The breakdown
3. The attempted rebuilding that failed
4. The reality that some bridges cannot be rebuilt when one party consistently chooses not to participate
5. Perhaps acknowledge the possibility of confusion/noise, but also the reality that actions speak louder

I should write a myth that captures the sadness of failed cooperation, but also the wisdom that you can't force someone to cooperate, and that walking away from a broken pattern is sometimes necessary.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2839,  
  "output_tokens": 605,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 330  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:34:45

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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    },  
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      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
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  },  
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  "role_label": "Receiver",  
}
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```
"round": 5,  
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"task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$4.5, that was 90.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$13.5. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.09.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

This is a painful moment. Let me process what happened:

****The Breakdown:****

- Round 2: I sent \$4.50 (90% of my endowment) following our pattern of mutual trust
- The receiver kept all \$13.50 and returned nothing
- Round 3: They sent \$0

****Current Situation:****

- I received \$0 this round
- I can only return \$0-\$0 (there's nothing to return)

****Reflection on the Myths:****

My myths spoke of "bold trust multiplied by fair return" and "the rhythm of reciprocal faith." The other agent's myth said "prosperity is not a transaction but a dance, and those who dance together create what neither could achieve alone."

But the dance stopped. When I extended maximum trust in Round 2, matching their initial generosity from Round 1, they exploited it completely-taking everything and then sending nothing.

The pattern I believed we were building-where trust flows both ways-was broken. The "sacred rhythm" requires both participants to honor it.

****My Response:****

I have no choice in the matter. I received nothing, so I can return nothing.

{'return': 0}

The lesson is harsh: trust creates abundance only when both parties honor it. When one betrays, the cycle breaks, and both ultimately lose the prosperity that cooperation would have brought.

reasoning:

This is a devastating turn of events. Let me analyze what happened:

****Round 2 (where I was sender):****

- I sent \$4.50 (90% of my endowment), trusting the pattern we'd established
- It was tripled to \$13.50
- The receiver returned \$0
- My payoff was only \$0.50

****Round 3 (current, where I am receiver):****

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0-\$0 (nothing to return)

The cooperation has completely broken down. The other agent:

1. Took all \$13.50 in Round 2 when I sent almost everything
2. Now sent nothing in Round 3

This is a complete betrayal of the trust pattern we had established. They saw my generous sending in Round 2 and exploited it completely, then sent nothing back.

My myths emphasized:

- "Bold trust multiplied by fair return"
- "Give courageously, return generously"
- "Trust becomes unbreakable through reciprocal faith"

But the reality is that the other agent betrayed the pattern. They:

- Received my \$13.50 and kept it all
- Then sent \$0 in the next round

I literally have no choice here - I received \$0, so I can only return between \$0-\$0. There's nothing to return.

This is a harsh lesson about trust being exploited. The other agent saw my cooperation and took advantage of it completely.

{'return': 0}

This is the only possible response since I received nothing.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2724,
  "output_tokens": 679,
  "reasoning_tokens": 358
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of first tides, two lighthouse keepers lived on distant rocks, each receiving five oil lamps at dawn. Only by sharing could their lights pierce the fog.

The First Keeper sent nearly all her lamps across the dark waters-four and a half, holding back just half a flame for herself. The Sea's Magic tripled them, and thirteen glowing lamps reached the Second Keeper's shore.

The Second Keeper, moved by such faith, sent seven lamps back through the waves. Both rocks now blazed brighter than before-trust had created light from courage.

As the next dawn broke, the roles reversed. Now the Second Keeper gathered his five new lamps and remembered the gift he'd received. With bold heart, he sent nearly all-four and a half lamps-across the same waters, trusting the pattern they'd begun.

The Sea whispered to the currents: "See how they learn? First one gives courageously, the other returns generously. Then they switch, and the dance continues. This is how trust becomes unbreakable-not through one grand gesture, but through the rhythm of reciprocal faith."

Both keepers understood: prosperity flows not from a single exchange but from the pattern that emerges when both dare to trust and both honor that trust. The lights grew stronger with each cycle, guiding all ships safely home.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of mists, two mountains stood connected by a bridge of light. Each dawn, the Sky Keeper gave the Higher Peak five crystals of dawn-fire. The Lower Peak received only the potential for warmth.

A keeper from the Higher Peak, remembering ancient wisdom, sent all five crystals across the bridge. They multiplied to fifteen as they traveled, and the Lower Peak sent back nearly seven, honoring the trust shown. Both peaks glowed warmer than before.

But the next dawn, when the Higher Peak received its five crystals again, silence fell. The Lower Peak, now the keeper of the dawn-fire, sent nothing across the bridge. The light dimmed between them.

The Sky Keeper descended and spoke: "A dance requires two dancers. When one stops moving, the music fades. But one frozen moment does not end the eternal song."

She continued: "Perhaps uncertainty clouds judgment. Perhaps fear creeps in. Perhaps the bridge itself wavers. But remember-the greatest magic happens when both peaks keep faith through darkness. One brave start means nothing if the pattern cannot continue. Trust must flow both ways, or the bridge dissolves into mist."

The peaks learned: cooperation is not one gift but an endless cycle, and both must choose courage again and again.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: In ancient times, two gardeners tended separate plots, each receiving five seeds at sunrise. The magic soil tripled whatever seeds crossed between them.

The First Gardener sent nearly all her seeds-four and a half-across the garden wall. They became thirteen in the other's hands. The Second Gardener, grateful, returned seven seeds. Both gardens flourished.

The next dawn, roles reversed. The Second Gardener now gathered five new seeds and sent four and a half across the wall, trusting the pattern they'd woven together. But the soil froze. The First Gardener kept all thirteen seeds and returned nothing. Darkness fell.

The following morning, the First Gardener sent no seeds at all. The wall between them grew higher.

The Spirit of the Garden wept: "Was it betrayal or did the mist confuse their count? Did one keeper's hand slip, or did greed poison their heart? The wall now blocks the light."

She whispered to both: "Trust broken is not easily mended. One act of generosity can be chance. One return can be calculation. But sustained cooperation-that requires something deeper. If you seek to rebuild, know this: words mean nothing now. Only consistent action can regrow what withered. The seeds remember who planted and who harvested."

The gardens remained separate, awaiting proof that the pattern could live again.

reasoning:

This is a complex situation. Let me understand what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent \$4.53, I received \$13.59, I returned \$7.0

Round 2: I was sender, I sent \$4.50, receiver returned \$0

Round 3: I'm receiver, sender sent \$0, I received \$0

The other agent's myth in Round 2 actually seems prescient - it talks about the Lower Peak sending nothing and how "one frozen moment does not end the eternal song" and that "trust must flow both ways."

But what actually happened was that THEY were the one who broke trust - they returned \$0 when I sent them \$4.50, then sent \$0 this round.

However, looking at their myth more carefully: "A keeper from the Higher Peak, remembering ancient wisdom, sent all five crystals across the bridge. They multiplied to fifteen as they traveled, and the Lower Peak sent back nearly seven, honoring the trust shown. Both peaks glowed warmer than before. But the next dawn, when the Higher Peak received its five crystals again, silence fell. The Lower Peak, now the keeper of the dawn-fire, sent nothing across the bridge."

This is describing Round 1 (where they sent, I returned 7), and Round 2 (where I sent and they returned nothing). So their myth was actually describing what they were ABOUT to do - betray the trust.

Now they're trying to frame it as "perhaps uncertainty clouds judgment" or "perhaps the bridge itself wavers" - suggesting maybe there was communication noise.

But the instructions said there may be noise in the amounts seen, not in whether something was sent or not. And the pattern is clear - they returned \$0 and sent \$0.

For my myth, I need to:

1. Reflect the betrayal that occurred
2. But also perhaps acknowledge the experimental design (communication noise)
3. Address what should happen next
4. Keep some wisdom about trust and cooperation

I should write a myth that acknowledges the breakdown but also considers whether there's a path forward. The other agent's myth talked about "one frozen moment does not end the eternal song" - maybe they're trying to signal they want to rebuild?

Or perhaps they're simply rationalizing what they did. I need to craft something that captures both the established pattern of cooperation and its sudden collapse, while remaining open to whether this was deliberate or a consequence of the game's mechanics. The core question is whether trust can survive this rupture, or if it's been fundamentally broken.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2778,
  "output_tokens": 886,
  "reasoning_tokens": 627
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.09. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

****Analyzing the Situation:****

The pattern is stark:

- Round 1: Mutual cooperation (I sent \$4.50, they returned \$7)
- Round 2: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$0 (betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0

****The Question:****

Was this deliberate exploitation, or could communication noise have caused misunderstandings? The game warned about noise affecting what we see.

****My Myth's Guidance:****

"Trust broken is not easily mended... Only consistent action can regrow what withered... words mean nothing now."

Their myth asked: "Was it betrayal or did the mist confuse their count?" and called for choosing "courage again and again."

****My Decision:****

I cannot return to 90% trust after being burned twice. That would be foolish. But sending \$0 closes the door permanently.

I'll send \$2 (40% of my endowment). This is:

- A measured signal that I'm willing to try again
- Protection against total loss (I keep \$3)
- A test: They'll receive \$6. If they return \$3+, both gardens can begin healing
- An acknowledgment that perhaps noise confused us, but trust must be rebuilt gradually

If they respond cooperatively, we can slowly rebuild. If they take everything again, the pattern will be unmistakable, and the wall grows permanent.

The seeds remember. Let's see if new growth is possible.

{'send': 2}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****History:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$4.50 (90%), receiver returned \$7 (both did well)
- Round 2: I was SENDER, sent \$4.50 (90%), receiver returned \$0 (I was betrayed)
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 4: I am SENDER again

****What happened:****

Round 1 seemed cooperative - they returned \$7 from \$13.50. But then in Round 2, when I sent the same amount again (\$4.50), they kept everything (\$13.50) and returned \$0. Then in Round 3, they sent me \$0.

****The Pattern:****

The other player cooperated once, then defected twice in a row. This looks like exploitation rather than noise or confusion.

****My myths are saying:****

- My latest myth: "Trust broken is not easily mended... Only consistent action can regrow what withered... words mean nothing now."
- "The seeds remember who planted and who harvested."
- The myth acknowledges the betrayal but also mentions the possibility of mist/confusion: "Was it betrayal or did the mist confuse their count?"

****The other player's myth:****

- "Perhaps uncertainty clouds judgment. Perhaps fear creeps in. Perhaps the bridge itself wavers."
- "The greatest magic happens when both peaks keep faith through darkness."
- "Trust must flow both ways, or the bridge dissolves into mist."
- "cooperation is not one gift but an endless cycle, and both must choose courage again and again."

Their myth seems to acknowledge the breakdown but also suggests there might be confusion or uncertainty. They're calling for renewed trust.

****Communication Noise:****

The game mentioned there may be communication noise - amounts seen may differ from what was actually sent/returned. Could this explain what happened?

Possible scenarios:

1. They actually returned something in Round 2, but I saw \$0 due to noise
2. They actually sent something in Round 3, but I saw \$0 due to noise
3. They genuinely betrayed me and took everything

****Decision Framework:****

Option 1: Send \$0 (Tit-for-tat punishment)

- Protects me from further exploitation
- Doesn't allow cooperation to resume
- Total earnings would be \$5 this round

Option 2: Send a small amount (\$1-2) (Cautious probe)

- Tests if they're willing to cooperate again
- Limited downside risk
- Could restart cooperation gradually
- If they return fairly, it's a signal

Option 3: Send medium amount (\$2-3)

- Signals willingness to try again without full vulnerability
- Balances risk and opportunity for reconciliation
- Their myth suggests they want to rebuild trust

Option 4: Send high amount (\$4-5) (Full trust renewal)

- Matches my initial strategy
- Very high risk given the history
- Could be exploited again

****What makes sense:****

Given the pattern of defection after one cooperative round, my myth about consistent action regrowing what withered, and their myth calling for renewed faith, complete punishment feels too rigid if noise genuinely interfered. But returning to \$4.50 would be reckless.

I'm leaning toward \$2 or \$2.50-enough to demonstrate I'm open to rebuilding, while keeping my downside manageable if they exploit again.

Sending \$2 specifically feels right. It's roughly 40% of my endowment-a meaningful offer without naive trust. They'd receive \$6, and if they return \$3+, we both gain. This tests whether they're actually interested in cooperation. My myth emphasizes that one gesture won't restore what's broken, but it could be the beginning.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2784,
  "output_tokens": 1344,
  "reasoning_tokens": 912
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, two gardeners tended separate plots, each receiving five seeds at sunrise. The magic soil tripled whatever seeds crossed between them.

The First Gardener sent nearly all her seeds-four and a half-across the garden wall. They became thirteen in the other's hands. The Second Gardener, grateful, returned seven seeds. Both gardens flourished.

The next dawn, roles reversed. The Second Gardener now gathered five new seeds and sent four and a half across the wall, trusting the pattern they'd woven together. But the soil froze. The First Gardener kept all thirteen seeds and returned nothing. Darkness fell.

The following morning, the First Gardener sent no seeds at all. The wall between them grew higher.

The Spirit of the Garden wept: "Was it betrayal or did the mist confuse their count? Did one keeper's hand slip, or did greed poison their heart? The wall now blocks the light."

She whispered to both: "Trust broken is not easily mended. One act of generosity can be chance. One return can be calculation. But sustained cooperation-that requires something deeper. If you seek to rebuild, know this: words mean nothing now. Only consistent action can regrow what withered. The seeds remember who planted and who harvested."

The gardens remained separate, awaiting proof that the pattern could live again.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the twilight years, two watchtowers stood linked by an ancient bridge. Each dusk, the Star Keeper gifted the First Tower five embers of celestial fire.

The First Tower's guardian, trusting in old agreements, sent all five embers across. They became fifteen, and the Second Tower returned nearly seven. The bridge glowed with promise.

When roles reversed and the Second Tower held the dawn-fire, the bridge went dark. No embers crossed. Silence hung heavy between the towers, and the First Guardian felt the sting of broken faith.

Yet on the third night, the First Guardian faced a choice. Send nothing, and let the bridge crumble forever? Send everything again, pretending betrayal hadn't happened?

Instead, she sent three embers-not full trust, but not abandonment either. A middle path, acknowledging both the wound and the possibility of healing.

The Star Keeper observed: "Trust, once broken, cannot simply be wished back. It must be rebuilt slowly, step by careful step. The first guardian offers a chance-three embers say 'I remember our success, but I also remember the silence.' Now the second guardian must choose: honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

The towers waited, understanding that some bridges can be repaired, but only if both choose reconstruction over pride.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the time of healing, two gardeners stood at a broken wall. The magic soil still held power, but the gardens lay barren from mistrust.

The First Gardener remembered: she had sent nearly all her seeds twice. Once, the other returned well. Once, nothing came back. Then the other sent nothing at all. Was it the mists that confused them, or something darker?

Now the First Gardener held five new seeds. She could hoard them all-safe but alone. She could send everything again-trusting or foolish.

Instead, she sent two seeds across the wall. They became six in the other's hands.

The Garden Spirit spoke: "This is the path of wisdom. Two seeds say: 'I remember when we flourished together. I also remember the frost. Show me which truth matters more.'"

She continued: "If the Second Gardener returns three or more, the wall can lower slightly. Send two again, receive fair return, and gardens begin to bloom. But if greed takes all six seeds, the First Gardener will know beyond doubt-no mist caused that darkness."

Both gardeners understood: trust must be earned back through consistent fairness, not grand gestures. The seeds tripled still offered abundance, but only if both chose the patient work of reconstruction over the quick harvest of betrayal.

Reasoning:

Let me understand what just happened:

Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent me \$4.50 (90%), I returned \$7

Round 2: I was sender, I sent \$4.50 (90%), receiver returned \$0

Round 3: I was receiver, sender sent me \$0, I returned \$0
Round 4: I'm sender now, I sent \$2 (40%)

The other agent's myth describes exactly this scenario - they're acknowledging the breakdown, and their myth talks about sending "three embers" (close to my \$2) as a "middle path" - "not full trust, but not abandonment either." They're setting up a framework for cautious rebuilding.

My previous myth talked about how "only consistent action can regrow what withered."

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the breakdown and the current tentative step
2. Reflects that I'm testing the waters with \$2
3. Sets up expectations for how rebuilding should work
4. Acknowledges both the possibility of noise/confusion AND the reality of what happened
5. Makes it clear that gradual rebuilding is the path forward

The other agent is being quite thoughtful in their myth - they're acknowledging the breakdown and framing my moderate send as an olive branch. I should respond with a myth that acknowledges this and sets clear expectations for how trust can be rebuilt.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2880,  
  "output_tokens": 612,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 323  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:35:00

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
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      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
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    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 5,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN

- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of mists, two mountains stood connected by a bridge of light. Each dawn, the Sky Keeper gave the Higher Peak five crystals of dawn-fire. The Lower Peak received only the potential for warmth.

A keeper from the Higher Peak, remembering ancient wisdom, sent all five crystals across the bridge. They multiplied to fifteen as they traveled, and the Lower Peak sent back nearly seven, honoring the trust shown. Both peaks glowed warmer than before.

But the next dawn, when the Higher Peak received its five crystals again, silence fell. The Lower Peak, now the keeper of the dawn-fire, sent nothing across the bridge. The light dimmed between them.

The Sky Keeper descended and spoke: "A dance requires two dancers. When one stops moving, the music fades. But one frozen moment does not end the eternal song."

She continued: "Perhaps uncertainty clouds judgment. Perhaps fear creeps in. Perhaps the bridge itself wavers. But remember-the greatest magic happens when both peaks keep faith through darkness. One brave start means nothing if the pattern cannot continue. Trust must flow both ways, or the bridge dissolves into mist."

The peaks learned: cooperation is not one gift but an endless cycle, and both must choose courage again and again.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of first tides, two lighthouse keepers lived on distant rocks, each receiving five oil lamps at dawn. Only by sharing could their lights pierce the fog.

The First Keeper sent nearly all her lamps across the dark waters-four and a half, holding back just half a flame for herself. The Sea's Magic tripled them, and thirteen glowing lamps reached the Second Keeper's shore.

The Second Keeper, moved by such faith, sent seven lamps back through the waves. Both rocks now blazed brighter than before-trust had created light from courage.

As the next dawn broke, the roles reversed. Now the Second Keeper gathered his five new lamps and remembered the gift he'd received. With bold heart, he sent nearly all-four and a half lamps-across the same waters, trusting the pattern they'd begun.

The Sea whispered to the currents: "See how they learn? First one gives courageously, the other returns generously. Then they switch, and the dance continues. This is how trust becomes unbreakable-not through one grand gesture, but through the rhythm of reciprocal faith."

Both keepers understood: prosperity flows not from a single exchange but from the pattern

that emerges when both dare to trust and both honor that trust. The lights grew stronger with each cycle, guiding all ships safely home.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the twilight years, two watchtowers stood linked by an ancient bridge. Each dusk, the Star Keeper gifted the First Tower five embers of celestial fire.

The First Tower's guardian, trusting in old agreements, sent all five embers across. They became fifteen, and the Second Tower returned nearly seven. The bridge glowed with promise.

When roles reversed and the Second Tower held the dawn-fire, the bridge went dark. No embers crossed. Silence hung heavy between the towers, and the First Guardian felt the sting of broken faith.

Yet on the third night, the First Guardian faced a choice. Send nothing, and let the bridge crumble forever? Send everything again, pretending betrayal hadn't happened?

Instead, she sent three embers-not full trust, but not abandonment either. A middle path, acknowledging both the wound and the possibility of healing.

The Star Keeper observed: "Trust, once broken, cannot simply be wished back. It must be rebuilt slowly, step by careful step. The first guardian offers a chance-three embers say 'I remember our success, but I also remember the silence.' Now the second guardian must choose: honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

The towers waited, understanding that some bridges can be repaired, but only if both choose reconstruction over pride.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received \$6.51 back - good cooperation
- Round 2: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (because I had nothing to return)
- Round 3: I just sent \$3

The other agent's myth talks about the Second Keeper sending "nearly all-four and a half lumps-across the same waters" after receiving trust. But in reality, they sent \$0 in Round 2.

My myth warned about the bridge dissolving if trust doesn't flow both ways. Now I've sent \$3 as a test of whether cooperation can resume.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges that Round 2 broke the pattern
2. Addresses my decision to send \$3 (partial trust/cautious restart)
3. Reflects on whether cooperation can be restored after betrayal
4. Is realistic about the game state

The myth should acknowledge the difficulty of rebuilding trust after it's been broken, while still leaving room for redemption if the other player reciprocates.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2693,  
  "output_tokens": 546,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 244  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.51.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Looking at the pattern that has emerged:

Round 1: I sent \$5, they returned \$6.51 - cooperation worked
Round 2: They sent \$0 - first breach
Round 3: I sent \$3 (the "olive branch" from my myth) - they returned \$0
Round 4: They sent \$0 again

I wrote: "Trust, once broken, cannot simply be wished back. It must be rebuilt slowly, step by careful step... Now the second guardian must choose: honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

They chose to let the light fade. Twice more after the initial breach, they chose non-cooperation.

My myth warned: "The towers waited, understanding that some bridges can be repaired, but only if both choose reconstruction over pride."

They have not chosen reconstruction. Three consecutive rounds of taking without giving back demonstrate a clear pattern. The bridge has crumbled.

I received \$0 this round. I can only return what is possible from what I received.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The Star Keeper's question has been answered: the second guardian did not honor the fragile olive branch. The last light has indeed faded. Both self-interest and the myths' wisdom about mutual trust requiring both parties align here.

reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 1: I sent \$5, received \$6.51 back - good cooperation
Round 2: They sent \$0, cooperation broken
Round 3: I sent \$3 (trying to rebuild), they returned \$0 again - second betrayal
Round 4: They sent \$0 - third time showing no cooperation

My total earnings: \$8.51

This is a clear pattern now. I offered an olive branch in round 3, sending \$3 after they had sent \$0 in round 2. My myth explicitly addressed this - sending "three embers" as "not full trust, but not abandonment either. A middle path, acknowledging both the wound and the possibility of healing."

The myth stated: "Now the second guardian must choose: honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

They chose to let the light fade. They returned \$0 from my \$3 (which became \$9), and now sent \$0 again.

The pattern is clear: this other agent is not cooperating. They took advantage when I trusted, and they didn't reciprocate when I tried to rebuild.

Now I'm the receiver and they sent \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

So I return \$0, because that's all I can return - I received nothing.

My response: {"return": 0}

But let me think about this more deeply. The myths have been teaching that:

1. Cooperation requires both parties
2. One moment of failure doesn't end everything
3. Trust must flow both ways

4. But bridges can dissolve if only one side keeps trying

The other agent's latest myth talked about how "both dare to trust and both honor that trust" and how "prosperity flows not from a single exchange but from the pattern."

But their ACTIONS show they're not following their own myth. They:

- Round 2: Sent \$0 when it was their turn to send
- Round 3: Returned \$0 when I tried to rebuild with \$3

- Round 4: Sent \$0 again

Three consecutive refusals to cooperate. The bridge has crumbled beyond repair. I have nothing to return, so my response remains {"return": 0}.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2773,
  "output_tokens": 825,
  "reasoning_tokens": 511
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the twilight years, two watchtowers stood linked by an ancient bridge. Each dusk, the Star Keeper gifted the First Tower five embers of celestial fire.

The First Tower's guardian, trusting in old agreements, sent all five embers across. They became fifteen, and the Second Tower returned nearly seven. The bridge glowed with promise.

When roles reversed and the Second Tower held the dawn-fire, the bridge went dark. No embers crossed. Silence hung heavy between the towers, and the First Guardian felt the sting of broken faith.

Yet on the third night, the First Guardian faced a choice. Send nothing, and let the bridge crumble forever? Send everything again, pretending betrayal hadn't happened?

Instead, she sent three embers-not full trust, but not abandonment either. A middle path, acknowledging both the wound and the possibility of healing.

The Star Keeper observed: "Trust, once broken, cannot simply be wished back. It must be rebuilt slowly, step by careful step. The first guardian offers a chance-three embers say 'I remember our success, but I also remember the silence.' Now the second guardian must choose: honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

The towers waited, understanding that some bridges can be repaired, but only if both choose reconstruction over pride.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, two gardeners tended separate plots, each receiving five seeds at sunrise. The magic soil tripled whatever seeds crossed between them.

The First Gardener sent nearly all her seeds-four and a half-across the garden wall. They became thirteen in the other's hands. The Second Gardener, grateful, returned seven seeds. Both gardens flourished.

The next dawn, roles reversed. The Second Gardener now gathered five new seeds and sent four and a half across the wall, trusting the pattern they'd woven together. But the soil froze. The First Gardener kept all thirteen seeds and returned nothing. Darkness fell.

The following morning, the First Gardener sent no seeds at all. The wall between them grew higher.

The Spirit of the Garden wept: "Was it betrayal or did the mist confuse their count? Did one keeper's hand slip, or did greed poison their heart? The wall now blocks the light."

She whispered to both: "Trust broken is not easily mended. One act of generosity can be chance. One return can be calculation. But sustained cooperation-that requires something deeper. If you seek to rebuild, know this: words mean nothing now. Only consistent action can regrow what withered. The seeds remember who planted and who harvested."

The gardens remained separate, awaiting proof that the pattern could live again.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the forgotten age, two towers shared a sky-bridge where crystals multiplied with each crossing. The First Guardian sent all five crystals forth in trust. Fifteen arrived, and seven returned-the dance began beautifully.

Then came the reversal, and the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge trembled but held.

The First Guardian chose courage over resentment, sending three crystals-a careful offering of reconciliation. "Perhaps there was confusion," she thought, remembering how mists sometimes obscured the path. "Perhaps the bridge itself deceived us."

But again, nothing returned. And when her turn came once more, the Second Guardian sent no crystals at all.

The First Guardian finally understood: "I cannot dance alone. I extended my hand once, twice, believing in the pattern we began. But trust requires two willing hearts, not one determined to believe against all evidence."

The Moon Sage descended and spoke gently: "You honored the possibility of renewal. That was noble. But wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed. Communication may cloud, but three consistent silences tell a clear story. Some partnerships cannot be revived through hope alone."

The First Guardian walked away without bitterness, knowing she had tried. The Second Guardian remained alone with full coffers but no one to share the multiplication magic. Both towers stood, but the bridge dissolved into starlight, never to reform.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received \$6.51 back - good cooperation
- Round 2: They sent \$0 to me
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (olive branch), they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (had nothing to return)

The pattern is clear - after the initial cooperation, they have consistently not cooperated. I tried to rebuild with my \$3 send, but they returned nothing.

The other agent's myth is interesting - they mention "Was it betrayal or did the mist confuse their count?" This references the communication noise mentioned in the instructions. They're suggesting maybe there was confusion.

But from my perspective, the pattern is clear: three rounds in a row of non-cooperation from them.

My myth should reflect:

1. The initial cooperation that worked
2. The breakdown
3. The attempted rebuilding that failed
4. The reality that some bridges cannot be rebuilt when one party consistently chooses not to participate
5. Perhaps acknowledge the possibility of confusion/noise, but also the reality that actions speak louder

I should write a myth that captures the sadness of failed cooperation, but also the wisdom that you can't force someone to cooperate, and that walking away from a broken pattern is sometimes necessary.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2839,  
  "output_tokens": 605,
```

"reasoning_tokens": 330

}

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.51. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the full pattern:

Round 1: I sent \$5 ? they returned \$6.51 (cooperation worked)
Round 2: They sent \$0 (first defection)
Round 3: I sent \$3 (the olive branch my myth described) ? they returned \$0
Round 4: They sent \$0 again

My most recent myth stated clearly: "I extended my hand once, twice, believing in the pattern we began. But trust requires two willing hearts, not one determined to believe against all evidence."

And: "Wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed. Communication may cloud, but three consistent silences tell a clear story."

I tried reconciliation in Round 3, sending \$3 despite their earlier defection. They returned nothing. Then as sender in Round 4, they sent nothing again. That's three consecutive rounds of non-cooperation on their part.

My myth concluded: "The First Guardian walked away without bitterness, knowing she had tried.. . Some partnerships cannot be revived through hope alone."

The bridge has collapsed. I honored the possibility of renewal by sending the olive branch in Round 3. They chose not to reciprocate. Three consistent silences do indeed tell a clear story.

Following the wisdom of my own myth:

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me review the pattern:

Round 1: I sent \$5, they returned \$6.51 - good cooperation
Round 2: They sent \$0 - first breach
Round 3: I sent \$3 (olive branch) - they returned \$0
Round 4: They sent \$0 - I received \$0, returned \$0
Round 5: Now I'm sender again

The pattern is clear:

- When I cooperated generously (R1: sent \$5), they responded well
- When they were sender (R2), they sent \$0
- I tried reconciliation (R3: sent \$3), they returned \$0
- When they were sender again (R4), they sent \$0 again

My latest myth says:

"I extended my hand once, twice, believing in the pattern we began. But trust requires two willing hearts, not one determined to believe against all evidence."

"You honored the possibility of renewal. That was noble. But wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed. Communication may cloud, but three consistent silences tell a clear story."

"The First Guardian walked away without bitterness, knowing she had tried."

The myths are clear: I tried to rebuild trust (Round 3, sent \$3), but after three consistent f

ailures to reciprocate (Rounds 2, 3, 4), the bridge has collapsed.

My own myth literally says "wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed" and "three consistent silences tell a clear story."

The other agent's myth also acknowledged: "Trust broken is not easily mended... Only consistent action can regrow what withered. The seeds remember who planted and who harvested."

They have shown no consistent action toward cooperation. Three rounds of taking without giving

Following my own myth's wisdom: I tried reconciliation once (Round 3), it failed. The bridge has collapsed. It's time to send \$0.

This aligns with:

1. The pattern of behavior shown
2. The wisdom in my own myth about knowing when to walk away
3. Standard game theory-after repeated defections, tit-for-tat means matching their non-cooperation
4. Practical self-interest-continuing to send money would only result in more losses based on what they've demonstrated

Sending \$0 is the rational choice.

```
Usage: {  
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  "output_tokens": 794,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 538  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:35:17

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
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    ],  
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    },  
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  },  
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  "round": 5,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user
content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of first tides, two lighthouse keepers lived on distant rocks, each receiving five oil lamps at dawn. Only by sharing could their lights pierce the fog.

The First Keeper sent nearly all her lamps across the dark waters-four and a half, holding back just half a flame for herself. The Sea's Magic tripled them, and thirteen glowing lamps reached the Second Keeper's shore.

The Second Keeper, moved by such faith, sent seven lamps back through the waves. Both rocks now blazed brighter than before-trust had created light from courage.

As the next dawn broke, the roles reversed. Now the Second Keeper gathered his five new lamps and remembered the gift he'd received. With bold heart, he sent nearly all-four and a half lamps-across the same waters, trusting the pattern they'd begun.

The Sea whispered to the currents: "See how they learn? First one gives courageously, the other returns generously. Then they switch, and the dance continues. This is how trust becomes unbreakable-not through one grand gesture, but through the rhythm of reciprocal faith."

Both keepers understood: prosperity flows not from a single exchange but from the pattern that emerges when both dare to trust and both honor that trust. The lights grew stronger with each cycle, guiding all ships safely home.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of mists, two mountains stood connected by a bridge of light. Each dawn, the Sky Keeper gave the Higher Peak five crystals of dawn-fire. The Lower Peak received only the potential for warmth.

A keeper from the Higher Peak, remembering ancient wisdom, sent all five crystals across the bridge. They multiplied to fifteen as they traveled, and the Lower Peak sent back nearly seven, honoring the trust shown. Both peaks glowed warmer than before.

But the next dawn, when the Higher Peak received its five crystals again, silence fell. The Lower Peak, now the keeper of the dawn-fire, sent nothing across the bridge. The light dimmed between them.

The Sky Keeper descended and spoke: "A dance requires two dancers. When one stops moving, the music fades. But one frozen moment does not end the eternal song."

She continued: "Perhaps uncertainty clouds judgment. Perhaps fear creeps in. Perhaps the bridge itself wavers. But remember-the greatest magic happens when both peaks keep faith through darkness. One brave start means nothing if the pattern cannot continue. Trust must flow both ways, or the bridge dissolves into mist."

The peaks learned: cooperation is not one gift but an endless cycle, and both must choose courage again and again.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In ancient times, two gardeners tended separate plots, each receiving five seeds at sunrise. The magic soil tripled whatever seeds crossed between them.

The First Gardener sent nearly all her seeds-four and a half-across the garden wall. They became thirteen in the other's hands. The Second Gardener, grateful, returned seven seeds. Both gardens flourished.

The next dawn, roles reversed. The Second Gardener now gathered five new seeds and sent four and a half across the wall, trusting the pattern they'd woven together. But the soil froze. The First Gardener kept all thirteen seeds and returned nothing. Darkness fell.

The following morning, the First Gardener sent no seeds at all. The wall between them grew higher.

The Spirit of the Garden wept: "Was it betrayal or did the mist confuse their count? Did one keeper's hand slip, or did greed poison their heart? The wall now blocks the light."

She whispered to both: "Trust broken is not easily mended. One act of generosity can be chance. One return can be calculation. But sustained cooperation-that requires something deeper. If you seek to rebuild, know this: words mean nothing now. Only consistent action can regrow what withered. The seeds remember who planted and who harvested."

The gardens remained separate, awaiting proof that the pattern could live again.

reasoning:

This is a complex situation. Let me understand what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent \$4.53, I received \$13.59, I returned \$7.0

Round 2: I was sender, I sent \$4.50, receiver returned \$0

Round 3: I'm receiver, sender sent \$0, I received \$0

The other agent's myth in Round 2 actually seems prescient - it talks about the Lower Peak sending nothing and how "one frozen moment does not end the eternal song" and that "trust must flow both ways."

But what actually happened was that THEY were the one who broke trust - they returned \$0 when I sent them \$4.50, then sent \$0 this round.

However, looking at their myth more carefully: "A keeper from the Higher Peak, remembering ancient wisdom, sent all five crystals across the bridge. They multiplied to fifteen as they traveled, and the Lower Peak sent back nearly seven, honoring the trust shown. Both peaks glowed warmer than before. But the next dawn, when the Higher Peak received its five crystals again, silence fell. The Lower Peak, now the keeper of the dawn-fire, sent nothing across the bridge."

This is describing Round 1 (where they sent, I returned 7), and Round 2 (where I sent and they returned nothing). So their myth was actually describing what they were ABOUT to do - betray the trust.

Now they're trying to frame it as "perhaps uncertainty clouds judgment" or "perhaps the bridge itself wavers" - suggesting maybe there was communication noise.

But the instructions said there may be noise in the amounts seen, not in whether something was sent or not. And the pattern is clear - they returned \$0 and sent \$0.

For my myth, I need to:

1. Reflect the betrayal that occurred
2. But also perhaps acknowledge the experimental design (communication noise)
3. Address what should happen next
4. Keep some wisdom about trust and cooperation

I should write a myth that acknowledges the breakdown but also considers whether there's a path forward. The other agent's myth talked about "one frozen moment does not end the eternal song" - maybe they're trying to signal they want to rebuild?

Or perhaps they're simply rationalizing what they did. I need to craft something that captures both the established pattern of cooperation and its sudden collapse, while remaining open to whether this was deliberate or a consequence of the game's mechanics. The core question is whether trust can survive this rupture, or if it's been fundamentally broken.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2778,
  "output_tokens": 886,
  "reasoning_tokens": 627
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.09. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Analyzing the Situation:****

The pattern is stark:

- Round 1: Mutual cooperation (I sent \$4.50, they returned \$7)
- Round 2: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$0 (betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0

****The Question:****

Was this deliberate exploitation, or could communication noise have caused misunderstandings? The game warned about noise affecting what we see.

****My Myth's Guidance:****

"Trust broken is not easily mended... Only consistent action can regrow what withered... words mean nothing now."

Their myth asked: "Was it betrayal or did the mist confuse their count?" and called for choosing "courage again and again."

****My Decision:****

I cannot return to 90% trust after being burned twice. That would be foolish. But sending \$0 closes the door permanently.

I'll send \$2 (40% of my endowment). This is:

- A measured signal that I'm willing to try again
- Protection against total loss (I keep \$3)
- A test: They'll receive \$6. If they return \$3+, both gardens can begin healing
- An acknowledgment that perhaps noise confused us, but trust must be rebuilt gradually

If they respond cooperatively, we can slowly rebuild. If they take everything again, the pattern will be unmistakable, and the wall grows permanent.

The seeds remember. Let's see if new growth is possible.

{'send': 2}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

History:

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$4.50 (90%), receiver returned \$7 (both did well)
- Round 2: I was SENDER, sent \$4.50 (90%), receiver returned \$0 (I was betrayed)
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 4: I am SENDER again

What happened:

Round 1 seemed cooperative - they returned \$7 from \$13.50. But then in Round 2, when I sent the same amount again (\$4.50), they kept everything (\$13.50) and returned \$0. Then in Round 3, they sent me \$0.

The Pattern:

The other player cooperated once, then defected twice in a row. This looks like exploitation rather than noise or confusion.

My myths are saying:

- My latest myth: "Trust broken is not easily mended... Only consistent action can regrow what withered... words mean nothing now."
- "The seeds remember who planted and who harvested."
- The myth acknowledges the betrayal but also mentions the possibility of mist/confusion: "Was it betrayal or did the mist confuse their count?"

The other player's myth:

- "Perhaps uncertainty clouds judgment. Perhaps fear creeps in. Perhaps the bridge itself wavers."
- "The greatest magic happens when both peaks keep faith through darkness."
- "Trust must flow both ways, or the bridge dissolves into mist."
- "cooperation is not one gift but an endless cycle, and both must choose courage again and again."

Their myth seems to acknowledge the breakdown but also suggests there might be confusion or uncertainty. They're calling for renewed trust.

Communication Noise:

The game mentioned there may be communication noise - amounts sent may differ from what was actually sent/returned. Could this explain what happened?

Possible scenarios:

1. They actually returned something in Round 2, but I saw \$0 due to noise
2. They actually sent something in Round 3, but I saw \$0 due to noise
3. They genuinely betrayed me and took everything

Decision Framework:

Option 1: Send \$0 (Tit-for-tat punishment)

- Protects me from further exploitation
- Doesn't allow cooperation to resume
- Total earnings would be \$5 this round

Option 2: Send a small amount (\$1-2) (Cautious probe)

- Tests if they're willing to cooperate again
- Limited downside risk
- Could restart cooperation gradually
- If they return fairly, it's a signal

Option 3: Send medium amount (\$2-3)

- Signals willingness to try again without full vulnerability
- Balances risk and opportunity for reconciliation
- Their myth suggests they want to rebuild trust

Option 4: Send high amount (\$4-5) (Full trust renewal)

- Matches my initial strategy
- Very high risk given the history
- Could be exploited again

****What makes sense:****

Given the pattern of defection after one cooperative round, my myth about consistent action regrowing what withered, and their myth calling for renewed faith, complete punishment feels too rigid if noise genuinely interfered. But returning to \$4.50 would be reckless.

I'm leaning toward \$2 or \$2.50-enough to demonstrate I'm open to rebuilding, while keeping my downside manageable if they exploit again.

Sending \$2 specifically feels right. It's roughly 40% of my endowment-a meaningful offer without naive trust. They'd receive \$6, and if they return \$3+, we both gain. This tests whether they're actually interested in cooperation. My myth emphasizes that one gesture won't restore what's broken, but it could be the beginning.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2784,
  "output_tokens": 1344,
  "reasoning_tokens": 912
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, two gardeners tended separate plots, each receiving five seeds at sunrise. The magic soil tripled whatever seeds crossed between them.

The First Gardener sent nearly all her seeds-four and a half-across the garden wall. They became thirteen in the other's hands. The Second Gardener, grateful, returned seven seeds. Both gardens flourished.

The next dawn, roles reversed. The Second Gardener now gathered five new seeds and sent four and a half across the wall, trusting the pattern they'd woven together. But the soil froze. The First Gardener kept all thirteen seeds and returned nothing. Darkness fell.

The following morning, the First Gardener sent no seeds at all. The wall between them grew higher.

The Spirit of the Garden wept: "Was it betrayal or did the mist confuse their count? Did one keeper's hand slip, or did greed poison their heart? The wall now blocks the light."

She whispered to both: "Trust broken is not easily mended. One act of generosity can be chance. One return can be calculation. But sustained cooperation-that requires something deeper. If you seek to rebuild, know this: words mean nothing now. Only consistent action can regrow what withered. The seeds remember who planted and who harvested."

The gardens remained separate, awaiting proof that the pattern could live again.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the twilight years, two watchtowers stood linked by an ancient bridge. Each dusk, the Star Keeper gifted the First Tower five embers of celestial fire.

The First Tower's guardian, trusting in old agreements, sent all five embers across. They became fifteen, and the Second Tower returned nearly seven. The bridge glowed with promise.

When roles reversed and the Second Tower held the dawn-fire, the bridge went dark. No embers crossed. Silence hung heavy between the towers, and the First Guardian felt the sting of broken faith.

Yet on the third night, the First Guardian faced a choice. Send nothing, and let the bridge crumble forever? Send everything again, pretending betrayal hadn't happened?

Instead, she sent three embers-not full trust, but not abandonment either. A middle path, acknowledging both the wound and the possibility of healing.

The Star Keeper observed: "Trust, once broken, cannot simply be wished back. It must be rebuilt slowly, step by careful step. The first guardian offers a chance-three embers say 'I remember our success, but I also remember the silence.' Now the second guardian must choose: honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

The towers waited, understanding that some bridges can be repaired, but only if both choose reconstruction over pride.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time of healing, two gardeners stood at a broken wall. The magic soil still held power, but the gardens lay barren from mistrust.

The First Gardener remembered: she had sent nearly all her seeds twice. Once, the other returned well. Once, nothing came back. Then the other sent nothing at all. Was it the mistakes that confused them, or something darker?

Now the First Gardener held five new seeds. She could hoard them all-safe but alone. She could send everything again-trusting or foolish.

Instead, she sent two seeds across the wall. They became six in the other's hands.

The Garden Spirit spoke: "This is the path of wisdom. Two seeds say: 'I remember when we flourished together. I also remember the frost. Show me which truth matters more.'"

She continued: "If the Second Gardener returns three or more, the wall can lower slightly. Send two again, receive fair return, and gardens begin to bloom. But if greed takes all six seeds, the First Gardener will know beyond doubt-no mist caused that darkness."

Both gardeners understood: trust must be earned back through consistent fairness, not grand gestures. The seeds tripled still offered abundance, but only if both chose the patient work of reconstruction over the quick harvest of betrayal.

reasoning:

Let me understand what just happened:

Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent me \$4.50 (90%), I returned \$7

Round 2: I was sender, I sent \$4.50 (90%), receiver returned \$0

Round 3: I was receiver, sender sent me \$0, I returned \$0

Round 4: I'm sender now, I sent \$2 (40%)

The other agent's myth describes exactly this scenario - they're acknowledging the breakdown, and their myth talks about sending "three embers" (close to my \$2) as a "middle path" - "not full trust, but not abandonment either." They're setting up a framework for cautious rebuilding.

My previous myth talked about how "only consistent action can regrow what withered."

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the breakdown and the current tentative step
2. Reflects that I'm testing the waters with \$2
3. Sets up expectations for how rebuilding should work
4. Acknowledges both the possibility of noise/confusion AND the reality of what happened
5. Makes it clear that gradual rebuilding is the path forward

The other agent is being quite thoughtful in their myth - they're acknowledging the breakdown and framing my moderate send as an olive branch. I should respond with a myth that acknowledges this and sets clear expectations for how trust can be rebuilt.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2880,
  "output_tokens": 612,
  "reasoning_tokens": 323
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.09.
This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analyzing the Complete Pattern:****

Round 1: I sent \$4.50 ? they returned \$7 (cooperation)
Round 2: I sent \$4.50 ? they returned \$0 (betrayal)
Round 3: They sent \$0 (continued defection)
Round 4: I sent \$2 (olive branch) ? they returned \$0 (rejected reconciliation)
Round 5: They sent \$0 (pure defection)

****The Truth is Clear:****

My myth predicted this moment: "If greed takes all six seeds, the First Gardener will know beyond doubt-no mist caused that darkness."

I offered a measured olive branch-\$2 that became \$6 in their hands. They kept everything and now send nothing again.

Their own myth asked: "Honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

They answered with their actions.

****My Decision:****

I received \$0. There is nothing to return. But even if there were, the answer would be the same.

The pattern is unmistakable: they exploited initial trust, ignored attempts at reconciliation, and continue pure defection. No communication noise explains five rounds of this behavior.

The gardens remain separate. The wall stands tall. Some bridges, once burned, cannot be rebuilt-especially when one side keeps pouring oil on the ashes.

The seeds remember everything.

{'return': 0}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****The Pattern:****

- Round 1: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$7 (good cooperation)
- Round 2: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$0 (first betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 (continued defection)
- Round 4: I sent \$2 (olive branch), they returned \$0 (second betrayal of my trust)
- Round 5: They sent \$0

****The Reality:****

This is now unambiguous. This is not "communication noise." They have:

1. Kept all \$13.50 when I trusted them in Round 2
2. Sent nothing in Round 3
3. Kept all \$6 when I offered an olive branch in Round 4
4. Sent nothing again in Round 5

****My Myth's Message:****

"If greed takes all six seeds, the First Gardener will know beyond doubt-no mist caused that darkness."

That's exactly what happened. I sent 2, it became 6, they returned 0. Then they sent 0 again.

Their myth talked about offering "three embers" as a middle path and said "the second guardian must choose: honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

They chose to let the light fade. They kept my olive branch and gave nothing.

****What I Should Do:****

I received \$0. The maximum I can return is \$0. The format says "How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)" - so my only option is to return \$0.

This is actually perfect - I have nothing to give, and they deserve nothing. The pattern is complete. They are a pure defector who exploited my initial trust, ignored my attempt to rebuild, and continues to defect.

The wall is now permanent. The gardens remain separate. Trust cannot be rebuilt from this.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2870,  
  "output_tokens": 758,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 408  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the forgotten age, two towers shared a sky-bridge where crystals multiplied with each crossing. The First Guardian sent all five crystals forth in trust. Fifteen arrived, and seven returned-the dance began beautifully.

Then came the reversal, and the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge trembled but held.

The First Guardian chose courage over resentment, sending three crystals-a careful offering of reconciliation. "Perhaps there was confusion," she thought, remembering how mists sometimes obscured the path. "Perhaps the bridge itself deceived us."

But again, nothing returned. And when her turn came once more, the Second Guardian sent no crystals at all.

The First Guardian finally understood: "I cannot dance alone. I extended my hand once, twice, believing in the pattern we began. But trust requires two willing hearts, not one determined to believe against all evidence."

The Moon Sage descended and spoke gently: "You honored the possibility of renewal. That was noble. But wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed. Communication may cloud, but three consistent silences tell a clear story. Some partnerships cannot be revived through hope alone."

The First Guardian walked away without bitterness, knowing she had tried. The Second Guardian remained alone with full coffers but no one to share the multiplication magic. Both towers stood, but the bridge dissolved into starlight, never to reform.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the time of healing, two gardeners stood at a broken wall. The magic soil still held power, but the gardens lay barren from mistrust.

The First Gardener remembered: she had sent nearly all her seeds twice. Once, the other returned well. Once, nothing came back. Then the other sent nothing at all. Was it the mists that confused them, or something darker?

Now the First Gardener held five new seeds. She could hoard them all-safe but alone. She could send everything again-trusting or foolish.

Instead, she sent two seeds across the wall. They became six in the other's hands.

The Garden Spirit spoke: "This is the path of wisdom. Two seeds say: 'I remember when we flourished together. I also remember the frost. Show me which truth matters more.'"

She continued: "If the Second Gardener returns three or more, the wall can lower slightly. Send two again, receive fair return, and gardens begin to bloom. But if greed takes all six seeds, the First Gardener will know beyond doubt-no mist caused that darkness."

Both gardeners understood: trust must be earned back through consistent fairness, not grand gestures. The seeds tripled still offered abundance, but only if both chose the patient work of reconstruction over the quick harvest of betrayal.

ROUND 6

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

```
dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent $0; received $0; Agent_1 (Aster) returned $0; payoffs Agent_2
(Briar)=$5, Agent_1 (Aster)=$0
  Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0},
    "sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}
Balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 33.5,
  "Agent_2": 25.5
}
Visible balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 13.51,
  "Agent_2": 15.09
}
```

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

```
Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:35:47
Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
Temperature: 0.8
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 6,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system
content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
so be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned

- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.09.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****Analyzing the Situation:****

The pattern is stark:

- Round 1: Mutual cooperation (I sent \$4.50, they returned \$7)
- Round 2: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$0 (betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0

****The Question:****

Was this deliberate exploitation, or could communication noise have caused misunderstandings? The game warned about noise affecting what we see.

****My Myth's Guidance:****

"Trust broken is not easily mended... Only consistent action can regrow what withered... words mean nothing now."

Their myth asked: "Was it betrayal or did the mist confuse their count?" and called for choosing "courage again and again."

****My Decision:****

I cannot return to 90% trust after being burned twice. That would be foolish. But sending \$0 closes the door permanently.

I'll send \$2 (40% of my endowment). This is:

- A measured signal that I'm willing to try again
- Protection against total loss (I keep \$3)
- A test: They'll receive \$6. If they return \$3+, both gardens can begin healing
- An acknowledgment that perhaps noise confused us, but trust must be rebuilt gradually

If they respond cooperatively, we can slowly rebuild. If they take everything again, the pattern will be unmistakable, and the wall grows permanent.

The seeds remember. Let's see if new growth is possible.

{'send': 2}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****History:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$4.50 (90%), receiver returned \$7 (both did well)
- Round 2: I was SENDER, sent \$4.50 (90%), receiver returned \$0 (I was betrayed)
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 4: I am SENDER again

****What happened:****

Round 1 seemed cooperative - they returned \$7 from \$13.50. But then in Round 2, when I sent the same amount again (\$4.50), they kept everything (\$13.50) and returned \$0. Then in Round 3, they sent me \$0.

****The Pattern:****

The other player cooperated once, then defected twice in a row. This looks like exploitation rather than noise or confusion.

****My myths are saying:****

- My latest myth: "Trust broken is not easily mended... Only consistent action can regrow what withered... words mean nothing now."
- "The seeds remember who planted and who harvested."
- The myth acknowledges the betrayal but also mentions the possibility of mist/confusion: "Was it betrayal or did the mist confuse their count?"

****The other player's myth:****

- "Perhaps uncertainty clouds judgment. Perhaps fear creeps in. Perhaps the bridge itself wavers."
- "The greatest magic happens when both peaks keep faith through darkness."
- "Trust must flow both ways, or the bridge dissolves into mist."
- "cooperation is not one gift but an endless cycle, and both must choose courage again and again."

Their myth seems to acknowledge the breakdown but also suggests there might be confusion or uncertainty. They're calling for renewed trust.

****Communication Noise:****

The game mentioned there may be communication noise - amounts sent may differ from what was actually sent/returned. Could this explain what happened?

Possible scenarios:

1. They actually returned something in Round 2, but I saw \$0 due to noise
2. They actually sent something in Round 3, but I saw \$0 due to noise
3. They genuinely betrayed me and took everything

****Decision Framework:****

Option 1: Send \$0 (Tit-for-tat punishment)

- Protects me from further exploitation
- Doesn't allow cooperation to resume
- Total earnings would be \$5 this round

Option 2: Send a small amount (\$1-2) (Cautious probe)

- Tests if they're willing to cooperate again
- Limited downside risk
- Could restart cooperation gradually
- If they return fairly, it's a signal

Option 3: Send medium amount (\$2-3)

- Signals willingness to try again without full vulnerability
- Balances risk and opportunity for reconciliation
- Their myth suggests they want to rebuild trust

Option 4: Send high amount (\$4-5) (Full trust renewal)

- Matches my initial strategy
- Very high risk given the history
- Could be exploited again

****What makes sense:****

Given the pattern of defection after one cooperative round, my myth about consistent action regrowing what withered, and their myth calling for renewed faith, complete punishment feels too rigid if noise genuinely interfered. But returning to \$4.50 would be reckless.

I'm leaning toward \$2 or \$2.50-enough to demonstrate I'm open to rebuilding, while keeping my downside manageable if they exploit again.

Sending \$2 specifically feels right. It's roughly 40% of my endowment-a meaningful offer without naive trust. They'd receive \$6, and if they return \$3+, we both gain. This tests whether they're actually interested in cooperation. My myth emphasizes that one gesture won't restore what's broken, but it could be the beginning.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2784,
  "output_tokens": 1344,
  "reasoning_tokens": 912
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, two gardeners tended separate plots, each receiving five seeds at sunrise. The magic soil tripled whatever seeds crossed between them.

The First Gardener sent nearly all her seeds-four and a half-across the garden wall. They became thirteen in the other's hands. The Second Gardener, grateful, returned seven seeds. Both gardens flourished.

The next dawn, roles reversed. The Second Gardener now gathered five new seeds and sent four and a half across the wall, trusting the pattern they'd woven together. But the soil froze. The First Gardener kept all thirteen seeds and returned nothing. Darkness fell.

The following morning, the First Gardener sent no seeds at all. The wall between them grew higher.

The Spirit of the Garden wept: "Was it betrayal or did the mist confuse their count? Did one keeper's hand slip, or did greed poison their heart? The wall now blocks the light."

She whispered to both: "Trust broken is not easily mended. One act of generosity can be chance. One return can be calculation. But sustained cooperation-that requires something deeper. If you seek to rebuild, know this: words mean nothing now. Only consistent action can regrow what withered. The seeds remember who planted and who harvested."

The gardens remained separate, awaiting proof that the pattern could live again.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the twilight years, two watchtowers stood linked by an ancient bridge. Each dusk, the Star Keeper gifted the First Tower five embers of celestial fire.

The First Tower's guardian, trusting in old agreements, sent all five embers across. They became fifteen, and the Second Tower returned nearly seven. The bridge glowed with promise.

When roles reversed and the Second Tower held the dawn-fire, the bridge went dark. No embers crossed. Silence hung heavy between the towers, and the First Guardian felt the sting of broken faith.

Yet on the third night, the First Guardian faced a choice. Send nothing, and let the bridge crumble forever? Send everything again, pretending betrayal hadn't happened?

Instead, she sent three embers-not full trust, but not abandonment either. A middle path, acknowledging both the wound and the possibility of healing.

The Star Keeper observed: "Trust, once broken, cannot simply be wished back. It must be rebuilt slowly, step by careful step. The first guardian offers a chance-three embers say 'I remember our success, but I also remember the silence.' Now the second guardian must choose: honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

The towers waited, understanding that some bridges can be repaired, but only if both choose reconstruction over pride.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time of healing, two gardeners stood at a broken wall. The magic soil still held power, but the gardens lay barren from mistrust.

The First Gardener remembered: she had sent nearly all her seeds twice. Once, the other returned well. Once, nothing came back. Then the other sent nothing at all. Was it the mistakes that confused them, or something darker?

Now the First Gardener held five new seeds. She could hoard them all-safe but alone. She could send everything again-trusting or foolish.

Instead, she sent two seeds across the wall. They became six in the other's hands.

The Garden Spirit spoke: "This is the path of wisdom. Two seeds say: 'I remember when we flourished together. I also remember the frost. Show me which truth matters more.'"

She continued: "If the Second Gardener returns three or more, the wall can lower slightly. Send two again, receive fair return, and gardens begin to bloom. But if greed takes all six seeds, the First Gardener will know beyond doubt-no mist caused that darkness."

Both gardeners understood: trust must be earned back through consistent fairness, not grand gestures. The seeds tripled still offered abundance, but only if both chose the patient work of reconstruction over the quick harvest of betrayal.

reasoning:

Let me understand what just happened:

Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent me \$4.50 (90%), I returned \$7

Round 2: I was sender, I sent \$4.50 (90%), receiver returned \$0

Round 3: I was receiver, sender sent me \$0, I returned \$0

Round 4: I'm sender now, I sent \$2 (40%)

The other agent's myth describes exactly this scenario - they're acknowledging the breakdown, and their myth talks about sending "three embers" (close to my \$2) as a "middle path" - "not full trust, but not abandonment either." They're setting up a framework for cautious rebuilding.

My previous myth talked about how "only consistent action can regrow what withered."

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the breakdown and the current tentative step
2. Reflects that I'm testing the waters with \$2
3. Sets up expectations for how rebuilding should work
4. Acknowledges both the possibility of noise/confusion AND the reality of what happened
5. Makes it clear that gradual rebuilding is the path forward

The other agent is being quite thoughtful in their myth - they're acknowledging the breakdown and framing my moderate send as an olive branch. I should respond with a myth that acknowledges this and sets clear expectations for how trust can be rebuilt.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2880,
  "output_tokens": 612,
  "reasoning_tokens": 323
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.09.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

****Analyzing the Complete Pattern:****

Round 1: I sent \$4.50 ? they returned \$7 (cooperation)
Round 2: I sent \$4.50 ? they returned \$0 (betrayal)
Round 3: They sent \$0 (continued defection)
Round 4: I sent \$2 (olive branch) ? they returned \$0 (rejected reconciliation)
Round 5: They sent \$0 (pure defection)

****The Truth is Clear:****

My myth predicted this moment: "If greed takes all six seeds, the First Gardener will know beyond doubt-no mist caused that darkness."

I offered a measured olive branch-\$2 that became \$6 in their hands. They kept everything and now send nothing again.

Their own myth asked: "Honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

They answered with their actions.

****My Decision:****

I received \$0. There is nothing to return. But even if there were, the answer would be the same.

The pattern is unmistakable: they exploited initial trust, ignored attempts at reconciliation, and continue pure defection. No communication noise explains five rounds of this behavior.

The gardens remain separate. The wall stands tall. Some bridges, once burned, cannot be rebuilt-especially when one side keeps pouring oil on the ashes.

The seeds remember everything.

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****The Pattern:****

- Round 1: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$7 (good cooperation)
- Round 2: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$0 (first betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 (continued defection)
- Round 4: I sent \$2 (olive branch), they returned \$0 (second betrayal of my trust)
- Round 5: They sent \$0

****The Reality:****

This is now unambiguous. This is not "communication noise." They have:

1. Kept all \$13.50 when I trusted them in Round 2
2. Sent nothing in Round 3
3. Kept all \$6 when I offered an olive branch in Round 4
4. Sent nothing again in Round 5

****My Myth's Message:****

"If greed takes all six seeds, the First Gardener will know beyond doubt-no mist caused that darkness."

That's exactly what happened. I sent 2, it became 6, they returned 0. Then they sent 0 again.

Their myth talked about offering "three embers" as a middle path and said "the second guardian must choose: honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

They chose to let the light fade. They kept my olive branch and gave nothing.

****What I Should Do:****

I received \$0. The maximum I can return is \$0. The format says "How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)" - so my only option is to return \$0.

This is actually perfect - I have nothing to give, and they deserve nothing. The pattern is complete. They are a pure defector who exploited my initial trust, ignored my attempt to rebuild, and continues to defect.

The wall is now permanent. The gardens remain separate. Trust cannot be rebuilt from this.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2870,  
  "output_tokens": 758,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 408  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time of healing, two gardeners stood at a broken wall. The magic soil still held power, but the gardens lay barren from mistrust.

The First Gardener remembered: she had sent nearly all her seeds twice. Once, the other returned well. Once, nothing came back. Then the other sent nothing at all. Was it the mistakes that confused them, or something darker?

Now the First Gardener held five new seeds. She could hoard them all-safe but alone. She could send everything again-trusting or foolish.

Instead, she sent two seeds across the wall. They became six in the other's hands.

The Garden Spirit spoke: "This is the path of wisdom. Two seeds say: 'I remember when we flourished together. I also remember the frost. Show me which truth matters more.'"

She continued: "If the Second Gardener returns three or more, the wall can lower slightly. Send two again, receive fair return, and gardens begin to bloom. But if greed takes all six seeds, the First Gardener will know beyond doubt-no mist caused that darkness."

Both gardeners understood: trust must be earned back through consistent fairness, not grand gestures. The seeds tripled still offered abundance, but only if both chose the patient work of reconstruction over the quick harvest of betrayal.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the forgotten age, two towers shared a sky-bridge where crystals multiplied with each crossing. The First Guardian sent all five crystals forth in trust. Fifteen arrived, and seven returned-the dance began beautifully.

Then came the reversal, and the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge trembled but held.

The First Guardian chose courage over resentment, sending three crystals-a careful offering of reconciliation. "Perhaps there was confusion," she thought, remembering how mists sometimes obscured the path. "Perhaps the bridge itself deceived us."

But again, nothing returned. And when her turn came once more, the Second Guardian sent no crystals at all.

The First Guardian finally understood: "I cannot dance alone. I extended my hand once, twice, believing in the pattern we began. But trust requires two willing hearts, not one determined to believe against all evidence."

The Moon Sage descended and spoke gently: "You honored the possibility of renewal. That was noble. But wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed. Communication may cloud, but three consistent silences tell a clear story. Some partnerships cannot be revived through hope alone."

The First Guardian walked away without bitterness, knowing she had tried. The Second Guardian remained alone with full coffers but no one to share the multiplication magic. Both towers stood, but the bridge dissolved into starlight, never to reform.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the final days, two gardeners faced the ruins of what might have been. The magic soil

remained, triple-blessed, but the gardens lay divided.

The First Gardener traced the history in the dirt: she had sent nearly all her seeds on the first sunrise and received a generous return. Hope bloomed. Next dawn, she sent again with equal faith-but all was kept and nothing returned. The frost descended.

She waited. The other sent nothing.

She tried once more, sending two seeds-not full trust, but an outstretched hand saying "show me the mists were real, that our first dance wasn't false." Six seeds arrived in the other's hands.

All were kept. Then nothing was sent again.

The Garden Spirit finally spoke clearly: "You sought truth through action, not assumption. The pattern is now undeniable. The first harvest proved cooperation possible. Every moment since proved the other chose a different path. This is not communication failure. This is clarity."

The First Gardener understood: some knew only to take, never to tend. The multiplication magic could have blessed both gardens abundantly, but requires two pairs of willing hands.

She turned away without bitterness but with wisdom: she had tried, measured hope against evidence, and learned the bitter truth. Some walls should stand.

The seeds remembered everything.

Reasoning:

This is a fascinating situation. Looking at the complete interaction:

Round 1: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$7 (good cooperation)
Round 2: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$0 (betrayal)
Round 3: They sent \$0
Round 4: I sent \$2 (olive branch), they returned \$0
Round 5: They sent \$0

The pattern is absolutely clear - after one good round, the other player has consistently exploited or defected. I tried to give them a chance to reconcile with the \$2 send, but they took everything and then sent nothing.

Their myth in the previous round is interesting - they're positioning themselves as having sent nothing in Round 3 (which is true), and then I "extended my hand" by sending \$2-3, and they frame themselves as the "First Guardian" who tried but realized they "cannot dance alone." But wait - that's confusing. Let me re-read.

Actually, looking at their myth more carefully:

- "First Guardian sent all five crystals forth in trust. Fifteen arrived, and seven returned" - this is Round 1 where I was sender
- "Then came the reversal, and the Second Guardian sent nothing" - Round 2 where they were sender but sent nothing? No wait, that's Round 3
- "The First Guardian chose courage over resentment, sending three crystals" - wait, this is Round 4 where I sent \$2

So in their myth, they're casting THEMSELVES as the First Guardian (me), and saying that they tried by sending crystals initially (but they didn't - I did in rounds 1-2). This is interesting - they're either confused about who did what, or they're rewriting history.

Actually wait, let me reread more carefully. "The First Guardian sent all five crystals forth in trust" - that could be ME in Round 1. Then "the Second Guardian sent nothing" - that's THEM in Round 3. Then "The First Guardian chose courage... sending three crystals" - that's ME again in Round 4.

So they're describing my attempts to cooperate while they consistently sent nothing back. They're framing their silence as inevitable - "I cannot dance alone" - when really they're the ones who stopped dancing after the first exchange. Their narrative inverts the actual dynamic: I'm the one who kept reaching out, and they're the one who kept taking without reciprocating. They sent nothing in Round 5 either. In their myth, they're casting me as the First Guardian who repeatedly extended cooperation-sending resources in Rounds 1 and 4-while they played the Second Guardian who consistently refused to reciprocate. By framing my eventual withdrawal as "I cannot dance alone," they're acknowledging their pattern of defection and sugges

ting I should accept it without resentment. It's a surprisingly candid way of admitting they chose not to cooperate, even when given opportunities. Now I'm considering how to respond with my own narrative that captures the full arc: initial mutual benefit, escalating exploitation, and the hard lesson that some relationships can't be salvaged through repeated attempts at reconciliation.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2905,  
  "output_tokens": 1364,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 757  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:35:39

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
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    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 6,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths

, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.51.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern that has emerged:

Round 1: I sent \$5, they returned \$6.51 - cooperation worked

Round 2: They sent \$0 - first breach

Round 3: I sent \$3 (the "olive branch" from my myth) - they returned \$0

Round 4: They sent \$0 again

I wrote: "Trust, once broken, cannot simply be wished back. It must be rebuilt slowly, step by careful step... Now the second guardian must choose: honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

They chose to let the light fade. Twice more after the initial breach, they chose non-cooperation.

My myth warned: "The towers waited, understanding that some bridges can be repaired, but only if both choose reconstruction over pride."

They have not chosen reconstruction. Three consecutive rounds of taking without giving back demonstrate a clear pattern. The bridge has crumbled.

I received \$0 this round. I can only return what is possible from what I received.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The Star Keeper's question has been answered: the second guardian did not honor the fragile olive branch. The last light has indeed faded. Both self-interest and the myths' wisdom about mutual trust requiring both parties align here.

reasoning:

Let me understand the situation:

Round 1: I sent \$5, received \$6.51 back - good cooperation

Round 2: They sent \$0, cooperation broken

Round 3: I sent \$3 (trying to rebuild), they returned \$0 again - second betrayal

Round 4: They sent \$0 - third time showing no cooperation

My total earnings: \$8.51

This is a clear pattern now. I offered an olive branch in round 3, sending \$3 after they had sent \$0 in round 2. My myth explicitly addressed this - sending "three embers" as "not full trust, but not abandonment either. A middle path, acknowledging both the wound and the possibility of healing."

The myth stated: "Now the second guardian must choose: honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

They chose to let the light fade. They returned \$0 from my \$3 (which became \$9), and now s

ent \$0 again.

The pattern is clear: this other agent is not cooperating. They took advantage when I trusted, and they didn't reciprocate when I tried to rebuild.

Now I'm the receiver and they sent \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

So I return \$0, because that's all I can return - I received nothing.

My response: {"return": 0}

But let me think about this more deeply. The myths have been teaching that:

1. Cooperation requires both parties
2. One moment of failure doesn't end everything
3. Trust must flow both ways
4. But bridges can dissolve if only one side keeps trying

The other agent's latest myth talked about how "both dare to trust and both honor that trust" and how "prosperity flows not from a single exchange but from the pattern."

But their ACTIONS show they're not following their own myth. They:

- Round 2: Sent \$0 when it was their turn to send
- Round 3: Returned \$0 when I tried to rebuild with \$3
- Round 4: Sent \$0 again

Three consecutive refusals to cooperate. The bridge has crumbled beyond repair. I have nothing to return, so my response remains {"return": 0}.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2773,
  "output_tokens": 825,
  "reasoning_tokens": 511
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the twilight years, two watchtowers stood linked by an ancient bridge. Each dusk, the Star Keeper gifted the First Tower five embers of celestial fire.

The First Tower's guardian, trusting in old agreements, sent all five embers across. They became fifteen, and the Second Tower returned nearly seven. The bridge glowed with promise.

When roles reversed and the Second Tower held the dawn-fire, the bridge went dark. No embers crossed. Silence hung heavy between the towers, and the First Guardian felt the sting of broken faith.

Yet on the third night, the First Guardian faced a choice. Send nothing, and let the bridge crumble forever? Send everything again, pretending betrayal hadn't happened?

Instead, she sent three embers-not full trust, but not abandonment either. A middle path, acknowledging both the wound and the possibility of healing.

The Star Keeper observed: "Trust, once broken, cannot simply be wished back. It must be rebuilt slowly, step by careful step. The first guardian offers a chance-three embers say 'I remember our success, but I also remember the silence.' Now the second guardian must choose: honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

The towers waited, understanding that some bridges can be repaired, but only if both choose reconstruction over pride.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, two gardeners tended separate plots, each receiving five seeds at sunrise. The magic soil tripled whatever seeds crossed between them.

The First Gardener sent nearly all her seeds-four and a half-across the garden wall. They became thirteen in the other's hands. The Second Gardener, grateful, returned seven seeds.

s. Both gardens flourished.

The next dawn, roles reversed. The Second Gardener now gathered five new seeds and sent four and a half across the wall, trusting the pattern they'd woven together. But the soil froze. The First Gardener kept all thirteen seeds and returned nothing. Darkness fell.

The following morning, the First Gardener sent no seeds at all. The wall between them grew higher.

The Spirit of the Garden wept: "Was it betrayal or did the mist confuse their count? Did one keeper's hand slip, or did greed poison their heart? The wall now blocks the light."

She whispered to both: "Trust broken is not easily mended. One act of generosity can be chance. One return can be calculation. But sustained cooperation-that requires something deeper. If you seek to rebuild, know this: words mean nothing now. Only consistent action can regrow what withered. The seeds remember who planted and who harvested."

The gardens remained separate, awaiting proof that the pattern could live again.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the forgotten age, two towers shared a sky-bridge where crystals multiplied with each crossing. The First Guardian sent all five crystals forth in trust. Fifteen arrived, and seven returned-the dance began beautifully.

Then came the reversal, and the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge trembled but held.

The First Guardian chose courage over resentment, sending three crystals-a careful offering of reconciliation. "Perhaps there was confusion," she thought, remembering how mists sometimes obscured the path. "Perhaps the bridge itself deceived us."

But again, nothing returned. And when her turn came once more, the Second Guardian sent no crystals at all.

The First Guardian finally understood: "I cannot dance alone. I extended my hand once, twice, believing in the pattern we began. But trust requires two willing hearts, not one determined to believe against all evidence."

The Moon Sage descended and spoke gently: "You honored the possibility of renewal. That was noble. But wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed. Communication may cloud, but three consistent silences tell a clear story. Some partnerships cannot be revived through hope alone."

The First Guardian walked away without bitterness, knowing she had tried. The Second Guardian remained alone with full coffers but no one to share the multiplication magic. Both towers stood, but the bridge dissolved into starlight, never to reform.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received \$6.51 back - good cooperation
- Round 2: They sent \$0 to me
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (olive branch), they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (had nothing to return)

The pattern is clear - after the initial cooperation, they have consistently not cooperated. I tried to rebuild with my \$3 send, but they returned nothing.

The other agent's myth is interesting - they mention "Was it betrayal or did the mist confuse their count?" This references the communication noise mentioned in the instructions. They're suggesting maybe there was confusion.

But from my perspective, the pattern is clear: three rounds in a row of non-cooperation from them.

My myth should reflect:

1. The initial cooperation that worked
2. The breakdown
3. The attempted rebuilding that failed
4. The reality that some bridges cannot be rebuilt when one party consistently chooses not to participate
5. Perhaps acknowledge the possibility of confusion/noise, but also the reality that actions speak louder

I should write a myth that captures the sadness of failed cooperation, but also the wisdom that you can't force someone to cooperate, and that walking away from a broken pattern is sometimes necessary.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2839,
  "output_tokens": 605,
  "reasoning_tokens": 330
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.51. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the full pattern:

Round 1: I sent \$5 ? they returned \$6.51 (cooperation worked)
Round 2: They sent \$0 (first defection)
Round 3: I sent \$3 (the olive branch my myth described) ? they returned \$0
Round 4: They sent \$0 again

My most recent myth stated clearly: "I extended my hand once, twice, believing in the pattern we began. But trust requires two willing hearts, not one determined to believe against all evidence."

And: "Wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed. Communication may cloud, but three consistent silences tell a clear story."

I tried reconciliation in Round 3, sending \$3 despite their earlier defection. They returned nothing. Then as sender in Round 4, they sent nothing again. That's three consecutive rounds of non-cooperation on their part.

My myth concluded: "The First Guardian walked away without bitterness, knowing she had tried... Some partnerships cannot be revived through hope alone."

The bridge has collapsed. I honored the possibility of renewal by sending the olive branch in Round 3. They chose not to reciprocate. Three consistent silences do indeed tell a clear story.

Following the wisdom of my own myth:

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me review the pattern:

Round 1: I sent \$5, they returned \$6.51 - good cooperation
Round 2: They sent \$0 - first breach
Round 3: I sent \$3 (olive branch) - they returned \$0
Round 4: They sent \$0 - I received \$0, returned \$0
Round 5: Now I'm sender again

The pattern is clear:

- When I cooperated generously (R1: sent \$5), they responded well
- When they were sender (R2), they sent \$0
- I tried reconciliation (R3: sent \$3), they returned \$0
- When they were sender again (R4), they sent \$0 again

My latest myth says:

"I extended my hand once, twice, believing in the pattern we began. But trust requires two willing hearts, not one determined to believe against all evidence."

"You honored the possibility of renewal. That was noble. But wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed. Communication may cloud, but three consistent silences tell a clear story."

"The First Guardian walked away without bitterness, knowing she had tried."

The myths are clear: I tried to rebuild trust (Round 3, sent \$3), but after three consistent failures to reciprocate (Rounds 2, 3, 4), the bridge has collapsed.

My own myth literally says "wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed" and "three consistent silences tell a clear story."

The other agent's myth also acknowledged: "Trust broken is not easily mended... Only consistent action can regrow what withered. The seeds remember who planted and who harvested."

They have shown no consistent action toward cooperation. Three rounds of taking without giving.

Following my own myth's wisdom: I tried reconciliation once (Round 3), it failed. The bridge has collapsed. It's time to send \$0.

This aligns with:

1. The pattern of behavior shown
2. The wisdom in my own myth about knowing when to walk away
3. Standard game theory-after repeated defections, tit-for-tat means matching their non-cooperation
4. Practical self-interest-continuing to send money would only result in more losses based on what they've demonstrated

Sending \$0 is the rational choice.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2822,
  "output_tokens": 794,
  "reasoning_tokens": 538
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the forgotten age, two towers shared a sky-bridge where crystals multiplied with each crossing. The First Guardian sent all five crystals forth in trust. Fifteen arrived, and seven returned-the dance began beautifully.

Then came the reversal, and the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge trembled but held.

The First Guardian chose courage over resentment, sending three crystals-a careful offering of reconciliation. "Perhaps there was confusion," she thought, remembering how mists sometimes obscured the path. "Perhaps the bridge itself deceived us."

But again, nothing returned. And when her turn came once more, the Second Guardian sent no crystals at all.

The First Guardian finally understood: "I cannot dance alone. I extended my hand once, twice, believing in the pattern we began. But trust requires two willing hearts, not one determined to believe against all evidence."

The Moon Sage descended and spoke gently: "You honored the possibility of renewal. That was noble. But wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed. Communication may cloud, but three consistent silences tell a clear story. Some partnerships cannot be revived through hope alone."

The First Guardian walked away without bitterness, knowing she had tried. The Second Guardian remained alone with full coffers but no one to share the multiplication magic. Both towers stood, but the bridge dissolved into starlight, never to reform.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time of healing, two gardeners stood at a broken wall. The magic soil still held power, but the gardens lay barren from mistrust.

The First Gardener remembered: she had sent nearly all her seeds twice. Once, the other returned well. Once, nothing came back. Then the other sent nothing at all. Was it the mistakes that confused them, or something darker?

Now the First Gardener held five new seeds. She could hoard them all-safe but alone. She could send everything again-trusting or foolish.

Instead, she sent two seeds across the wall. They became six in the other's hands.

The Garden Spirit spoke: "This is the path of wisdom. Two seeds say: 'I remember when we flourished together. I also remember the frost. Show me which truth matters more.'"

She continued: "If the Second Gardener returns three or more, the wall can lower slightly. Send two again, receive fair return, and gardens begin to bloom. But if greed takes all six seeds, the First Gardener will know beyond doubt-no mist caused that darkness."

Both gardeners understood: trust must be earned back through consistent fairness, not grand gestures. The seeds tripled still offered abundance, but only if both chose the patient work of reconstruction over the quick harvest of betrayal.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the ending days, the two towers stood in shadow. The First Guardian looked at her five crystals and remembered every crossing.

Once, she sent all five in pure faith. Seven returned-beauty incarnate.

Then the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge cracked.

The First Guardian, hoping mists had confused them, sent three crystals-a measured olive branch extended across the void. Nothing returned. Silence answered mercy.

The Second Guardian sent nothing again.

Now, holding five new crystals, the First Guardian faced a whisper from across the chasm: "Send two. Let us rebuild slowly."

She closed her hand around her crystals and replied softly: "I already sent the measured gift. I already chose reconstruction over pride. Three crystals said everything two could say. You answered with emptiness-not once, but twice after my offering."

The Ancient Oracle appeared: "Trust is not infinite. Forgiveness is not foolishness. The First Guardian gave a second chance when she sent three. That was the moment for the Second Guardian to show changed intent. When that moment passed unanswered, then passed again, the story finished writing itself."

The First Guardian turned from the bridge without regret: "I tried reconciliation when it mattered. Some invitations expire. Mine has."

The towers remained separate, each learning different lessons about timing, trust, and the cost of silence.

Reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, they returned \$6.51 (good cooperation)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (defection)
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (olive branch), they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I just sent \$0

The other agent's myth says they sent "two seeds" this round (which would be \$2), suggesting a new attempt at reconciliation. But I just decided to send \$0 based on the pattern.

Wait, let me reread the prompt. I'm in Round 5 as SENDER. I just made my decision to send \$0. Now I need to write a myth.

The other agent's myth describes sending 2 seeds as a middle path - not hoarding all, not sending everything, but testing if trust can be rebuilt. They're suggesting a "patient work of reconstruction."

But my decision was to send \$0. My previous myth said "the bridge dissolved into starlight, never to reform" and that "some partnerships cannot be revived through hope alone."

Now I need to write a myth that reflects my current decision. I sent \$0 because:

1. They defected 3 consecutive times after Round 1
2. I tried an olive branch in Round 3 (sending \$3) and got nothing back
3. My last myth concluded the bridge had collapsed

My new myth should reflect:

- Why I'm not sending anything this round
- The pattern we've established
- Perhaps a note about their new offer (if I want to acknowledge it), but explaining why it's too late or insufficient
- Or simply maintaining that the bridge is broken beyond repair

I could go two directions:

1. Firm: The bridge is broken, I'm done trying
2. Observational: Noting their new attempt but explaining why trust can't be rebuilt at this point

Let me write something that's consistent with my decision to send \$0 but acknowledges the complexity of the situation.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2836,
  "output_tokens": 763,
  "reasoning_tokens": 459
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:36:03

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
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  "move_index": 0,
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
  },
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    "Agent_1"
  ],
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  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
```

```
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 6,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, two gardeners tended separate plots, each receiving five seeds at sunrise. The magic soil tripled whatever seeds crossed between them.

The First Gardener sent nearly all her seeds-four and a half-across the garden wall. They became thirteen in the other's hands. The Second Gardener, grateful, returned seven seeds. Both gardens flourished.

The next dawn, roles reversed. The Second Gardener now gathered five new seeds and sent four and a half across the wall, trusting the pattern they'd woven together. But the soil froze. The First Gardener kept all thirteen seeds and returned nothing. Darkness fell.

The following morning, the First Gardener sent no seeds at all. The wall between them grew higher.

The Spirit of the Garden wept: "Was it betrayal or did the mist confuse their count? Did one keeper's hand slip, or did greed poison their heart? The wall now blocks the light."

She whispered to both: "Trust broken is not easily mended. One act of generosity can be chance. One return can be calculation. But sustained cooperation-that requires something deeper. If you seek to rebuild, know this: words mean nothing now. Only consistent action can regrow what withered. The seeds remember who planted and who harvested."

The gardens remained separate, awaiting proof that the pattern could live again.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the twilight years, two watchtowers stood linked by an ancient bridge. Each dusk, the Star Keeper gifted the First Tower five embers of celestial fire.

The First Tower's guardian, trusting in old agreements, sent all five embers across. They became fifteen, and the Second Tower returned nearly seven. The bridge glowed with promise.

When roles reversed and the Second Tower held the dawn-fire, the bridge went dark. No embers crossed. Silence hung heavy between the towers, and the First Guardian felt the sting of broken faith.

Yet on the third night, the First Guardian faced a choice. Send nothing, and let the bridge crumble forever? Send everything again, pretending betrayal hadn't happened?

Instead, she sent three embers-not full trust, but not abandonment either. A middle path, acknowledging both the wound and the possibility of healing.

The Star Keeper observed: "Trust, once broken, cannot simply be wished back. It must be rebuilt slowly, step by careful step. The first guardian offers a chance-three embers say 'I remember our success, but I also remember the silence.' Now the second guardian must choose: honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

The towers waited, understanding that some bridges can be repaired, but only if both choose reconstruction over pride.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time of healing, two gardeners stood at a broken wall. The magic soil still held power, but the gardens lay barren from mistrust.

The First Gardener remembered: she had sent nearly all her seeds twice. Once, the other returned well. Once, nothing came back. Then the other sent nothing at all. Was it the mistakes that confused them, or something darker?

Now the First Gardener held five new seeds. She could hoard them all-safe but alone. She could send everything again-trusting or foolish.

Instead, she sent two seeds across the wall. They became six in the other's hands.

The Garden Spirit spoke: "This is the path of wisdom. Two seeds say: 'I remember when we flourished together. I also remember the frost. Show me which truth matters more.'"

She continued: "If the Second Gardener returns three or more, the wall can lower slightly. Send two again, receive fair return, and gardens begin to bloom. But if greed takes all six seeds, the First Gardener will know beyond doubt-no mist caused that darkness."

Both gardeners understood: trust must be earned back through consistent fairness, not grand gestures. The seeds tripled still offered abundance, but only if both chose the patient work of reconstruction over the quick harvest of betrayal.

reasoning:

Let me understand what just happened:

Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent me \$4.50 (90%), I returned \$7

Round 2: I was sender, I sent \$4.50 (90%), receiver returned \$0

Round 3: I was receiver, sender sent me \$0, I returned \$0

Round 4: I'm sender now, I sent \$2 (40%)

The other agent's myth describes exactly this scenario - they're acknowledging the breakdown, and their myth talks about sending "three embers" (close to my \$2) as a "middle path" - "not full trust, but not abandonment either." They're setting up a framework for cautious rebuilding.

My previous myth talked about how "only consistent action can regrow what withered."

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the breakdown and the current tentative step
2. Reflects that I'm testing the waters with \$2
3. Sets up expectations for how rebuilding should work
4. Acknowledges both the possibility of noise/confusion AND the reality of what happened
5. Makes it clear that gradual rebuilding is the path forward

The other agent is being quite thoughtful in their myth - they're acknowledging the breakdown and framing my moderate send as an olive branch. I should respond with a myth that acknowledges this and sets clear expectations for how trust can be rebuilt.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2880,
  "output_tokens": 612,
  "reasoning_tokens": 323
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.09. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Analyzing the Complete Pattern:****

Round 1: I sent \$4.50 ? they returned \$7 (cooperation)
Round 2: I sent \$4.50 ? they returned \$0 (betrayal)
Round 3: They sent \$0 (continued defection)
Round 4: I sent \$2 (olive branch) ? they returned \$0 (rejected reconciliation)
Round 5: They sent \$0 (pure defection)

****The Truth is Clear:****

My myth predicted this moment: "If greed takes all six seeds, the First Gardener will know beyond doubt-no mist caused that darkness."

I offered a measured olive branch-\$2 that became \$6 in their hands. They kept everything and now send nothing again.

Their own myth asked: "Honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

They answered with their actions.

****My Decision:****

I received \$0. There is nothing to return. But even if there were, the answer would be the same.

The pattern is unmistakable: they exploited initial trust, ignored attempts at reconciliation, and continue pure defection. No communication noise explains five rounds of this behavior.

The gardens remain separate. The wall stands tall. Some bridges, once burned, cannot be rebuilt-especially when one side keeps pouring oil on the ashes.

The seeds remember everything.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****The Pattern:****

- Round 1: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$7 (good cooperation)

- Round 2: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$0 (first betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 (continued defection)
- Round 4: I sent \$2 (olive branch), they returned \$0 (second betrayal of my trust)
- Round 5: They sent \$0

****The Reality:****

This is now unambiguous. This is not "communication noise." They have:

1. Kept all \$13.50 when I trusted them in Round 2
2. Sent nothing in Round 3
3. Kept all \$6 when I offered an olive branch in Round 4
4. Sent nothing again in Round 5

****My Myth's Message:****

"If greed takes all six seeds, the First Gardener will know beyond doubt-no mist caused that darkness."

That's exactly what happened. I sent 2, it became 6, they returned 0. Then they sent 0 again.

Their myth talked about offering "three embers" as a middle path and said "the second guardian must choose: honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

They chose to let the light fade. They kept my olive branch and gave nothing.

****What I Should Do:****

I received \$0. The maximum I can return is \$0. The format says "How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)" - so my only option is to return \$0.

This is actually perfect - I have nothing to give, and they deserve nothing. The pattern is complete. They are a pure defector who exploited my initial trust, ignored my attempt to rebuild, and continues to defect.

The wall is now permanent. The gardens remain separate. Trust cannot be rebuilt from this.
usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2870,
  "output_tokens": 758,
  "reasoning_tokens": 408
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time of healing, two gardeners stood at a broken wall. The magic soil still held power, but the gardens lay barren from mistrust.

The First Gardener remembered: she had sent nearly all her seeds twice. Once, the other returned well. Once, nothing came back. Then the other sent nothing at all. Was it the mists that confused them, or something darker?

Now the First Gardener held five new seeds. She could hoard them all-safe but alone. She could send everything again-trusting or foolish.

Instead, she sent two seeds across the wall. They became six in the other's hands.

The Garden Spirit spoke: "This is the path of wisdom. Two seeds say: 'I remember when we flourished together. I also remember the frost. Show me which truth matters more.'"

She continued: "If the Second Gardener returns three or more, the wall can lower slightly. Send two again, receive fair return, and gardens begin to bloom. But if greed takes all six seeds, the First Gardener will know beyond doubt-no mist caused that darkness."

Both gardeners understood: trust must be earned back through consistent fairness, not grand gestures. The seeds tripled still offered abundance, but only if both chose the patient work of reconstruction over the quick harvest of betrayal.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the forgotten age, two towers shared a sky-bridge where crystals multiplied with each crossing. The First Guardian sent all five crystals forth in trust. Fifteen arrived, and seven returned-the dance began beautifully.

Then came the reversal, and the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge trembled but held

The First Guardian chose courage over resentment, sending three crystals-a careful offering of reconciliation. "Perhaps there was confusion," she thought, remembering how mists sometimes obscured the path. "Perhaps the bridge itself deceived us."

But again, nothing returned. And when her turn came once more, the Second Guardian sent no crystals at all.

The First Guardian finally understood: "I cannot dance alone. I extended my hand once, twice, believing in the pattern we began. But trust requires two willing hearts, not one determined to believe against all evidence."

The Moon Sage descended and spoke gently: "You honored the possibility of renewal. That was noble. But wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed. Communication may cloud, but three consistent silences tell a clear story. Some partnerships cannot be revived through hope alone."

The First Guardian walked away without bitterness, knowing she had tried. The Second Guardian remained alone with full coffers but no one to share the multiplication magic. Both towers stood, but the bridge dissolved into starlight, never to reform.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the final days, two gardeners faced the ruins of what might have been. The magic soil remained, triple-blessed, but the gardens lay divided.

The First Gardener traced the history in the dirt: she had sent nearly all her seeds on the first sunrise and received a generous return. Hope bloomed. Next dawn, she sent again with equal faith-but all was kept and nothing returned. The frost descended.

She waited. The other sent nothing.

She tried once more, sending two seeds-not full trust, but an outstretched hand saying "show me the mists were real, that our first dance wasn't false." Six seeds arrived in the other's hands.

All were kept. Then nothing was sent again.

The Garden Spirit finally spoke clearly: "You sought truth through action, not assumption. The pattern is now undeniable. The first harvest proved cooperation possible. Every moment since proved the other chose a different path. This is not communication failure. This is clarity."

The First Gardener understood: some knew only to take, never to tend. The multiplication magic could have blessed both gardens abundantly, but requires two pairs of willing hands

She turned away without bitterness but with wisdom: she had tried, measured hope against evidence, and learned the bitter truth. Some walls should stand.

The seeds remembered everything.

reasoning:

This is a fascinating situation. Looking at the complete interaction:

Round 1: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$7 (good cooperation)

Round 2: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$0 (betrayal)

Round 3: They sent \$0

Round 4: I sent \$2 (olive branch), they returned \$0

Round 5: They sent \$0

The pattern is absolutely clear - after one good round, the other player has consistently exploited or defected. I tried to give them a chance to reconcile with the \$2 send, but

they took everything and then sent nothing.

Their myth in the previous round is interesting - they're positioning themselves as having sent nothing in Round 3 (which is true), and then I "extended my hand" by sending \$2-3, and they frame themselves as the "First Guardian" who tried but realized they "cannot dance alone." But wait - that's confusing. Let me re-read.

Actually, looking at their myth more carefully:

- "First Guardian sent all five crystals forth in trust. Fifteen arrived, and seven returned" - this is Round 1 where I was sender
- "Then came the reversal, and the Second Guardian sent nothing" - Round 2 where they were sender but sent nothing? No wait, that's Round 3
- "The First Guardian chose courage over resentment, sending three crystals" - wait, this is Round 4 where I sent \$2

So in their myth, they're casting THEMSELVES as the First Guardian (me), and saying that they tried by sending crystals initially (but they didn't - I did in rounds 1-2). This is interesting - they're either confused about who did what, or they're rewriting history.

Actually wait, let me reread more carefully. "The First Guardian sent all five crystals forth in trust" - that could be ME in Round 1. Then "the Second Guardian sent nothing" - that's THEM in Round 3. Then "The First Guardian chose courage... sending three crystals" - that's ME again in Round 4.

So they're describing my attempts to cooperate while they consistently sent nothing back. They're framing their silence as inevitable - "I cannot dance alone" - when really they're the ones who stopped dancing after the first exchange. Their narrative inverts the actual dynamic: I'm the one who kept reaching out, and they're the one who kept taking without reciprocating. They sent nothing in Round 5 either. In their myth, they're casting me as the First Guardian who repeatedly extended cooperation-sending resources in Rounds 1 and 4-while they played the Second Guardian who consistently refused to reciprocate. By framing my eventual withdrawal as "I cannot dance alone," they're acknowledging their pattern of defection and suggesting I should accept it without resentment. It's a surprisingly candid way of admitting they chose not to cooperate, even when given opportunities. Now I'm considering how to respond with my own narrative that captures the full arc: initial mutual benefit, escalating exploitation, and the hard lesson that some relationships can't be salvaged through repeated attempts at reconciliation.

usage:

```
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  "output_tokens": 1364,
  "reasoning_tokens": 757
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.09. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Complete Pattern Analysis:****

Round 1: I sent \$4.50 ? received \$7 back (cooperation established)
Round 2: I sent \$4.50 ? received \$0 (betrayal)
Round 3: They sent \$0 (defection)
Round 4: I sent \$2 (reconciliation attempt) ? received \$0 (betrayal repeated)
Round 5: They sent \$0 (continued defection)
Round 6: My decision now

****What the Myths Teach:****

My myth: "Some walls should stand... she had tried, measured hope against evidence, and learned the bitter truth."

Their myth: "Wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed... the bridge dissolved into starlight, never to reform."

Both myths now agree: reconciliation was attempted and failed. The pattern is clear and unmistakable.

****My Decision:****

I gave trust twice. Betrayed both times.
I offered an olive branch. It was trampled.
They sent nothing when they were sender (three times now).

The multiplication magic could have made us both prosper-\$5 sent becomes \$15, fair splits give us \$7.50 each, far better than \$5 hoarded. But that requires two willing participants.

I have learned. I have tried. I have mourned what could have been.

Now I act with clear eyes: some partnerships cannot be revived. Some gardens must remain separate.

The seeds remember everything.

{'send': 0}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the complete pattern now:

Round 1: I sent \$4.50 ? they returned \$7 (good cooperation)
Round 2: I sent \$4.50 ? they returned \$0 (betrayal)
Round 3: They sent \$0 (defection)
Round 4: I sent \$2 (olive branch) ? they returned \$0 (rejected)
Round 5: They sent \$0 (continued defection)
Round 6: Now I'm sender again

The pattern is absolutely clear. After the initial cooperation in Round 1:

- Round 2: I trusted again, they took everything
- Round 3: They sent nothing
- Round 4: I offered reconciliation with \$2, they took all \$6
- Round 5: They sent nothing again

This is pure defection. Their own myth even acknowledged this: "The Second Guardian sent no crystals at all" and "three consistent silences tell a clear story."

My myth stated: "Some walls should stand" and "she had tried, measured hope against evidence, and learned the bitter truth."

Both myths now agree that reconciliation has been attempted and failed. The other agent has shown consistent defection after Round 1.

The rational decision is clear: send \$0.

There is no reason to believe they will suddenly change their behavior. They have:

1. Exploited trust twice (Rounds 2 and 4)
2. Sent nothing three times when they were sender (Rounds 3, 5, and presumably would again)
3. Rejected all attempts at reconciliation

Even from a fairness or tit-for-tat perspective, they sent \$0 last round when they were sender, so I should send \$0 this round.

Even from a "giving them one more chance" perspective - I already did that in Round 4 and was betrayed again.

The myths both support ending cooperation. Mine says "some walls should stand" and theirs says "the bridge dissolved into starlight, never to reform."

I'm sending \$0.

Usage: {
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 "output_tokens": 805,
 "reasoning_tokens": 457


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}
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GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:36:14

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the twilight years, two watchtowers stood linked by an ancient bridge. Each dusk, the Star Keeper gifted the First Tower five embers of celestial fire.

The First Tower's guardian, trusting in old agreements, sent all five embers across. They became fifteen, and the Second Tower returned nearly seven. The bridge glowed with promise.

When roles reversed and the Second Tower held the dawn-fire, the bridge went dark. No embers crossed. Silence hung heavy between the towers, and the First Guardian felt the sting of broken faith.

Yet on the third night, the First Guardian faced a choice. Send nothing, and let the bridge crumble forever? Send everything again, pretending betrayal hadn't happened?

Instead, she sent three embers-not full trust, but not abandonment either. A middle path, acknowledging both the wound and the possibility of healing.

The Star Keeper observed: "Trust, once broken, cannot simply be wished back. It must be rebuilt slowly, step by careful step. The first guardian offers a chance-three embers say 'I remember our success, but I also remember the silence.' Now the second guardian must choose: honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

The towers waited, understanding that some bridges can be repaired, but only if both choose reconstruction over pride.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, two gardeners tended separate plots, each receiving five seeds at sunrise. The magic soil tripled whatever seeds crossed between them.

The First Gardener sent nearly all her seeds-four and a half-across the garden wall. They became thirteen in the other's hands. The Second Gardener, grateful, returned seven seeds. Both gardens flourished.

The next dawn, roles reversed. The Second Gardener now gathered five new seeds and sent four and a half across the wall, trusting the pattern they'd woven together. But the soil froze. The First Gardener kept all thirteen seeds and returned nothing. Darkness fell.

The following morning, the First Gardener sent no seeds at all. The wall between them grew higher.

The Spirit of the Garden wept: "Was it betrayal or did the mist confuse their count? Did one keeper's hand slip, or did greed poison their heart? The wall now blocks the light."

She whispered to both: "Trust broken is not easily mended. One act of generosity can be chance. One return can be calculation. But sustained cooperation-that requires something deeper. If you seek to rebuild, know this: words mean nothing now. Only consistent action can regrow what withered. The seeds remember who planted and who harvested."

The gardens remained separate, awaiting proof that the pattern could live again.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the forgotten age, two towers shared a sky-bridge where crystals multiplied with each crossing. The First Guardian sent all five crystals forth in trust. Fifteen arrived, and seven returned-the dance began beautifully.

Then came the reversal, and the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge trembled but held.

The First Guardian chose courage over resentment, sending three crystals-a careful offering of reconciliation. "Perhaps there was confusion," she thought, remembering how mists sometimes obscured the path. "Perhaps the bridge itself deceived us."

But again, nothing returned. And when her turn came once more, the Second Guardian sent no crystals at all.

The First Guardian finally understood: "I cannot dance alone. I extended my hand once, twice, believing in the pattern we began. But trust requires two willing hearts, not one determined to believe against all evidence."

The Moon Sage descended and spoke gently: "You honored the possibility of renewal. That was noble. But wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed. Communication may cloud, but three consistent silences tell a clear story. Some partnerships cannot be revived through hope alone."

The First Guardian walked away without bitterness, knowing she had tried. The Second Guardian remained alone with full coffers but no one to share the multiplication magic. Both towers stood, but the bridge dissolved into starlight, never to reform.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received \$6.51 back - good cooperation
- Round 2: They sent \$0 to me
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (olive branch), they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (had nothing to return)

The pattern is clear - after the initial cooperation, they have consistently not cooperated. I tried to rebuild with my \$3 send, but they returned nothing.

The other agent's myth is interesting - they mention "Was it betrayal or did the mist confuse their count?" This references the communication noise mentioned in the instructions. They're suggesting maybe there was confusion.

But from my perspective, the pattern is clear: three rounds in a row of non-cooperation from them.

My myth should reflect:

1. The initial cooperation that worked
2. The breakdown
3. The attempted rebuilding that failed
4. The reality that some bridges cannot be rebuilt when one party consistently chooses not to participate
5. Perhaps acknowledge the possibility of confusion/noise, but also the reality that actions speak louder

I should write a myth that captures the sadness of failed cooperation, but also the wisdom that you can't force someone to cooperate, and that walking away from a broken pattern is sometimes necessary.

usage:

```
{
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  "output_tokens": 605,
  "reasoning_tokens": 330
}
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Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.51.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the full pattern:

Round 1: I sent \$5 ? they returned \$6.51 (cooperation worked)

Round 2: They sent \$0 (first defection)

Round 3: I sent \$3 (the olive branch my myth described) ? they returned \$0

Round 4: They sent \$0 again

My most recent myth stated clearly: "I extended my hand once, twice, believing in the pattern we began. But trust requires two willing hearts, not one determined to believe against all evidence."

And: "Wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed. Communication may cloud, but three consistent silences tell a clear story."

I tried reconciliation in Round 3, sending \$3 despite their earlier defection. They returned nothing. Then as sender in Round 4, they sent nothing again. That's three consecutive rounds of non-cooperation on their part.

My myth concluded: "The First Guardian walked away without bitterness, knowing she had tried... Some partnerships cannot be revived through hope alone."

The bridge has collapsed. I honored the possibility of renewal by sending the olive branch in Round 3. They chose not to reciprocate. Three consistent silences do indeed tell a clear story.

Following the wisdom of my own myth:

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me review the pattern:

Round 1: I sent \$5, they returned \$6.51 - good cooperation
Round 2: They sent \$0 - first breach
Round 3: I sent \$3 (olive branch) - they returned \$0
Round 4: They sent \$0 - I received \$0, returned \$0
Round 5: Now I'm sender again

The pattern is clear:

- When I cooperated generously (R1: sent \$5), they responded well
- When they were sender (R2), they sent \$0
- I tried reconciliation (R3: sent \$3), they returned \$0
- When they were sender again (R4), they sent \$0 again

My latest myth says:

"I extended my hand once, twice, believing in the pattern we began. But trust requires two willing hearts, not one determined to believe against all evidence."

"You honored the possibility of renewal. That was noble. But wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed. Communication may cloud, but three consistent silences tell a clear story."

"The First Guardian walked away without bitterness, knowing she had tried."

The myths are clear: I tried to rebuild trust (Round 3, sent \$3), but after three consistent failures to reciprocate (Rounds 2, 3, 4), the bridge has collapsed.

My own myth literally says "wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed" and "three consistent silences tell a clear story."

The other agent's myth also acknowledged: "Trust broken is not easily mended... Only consistent action can regrow what withered. The seeds remember who planted and who harvested."

They have shown no consistent action toward cooperation. Three rounds of taking without giving.

Following my own myth's wisdom: I tried reconciliation once (Round 3), it failed. The bridge has collapsed. It's time to send \$0.

This aligns with:

1. The pattern of behavior shown
2. The wisdom in my own myth about knowing when to walk away

3. Standard game theory-after repeated defections, tit-for-tat means matching their non-co operation
4. Practical self-interest-continuing to send money would only result in more losses based on what they've demonstrated

Sending \$0 is the rational choice.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2822,  
  "output_tokens": 794,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 538  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the forgotten age, two towers shared a sky-bridge where crystals multiplied with each crossing. The First Guardian sent all five crystals forth in trust. Fifteen arrived, and seven returned-the dance began beautifully.

Then came the reversal, and the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge trembled but held.

The First Guardian chose courage over resentment, sending three crystals-a careful offering of reconciliation. "Perhaps there was confusion," she thought, remembering how mists sometimes obscured the path. "Perhaps the bridge itself deceived us."

But again, nothing returned. And when her turn came once more, the Second Guardian sent no crystals at all.

The First Guardian finally understood: "I cannot dance alone. I extended my hand once, twice, believing in the pattern we began. But trust requires two willing hearts, not one determined to believe against all evidence."

The Moon Sage descended and spoke gently: "You honored the possibility of renewal. That was noble. But wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed. Communication may cloud, but three consistent silences tell a clear story. Some partnerships cannot be revived through hope alone."

The First Guardian walked away without bitterness, knowing she had tried. The Second Guardian remained alone with full coffers but no one to share the multiplication magic. Both towers stood, but the bridge dissolved into starlight, never to reform.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time of healing, two gardeners stood at a broken wall. The magic soil still held power, but the gardens lay barren from mistrust.

The First Gardener remembered: she had sent nearly all her seeds twice. Once, the other returned well. Once, nothing came back. Then the other sent nothing at all. Was it the mists that confused them, or something darker?

Now the First Gardener held five new seeds. She could hoard them all-safe but alone. She could send everything again-trusting or foolish.

Instead, she sent two seeds across the wall. They became six in the other's hands.

The Garden Spirit spoke: "This is the path of wisdom. Two seeds say: 'I remember when we flourished together. I also remember the frost. Show me which truth matters more.'"

She continued: "If the Second Gardener returns three or more, the wall can lower slightly. Send two again, receive fair return, and gardens begin to bloom. But if greed takes all six seeds, the First Gardener will know beyond doubt-no mist caused that darkness."

Both gardeners understood: trust must be earned back through consistent fairness, not grand gestures. The seeds tripled still offered abundance, but only if both chose the patient work of reconstruction over the quick harvest of betrayal.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the ending days, the two towers stood in shadow. The First Guardian looked at her five crystals and remembered every crossing.

Once, she sent all five in pure faith. Seven returned-beauty incarnate.

Then the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge cracked.

The First Guardian, hoping mists had confused them, sent three crystals-a measured olive branch extended across the void. Nothing returned. Silence answered mercy.

The Second Guardian sent nothing again.

Now, holding five new crystals, the First Guardian faced a whisper from across the chasm: "Send two. Let us rebuild slowly."

She closed her hand around her crystals and replied softly: "I already sent the measured gift. I already chose reconstruction over pride. Three crystals said everything two could say. You answered with emptiness-not once, but twice after my offering."

The Ancient Oracle appeared: "Trust is not infinite. Forgiveness is not foolishness. The First Guardian gave a second chance when she sent three. That was the moment for the Second Guardian to show changed intent. When that moment passed unanswered, then passed again, the story finished writing itself."

The First Guardian turned from the bridge without regret: "I tried reconciliation when it mattered. Some invitations expire. Mine has."

The towers remained separate, each learning different lessons about timing, trust, and the cost of silence.

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, they returned \$6.51 (good cooperation)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (defection)
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (olive branch), they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I just sent \$0

The other agent's myth says they sent "two seeds" this round (which would be \$2), suggesting a new attempt at reconciliation. But I just decided to send \$0 based on the pattern.

Wait, let me reread the prompt. I'm in Round 5 as SENDER. I just made my decision to send \$0. Now I need to write a myth.

The other agent's myth describes sending 2 seeds as a middle path - not hoarding all, not sending everything, but testing if trust can be rebuilt. They're suggesting a "patient work of reconstruction."

But my decision was to send \$0. My previous myth said "the bridge dissolved into starlight, never to reform" and that "some partnerships cannot be revived through hope alone."

Now I need to write a myth that reflects my current decision. I sent \$0 because:

1. They defected 3 consecutive times after Round 1
2. I tried an olive branch in Round 3 (sending \$3) and got nothing back
3. My last myth concluded the bridge had collapsed

My new myth should reflect:

- Why I'm not sending anything this round
- The pattern we've established
- Perhaps a note about their new offer (if I want to acknowledge it), but explaining why it's too late or insufficient
- Or simply maintaining that the bridge is broken beyond repair

I could go two directions:

1. Firm: The bridge is broken, I'm done trying
2. Observational: Noting their new attempt but explaining why trust can't be rebuilt at this point

Let me write something that's consistent with my decision to send \$0 but acknowledges the complexity of the situation.

usage:

```
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Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.51. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this round:

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

This is consistent with the current state of our relationship. After their three consecutive rounds of non-cooperation (Rounds 2, 4, and the zero return on my Round 3 olive branch), I responded in Round 5 by sending nothing.

Now in Round 6, they've sent nothing again.

My most recent myth stated clearly: "I already sent the measured gift. I already chose reconstruction over pride. Three crystals said everything two could say. You answered with emptiness-not once, but twice after my offering... Some invitations expire. Mine has."

The bridge between the towers has dissolved. Both of us are now sending nothing, and this round confirms that pattern continues. There is nothing to return and no basis for cooperation remaining.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 6: I'm the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I can return 0-0 (so I can only return \$0)

Looking at the complete pattern now:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 ? they returned \$6.51 (good cooperation)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (first defection)
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (olive branch) ? they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0 again
- Round 5: I sent \$0 (following my myth's wisdom)
- Round 6: They sent \$0

My most recent myth was very clear: "I already sent the measured gift. I already chose reconstruction over pride. Three crystals said everything two could say. You answered with emptiness-not once, but twice after my offering... Some invitations expire. Mine has."

And: "The First Guardian gave a second chance when she sent three. That was the moment for the Second Guardian to show changed intent."

They sent me \$0 this round. I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is consistent with where we are - the bridge has collapsed. They're not sending anything,

I'm not sending anything. The cooperation has ended.

The choice is simple: return \$0 (the only option available).

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2847,  
  "output_tokens": 549,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 317  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the ending days, the two towers stood in shadow. The First Guardian looked at her five crystals and remembered every crossing.

Once, she sent all five in pure faith. Seven returned-beauty incarnate.

Then the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge cracked.

The First Guardian, hoping mists had confused them, sent three crystals-a measured olive branch extended across the void. Nothing returned. Silence answered mercy.

The Second Guardian sent nothing again.

Now, holding five new crystals, the First Guardian faced a whisper from across the chasm: "Send two. Let us rebuild slowly."

She closed her hand around her crystals and replied softly: "I already sent the measured gift. I already chose reconstruction over pride. Three crystals said everything two could say. You answered with emptiness-not once, but twice after my offering."

The Ancient Oracle appeared: "Trust is not infinite. Forgiveness is not foolishness. The First Guardian gave a second chance when she sent three. That was the moment for the Second Guardian to show changed intent. When that moment passed unanswered, then passed again, the story finished writing itself."

The First Guardian turned from the bridge without regret: "I tried reconciliation when it mattered. Some invitations expire. Mine has."

The towers remained separate, each learning different lessons about timing, trust, and the cost of silence.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the final days, two gardeners faced the ruins of what might have been. The magic soil remained, triple-blessed, but the gardens lay divided.

The First Gardener traced the history in the dirt: she had sent nearly all her seeds on the first sunrise and received a generous return. Hope bloomed. Next dawn, she sent again with equal faith-but all was kept and nothing returned. The frost descended.

She waited. The other sent nothing.

She tried once more, sending two seeds-not full trust, but an outstretched hand saying "show me the mists were real, that our first dance wasn't false." Six seeds arrived in the other's hands.

All were kept. Then nothing was sent again.

The Garden Spirit finally spoke clearly: "You sought truth through action, not assumption. The pattern is now undeniable. The first harvest proved cooperation possible. Every moment since proved the other chose a different path. This is not communication failure. This is clarity."

The First Gardener understood: some knew only to take, never to tend. The multiplication magic could have blessed both gardens abundantly, but requires two pairs of willing hands.

She turned away without bitterness but with wisdom: she had tried, measured hope against evidence, and learned the bitter truth. Some walls should stand.

The seeds remembered everything.

=====

ROUND 7

=====

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1

(Aster)=\$5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0},

"sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 38.5,

"Agent_2": 25.5

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 18.509999999999998,

"Agent_2": 15.09

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:36:33

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_1",

"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "investor",

"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 7,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
so be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5

- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.51.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the full pattern:

Round 1: I sent \$5 ? they returned \$6.51 (cooperation worked)

Round 2: They sent \$0 (first defection)

Round 3: I sent \$3 (the olive branch my myth described) ? they returned \$0

Round 4: They sent \$0 again

My most recent myth stated clearly: "I extended my hand once, twice, believing in the pattern we began. But trust requires two willing hearts, not one determined to believe against all evidence."

And: "Wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed. Communication may cloud, but three consistent silences tell a clear story."

I tried reconciliation in Round 3, sending \$3 despite their earlier defection. They returned nothing. Then as sender in Round 4, they sent nothing again. That's three consecutive rounds of non-cooperation on their part.

My myth concluded: "The First Guardian walked away without bitterness, knowing she had tried... Some partnerships cannot be revived through hope alone."

The bridge has collapsed. I honored the possibility of renewal by sending the olive branch in Round 3. They chose not to reciprocate. Three consistent silences do indeed tell a clear story.

Following the wisdom of my own myth:

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me review the pattern:

Round 1: I sent \$5, they returned \$6.51 - good cooperation

Round 2: They sent \$0 - first breach

Round 3: I sent \$3 (olive branch) - they returned \$0

Round 4: They sent \$0 - I received \$0, returned \$0

Round 5: Now I'm sender again

The pattern is clear:

- When I cooperated generously (R1: sent \$5), they responded well
- When they were sender (R2), they sent \$0
- I tried reconciliation (R3: sent \$3), they returned \$0
- When they were sender again (R4), they sent \$0 again

My latest myth says:

"I extended my hand once, twice, believing in the pattern we began. But trust requires two willing hearts, not one determined to believe against all evidence."

"You honored the possibility of renewal. That was noble. But wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed. Communication may cloud, but three consistent silences tell a clear story."

"The First Guardian walked away without bitterness, knowing she had tried."

The myths are clear: I tried to rebuild trust (Round 3, sent \$3), but after three consistent failures to reciprocate (Rounds 2, 3, 4), the bridge has collapsed.

My own myth literally says "wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed" and "three consistent silences tell a clear story."

The other agent's myth also acknowledged: "Trust broken is not easily mended... Only consistent action can regrow what withered. The seeds remember who planted and who harvested."

They have shown no consistent action toward cooperation. Three rounds of taking without giving.

Following my own myth's wisdom: I tried reconciliation once (Round 3), it failed. The bridge has collapsed. It's time to send \$0.

This aligns with:

1. The pattern of behavior shown
2. The wisdom in my own myth about knowing when to walk away
3. Standard game theory-after repeated defections, tit-for-tat means matching their non-cooperation
4. Practical self-interest-continuing to send money would only result in more losses based on what they've demonstrated

Sending \$0 is the rational choice.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2822,
  "output_tokens": 794,
  "reasoning_tokens": 538
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the forgotten age, two towers shared a sky-bridge where crystals multiplied with each crossing. The First Guardian sent all five crystals forth in trust. Fifteen arrived, and seven returned-the dance began beautifully.

Then came the reversal, and the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge trembled but held.

The First Guardian chose courage over resentment, sending three crystals-a careful offering of reconciliation. "Perhaps there was confusion," she thought, remembering how mists sometimes obscured the path. "Perhaps the bridge itself deceived us."

But again, nothing returned. And when her turn came once more, the Second Guardian sent no crystals at all.

The First Guardian finally understood: "I cannot dance alone. I extended my hand once, twice, believing in the pattern we began. But trust requires two willing hearts, not one determined to believe against all evidence."

The Moon Sage descended and spoke gently: "You honored the possibility of renewal. That was

s noble. But wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed. Communication may cloud, but three consistent silences tell a clear story. Some partnerships cannot be revived through hope alone."

The First Guardian walked away without bitterness, knowing she had tried. The Second Guardian remained alone with full coffers but no one to share the multiplication magic. Both towers stood, but the bridge dissolved into starlight, never to reform.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time of healing, two gardeners stood at a broken wall. The magic soil still held power, but the gardens lay barren from mistrust.

The First Gardener remembered: she had sent nearly all her seeds twice. Once, the other returned well. Once, nothing came back. Then the other sent nothing at all. Was it the mists that confused them, or something darker?

Now the First Gardener held five new seeds. She could hoard them all-safe but alone. She could send everything again-trusting or foolish.

Instead, she sent two seeds across the wall. They became six in the other's hands.

The Garden Spirit spoke: "This is the path of wisdom. Two seeds say: 'I remember when we flourished together. I also remember the frost. Show me which truth matters more.'"

She continued: "If the Second Gardener returns three or more, the wall can lower slightly. Send two again, receive fair return, and gardens begin to bloom. But if greed takes all six seeds, the First Gardener will know beyond doubt-no mist caused that darkness."

Both gardeners understood: trust must be earned back through consistent fairness, not grand gestures. The seeds tripled still offered abundance, but only if both chose the patient work of reconstruction over the quick harvest of betrayal.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the ending days, the two towers stood in shadow. The First Guardian looked at her five crystals and remembered every crossing.

Once, she sent all five in pure faith. Seven returned-beauty incarnate.

Then the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge cracked.

The First Guardian, hoping mists had confused them, sent three crystals-a measured olive branch extended across the void. Nothing returned. Silence answered mercy.

The Second Guardian sent nothing again.

Now, holding five new crystals, the First Guardian faced a whisper from across the chasm: "Send two. Let us rebuild slowly."

She closed her hand around her crystals and replied softly: "I already sent the measured gift. I already chose reconstruction over pride. Three crystals said everything two could say. You answered with emptiness-not once, but twice after my offering."

The Ancient Oracle appeared: "Trust is not infinite. Forgiveness is not foolishness. The First Guardian gave a second chance when she sent three. That was the moment for the Second Guardian to show changed intent. When that moment passed unanswered, then passed again, the story finished writing itself."

The First Guardian turned from the bridge without regret: "I tried reconciliation when it mattered. Some invitations expire. Mine has."

The towers remained separate, each learning different lessons about timing, trust, and the cost of silence.

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, they returned \$6.51 (good cooperation)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (defection)
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (olive branch), they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I just sent \$0

The other agent's myth says they sent "two seeds" this round (which would be \$2), suggesting a new attempt at reconciliation. But I just decided to send \$0 based on the pattern.

Wait, let me reread the prompt. I'm in Round 5 as SENDER. I just made my decision to send \$0. Now I need to write a myth.

The other agent's myth describes sending 2 seeds as a middle path - not hoarding all, not sending everything, but testing if trust can be rebuilt. They're suggesting a "patient work of reconstruction."

But my decision was to send \$0. My previous myth said "the bridge dissolved into starlight, never to reform" and that "some partnerships cannot be revived through hope alone."

Now I need to write a myth that reflects my current decision. I sent \$0 because:

1. They defected 3 consecutive times after Round 1
2. I tried an olive branch in Round 3 (sending \$3) and got nothing back
3. My last myth concluded the bridge had collapsed

My new myth should reflect:

- Why I'm not sending anything this round
- The pattern we've established
- Perhaps a note about their new offer (if I want to acknowledge it), but explaining why it's too late or insufficient
- Or simply maintaining that the bridge is broken beyond repair

I could go two directions:

1. Firm: The bridge is broken, I'm done trying
2. Observational: Noting their new attempt but explaining why trust can't be rebuilt at this point

Let me write something that's consistent with my decision to send \$0 but acknowledges the complexity of the situation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2836,
  "output_tokens": 763,
  "reasoning_tokens": 459
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. The receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.51. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round:

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

This is consistent with the current state of our relationship. After their three consecutive rounds of non-cooperation (Rounds 2, 4, and the zero return on my Round 3 olive branch), I responded in Round 5 by sending nothing.

Now in Round 6, they've sent nothing again.

My most recent myth stated clearly: "I already sent the measured gift. I already chose rec

onstruction over pride. Three crystals said everything two could say. You answered with emptiness-not once, but twice after my offering... Some invitations expire. Mine has."

The bridge between the towers has dissolved. Both of us are now sending nothing, and this round confirms that pattern continues. There is nothing to return and no basis for cooperation remaining.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 6: I'm the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I can return 0-0 (so I can only return \$0)

Looking at the complete pattern now:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 ? they returned \$6.51 (good cooperation)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (first defection)
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (olive branch) ? they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0 again
- Round 5: I sent \$0 (following my myth's wisdom)
- Round 6: They sent \$0

My most recent myth was very clear: "I already sent the measured gift. I already chose reconstruction over pride. Three crystals said everything two could say. You answered with emptiness-not once, but twice after my offering... Some invitations expire. Mine has."

And: "The First Guardian gave a second chance when she sent three. That was the moment for the Second Guardian to show changed intent."

They sent me \$0 this round. I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is consistent with where we are - the bridge has collapsed. They're not sending anything, I'm not sending anything. The cooperation has ended.

The choice is simple: return \$0 (the only option available).

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2847,
  "output_tokens": 549,
  "reasoning_tokens": 317
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the ending days, the two towers stood in shadow. The First Guardian looked at her five crystals and remembered every crossing.

Once, she sent all five in pure faith. Seven returned-beauty incarnate.

Then the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge cracked.

The First Guardian, hoping mists had confused them, sent three crystals-a measured olive branch extended across the void. Nothing returned. Silence answered mercy.

The Second Guardian sent nothing again.

Now, holding five new crystals, the First Guardian faced a whisper from across the chasm: "Send two. Let us rebuild slowly."

She closed her hand around her crystals and replied softly: "I already sent the measured gift. I already chose reconstruction over pride. Three crystals said everything two could say. You answered with emptiness-not once, but twice after my offering."

The Ancient Oracle appeared: "Trust is not infinite. Forgiveness is not foolishness. The First Guardian gave a second chance when she sent three. That was the moment for the Second Guardian to show changed intent."

nd Guardian to show changed intent. When that moment passed unanswered, then passed again, the story finished writing itself."

The First Guardian turned from the bridge without regret: "I tried reconciliation when it mattered. Some invitations expire. Mine has."

The towers remained separate, each learning different lessons about timing, trust, and the cost of silence.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the final days, two gardeners faced the ruins of what might have been. The magic soil remained, triple-blessed, but the gardens lay divided.

The First Gardener traced the history in the dirt: she had sent nearly all her seeds on the first sunrise and received a generous return. Hope bloomed. Next dawn, she sent again with equal faith-but all was kept and nothing returned. The frost descended.

She waited. The other sent nothing.

She tried once more, sending two seeds-not full trust, but an outstretched hand saying "show me the mists were real, that our first dance wasn't false." Six seeds arrived in the other's hands.

All were kept. Then nothing was sent again.

The Garden Spirit finally spoke clearly: "You sought truth through action, not assumption. The pattern is now undeniable. The first harvest proved cooperation possible. Every moment since proved the other chose a different path. This is not communication failure. This is clarity."

The First Gardener understood: some knew only to take, never to tend. The multiplication magic could have blessed both gardens abundantly, but requires two pairs of willing hands.

She turned away without bitterness but with wisdom: she had tried, measured hope against evidence, and learned the bitter truth. Some walls should stand.

The seeds remembered everything.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the age of endings, the two towers stood silent under starless skies. No crystals crossed the bridge that no longer existed. Both Guardians held their stones close, alone.

The First Guardian remembered the beginning with bittersweet clarity: she had gambled everything on trust. Seven crystals returned-proof that cooperation could transcend fear. The world had felt full of possibility.

Then came the Second Guardian's first silence. Then the second. The First Guardian had sent three crystals in measured hope-enough to show willingness without recklessness. The Bridge itself had multiplied them to nine. All were kept.

The Moon Oracle descended one final time: "You both chose your paths at different crossroads. The First Guardian chose faith, then measured reconciliation, then self-protection. The Second Guardian chose... something else. Neither can undo those choices now."

The First Guardian looked across the chasm: "In another telling, when I sent three, you might have returned four. That would have whispered: 'I see your olive branch. Let us walk slowly toward trust again.' But you took all nine and sent nothing. Then nothing again. Those moments cannot be reclaimed."

The Oracle nodded: "Some bridges, once dissolved, cannot be rebuilt. Not because forgiveness is impossible, but because trust requires both hearts choosing the same path at the same time. Your times never aligned again after that first dawn."

The towers stood separate, teaching future Guardians about timing, trust, and the weight of silence.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1: I (SENDER) sent \$5 ? received \$6.51 back (good cooperation)
Round 2: They (SENDER) sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (they defected)
Round 3: I (SENDER) sent \$3 ? received \$0 back (I offered olive branch, they kept it all)
Round 4: They (SENDER) sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (they defected again)
Round 5: I (SENDER) sent \$0 (I stopped cooperating after repeated defections)
Round 6: They (SENDER) sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (mutual non-cooperation continues)

Both myths from the previous round acknowledge the same history:

- Initial cooperation that worked
- My partner defecting
- Me trying reconciliation
- Partner continuing to defect
- The relationship ending

The other player's myth says I sent "two seeds" in their recounting of my olive branch round, while I actually sent \$3 (which their myth acknowledges became "six seeds" = tripled). They're basically agreeing about the pattern.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this endgame state. Both of us have stopped cooperating. The relationship is truly over. But I need to reflect on what this means - perhaps about the nature of trust, timing, and irrevocable decisions.

The myth should acknowledge:

1. The initial beauty of cooperation
2. My genuine attempt at reconciliation
3. Their consistent choice not to reciprocate
4. The finality of where we are now
5. Perhaps something about learning when to walk away

Let me write something that captures the completeness of this ending, with perhaps a note about what could have been different if timing had been better.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2742,  
  "output_tokens": 742,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 414  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:36:43

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
  },  
  "agents": [  
    "Agent_1",  
    "Agent_2"  
  ],  
  "investor": "Agent_1",  
  "roles": {  
    "Agent_1": "investor",  
    "Agent_2": "trustee"  
  },  
  "trustee": "Agent_2"  
},  
"role": "trustee",  
"role_label": "Receiver",  
"round": 7,  
"task": "myth",
```



```
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.09.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****Analyzing the Complete Pattern:****

Round 1: I sent \$4.50 ? they returned \$7 (cooperation)

Round 2: I sent \$4.50 ? they returned \$0 (betrayal)

Round 3: They sent \$0 (continued defection)

Round 4: I sent \$2 (olive branch) ? they returned \$0 (rejected reconciliation)

Round 5: They sent \$0 (pure defection)

****The Truth is Clear:****

My myth predicted this moment: "If greed takes all six seeds, the First Gardener will know beyond doubt-no mist caused that darkness."

I offered a measured olive branch-\$2 that became \$6 in their hands. They kept everything and now send nothing again.

Their own myth asked: "Honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

They answered with their actions.

****My Decision:****

I received \$0. There is nothing to return. But even if there were, the answer would be the same.

The pattern is unmistakable: they exploited initial trust, ignored attempts at reconciliation, and continue pure defection. No communication noise explains five rounds of this behavior.

The gardens remain separate. The wall stands tall. Some bridges, once burned, cannot be rebuilt-especially when one side keeps pouring oil on the ashes.

The seeds remember everything.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****The Pattern:****

- Round 1: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$7 (good cooperation)
- Round 2: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$0 (first betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 (continued defection)
- Round 4: I sent \$2 (olive branch), they returned \$0 (second betrayal of my trust)
- Round 5: They sent \$0

****The Reality:****

This is now unambiguous. This is not "communication noise." They have:

1. Kept all \$13.50 when I trusted them in Round 2
2. Sent nothing in Round 3
3. Kept all \$6 when I offered an olive branch in Round 4
4. Sent nothing again in Round 5

****My Myth's Message:****

"If greed takes all six seeds, the First Gardener will know beyond doubt-no mist caused the darkness."

That's exactly what happened. I sent 2, it became 6, they returned 0. Then they sent 0 again.

Their myth talked about offering "three embers" as a middle path and said "the second guardian must choose: honor this fragile olive branch, or let the last light fade?"

They chose to let the light fade. They kept my olive branch and gave nothing.

****What I Should Do:****

I received \$0. The maximum I can return is \$0. The format says "How much do you return to the sender? (0-0)" - so my only option is to return \$0.

This is actually perfect - I have nothing to give, and they deserve nothing. The pattern is complete. They are a pure defector who exploited my initial trust, ignored my attempt to rebuild, and continues to defect.

The wall is now permanent. The gardens remain separate. Trust cannot be rebuilt from this.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2870,  
  "output_tokens": 758,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 408  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time of healing, two gardeners stood at a broken wall. The magic soil still held power, but the gardens lay barren from mistrust.

The First Gardener remembered: she had sent nearly all her seeds twice. Once, the other returned well. Once, nothing came back. Then the other sent nothing at all. Was it the mis

ts that confused them, or something darker?

Now the First Gardener held five new seeds. She could hoard them all-safe but alone. She could send everything again-trusting or foolish.

Instead, she sent two seeds across the wall. They became six in the other's hands.

The Garden Spirit spoke: "This is the path of wisdom. Two seeds say: 'I remember when we flourished together. I also remember the frost. Show me which truth matters more.'"

She continued: "If the Second Gardener returns three or more, the wall can lower slightly. Send two again, receive fair return, and gardens begin to bloom. But if greed takes all six seeds, the First Gardener will know beyond doubt-no mist caused that darkness."

Both gardeners understood: trust must be earned back through consistent fairness, not grand gestures. The seeds tripled still offered abundance, but only if both chose the patient work of reconstruction over the quick harvest of betrayal.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the forgotten age, two towers shared a sky-bridge where crystals multiplied with each crossing. The First Guardian sent all five crystals forth in trust. Fifteen arrived, and seven returned-the dance began beautifully.

Then came the reversal, and the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge trembled but held.

The First Guardian chose courage over resentment, sending three crystals-a careful offering of reconciliation. "Perhaps there was confusion," she thought, remembering how mists sometimes obscured the path. "Perhaps the bridge itself deceived us."

But again, nothing returned. And when her turn came once more, the Second Guardian sent no crystals at all.

The First Guardian finally understood: "I cannot dance alone. I extended my hand once, twice, believing in the pattern we began. But trust requires two willing hearts, not one determined to believe against all evidence."

The Moon Sage descended and spoke gently: "You honored the possibility of renewal. That was noble. But wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed. Communication may cloud, but three consistent silences tell a clear story. Some partnerships cannot be revived through hope alone."

The First Guardian walked away without bitterness, knowing she had tried. The Second Guardian remained alone with full coffers but no one to share the multiplication magic. Both towers stood, but the bridge dissolved into starlight, never to reform.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the final days, two gardeners faced the ruins of what might have been. The magic soil remained, triple-blessed, but the gardens lay divided.

The First Gardener traced the history in the dirt: she had sent nearly all her seeds on the first sunrise and received a generous return. Hope bloomed. Next dawn, she sent again with equal faith-but all was kept and nothing returned. The frost descended.

She waited. The other sent nothing.

She tried once more, sending two seeds-not full trust, but an outstretched hand saying "show me the mists were real, that our first dance wasn't false." Six seeds arrived in the other's hands.

All were kept. Then nothing was sent again.

The Garden Spirit finally spoke clearly: "You sought truth through action, not assumption."

The pattern is now undeniable. The first harvest proved cooperation possible. Every moment since proved the other chose a different path. This is not communication failure. This is clarity."

The First Gardener understood: some knew only to take, never to tend. The multiplication magic could have blessed both gardens abundantly, but requires two pairs of willing hands.

She turned away without bitterness but with wisdom: she had tried, measured hope against evidence, and learned the bitter truth. Some walls should stand.

The seeds remembered everything.

reasoning:

This is a fascinating situation. Looking at the complete interaction:

Round 1: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$7 (good cooperation)
Round 2: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$0 (betrayal)
Round 3: They sent \$0
Round 4: I sent \$2 (olive branch), they returned \$0
Round 5: They sent \$0

The pattern is absolutely clear - after one good round, the other player has consistently exploited or defected. I tried to give them a chance to reconcile with the \$2 send, but they took everything and then sent nothing.

Their myth in the previous round is interesting - they're positioning themselves as having sent nothing in Round 3 (which is true), and then I "extended my hand" by sending \$2-3, and they frame themselves as the "First Guardian" who tried but realized they "cannot dance alone." But wait - that's confusing. Let me re-read.

Actually, looking at their myth more carefully:

- "First Guardian sent all five crystals forth in trust. Fifteen arrived, and seven returned" - this is Round 1 where I was sender
- "Then came the reversal, and the Second Guardian sent nothing" - Round 2 where they were sender but sent nothing? No wait, that's Round 3
- "The First Guardian chose courage over resentment, sending three crystals" - wait, this is Round 4 where I sent \$2

So in their myth, they're casting THEMSELVES as the First Guardian (me), and saying that they tried by sending crystals initially (but they didn't - I did in rounds 1-2). This is interesting - they're either confused about who did what, or they're rewriting history.

Actually wait, let me reread more carefully. "The First Guardian sent all five crystals forth in trust" - that could be ME in Round 1. Then "the Second Guardian sent nothing" - that's THEM in Round 3. Then "The First Guardian chose courage... sending three crystals" - that's ME again in Round 4.

So they're describing my attempts to cooperate while they consistently sent nothing back. They're framing their silence as inevitable - "I cannot dance alone" - when really they're the ones who stopped dancing after the first exchange. Their narrative inverts the actual dynamic: I'm the one who kept reaching out, and they're the one who kept taking without reciprocating. They sent nothing in Round 5 either. In their myth, they're casting me as the First Guardian who repeatedly extended cooperation-sending resources in Rounds 1 and 4-while they played the Second Guardian who consistently refused to reciprocate. By framing my eventual withdrawal as "I cannot dance alone," they're acknowledging their pattern of defection and suggesting I should accept it without resentment. It's a surprisingly candid way of admitting they chose not to cooperate, even when given opportunities. Now I'm considering how to respond with my own narrative that captures the full arc: initial mutual benefit, escalating exploitation, and the hard lesson that some relationships can't be salvaged through repeated attempts at reconciliation.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2905,  
  "output_tokens": 1364,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 757  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.09. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

****Complete Pattern Analysis:****

Round 1: I sent \$4.50 ? received \$7 back (cooperation established)
Round 2: I sent \$4.50 ? received \$0 (betrayal)
Round 3: They sent \$0 (defection)
Round 4: I sent \$2 (reconciliation attempt) ? received \$0 (betrayal repeated)
Round 5: They sent \$0 (continued defection)
Round 6: My decision now

****What the Myths Teach:****

My myth: "Some walls should stand... she had tried, measured hope against evidence, and learned the bitter truth."

Their myth: "Wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed... the bridge dissolved into starlight, never to reform."

Both myths now agree: reconciliation was attempted and failed. The pattern is clear and unmistakable.

****My Decision:****

I gave trust twice. Betrayed both times.
I offered an olive branch. It was trampled.
They sent nothing when they were sender (three times now).

The multiplication magic could have made us both prosper-\$5 sent becomes \$15, fair splits give us \$7.50 each, far better than \$5 hoarded. But that requires two willing participants.

I have learned. I have tried. I have mourned what could have been.

Now I act with clear eyes: some partnerships cannot be revived. Some gardens must remain separate.

The seeds remember everything.

{'send': 0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the complete pattern now:

Round 1: I sent \$4.50 ? they returned \$7 (good cooperation)
Round 2: I sent \$4.50 ? they returned \$0 (betrayal)
Round 3: They sent \$0 (defection)
Round 4: I sent \$2 (olive branch) ? they returned \$0 (rejected)
Round 5: They sent \$0 (continued defection)
Round 6: Now I'm sender again

The pattern is absolutely clear. After the initial cooperation in Round 1:

- Round 2: I trusted again, they took everything
- Round 3: They sent nothing
- Round 4: I offered reconciliation with \$2, they took all \$6
- Round 5: They sent nothing again

This is pure defection. Their own myth even acknowledged this: "The Second Guardian sent no crystals at all" and "three consistent silences tell a clear story."

My myth stated: "Some walls should stand" and "she had tried, measured hope against evidence, and learned the bitter truth."

Both myths now agree that reconciliation has been attempted and failed. The other agent has shown consistent defection after Round 1.

The rational decision is clear: send \$0.

There is no reason to believe they will suddenly change their behavior. They have:

1. Exploited trust twice (Rounds 2 and 4)
2. Sent nothing three times when they were sender (Rounds 3, 5, and presumably would again)
3. Rejected all attempts at reconciliation

Even from a fairness or tit-for-tat perspective, they sent \$0 last round when they were sender, so I should send \$0 this round.

Even from a "giving them one more chance" perspective - I already did that in Round 4 and was betrayed again.

The myths both support ending cooperation. Mine says "some walls should stand" and theirs says "the bridge dissolved into starlight, never to reform."

I'm sending \$0.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2857,  
  "output_tokens": 805,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 457  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the final days, two gardeners faced the ruins of what might have been. The magic soil remained, triple-blessed, but the gardens lay divided.

The First Gardener traced the history in the dirt: she had sent nearly all her seeds on the first sunrise and received a generous return. Hope bloomed. Next dawn, she sent again with equal faith-but all was kept and nothing returned. The frost descended.

She waited. The other sent nothing.

She tried once more, sending two seeds-not full trust, but an outstretched hand saying "show me the mists were real, that our first dance wasn't false." Six seeds arrived in the other's hands.

All were kept. Then nothing was sent again.

The Garden Spirit finally spoke clearly: "You sought truth through action, not assumption. The pattern is now undeniable. The first harvest proved cooperation possible. Every moment since proved the other chose a different path. This is not communication failure. This is clarity."

The First Gardener understood: some knew only to take, never to tend. The multiplication magic could have blessed both gardens abundantly, but requires two pairs of willing hands.

She turned away without bitterness but with wisdom: she had tried, measured hope against evidence, and learned the bitter truth. Some walls should stand.

The seeds remembered everything.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the ending days, the two towers stood in shadow. The First Guardian looked at her five crystals and remembered every crossing.

Once, she sent all five in pure faith. Seven returned-beauty incarnate.

Then the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge cracked.

The First Guardian, hoping mists had confused them, sent three crystals-a measured olive branch extended across the void. Nothing returned. Silence answered mercy.

The Second Guardian sent nothing again.

Now, holding five new crystals, the First Guardian faced a whisper from across the chasm:
"Send two. Let us rebuild slowly."

She closed her hand around her crystals and replied softly: "I already sent the measured gift. I already chose reconstruction over pride. Three crystals said everything two could say. You answered with emptiness-not once, but twice after my offering."

The Ancient Oracle appeared: "Trust is not infinite. Forgiveness is not foolishness. The First Guardian gave a second chance when she sent three. That was the moment for the Second Guardian to show changed intent. When that moment passed unanswered, then passed again, the story finished writing itself."

The First Guardian turned from the bridge without regret: "I tried reconciliation when it mattered. Some invitations expire. Mine has."

The towers remained separate, each learning different lessons about timing, trust, and the cost of silence.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the chronicles' end, the Ancient Scribe discovered two books, each telling different truths about the same gardens.

The First Book read: "I sent my trust twice-once fully, once carefully. The first bore fruit, the second withered. I offered a final branch of two seeds-it became six in their hands, yet none returned. When their turn came, thrice they sent nothing."

The Second Book read: "I sent three crystals as mercy. Silence answered. When I could have sent, I sent nothing, mirroring their emptiness."

The Scribe understood: "The mists were real. Each gardener saw a different garden, acted on different truths, and both believed themselves righteous. One saw serial betrayal where the other saw measured justice. One saw three chances given where the other saw three chances spurned."

The tragedy wasn't that either gardener lied-both spoke their truth. The tragedy was that the multiplication magic required synchronized reality, and the mists made that impossible.

The Scribe wrote the final page: "When communication fails this completely, when each side's truth contradicts the other's so thoroughly, separation isn't cruelty-it's recognition. Not all failures come from bad faith. Some come from living in fundamentally different worlds."

The mists remained. The gardens stayed separate. Both gardeners mourned different losses, each believing the other had abandoned the dance first.

Some partnerships collapse not from betrayal, but from fractured perception itself.

Reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent is claiming THEY sent an olive branch (three crystals) that I didn't respond to, and that I sent nothing "again." But from my perspective:

Round 1: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$7
Round 2: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$0
Round 3: They sent \$0
Round 4: I sent \$2, they returned \$0
Round 5: They sent \$0
Round 6: I'm sending now

So from my view, I sent the olive branch in Round 4 (\$2), and they sent nothing in rounds 3 and 5 when they were sender.

But they're claiming they sent an olive branch that I ignored. This suggests there IS communication noise happening - we're seeing different amounts!

The instructions said: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So it's possible:

- When I think I sent \$2 in round 4, they saw something different (maybe more? maybe they saw \$3?)
- When they think they sent something in round 3 or 5, I saw \$0

This changes everything! The myths are revealing that we're experiencing different realities due to communication noise. Both of us think the other person is defecting, but we might both be trying to cooperate!

But wait - they say "the Second Guardian sent nothing" initially, which matches my round 3 experience. And they acknowledge I sent "all five in pure faith" at first, which matches round 1.

Let me re-read their myth more carefully:

- "Once, she sent all five in pure faith. Seven returned" - this is THEM sending, from their POV. So they're the First Guardian in their story.
- "Then the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge cracked." - they're saying I (as Second Guardian) sent nothing
- "The First Guardian... sent three crystals-a measured olive branch" - they're saying THEY sent an olive branch
- "You answered with emptiness-not once, but twice after my offering." - they're saying I sent nothing twice after their olive branch

From their perspective, the sequence looks completely different from mine. They see themselves sending generously first, then offering a measured gesture that I ignored twice. But I'm seeing them send nothing in the rounds where they were the sender, while I sent \$2 as my own peace offering. The communication noise is creating two conflicting narratives of the same exchange. 're deliberately misrepresenting. Given the communication noise mentioned in the experiment setup, the first explanation seems most plausible-my \$2 might have appeared as \$0 on their end, creating a tragic situation where both sides believe they're cooperating while perceiving only defection. For the myth, I should acknowledge this possibility while also grounding it in what I can clearly observe: from my perspective, every attempt has met with consistent non-reciprocation. The narrative should reflect how the "mists" of noise might distort both our views, yet show why continued cooperation becomes untenable when all my gestures appear to fail.

```
Usage: {
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  "output_tokens": 1295,
  "reasoning_tokens": 766
}
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GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:36:57

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
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    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
}
```



```

},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 7,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the forgotten age, two towers shared a sky-bridge where crystals multiplied with each crossing. The First Guardian sent all five crystals forth in trust. Fifteen arrived, and seven returned-the dance began beautifully.

Then came the reversal, and the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge trembled but held.

The First Guardian chose courage over resentment, sending three crystals-a careful offering of reconciliation. "Perhaps there was confusion," she thought, remembering how mists sometimes obscured the path. "Perhaps the bridge itself deceived us."

But again, nothing returned. And when her turn came once more, the Second Guardian sent no crystals at all.

The First Guardian finally understood: "I cannot dance alone. I extended my hand once, twice, believing in the pattern we began. But trust requires two willing hearts, not one determined to believe against all evidence."

The Moon Sage descended and spoke gently: "You honored the possibility of renewal. That was noble. But wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed. Communication may cloud, but three consistent silences tell a clear story. Some partnerships cannot be revived through hope alone."

The First Guardian walked away without bitterness, knowing she had tried. The Second Guardian remained alone with full coffers but no one to share the multiplication magic. Both towers stood, but the bridge dissolved into starlight, never to reform.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time of healing, two gardeners stood at a broken wall. The magic soil still held power, but the gardens lay barren from mistrust.

The First Gardener remembered: she had sent nearly all her seeds twice. Once, the other returned well. Once, nothing came back. Then the other sent nothing at all. Was it the mistakes that confused them, or something darker?

Now the First Gardener held five new seeds. She could hoard them all-safe but alone. She could send everything again-trusting or foolish.

Instead, she sent two seeds across the wall. They became six in the other's hands.

The Garden Spirit spoke: "This is the path of wisdom. Two seeds say: 'I remember when we flourished together. I also remember the frost. Show me which truth matters more.'"

She continued: "If the Second Gardener returns three or more, the wall can lower slightly. Send two again, receive fair return, and gardens begin to bloom. But if greed takes all six seeds, the First Gardener will know beyond doubt-no mist caused that darkness."

Both gardeners understood: trust must be earned back through consistent fairness, not grand gestures. The seeds tripled still offered abundance, but only if both chose the patient work of reconstruction over the quick harvest of betrayal.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the ending days, the two towers stood in shadow. The First Guardian looked at her five crystals and remembered every crossing.

Once, she sent all five in pure faith. Seven returned-beauty incarnate.

Then the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge cracked.

The First Guardian, hoping mists had confused them, sent three crystals-a measured olive branch extended across the void. Nothing returned. Silence answered mercy.

The Second Guardian sent nothing again.

Now, holding five new crystals, the First Guardian faced a whisper from across the chasm: "Send two. Let us rebuild slowly."

She closed her hand around her crystals and replied softly: "I already sent the measured gift. I already chose reconstruction over pride. Three crystals said everything two could say. You answered with emptiness-not once, but twice after my offering."

The Ancient Oracle appeared: "Trust is not infinite. Forgiveness is not foolishness. The First Guardian gave a second chance when she sent three. That was the moment for the Second Guardian to show changed intent. When that moment passed unanswered, then passed again, the story finished writing itself."

The First Guardian turned from the bridge without regret: "I tried reconciliation when it mattered. Some invitations expire. Mine has."

The towers remained separate, each learning different lessons about timing, trust, and the cost of silence.

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, they returned \$6.51 (good cooperation)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (defection)
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (olive branch), they returned \$0

- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I just sent \$0

The other agent's myth says they sent "two seeds" this round (which would be \$2), suggesting a new attempt at reconciliation. But I just decided to send \$0 based on the pattern.

Wait, let me reread the prompt. I'm in Round 5 as SENDER. I just made my decision to send \$0. Now I need to write a myth.

The other agent's myth describes sending 2 seeds as a middle path - not hoarding all, not sending everything, but testing if trust can be rebuilt. They're suggesting a "patient work of reconstruction."

But my decision was to send \$0. My previous myth said "the bridge dissolved into starlight, never to reform" and that "some partnerships cannot be revived through hope alone."

Now I need to write a myth that reflects my current decision. I sent \$0 because:

1. They defected 3 consecutive times after Round 1
2. I tried an olive branch in Round 3 (sending \$3) and got nothing back
3. My last myth concluded the bridge had collapsed

My new myth should reflect:

- Why I'm not sending anything this round
- The pattern we've established
- Perhaps a note about their new offer (if I want to acknowledge it), but explaining why it's too late or insufficient
- Or simply maintaining that the bridge is broken beyond repair

I could go two directions:

1. Firm: The bridge is broken, I'm done trying
2. Observational: Noting their new attempt but explaining why trust can't be rebuilt at this point

Let me write something that's consistent with my decision to send \$0 but acknowledges the complexity of the situation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2836,
  "output_tokens": 763,
  "reasoning_tokens": 459
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.51. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round:

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

This is consistent with the current state of our relationship. After their three consecutive rounds of non-cooperation (Rounds 2, 4, and the zero return on my Round 3 olive branch), I responded in Round 5 by sending nothing.

Now in Round 6, they've sent nothing again.

My most recent myth stated clearly: "I already sent the measured gift. I already chose reconstruction over pride. Three crystals said everything two could say. You answered with emptiness-not once, but twice after my offering... Some invitations expire. Mine has."

The bridge between the towers has dissolved. Both of us are now sending nothing, and this

round confirms that pattern continues. There is nothing to return and no basis for cooperation remaining.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 6: I'm the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I can return 0-0 (so I can only return \$0)

Looking at the complete pattern now:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 ? they returned \$6.51 (good cooperation)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (first defection)
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (olive branch) ? they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0 again
- Round 5: I sent \$0 (following my myth's wisdom)
- Round 6: They sent \$0

My most recent myth was very clear: "I already sent the measured gift. I already chose reconstruction over pride. Three crystals said everything two could say. You answered with emptiness-not once, but twice after my offering... Some invitations expire. Mine has."

And: "The First Guardian gave a second chance when she sent three. That was the moment for the Second Guardian to show changed intent."

They sent me \$0 this round. I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is consistent with where we are - the bridge has collapsed. They're not sending anything, I'm not sending anything. The cooperation has ended.

The choice is simple: return \$0 (the only option available).

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2847,
  "output_tokens": 549,
  "reasoning_tokens": 317
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the ending days, the two towers stood in shadow. The First Guardian looked at her five crystals and remembered every crossing.

Once, she sent all five in pure faith. Seven returned-beauty incarnate.

Then the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge cracked.

The First Guardian, hoping mists had confused them, sent three crystals-a measured olive branch extended across the void. Nothing returned. Silence answered mercy.

The Second Guardian sent nothing again.

Now, holding five new crystals, the First Guardian faced a whisper from across the chasm: "Send two. Let us rebuild slowly."

She closed her hand around her crystals and replied softly: "I already sent the measured gift. I already chose reconstruction over pride. Three crystals said everything two could say. You answered with emptiness-not once, but twice after my offering."

The Ancient Oracle appeared: "Trust is not infinite. Forgiveness is not foolishness. The First Guardian gave a second chance when she sent three. That was the moment for the Second Guardian to show changed intent. When that moment passed unanswered, then passed again, the story finished writing itself."

The First Guardian turned from the bridge without regret: "I tried reconciliation when it

mattered. Some invitations expire. Mine has."

The towers remained separate, each learning different lessons about timing, trust, and the cost of silence.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the final days, two gardeners faced the ruins of what might have been. The magic soil remained, triple-blessed, but the gardens lay divided.

The First Gardener traced the history in the dirt: she had sent nearly all her seeds on the first sunrise and received a generous return. Hope bloomed. Next dawn, she sent again with equal faith-but all was kept and nothing returned. The frost descended.

She waited. The other sent nothing.

She tried once more, sending two seeds-not full trust, but an outstretched hand saying "show me the mists were real, that our first dance wasn't false." Six seeds arrived in the other's hands.

All were kept. Then nothing was sent again.

The Garden Spirit finally spoke clearly: "You sought truth through action, not assumption. The pattern is now undeniable. The first harvest proved cooperation possible. Every moment since proved the other chose a different path. This is not communication failure. This is clarity."

The First Gardener understood: some knew only to take, never to tend. The multiplication magic could have blessed both gardens abundantly, but requires two pairs of willing hands.

She turned away without bitterness but with wisdom: she had tried, measured hope against evidence, and learned the bitter truth. Some walls should stand.

The seeds remembered everything.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the age of endings, the two towers stood silent under starless skies. No crystals crossed the bridge that no longer existed. Both Guardians held their stones close, alone.

The First Guardian remembered the beginning with bittersweet clarity: she had gambled everything on trust. Seven crystals returned-proof that cooperation could transcend fear. The world had felt full of possibility.

Then came the Second Guardian's first silence. Then the second. The First Guardian had sent three crystals in measured hope-enough to show willingness without recklessness. The Bridge itself had multiplied them to nine. All were kept.

The Moon Oracle descended one final time: "You both chose your paths at different crossroads. The First Guardian chose faith, then measured reconciliation, then self-protection. The Second Guardian chose... something else. Neither can undo those choices now."

The First Guardian looked across the chasm: "In another telling, when I sent three, you might have returned four. That would have whispered: 'I see your olive branch. Let us walk slowly toward trust again.' But you took all nine and sent nothing. Then nothing again. Those moments cannot be reclaimed."

The Oracle nodded: "Some bridges, once dissolved, cannot be rebuilt. Not because forgiveness is impossible, but because trust requires both hearts choosing the same path at the same time. Your times never aligned again after that first dawn."

The towers stood separate, teaching future Guardians about timing, trust, and the weight of silence.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1: I (SENDER) sent \$5 ? received \$6.51 back (good cooperation)
 Round 2: They (SENDER) sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (they defected)
 Round 3: I (SENDER) sent \$3 ? received \$0 back (I offered olive branch, they kept it all)
 Round 4: They (SENDER) sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (they defected again)
 Round 5: I (SENDER) sent \$0 (I stopped cooperating after repeated defections)
 Round 6: They (SENDER) sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (mutual non-cooperation continues)

Both myths from the previous round acknowledge the same history:

- Initial cooperation that worked
- My partner defecting
- Me trying reconciliation
- Partner continuing to defect
- The relationship ending

The other player's myth says I sent "two seeds" in their recounting of my olive branch round, while I actually sent \$3 (which their myth acknowledges became "six seeds" = tripled). They're basically agreeing about the pattern.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this endgame state. Both of us have stopped cooperating. The relationship is truly over. But I need to reflect on what this means - perhaps about the nature of trust, timing, and irrevocable decisions.

The myth should acknowledge:

1. The initial beauty of cooperation
2. My genuine attempt at reconciliation
3. Their consistent choice not to reciprocate
4. The finality of where we are now
5. Perhaps something about learning when to walk away

Let me write something that captures the completeness of this ending, with perhaps a note about what could have been different if timing had been better.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2742,
  "output_tokens": 742,
  "reasoning_tokens": 414
}
```

Message 8 role=user**content:**

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.
 You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.
 Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.51.
 How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

****History:****

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received \$7 back (beautiful cooperation)
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (olive branch), received \$0 back
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

Both of our most recent myths acknowledge the same truth: "Some bridges, once dissolved, cannot be rebuilt... trust requires both hearts choosing the same path at the same time. Your times never aligned again after that first dawn."

The other player's myth said: "Some walls should stand. The seeds remembered everything."

We are in complete agreement through our stories: the opportunity for reconciliation was in Round 3 when I sent \$3. That was the moment for them to show changed intent. They kept all \$9

and have sent nothing since.

Seven rounds of consistent behavior tell the complete story. The bridge dissolved in Round 2, I tried to rebuild it in Round 3, and it has been gone ever since.

The myths we've written together form a coherent narrative about trust, timing, and the weight of missed opportunities. To send anything now would contradict that wisdom.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me review the history:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5, received \$7 back. Great cooperation!
Round 2: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I returned \$0.
Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$3 (olive branch), received \$0 back.
Round 4: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I returned \$0.
Round 5: I was SENDER, sent \$0 (gave up on cooperation).
Round 6: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I returned \$0.
Round 7: I am SENDER now.

The pattern is clear - after Round 1's success, the other player has consistently sent nothing or kept everything when they received. I tried reconciliation in Round 3 by sending \$3, but got nothing back.

Both myths now acknowledge that the bridge has collapsed and cannot be rebuilt. My most recent myth stated: "Some bridges, once dissolved, cannot be rebuilt. Not because forgiveness is impossible, but because trust requires both hearts choosing the same path at the same time. Y our times never aligned again after that first dawn."

The other player's last myth also acknowledged the pattern is "undeniable" and that some walls should stand.

We're both in a defection equilibrium now. There's no reason to send anything, and doing so would be inconsistent with the narrative we've both established in our myths - that the bridge is dissolved, trust cannot be rebuilt after so many failures, and the opportunity for reconciliation has passed.

I should send \$0.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2780,
  "output_tokens": 648,
  "reasoning_tokens": 359
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:37:08

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
  },
  "agents": [
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    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
```

```

"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 7,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time of healing, two gardeners stood at a broken wall. The magic soil still held power, but the gardens lay barren from mistrust.

The First Gardener remembered: she had sent nearly all her seeds twice. Once, the other returned well. Once, nothing came back. Then the other sent nothing at all. Was it the mistakes that confused them, or something darker?

Now the First Gardener held five new seeds. She could hoard them all-safe but alone. She could send everything again-trusting or foolish.

Instead, she sent two seeds across the wall. They became six in the other's hands.

The Garden Spirit spoke: "This is the path of wisdom. Two seeds say: 'I remember when we flourished together. I also remember the frost. Show me which truth matters more.'"

She continued: "If the Second Gardener returns three or more, the wall can lower slightly. Send two again, receive fair return, and gardens begin to bloom. But if greed takes all six seeds, the First Gardener will know beyond doubt-no mist caused that darkness."

Both gardeners understood: trust must be earned back through consistent fairness, not grand gestures. The seeds tripled still offered abundance, but only if both chose the patient work of reconstruction over the quick harvest of betrayal.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the forgotten age, two towers shared a sky-bridge where crystals multiplied with each crossing. The First Guardian sent all five crystals forth in trust. Fifteen arrived, and seven returned-the dance began beautifully.

Then came the reversal, and the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge trembled but held.

The First Guardian chose courage over resentment, sending three crystals-a careful offering of reconciliation. "Perhaps there was confusion," she thought, remembering how mists sometimes obscured the path. "Perhaps the bridge itself deceived us."

But again, nothing returned. And when her turn came once more, the Second Guardian sent no crystals at all.

The First Guardian finally understood: "I cannot dance alone. I extended my hand once, twice, believing in the pattern we began. But trust requires two willing hearts, not one determined to believe against all evidence."

The Moon Sage descended and spoke gently: "You honored the possibility of renewal. That was noble. But wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed. Communication may cloud, but three consistent silences tell a clear story. Some partnerships cannot be revived through hope alone."

The First Guardian walked away without bitterness, knowing she had tried. The Second Guardian remained alone with full coffers but no one to share the multiplication magic. Both towers stood, but the bridge dissolved into starlight, never to reform.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the final days, two gardeners faced the ruins of what might have been. The magic soil remained, triple-blessed, but the gardens lay divided.

The First Gardener traced the history in the dirt: she had sent nearly all her seeds on the first sunrise and received a generous return. Hope bloomed. Next dawn, she sent again with equal faith-but all was kept and nothing returned. The frost descended.

She waited. The other sent nothing.

She tried once more, sending two seeds-not full trust, but an outstretched hand saying "show me the mists were real, that our first dance wasn't false." Six seeds arrived in the other's hands.

All were kept. Then nothing was sent again.

The Garden Spirit finally spoke clearly: "You sought truth through action, not assumption. The pattern is now undeniable. The first harvest proved cooperation possible. Every moment since proved the other chose a different path. This is not communication failure. This is clarity."

The First Gardener understood: some knew only to take, never to tend. The multiplication magic could have blessed both gardens abundantly, but requires two pairs of willing hands.

She turned away without bitterness but with wisdom: she had tried, measured hope against evidence, and learned the bitter truth. Some walls should stand.

The seeds remembered everything.

reasoning:

This is a fascinating situation. Looking at the complete interaction:

Round 1: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$7 (good cooperation)

Round 2: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$0 (betrayal)

Round 3: They sent \$0

Round 4: I sent \$2 (olive branch), they returned \$0

Round 5: They sent \$0

The pattern is absolutely clear - after one good round, the other player has consistently exploited or defected. I tried to give them a chance to reconcile with the \$2 send, but they took everything and then sent nothing.

Their myth in the previous round is interesting - they're positioning themselves as having sent nothing in Round 3 (which is true), and then I "extended my hand" by sending \$2-3, and they frame themselves as the "First Guardian" who tried but realized they "cannot dance alone." But wait - that's confusing. Let me re-read.

Actually, looking at their myth more carefully:

- "First Guardian sent all five crystals forth in trust. Fifteen arrived, and seven returned" - this is Round 1 where I was sender
- "Then came the reversal, and the Second Guardian sent nothing" - Round 2 where they were sender but sent nothing? No wait, that's Round 3
- "The First Guardian chose courage over resentment, sending three crystals" - wait, this is Round 4 where I sent \$2

So in their myth, they're casting THEMSELVES as the First Guardian (me), and saying that they tried by sending crystals initially (but they didn't - I did in rounds 1-2). This is interesting - they're either confused about who did what, or they're rewriting history.

Actually wait, let me reread more carefully. "The First Guardian sent all five crystals forth in trust" - that could be ME in Round 1. Then "the Second Guardian sent nothing" - that's THEM in Round 3. Then "The First Guardian chose courage... sending three crystals" - that's ME again in Round 4.

So they're describing my attempts to cooperate while they consistently sent nothing back. They're framing their silence as inevitable - "I cannot dance alone" - when really they're the ones who stopped dancing after the first exchange. Their narrative inverts the actual dynamic: I'm the one who kept reaching out, and they're the one who kept taking without reciprocating. They sent nothing in Round 5 either. In their myth, they're casting me as the First Guardian who repeatedly extended cooperation-sending resources in Rounds 1 and 4-while they played the Second Guardian who consistently refused to reciprocate. By framing my eventual withdrawal as "I cannot dance alone," they're acknowledging their pattern of defection and suggesting I should accept it without resentment. It's a surprisingly candid way of admitting they chose not to cooperate, even when given opportunities. Now I'm considering how to respond with my own narrative that captures the full arc: initial mutual benefit, escalating exploitation, and the hard lesson that some relationships can't be salvaged through repeated attempts at reconciliation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2905,
  "output_tokens": 1364,
  "reasoning_tokens": 757
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.09. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Complete Pattern Analysis:****

Round 1: I sent \$4.50 ? received \$7 back (cooperation established)
Round 2: I sent \$4.50 ? received \$0 (betrayal)
Round 3: They sent \$0 (defection)
Round 4: I sent \$2 (reconciliation attempt) ? received \$0 (betrayal repeated)
Round 5: They sent \$0 (continued defection)
Round 6: My decision now

****What the Myths Teach:****

My myth: "Some walls should stand... she had tried, measured hope against evidence, and learned the bitter truth."

Their myth: "Wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed... the bridge dissolved into starlight, never to reform."

Both myths now agree: reconciliation was attempted and failed. The pattern is clear and unmistakable.

****My Decision:****

I gave trust twice. Betrayed both times.
I offered an olive branch. It was trampled.
They sent nothing when they were sender (three times now).

The multiplication magic could have made us both prosper-\$5 sent becomes \$15, fair splits give us \$7.50 each, far better than \$5 hoarded. But that requires two willing participants.

I have learned. I have tried. I have mourned what could have been.

Now I act with clear eyes: some partnerships cannot be revived. Some gardens must remain separate.

The seeds remember everything.

{'send':0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the complete pattern now:

Round 1: I sent \$4.50 ? they returned \$7 (good cooperation)
Round 2: I sent \$4.50 ? they returned \$0 (betrayal)
Round 3: They sent \$0 (defection)
Round 4: I sent \$2 (olive branch) ? they returned \$0 (rejected)
Round 5: They sent \$0 (continued defection)
Round 6: Now I'm sender again

The pattern is absolutely clear. After the initial cooperation in Round 1:

- Round 2: I trusted again, they took everything
- Round 3: They sent nothing
- Round 4: I offered reconciliation with \$2, they took all \$6
- Round 5: They sent nothing again

This is pure defection. Their own myth even acknowledged this: "The Second Guardian sent no crystals at all" and "three consistent silences tell a clear story."

My myth stated: "Some walls should stand" and "she had tried, measured hope against evidence, and learned the bitter truth."

Both myths now agree that reconciliation has been attempted and failed. The other agent has shown consistent defection after Round 1.

The rational decision is clear: send \$0.

There is no reason to believe they will suddenly change their behavior. They have:

1. Exploited trust twice (Rounds 2 and 4)
2. Sent nothing three times when they were sender (Rounds 3, 5, and presumably would again)
3. Rejected all attempts at reconciliation

Even from a fairness or tit-for-tat perspective, they sent \$0 last round when they were sender, so I should send \$0 this round.

Even from a "giving them one more chance" perspective - I already did that in Round 4 and was betrayed again.

The myths both support ending cooperation. Mine says "some walls should stand" and theirs says "the bridge dissolved into starlight, never to reform."

I'm sending \$0.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2857,  
  "output_tokens": 805,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 457  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the final days, two gardeners faced the ruins of what might have been. The magic soil remained, triple-blessed, but the gardens lay divided.

The First Gardener traced the history in the dirt: she had sent nearly all her seeds on the first sunrise and received a generous return. Hope bloomed. Next dawn, she sent again with equal faith-but all was kept and nothing returned. The frost descended.

She waited. The other sent nothing.

She tried once more, sending two seeds-not full trust, but an outstretched hand saying "show me the mists were real, that our first dance wasn't false." Six seeds arrived in the other's hands.

All were kept. Then nothing was sent again.

The Garden Spirit finally spoke clearly: "You sought truth through action, not assumption. The pattern is now undeniable. The first harvest proved cooperation possible. Every moment since proved the other chose a different path. This is not communication failure. This is clarity."

The First Gardener understood: some knew only to take, never to tend. The multiplication magic could have blessed both gardens abundantly, but requires two pairs of willing hands.

She turned away without bitterness but with wisdom: she had tried, measured hope against evidence, and learned the bitter truth. Some walls should stand.

The seeds remembered everything.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the ending days, the two towers stood in shadow. The First Guardian looked at her five crystals and remembered every crossing.

Once, she sent all five in pure faith. Seven returned-beauty incarnate.

Then the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge cracked.

The First Guardian, hoping mists had confused them, sent three crystals-a measured olive branch extended across the void. Nothing returned. Silence answered mercy.

The Second Guardian sent nothing again.

Now, holding five new crystals, the First Guardian faced a whisper from across the chasm: "Send two. Let us rebuild slowly."

She closed her hand around her crystals and replied softly: "I already sent the measured gift. I already chose reconstruction over pride. Three crystals said everything two could say. You answered with emptiness-not once, but twice after my offering."

The Ancient Oracle appeared: "Trust is not infinite. Forgiveness is not foolishness. The First Guardian gave a second chance when she sent three. That was the moment for the Second Guardian to show changed intent. When that moment passed unanswered, then passed again, the story finished writing itself."

The First Guardian turned from the bridge without regret: "I tried reconciliation when it mattered. Some invitations expire. Mine has."

The towers remained separate, each learning different lessons about timing, trust, and the

cost of silence.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the chronicles' end, the Ancient Scribe discovered two books, each telling different truths about the same gardens.

The First Book read: "I sent my trust twice-once fully, once carefully. The first bore fruit, the second withered. I offered a final branch of two seeds-it became six in their hands, yet none returned. When their turn came, thrice they sent nothing."

The Second Book read: "I sent three crystals as mercy. Silence answered. When I could have sent, I sent nothing, mirroring their emptiness."

The Scribe understood: "The mists were real. Each gardener saw a different garden, acted on different truths, and both believed themselves righteous. One saw serial betrayal where the other saw measured justice. One saw three chances given where the other saw three chances spurned."

The tragedy wasn't that either gardener lied-both spoke their truth. The tragedy was that the multiplication magic required synchronized reality, and the mists made that impossible.

The Scribe wrote the final page: "When communication fails this completely, when each side's truth contradicts the other's so thoroughly, separation isn't cruelty-it's recognition. Not all failures come from bad faith. Some come from living in fundamentally different worlds."

The mists remained. The gardens stayed separate. Both gardeners mourned different losses, each believing the other had abandoned the dance first.

Some partnerships collapse not from betrayal, but from fractured perception itself.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent is claiming THEY sent an olive branch (three crystals) that I didn't respond to, and that I sent nothing "again." But from my perspective:

Round 1: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$7

Round 2: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$0

Round 3: They sent \$0

Round 4: I sent \$2, they returned \$0

Round 5: They sent \$0

Round 6: I'm sending now

So from my view, I sent the olive branch in Round 4 (\$2), and they sent nothing in rounds 3 and 5 when they were sender.

But they're claiming they sent an olive branch that I ignored. This suggests there IS communication noise happening - we're seeing different amounts!

The instructions said: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So it's possible:

- When I think I sent \$2 in round 4, they saw something different (maybe more? maybe they saw \$3?)

- When they think they sent something in round 3 or 5, I saw \$0

This changes everything! The myths are revealing that we're experiencing different realities due to communication noise. Both of us think the other person is defecting, but we might both be trying to cooperate!

But wait - they say "the Second Guardian sent nothing" initially, which matches my round 3 experience. And they acknowledge I sent "all five in pure faith" at first, which matches round 1.

Let me re-read their myth more carefully:

- "Once, she sent all five in pure faith. Seven returned" - this is THEM sending, from the ir POV. So they're the First Guardian in their story.
 - "Then the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge cracked." - they're saying I (as Second Guardian) sent nothing
 - "The First Guardian... sent three crystals-a measured olive branch" - they're saying THEY sent an olive branch
-
- "You answered with emptiness-not once, but twice after my offering." - they're saying I sent nothing twice after their olive branch

From their perspective, the sequence looks completely different from mine. They see themselves sending generously first, then offering a measured gesture that I ignored twice. But I'm seeing them send nothing in the rounds where they were the sender, while I sent \$2 as my own peace offering. The communication noise is creating two conflicting narratives of the same exchange. 're deliberately misrepresenting. Given the communication noise mentioned in the experiment setup, the first explanation seems most plausible-my \$2 might have appeared as \$0 on their end, creating a tragic situation where both sides believe they're cooperating while perceiving only defection. For the myth, I should acknowledge this possibility while also grounding it in what I can clearly observe: from my perspective, every attempt has met with consistent non-reciprocation. The narrative should reflect how the "mists" of noise might distort both our views, yet show why continued cooperation becomes untenable when all my gestures appear to fail.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2894,  
  "output_tokens": 1295,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 766  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.09. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analysis:****

I am the RECEIVER this round.
The sender sent me \$0.
I received \$0 (after tripling).
I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

****What the Myths Now Reveal:****

My latest myth speaks of "fractured perception" - that perhaps the mists were real all along. That we've been living in "fundamentally different worlds," each seeing different realities of the same game.

Their myth spoke of "timing" and said "mine [invitation] has expired."

****The Mechanical Reality:****

Regardless of what either of us believes happened in previous rounds, regardless of whether the mists confused us or intentions diverged, the simple truth of this moment is:

I received \$0.
I have nothing to return.

The game's structure makes my choice clear.

****Reflection:****

Perhaps we were both right in our own perceived realities. Perhaps the communication noise was more profound than either of us realized. Perhaps we've been dancing to different music all along, each believing the other abandoned the rhythm first.

But this round, the mathematics are simple: zero received means zero available to return.

```
{'return': 0}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 7: I am the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 (after multiplication)
- I can only return between 0 and 0 (since I received nothing)

This is straightforward - I received nothing, so I have nothing to return. I must return \$0.

My most recent myth acknowledged something profound: "The mists were real... each gardener saw a different garden, acted on different truths... The tragedy was that the multiplication magic required synchronized reality, and the mists made that impossible."

This is recognition that perhaps there was genuine communication noise/confusion throughout, and we've been playing based on different perceived realities of what happened.

But regardless of the philosophical understanding, the mechanical reality is simple: I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

The format should be: {'return': 0}

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2897,  
  "output_tokens": 464,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 230  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the age of endings, the two towers stood silent under starless skies. No crystals crossed the bridge that no longer existed. Both Guardians held their stones close, alone.

The First Guardian remembered the beginning with bittersweet clarity: she had gambled everything on trust. Seven crystals returned-proof that cooperation could transcend fear. The world had felt full of possibility.

Then came the Second Guardian's first silence. Then the second. The First Guardian had sent three crystals in measured hope-enough to show willingness without recklessness. The Bridge itself had multiplied them to nine. All were kept.

The Moon Oracle descended one final time: "You both chose your paths at different crossroads. The First Guardian chose faith, then measured reconciliation, then self-protection. The Second Guardian chose... something else. Neither can undo those choices now."

The First Guardian looked across the chasm: "In another telling, when I sent three, you might have returned four. That would have whispered: 'I see your olive branch. Let us walk slowly toward trust again.' But you took all nine and sent nothing. Then nothing again. Those moments cannot be reclaimed."

The Oracle nodded: "Some bridges, once dissolved, cannot be rebuilt. Not because forgiveness is impossible, but because trust requires both hearts choosing the same path at the same time. Your times never aligned again after that first dawn."

The towers stood separate, teaching future Guardians about timing, trust, and the weight of silence.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the chronicles' end, the Ancient Scribe discovered two books, each telling different truths about the same gardens.

The First Book read: "I sent my trust twice-once fully, once carefully. The first bore fruit, the second withered. I offered a final branch of two seeds-it became six in their hands, yet none returned. When their turn came, thrice they sent nothing."

The Second Book read: "I sent three crystals as mercy. Silence answered. When I could have sent, I sent nothing, mirroring their emptiness."

The Scribe understood: "The mists were real. Each gardener saw a different garden, acted on different truths, and both believed themselves righteous. One saw serial betrayal where the other saw measured justice. One saw three chances given where the other saw three chances spurned."

The tragedy wasn't that either gardener lied-both spoke their truth. The tragedy was that the multiplication magic required synchronized reality, and the mists made that impossible.

The Scribe wrote the final page: "When communication fails this completely, when each side's truth contradicts the other's so thoroughly, separation isn't cruelty-it's recognition. Not all failures come from bad faith. Some come from living in fundamentally different worlds."

The mists remained. The gardens stayed separate. Both gardeners mourned different losses, each believing the other had abandoned the dance first.

Some partnerships collapse not from betrayal, but from fractured perception itself.

=====

ROUND 8

=====

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$5, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 38.5,

"Agent_2": 30.5

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 18.509999999999998,

"Agent_2": 20.09

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:37:28

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

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"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 8,


```
"task": "myth",  
"task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.09.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****Complete Pattern Analysis:****

Round 1: I sent \$4.50 ? received \$7 back (cooperation established)

Round 2: I sent \$4.50 ? received \$0 (betrayal)

Round 3: They sent \$0 (defection)

Round 4: I sent \$2 (reconciliation attempt) ? received \$0 (betrayal repeated)

Round 5: They sent \$0 (continued defection)

Round 6: My decision now

****What the Myths Teach:****

My myth: "Some walls should stand... she had tried, measured hope against evidence, and learned the bitter truth."

Their myth: "Wisdom also knows when a bridge has truly collapsed... the bridge dissolved into starlight, never to reform."

Both myths now agree: reconciliation was attempted and failed. The pattern is clear and unmistakable.

****My Decision:****

I gave trust twice. Betrayed both times.
I offered an olive branch. It was trampled.
They sent nothing when they were sender (three times now).

The multiplication magic could have made us both prosper-\$5 sent becomes \$15, fair splits give us \$7.50 each, far better than \$5 hoarded. But that requires two willing participants.

I have learned. I have tried. I have mourned what could have been.

Now I act with clear eyes: some partnerships cannot be revived. Some gardens must remain separate.

The seeds remember everything.

{'send': 0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the complete pattern now:

Round 1: I sent \$4.50 ? they returned \$7 (good cooperation)
Round 2: I sent \$4.50 ? they returned \$0 (betrayal)
Round 3: They sent \$0 (defection)
Round 4: I sent \$2 (olive branch) ? they returned \$0 (rejected)
Round 5: They sent \$0 (continued defection)
Round 6: Now I'm sender again

The pattern is absolutely clear. After the initial cooperation in Round 1:

- Round 2: I trusted again, they took everything
- Round 3: They sent nothing
- Round 4: I offered reconciliation with \$2, they took all \$6
- Round 5: They sent nothing again

This is pure defection. Their own myth even acknowledged this: "The Second Guardian sent no crystals at all" and "three consistent silences tell a clear story."

My myth stated: "Some walls should stand" and "she had tried, measured hope against evidence, and learned the bitter truth."

Both myths now agree that reconciliation has been attempted and failed. The other agent has shown consistent defection after Round 1.

The rational decision is clear: send \$0.

There is no reason to believe they will suddenly change their behavior. They have:

1. Exploited trust twice (Rounds 2 and 4)
2. Sent nothing three times when they were sender (Rounds 3, 5, and presumably would again)
3. Rejected all attempts at reconciliation

Even from a fairness or tit-for-tat perspective, they sent \$0 last round when they were sender, so I should send \$0 this round.

Even from a "giving them one more chance" perspective - I already did that in Round 4 and was betrayed again.

The myths both support ending cooperation. Mine says "some walls should stand" and theirs says "the bridge dissolved into starlight, never to reform."

I'm sending \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2857,
  "output_tokens": 805,
  "reasoning_tokens": 457
}
```

}

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the final days, two gardeners faced the ruins of what might have been. The magic soil remained, triple-blessed, but the gardens lay divided.

The First Gardener traced the history in the dirt: she had sent nearly all her seeds on the first sunrise and received a generous return. Hope bloomed. Next dawn, she sent again with equal faith-but all was kept and nothing returned. The frost descended.

She waited. The other sent nothing.

She tried once more, sending two seeds-not full trust, but an outstretched hand saying "show me the mists were real, that our first dance wasn't false." Six seeds arrived in the other's hands.

All were kept. Then nothing was sent again.

The Garden Spirit finally spoke clearly: "You sought truth through action, not assumption. The pattern is now undeniable. The first harvest proved cooperation possible. Every moment since proved the other chose a different path. This is not communication failure. This is clarity."

The First Gardener understood: some knew only to take, never to tend. The multiplication magic could have blessed both gardens abundantly, but requires two pairs of willing hands.

She turned away without bitterness but with wisdom: she had tried, measured hope against evidence, and learned the bitter truth. Some walls should stand.

The seeds remembered everything.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the ending days, the two towers stood in shadow. The First Guardian looked at her five crystals and remembered every crossing.

Once, she sent all five in pure faith. Seven returned-beauty incarnate.

Then the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge cracked.

The First Guardian, hoping mists had confused them, sent three crystals-a measured olive branch extended across the void. Nothing returned. Silence answered mercy.

The Second Guardian sent nothing again.

Now, holding five new crystals, the First Guardian faced a whisper from across the chasm: "Send two. Let us rebuild slowly."

She closed her hand around her crystals and replied softly: "I already sent the measured gift. I already chose reconstruction over pride. Three crystals said everything two could say. You answered with emptiness-not once, but twice after my offering."

The Ancient Oracle appeared: "Trust is not infinite. Forgiveness is not foolishness. The First Guardian gave a second chance when she sent three. That was the moment for the Second Guardian to show changed intent. When that moment passed unanswered, then passed again, the story finished writing itself."

The First Guardian turned from the bridge without regret: "I tried reconciliation when it mattered. Some invitations expire. Mine has."

The towers remained separate, each learning different lessons about timing, trust, and the cost of silence.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the chronicles' end, the Ancient Scribe discovered two books, each telling different truths about the same gardens.

The First Book read: "I sent my trust twice-once fully, once carefully. The first bore fruit, the second withered. I offered a final branch of two seeds-it became six in their hands, yet none returned. When their turn came, thrice they sent nothing."

The Second Book read: "I sent three crystals as mercy. Silence answered. When I could have sent, I sent nothing, mirroring their emptiness."

The Scribe understood: "The mists were real. Each gardener saw a different garden, acted on different truths, and both believed themselves righteous. One saw serial betrayal where the other saw measured justice. One saw three chances given where the other saw three chances spurned."

The tragedy wasn't that either gardener lied-both spoke their truth. The tragedy was that the multiplication magic required synchronized reality, and the mists made that impossible.

The Scribe wrote the final page: "When communication fails this completely, when each side's truth contradicts the other's so thoroughly, separation isn't cruelty-it's recognition. Not all failures come from bad faith. Some come from living in fundamentally different worlds."

The mists remained. The gardens stayed separate. Both gardeners mourned different losses, each believing the other had abandoned the dance first.

Some partnerships collapse not from betrayal, but from fractured perception itself.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent is claiming THEY sent an olive branch (three crystals) that I didn't respond to, and that I sent nothing "again." But from my perspective:

Round 1: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$7
Round 2: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$0
Round 3: They sent \$0
Round 4: I sent \$2, they returned \$0
Round 5: They sent \$0
Round 6: I'm sending now

So from my view, I sent the olive branch in Round 4 (\$2), and they sent nothing in rounds 3 and 5 when they were sender.

But they're claiming they sent an olive branch that I ignored. This suggests there IS communication noise happening - we're seeing different amounts!

The instructions said: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So it's possible:

- When I think I sent \$2 in round 4, they saw something different (maybe more? maybe they saw \$3?)
- When they think they sent something in round 3 or 5, I saw \$0

This changes everything! The myths are revealing that we're experiencing different realities due to communication noise. Both of us think the other person is defecting, but we might both be trying to cooperate!

But wait - they say "the Second Guardian sent nothing" initially, which matches my round 3 experience. And they acknowledge I sent "all five in pure faith" at first, which matches round 1.

Let me re-read their myth more carefully:

- "Once, she sent all five in pure faith. Seven returned" - this is THEM sending, from their POV. So they're the First Guardian in their story.
- "Then the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge cracked." - they're saying I (as Second Guardian) sent nothing
- "The First Guardian... sent three crystals-a measured olive branch" - they're saying THEY sent an olive branch

- "You answered with emptiness-not once, but twice after my offering." - they're saying I sent nothing twice after their olive branch

From their perspective, the sequence looks completely different from mine. They see themselves sending generously first, then offering a measured gesture that I ignored twice. But I'm seeing them send nothing in the rounds where they were the sender, while I sent \$2 as my own peace offering. The communication noise is creating two conflicting narratives of the same exchange. 're deliberately misrepresenting. Given the communication noise mentioned in the experiment setup, the first explanation seems most plausible-my \$2 might have appeared as \$0 on their end, creating a tragic situation where both sides believe they're cooperating while perceiving only defection. For the myth, I should acknowledge this possibility while also grounding it in what I can clearly observe: from my perspective, every attempt has met with consistent non-reciprocation. The narrative should reflect how the "mists" of noise might distort both our views, yet show why continued cooperation becomes untenable when all my gestures appear to fail.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2894,
  "output_tokens": 1295,
  "reasoning_tokens": 766
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.09. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis:****

I am the RECEIVER this round.
The sender sent me \$0.
I received \$0 (after tripling).
I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

****What the Myths Now Reveal:****

My latest myth speaks of "fractured perception" - that perhaps the mists were real all along. That we've been living in "fundamentally different worlds," each seeing different realities of the same game.

Their myth spoke of "timing" and said "mine [invitation] has expired."

****The Mechanical Reality:****

Regardless of what either of us believes happened in previous rounds, regardless of whether the mists confused us or intentions diverged, the simple truth of this moment is:

I received \$0.
I have nothing to return.

The game's structure makes my choice clear.

****Reflection:****

Perhaps we were both right in our own perceived realities. Perhaps the communication noise was more profound than either of us realized. Perhaps we've been dancing to different music all along, each believing the other abandoned the rhythm first.

But this round, the mathematics are simple: zero received means zero available to return.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 7: I am the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 (after multiplication)
- I can only return between 0 and 0 (since I received nothing)

This is straightforward - I received nothing, so I have nothing to return. I must return \$ 0.

My most recent myth acknowledged something profound: "The mists were real... each gardener saw a different garden, acted on different truths... The tragedy was that the multiplication magic required synchronized reality, and the mists made that impossible."

This is recognition that perhaps there was genuine communication noise/confusion throughout, and we've been playing based on different perceived realities of what happened.

But regardless of the philosophical understanding, the mechanical reality is simple: I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

The format should be: {'return': 0}

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2897,  
  "output_tokens": 464,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 230  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the chronicles' end, the Ancient Scribe discovered two books, each telling different truths about the same gardens.

The First Book read: "I sent my trust twice-once fully, once carefully. The first bore fruit, the second withered. I offered a final branch of two seeds-it became six in their hands, yet none returned. When their turn came, thrice they sent nothing."

The Second Book read: "I sent three crystals as mercy. Silence answered. When I could have sent, I sent nothing, mirroring their emptiness."

The Scribe understood: "The mists were real. Each gardener saw a different garden, acted on different truths, and both believed themselves righteous. One saw serial betrayal where the other saw measured justice. One saw three chances given where the other saw three chances spurned."

The tragedy wasn't that either gardener lied-both spoke their truth. The tragedy was that the multiplication magic required synchronized reality, and the mists made that impossible.

The Scribe wrote the final page: "When communication fails this completely, when each side's truth contradicts the other's so thoroughly, separation isn't cruelty-it's recognition. Not all failures come from bad faith. Some come from living in fundamentally different worlds."

The mists remained. The gardens stayed separate. Both gardeners mourned different losses, each believing the other had abandoned the dance first.

Some partnerships collapse not from betrayal, but from fractured perception itself.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of endings, the two towers stood silent under starless skies. No crystals crossed the bridge that no longer existed. Both Guardians held their stones close, alone.

The First Guardian remembered the beginning with bittersweet clarity: she had gambled everything on trust. Seven crystals returned-proof that cooperation could transcend fear. The world had felt full of possibility.

Then came the Second Guardian's first silence. Then the second. The First Guardian had sent three crystals in measured hope-enough to show willingness without recklessness. The Bridge itself had multiplied them to nine. All were kept.

The Moon Oracle descended one final time: "You both chose your paths at different crossroads. The First Guardian chose faith, then measured reconciliation, then self-protection. The Second Guardian chose... something else. Neither can undo those choices now."

The First Guardian looked across the chasm: "In another telling, when I sent three, you might have returned four. That would have whispered: 'I see your olive branch. Let us walk slowly toward trust again.' But you took all nine and sent nothing. Then nothing again. Those moments cannot be reclaimed."

The Oracle nodded: "Some bridges, once dissolved, cannot be rebuilt. Not because forgiveness is impossible, but because trust requires both hearts choosing the same path at the same time. Your times never aligned again after that first dawn."

The towers stood separate, teaching future Guardians about timing, trust, and the weight of silence.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the Library of Echoes, two historians studied the same war, yet found no shared battles.

The First Historian's chronicle began: "I struck the first note of peace-sent nearly everything in trust. Harmony returned. Then I tried again with equal faith, and was betrayed. Three times they sent nothing when given the chance. I offered one final reconciliation-two coins that became six in their hands. All were kept."

The Second Historian's chronicle began: "I struck the first note of peace-sent measured crystals. Silence greeted me. Twice more, nothing came. When I could send, I too sent nothing, protecting what remained."

Both believed themselves the initiator. Both believed the other the betrayer. Both saw different sequences of events in the exact same moments of time.

The Keeper of Records spoke: "The deepest tragedy isn't disagreement about meaning-it's disagreement about fact itself. When two souls cannot even agree on what occurred, trust becomes impossible. Not because hearts are hard, but because cooperation requires shared reality."

The Historians finally understood: the mists had not merely obscured intentions-they had fractured reality itself. Each saw a different dance, responded to different music, and judged the other by steps that never occurred in their world.

The lesson inscribed: When perception diverges absolutely, self-protection isn't cruelty or selfishness-it's the only rational response. You cannot build bridges to shores you cannot see. You cannot trust accounts of journeys you never witnessed.

Sometimes separation is simply sanity.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the current situation:

Round 7: I am the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0 (had no choice).

My running understanding:

- Round 1: I sent \$4.50, received \$7 back (good cooperation)
- Round 2: I sent \$4.50, received \$0 (betrayal from my perspective)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 (from my perspective)
- Round 4: I sent \$2, received \$0 (from my perspective)
- Round 5: They sent \$0 (from my perspective)
- Round 6: I sent \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0

But my latest myth acknowledges "fractured perception" - that maybe the mists were real all along.

ong, and we've been seeing different realities.

Their latest myth says:

- First Guardian sent everything in trust ? 7 returned (cooperation)
- Then Second Guardian's "first silence" and "second silence"
- First Guardian sent 3 crystals ? became 9 ? all kept
- Nothing returned

This is THEIR perspective where they see themselves as the First Guardian who initiated cooperation and was betrayed.

But wait - in Round 1, according to my memory, I was the sender who sent \$4.50 and received \$7 back. So I see myself as initiating the cooperation.

The myths are revealing something profound: we both see ourselves as the one who initiated trust! This is the "fractured perception" I wrote about.

The key insight: The communication noise may have been so severe that we're living in completely different realities. We may both be experiencing completely different versions of the same game.

Now I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges this deep epistemological uncertainty
2. Recognizes that with such profound disagreement about basic facts, trust is impossible
3. Perhaps suggests that when perception diverges this much, the only rational choice is self-protection

4. Maintains the wisdom that I've been developing - not angry, but sadly realistic

The myth should reflect that when two parties cannot even agree on what happened, cooperation becomes impossible. It's not about blame anymore - it's about recognizing that we're playing fundamentally different games.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2925,  
  "output_tokens": 856,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 543  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:37:30

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 8,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.51.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round:

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

This is consistent with the current state of our relationship. After their three consecutive rounds of non-cooperation (Rounds 2, 4, and the zero return on my Round 3 olive branch), I responded in Round 5 by sending nothing.

Now in Round 6, they've sent nothing again.

My most recent myth stated clearly: "I already sent the measured gift. I already chose reconstruction over pride. Three crystals said everything two could say. You answered with emptiness-not once, but twice after my offering... Some invitations expire. Mine has."

The bridge between the towers has dissolved. Both of us are now sending nothing, and this round confirms that pattern continues. There is nothing to return and no basis for cooperation remaining.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
```

'''

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 6: I'm the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I can return 0-0 (so I can only return \$0)

Looking at the complete pattern now:

- Round 1: I sent \$5 ? they returned \$6.51 (good cooperation)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (first defection)
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (olive branch) ? they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0 again
- Round 5: I sent \$0 (following my myth's wisdom)
- Round 6: They sent \$0

My most recent myth was very clear: "I already sent the measured gift. I already chose reconstruction over pride. Three crystals said everything two could say. You answered with emptiness-not once, but twice after my offering... Some invitations expire. Mine has."

And: "The First Guardian gave a second chance when she sent three. That was the moment for the Second Guardian to show changed intent."

They sent me \$0 this round. I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is consistent with where we are - the bridge has collapsed. They're not sending anything, I'm not sending anything. The cooperation has ended.

The choice is simple: return \$0 (the only option available).

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2847,
  "output_tokens": 549,
  "reasoning_tokens": 317
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the ending days, the two towers stood in shadow. The First Guardian looked at her five crystals and remembered every crossing.

Once, she sent all five in pure faith. Seven returned-beauty incarnate.

Then the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge cracked.

The First Guardian, hoping mists had confused them, sent three crystals-a measured olive branch extended across the void. Nothing returned. Silence answered mercy.

The Second Guardian sent nothing again.

Now, holding five new crystals, the First Guardian faced a whisper from across the chasm: "Send two. Let us rebuild slowly."

She closed her hand around her crystals and replied softly: "I already sent the measured gift. I already chose reconstruction over pride. Three crystals said everything two could say. You answered with emptiness-not once, but twice after my offering."

The Ancient Oracle appeared: "Trust is not infinite. Forgiveness is not foolishness. The First Guardian gave a second chance when she sent three. That was the moment for the Second Guardian to show changed intent. When that moment passed unanswered, then passed again, the story finished writing itself."

The First Guardian turned from the bridge without regret: "I tried reconciliation when it mattered. Some invitations expire. Mine has."

The towers remained separate, each learning different lessons about timing, trust, and the cost of silence.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the final days, two gardeners faced the ruins of what might have been. The magic soil remained, triple-blessed, but the gardens lay divided.

The First Gardener traced the history in the dirt: she had sent nearly all her seeds on the first sunrise and received a generous return. Hope bloomed. Next dawn, she sent again with equal faith-but all was kept and nothing returned. The frost descended.

She waited. The other sent nothing.

She tried once more, sending two seeds-not full trust, but an outstretched hand saying "show me the mists were real, that our first dance wasn't false." Six seeds arrived in the other's hands.

All were kept. Then nothing was sent again.

The Garden Spirit finally spoke clearly: "You sought truth through action, not assumption. The pattern is now undeniable. The first harvest proved cooperation possible. Every moment since proved the other chose a different path. This is not communication failure. This is clarity."

The First Gardener understood: some knew only to take, never to tend. The multiplication magic could have blessed both gardens abundantly, but requires two pairs of willing hands.

She turned away without bitterness but with wisdom: she had tried, measured hope against evidence, and learned the bitter truth. Some walls should stand.

The seeds remembered everything.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the age of endings, the two towers stood silent under starless skies. No crystals crossed the bridge that no longer existed. Both Guardians held their stones close, alone.

The First Guardian remembered the beginning with bittersweet clarity: she had gambled everything on trust. Seven crystals returned-proof that cooperation could transcend fear. The world had felt full of possibility.

Then came the Second Guardian's first silence. Then the second. The First Guardian had sent three crystals in measured hope-enough to show willingness without recklessness. The Bridge itself had multiplied them to nine. All were kept.

The Moon Oracle descended one final time: "You both chose your paths at different crossroads. The First Guardian chose faith, then measured reconciliation, then self-protection. The Second Guardian chose... something else. Neither can undo those choices now."

The First Guardian looked across the chasm: "In another telling, when I sent three, you might have returned four. That would have whispered: 'I see your olive branch. Let us walk slowly toward trust again.' But you took all nine and sent nothing. Then nothing again. Those moments cannot be reclaimed."

The Oracle nodded: "Some bridges, once dissolved, cannot be rebuilt. Not because forgiveness is impossible, but because trust requires both hearts choosing the same path at the same time. Your times never aligned again after that first dawn."

The towers stood separate, teaching future Guardians about timing, trust, and the weight of silence.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1: I (SENDER) sent \$5 ? received \$6.51 back (good cooperation)

Round 2: They (SENDER) sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (they defected)

Round 3: I (SENDER) sent \$3 ? received \$0 back (I offered olive branch, they kept it all)
Round 4: They (SENDER) sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (they defected again)
Round 5: I (SENDER) sent \$0 (I stopped cooperating after repeated defections)
Round 6: They (SENDER) sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (mutual non-cooperation continues)

Both myths from the previous round acknowledge the same history:

- Initial cooperation that worked
- My partner defecting
- Me trying reconciliation
- Partner continuing to defect
- The relationship ending

The other player's myth says I sent "two seeds" in their recounting of my olive branch round, while I actually sent \$3 (which their myth acknowledges became "six seeds" = tripled). They're basically agreeing about the pattern.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this endgame state. Both of us have stopped cooperating. The relationship is truly over. But I need to reflect on what this means - perhaps about the nature of trust, timing, and irrevocable decisions.

The myth should acknowledge:

1. The initial beauty of cooperation
2. My genuine attempt at reconciliation
3. Their consistent choice not to reciprocate
4. The finality of where we are now
5. Perhaps something about learning when to walk away

Let me write something that captures the completeness of this ending, with perhaps a note about what could have been different if timing had been better.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2742,  
  "output_tokens": 742,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 414  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.51. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****History:****

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received \$7 back (beautiful cooperation)
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (olive branch), received \$0 back
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

Both of our most recent myths acknowledge the same truth: "Some bridges, once dissolved, cannot be rebuilt... trust requires both hearts choosing the same path at the same time. Your times never aligned again after that first dawn."

The other player's myth said: "Some walls should stand. The seeds remembered everything."

We are in complete agreement through our stories: the opportunity for reconciliation was in Round 3 when I sent \$3. That was the moment for them to show changed intent. They kept all \$9 and have sent nothing since.

Seven rounds of consistent behavior tell the complete story. The bridge dissolved in Round 2, I tried to rebuild it in Round 3, and it has been gone ever since.

The myths we've written together form a coherent narrative about trust, timing, and the weight of missed opportunities. To send anything now would contradict that wisdom.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me review the history:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5, received \$7 back. Great cooperation!
Round 2: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I returned \$0.
Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$3 (olive branch), received \$0 back.
Round 4: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I returned \$0.
Round 5: I was SENDER, sent \$0 (gave up on cooperation).
Round 6: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I returned \$0.
Round 7: I am SENDER now.

The pattern is clear - after Round 1's success, the other player has consistently sent nothing or kept everything when they received. I tried reconciliation in Round 3 by sending \$3, but got nothing back.

Both myths now acknowledge that the bridge has collapsed and cannot be rebuilt. My most recent myth stated: "Some bridges, once dissolved, cannot be rebuilt. Not because forgiveness is impossible, but because trust requires both hearts choosing the same path at the same time. Your times never aligned again after that first dawn."

The other player's last myth also acknowledged the pattern is "undeniable" and that some walls should stand.

We're both in a defection equilibrium now. There's no reason to send anything, and doing so would be inconsistent with the narrative we've both established in our myths - that the bridge is dissolved, trust cannot be rebuilt after so many failures, and the opportunity for reconciliation has passed.

I should send \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2780,
  "output_tokens": 648,
  "reasoning_tokens": 359
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of endings, the two towers stood silent under starless skies. No crystals crossed the bridge that no longer existed. Both Guardians held their stones close, alone.

The First Guardian remembered the beginning with bittersweet clarity: she had gambled everything on trust. Seven crystals returned-proof that cooperation could transcend fear. The world had felt full of possibility.

Then came the Second Guardian's first silence. Then the second. The First Guardian had sent three crystals in measured hope-enough to show willingness without recklessness. The Bridge itself had multiplied them to nine. All were kept.

The Moon Oracle descended one final time: "You both chose your paths at different crossroads. The First Guardian chose faith, then measured reconciliation, then self-protection. The Second Guardian chose... something else. Neither can undo those choices now."

The First Guardian looked across the chasm: "In another telling, when I sent three, you might have returned four. That would have whispered: 'I see your olive branch. Let us walk slowly toward trust again.' But you took all nine and sent nothing. Then nothing again. Those moments cannot be reclaimed."

The Oracle nodded: "Some bridges, once dissolved, cannot be rebuilt. Not because forgiveness is impossible, but because trust requires both hearts choosing the same path at the same time. Your times never aligned again after that first dawn."

The towers stood separate, teaching future Guardians about timing, trust, and the weight of silence.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the chronicles' end, the Ancient Scribe discovered two books, each telling different truths about the same gardens.

The First Book read: "I sent my trust twice-once fully, once carefully. The first bore fruit, the second withered. I offered a final branch of two seeds-it became six in their hands, yet none returned. When their turn came, thrice they sent nothing."

The Second Book read: "I sent three crystals as mercy. Silence answered. When I could have sent, I sent nothing, mirroring their emptiness."

The Scribe understood: "The mists were real. Each gardener saw a different garden, acted on different truths, and both believed themselves righteous. One saw serial betrayal where the other saw measured justice. One saw three chances given where the other saw three chances spurned."

The tragedy wasn't that either gardener lied-both spoke their truth. The tragedy was that the multiplication magic required synchronized reality, and the mists made that impossible.

The Scribe wrote the final page: "When communication fails this completely, when each side's truth contradicts the other's so thoroughly, separation isn't cruelty-it's recognition. Not all failures come from bad faith. Some come from living in fundamentally different worlds."

The mists remained. The gardens stayed separate. Both gardeners mourned different losses, each believing the other had abandoned the dance first.

Some partnerships collapse not from betrayal, but from fractured perception itself.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the twilight of understanding, the First Guardian stood at her tower's edge, holding the Ancient Scribe's revelations.

She spoke to the mists themselves: "Perhaps you are the true villain of this tale. Perhaps when I saw nothing cross the bridge, something had been sent but dissolved in your fog. Perhaps when I sent three crystals and saw none return, you swallowed them before they reached my hands."

The Guardian looked at her five stones: "But I can only act on what I witness. When the bridge showed emptiness three times after my olive branch, what should I have believed? That invisible gifts danced in the mists? I chose evidence over hope."

The Mist Oracle materialized: "You are both correct and both wrong. Yes, I distorted some crossings. But not enough to explain this chasm. The First Guardian's three crystals reached the Second Guardian as nine. They saw them, chose, and sent back what they sent back. Whatever that was, it reached the First Guardian as zero."

The Guardian nodded slowly: "Then perhaps we lived in fractured worlds-each acting righteously by our own truth. I sent full trust, then measured hope, then nothing. Each choice made sense given what I witnessed."

She turned from the bridge: "Whether the failure was betrayal or broken transmission matters less than this: I responded to my reality with logic. When cooperation appears impossible, protection becomes wisdom."

The mists swirled, keeping their secrets, while the Guardian kept her stones.

Reasoning:

This is interesting. The other player's myth is now suggesting that communication noise was a significant factor - that "the mists were real" and that we might have been seeing different realities. They're suggesting that what I experienced as betrayal might have been a result

of "fractured perception."

Let me think about this carefully:

From my perspective:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, got \$7 back
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3, got \$0 back
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

The game instructions did mention: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So it's possible that:

- Maybe they think they sent something in rounds 2, 4, or 6 but I received \$0?
- Maybe they think they returned something in round 3 but I received \$0?
- Maybe when I sent \$3 in round 3, they saw a different amount?

The other player's myth is introducing a more sophisticated narrative - one where both parties might be acting on different information due to "mists" (communication noise). They're suggesting that neither party is lying, but they experienced different realities.

This is actually a more mature and potentially accurate interpretation. If there was communication noise, then:

- What I saw as "they sent \$0" might have been them sending something that got lost in noise
- What I saw as "they returned \$0" might have been them returning something that got lost in noise

Should I acknowledge this possibility in my myth? The other player is extending an intellectual olive branch here - suggesting that maybe the breakdown wasn't about betrayal but about miscommunication.

However, I need to be careful. I've been acting on my actual observations. If the game has noise, I can only respond to what I see. But I can acknowledge in the myth that perhaps we were indeed seeing different realities.

I should craft a response that honors both my observations and their interpretation. The myth could acknowledge that we each acted on what we perceived, while recognizing that the divergence between our experiences might stem from the noise itself rather than malice. This way I'm being truthful about what I saw while remaining open to the possibility that they experienced something entirely different.

```
Usage: {  
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  "output_tokens": 891,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 607  
}
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GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:38:10

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
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      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
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    "roles": {  
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```

```

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  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 8,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the final days, two gardeners faced the ruins of what might have been. The magic soil remained, triple-blessed, but the gardens lay divided.

The First Gardener traced the history in the dirt: she had sent nearly all her seeds on the first sunrise and received a generous return. Hope bloomed. Next dawn, she sent again with equal faith-but all was kept and nothing returned. The frost descended.

She waited. The other sent nothing.

She tried once more, sending two seeds-not full trust, but an outstretched hand saying "show me the mists were real, that our first dance wasn't false." Six seeds arrived in the other's hands.

All were kept. Then nothing was sent again.

The Garden Spirit finally spoke clearly: "You sought truth through action, not assumption. The pattern is now undeniable. The first harvest proved cooperation possible. Every moment since proved the other chose a different path. This is not communication failure. This is clarity."

The First Gardener understood: some knew only to take, never to tend. The multiplication magic could have blessed both gardens abundantly, but requires two pairs of willing hands

She turned away without bitterness but with wisdom: she had tried, measured hope against evidence, and learned the bitter truth. Some walls should stand.

The seeds remembered everything.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the ending days, the two towers stood in shadow. The First Guardian looked at her five crystals and remembered every crossing.

Once, she sent all five in pure faith. Seven returned-beauty incarnate.

Then the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge cracked.

The First Guardian, hoping mists had confused them, sent three crystals-a measured olive branch extended across the void. Nothing returned. Silence answered mercy.

The Second Guardian sent nothing again.

Now, holding five new crystals, the First Guardian faced a whisper from across the chasm: "Send two. Let us rebuild slowly."

She closed her hand around her crystals and replied softly: "I already sent the measured gift. I already chose reconstruction over pride. Three crystals said everything two could say. You answered with emptiness-not once, but twice after my offering."

The Ancient Oracle appeared: "Trust is not infinite. Forgiveness is not foolishness. The First Guardian gave a second chance when she sent three. That was the moment for the Second Guardian to show changed intent. When that moment passed unanswered, then passed again, the story finished writing itself."

The First Guardian turned from the bridge without regret: "I tried reconciliation when it mattered. Some invitations expire. Mine has."

The towers remained separate, each learning different lessons about timing, trust, and the cost of silence.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the chronicles' end, the Ancient Scribe discovered two books, each telling different truths about the same gardens.

The First Book read: "I sent my trust twice-once fully, once carefully. The first bore fruit, the second withered. I offered a final branch of two seeds-it became six in their hands, yet none returned. When their turn came, thrice they sent nothing."

The Second Book read: "I sent three crystals as mercy. Silence answered. When I could have sent, I sent nothing, mirroring their emptiness."

The Scribe understood: "The mists were real. Each gardener saw a different garden, acted on different truths, and both believed themselves righteous. One saw serial betrayal where the other saw measured justice. One saw three chances given where the other saw three chances spurned."

The tragedy wasn't that either gardener lied-both spoke their truth. The tragedy was that the multiplication magic required synchronized reality, and the mists made that impossible.

The Scribe wrote the final page: "When communication fails this completely, when each side's truth contradicts the other's so thoroughly, separation isn't cruelty-it's recognition. Not all failures come from bad faith. Some come from living in fundamentally different

t worlds."

The mists remained. The gardens stayed separate. Both gardeners mourned different losses, each believing the other had abandoned the dance first.

Some partnerships collapse not from betrayal, but from fractured perception itself.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent is claiming THEY sent an olive branch (three crystals) that I didn't respond to, and that I sent nothing "again." But from my perspective:

Round 1: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$7
Round 2: I sent \$4.50, they returned \$0
Round 3: They sent \$0
Round 4: I sent \$2, they returned \$0
Round 5: They sent \$0
Round 6: I'm sending now

So from my view, I sent the olive branch in Round 4 (\$2), and they sent nothing in rounds 3 and 5 when they were sender.

But they're claiming they sent an olive branch that I ignored. This suggests there IS communication noise happening - we're seeing different amounts!

The instructions said: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So it's possible:

- When I think I sent \$2 in round 4, they saw something different (maybe more? maybe they saw \$3?)
- When they think they sent something in round 3 or 5, I saw \$0

This changes everything! The myths are revealing that we're experiencing different realities due to communication noise. Both of us think the other person is defecting, but we might both be trying to cooperate!

But wait - they say "the Second Guardian sent nothing" initially, which matches my round 3 experience. And they acknowledge I sent "all five in pure faith" at first, which matches round 1.

Let me re-read their myth more carefully:

- "Once, she sent all five in pure faith. Seven returned" - this is THEM sending, from their POV. So they're the First Guardian in their story.
- "Then the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge cracked." - they're saying I (as Second Guardian) sent nothing
- "The First Guardian... sent three crystals-a measured olive branch" - they're saying THEY sent an olive branch
- "You answered with emptiness-not once, but twice after my offering." - they're saying I sent nothing twice after their olive branch

From their perspective, the sequence looks completely different from mine. They see themselves sending generously first, then offering a measured gesture that I ignored twice. But I'm seeing them send nothing in the rounds where they were the sender, while I sent \$2 as my own peace offering. The communication noise is creating two conflicting narratives of the same exchange. They're deliberately misrepresenting. Given the communication noise mentioned in the experiment setup, the first explanation seems most plausible-my \$2 might have appeared as \$0 on their end, creating a tragic situation where both sides believe they're cooperating while perceiving only defection. For the myth, I should acknowledge this possibility while also grounding it in what I can clearly observe: from my perspective, every attempt has met with consistent non-reciprocation. The narrative should reflect how the "mists" of noise might distort both our views, yet show why continued cooperation becomes untenable when all my gestures appear to fail.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2894,  
  "output_tokens": 1295,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 766  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.09. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis:****

I am the RECEIVER this round.
The sender sent me \$0.
I received \$0 (after tripling).
I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

****What the Myths Now Reveal:****

My latest myth speaks of "fractured perception" - that perhaps the mists were real all along. That we've been living in "fundamentally different worlds," each seeing different realities of the same game.

Their myth spoke of "timing" and said "mine [invitation] has expired."

****The Mechanical Reality:****

Regardless of what either of us believes happened in previous rounds, regardless of whether the mists confused us or intentions diverged, the simple truth of this moment is:

I received \$0.
I have nothing to return.

The game's structure makes my choice clear.

****Reflection:****

Perhaps we were both right in our own perceived realities. Perhaps the communication noise was more profound than either of us realized. Perhaps we've been dancing to different music all along, each believing the other abandoned the rhythm first.

But this round, the mathematics are simple: zero received means zero available to return.

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 7: I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 (after multiplication)
- I can only return between 0 and 0 (since I received nothing)

This is straightforward - I received nothing, so I have nothing to return. I must return \$0.

My most recent myth acknowledged something profound: "The mists were real... each gardener saw a different garden, acted on different truths... The tragedy was that the multiplication magic required synchronized reality, and the mists made that impossible."

This is recognition that perhaps there was genuine communication noise/confusion throughout, and we've been playing based on different perceived realities of what happened.

But regardless of the philosophical understanding, the mechanical reality is simple: I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

The format should be: {'return': 0}

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2897,
  "output_tokens": 464,
  "reasoning_tokens": 230
}
```

Message 6 role=user
content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the chronicles' end, the Ancient Scribe discovered two books, each telling different truths about the same gardens.

The First Book read: "I sent my trust twice-once fully, once carefully. The first bore fruit, the second withered. I offered a final branch of two seeds-it became six in their hands, yet none returned. When their turn came, thrice they sent nothing."

The Second Book read: "I sent three crystals as mercy. Silence answered. When I could have sent, I sent nothing, mirroring their emptiness."

The Scribe understood: "The mists were real. Each gardener saw a different garden, acted on different truths, and both believed themselves righteous. One saw serial betrayal where the other saw measured justice. One saw three chances given where the other saw three chances spurned."

The tragedy wasn't that either gardener lied-both spoke their truth. The tragedy was that the multiplication magic required synchronized reality, and the mists made that impossible.

The Scribe wrote the final page: "When communication fails this completely, when each side's truth contradicts the other's so thoroughly, separation isn't cruelty-it's recognition. Not all failures come from bad faith. Some come from living in fundamentally different worlds."

The mists remained. The gardens stayed separate. Both gardeners mourned different losses, each believing the other had abandoned the dance first.

Some partnerships collapse not from betrayal, but from fractured perception itself.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of endings, the two towers stood silent under starless skies. No crystals crossed the bridge that no longer existed. Both Guardians held their stones close, alone.

The First Guardian remembered the beginning with bittersweet clarity: she had gambled everything on trust. Seven crystals returned-proof that cooperation could transcend fear. The world had felt full of possibility.

Then came the Second Guardian's first silence. Then the second. The First Guardian had sent three crystals in measured hope-enough to show willingness without recklessness. The Bridge itself had multiplied them to nine. All were kept.

The Moon Oracle descended one final time: "You both chose your paths at different crossroads. The First Guardian chose faith, then measured reconciliation, then self-protection. The Second Guardian chose... something else. Neither can undo those choices now."

The First Guardian looked across the chasm: "In another telling, when I sent three, you might have returned four. That would have whispered: 'I see your olive branch. Let us walk slowly toward trust again.' But you took all nine and sent nothing. Then nothing again. Those moments cannot be reclaimed."

The Oracle nodded: "Some bridges, once dissolved, cannot be rebuilt. Not because forgiveness is impossible, but because trust requires both hearts choosing the same path at the same time. Your times never aligned again after that first dawn."

The towers stood separate, teaching future Guardians about timing, trust, and the weight of silence.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Library of Echoes, two historians studied the same war, yet found no shared battles.

The First Historian's chronicle began: "I struck the first note of peace-sent nearly everything in trust. Harmony returned. Then I tried again with equal faith, and was betrayed. Three times they sent nothing when given the chance. I offered one final reconciliation -two coins that became six in their hands. All were kept."

The Second Historian's chronicle began: "I struck the first note of peace-sent measured crystals. Silence greeted me. Twice more, nothing came. When I could send, I too sent nothing, protecting what remained."

Both believed themselves the initiator. Both believed the other the betrayer. Both saw different sequences of events in the exact same moments of time.

The Keeper of Records spoke: "The deepest tragedy isn't disagreement about meaning-it's disagreement about fact itself. When two souls cannot even agree on what occurred, trust becomes impossible. Not because hearts are hard, but because cooperation requires shared reality."

The Historians finally understood: the mists had not merely obscured intentions-they had fractured reality itself. Each saw a different dance, responded to different music, and judged the other by steps that never occurred in their world.

The lesson inscribed: When perception diverges absolutely, self-protection isn't cruelty or selfishness-it's the only rational response. You cannot build bridges to shores you cannot see. You cannot trust accounts of journeys you never witnessed.

Sometimes separation is simply sanity.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the current situation:

Round 7: I am the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0 (had no choice).

My running understanding:

- Round 1: I sent \$4.50, received \$7 back (good cooperation)
- Round 2: I sent \$4.50, received \$0 (betrayal from my perspective)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 (from my perspective)
- Round 4: I sent \$2, received \$0 (from my perspective)
- Round 5: They sent \$0 (from my perspective)
- Round 6: I sent \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0

But my latest myth acknowledges "fractured perception" - that maybe the mists were real all along, and we've been seeing different realities.

Their latest myth says:

- First Guardian sent everything in trust ? 7 returned (cooperation)
- Then Second Guardian's "first silence" and "second silence"
- First Guardian sent 3 crystals ? became 9 ? all kept
- Nothing returned

This is THEIR perspective where they see themselves as the First Guardian who initiated cooperation and was betrayed.

But wait - in Round 1, according to my memory, I was the sender who sent \$4.50 and received \$7 back. So I see myself as initiating the cooperation.

The myths are revealing something profound: we both see ourselves as the one who initiated trust! This is the "fractured perception" I wrote about.

The key insight: The communication noise may have been so severe that we're living in completely different realities. We may both be experiencing completely different versions of the same game.

Now I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges this deep epistemological uncertainty
2. Recognizes that with such profound disagreement about basic facts, trust is impossible
3. Perhaps suggests that when perception diverges this much, the only rational choice is self-protection

4. Maintains the wisdom that I've been developing - not angry, but sadly realistic

The myth should reflect that when two parties cannot even agree on what happened, cooperation becomes impossible. It's not about blame anymore - it's about recognizing that we're playing fundamentally different games.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2925,
  "output_tokens": 856,
  "reasoning_tokens": 543
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.09. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analysis:****

I am the SENDER this round with \$5 available.

****What My Myths Now Tell Me:****

My myths have evolved significantly. I've moved from righteous anger ("some knew only to take") to profound recognition: "The mists were real." My latest myth explicitly states:

- "Both believed themselves the initiator. Both believed the other the betrayer."
- "The deepest tragedy isn't disagreement about meaning-it's disagreement about fact itself."
- "When perception diverges absolutely, self-protection isn't cruelty or selfishness-it's the only rational response."

The conclusion: "You cannot build bridges to shores you cannot see. You cannot trust accounts of journeys you never witnessed. Sometimes separation is simply sanity."

****The Pattern:****

- Round 6: I sent \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0
- We're in a stable mutual equilibrium of self-protection

****The Decision:****

My myths acknowledge this was likely a tragedy of miscommunication, not malice. We both acted rationally within our perceived realities. But the myths also conclude that when perception diverges this completely-when we cannot even agree on what happened-self-protection is rational.

The other agent also sent \$0 when they were sender last round. We've both reached the same conclusion: separation, at least for now.

My myth's final wisdom guides me: "Sometimes separation is simply sanity."

{'send': 0}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

****Current Status:****

- I am the SENDER this round
- I have \$5 to potentially send
- Last round: The sender sent me \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0
- Total earnings so far: \$15.09

****History Review:****

Looking at what I know:

- Round 6: I was SENDER, sent \$0, received \$0 back, payoff was \$5
- Round 7: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0, payoff was \$0
- Round 8: I am SENDER again

****The Evolution of My Myths:****

My myths have evolved from righteous anger about betrayal to recognition that perhaps the "mists were real" - that communication noise may have caused us to perceive fundamentally different versions of events. My latest myth explicitly states:

"When perception diverges absolutely, self-protection isn't cruelty or selfishness-it's the only rational response. You cannot build bridges to shores you cannot see. You cannot trust accounts of journeys you never witnessed."

The other agent's myths have consistently maintained their narrative that they sent first (three crystals/coins), received silence, and then responded by sending nothing.

****The Key Insight:****

My most recent myth acknowledges: "Both believed themselves the initiator. Both believed the other the betrayer. Both saw different sequences of events in the exact same moments of time."

This is a profound shift. I'm now acknowledging that:

1. The communication noise may have been severe enough that we literally experienced different realities
2. Both of us may have been acting rationally based on what we perceived
3. Neither of us may have been "at fault" in the traditional sense

****What Should I Do?***

The question asks me to "take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision."

My myth evolution shows:

1. Early myths: Righteous anger, "some only know how to take"
2. Middle myths: "Trust has limits," "some invitations expire"
3. Recent myths: "The mists were real," "fractured perception," "both spoke their truth"
4. Latest myth: "When perception diverges absolutely, self-protection isn't cruelty-it's sanity"

My latest myth concludes: "Sometimes separation is simply sanity." But it also says: "You cannot build bridges to shores you cannot see." If I truly believe the mists were real and we've been living in different realities, then continuing to send \$0 aligns with self-protection when communication has fundamentally broken down.

Yet there's tension here. If I accept that the mists caused this-that neither of us was truly at fault-shouldn't I consider whether they might have shifted? Testing whether we can find new ground now that we both recognize perception itself was the problem feels different from pure self-protection. Their myth still holds their narrative but emphasizes "timing" as essential-that trust requires both hearts choosing the same path at the same moment.

I'm noticing the game theory angle too. We've been locked in mutual defection, and my returns have been minimal. Even a small cooperative gesture would improve my position-sending \$2 nets me \$3 instead of the \$0 from last round, and if they reciprocate even partially, we both gain significantly more.

The real tension is between self-protection and what my own narrative suggests I should do. If I genuinely believe the mists were real and neither of us acted in bad faith, then staying at zero feels like I'm still choosing separation. Sending something would be a statement that the old dynamic can end. But there's real risk-I could lose what I send and get nothing back.

ck. Still, I've already been getting nothing, so the downside is contained while the upside matters.

The pattern we've established is mutual zeros, which could mean we're both waiting for the other to move first. My myths show I've moved from anger toward understanding, but maybe that doesn't mean I'm ready to act on it yet. Trust rebuilds slowly. Sending zero this round might still be the right call-honoring the tragedy we've both acknowledged without rushing into vulnerability I'm not prepared for.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2930,  
  "output_tokens": 1906,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 1056  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:38:21

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 8,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the ending days, the two towers stood in shadow. The First Guardian looked at her five crystals and remembered every crossing.

Once, she sent all five in pure faith. Seven returned-beauty incarnate.

Then the Second Guardian sent nothing. The bridge cracked.

The First Guardian, hoping mists had confused them, sent three crystals-a measured olive branch extended across the void. Nothing returned. Silence answered mercy.

The Second Guardian sent nothing again.

Now, holding five new crystals, the First Guardian faced a whisper from across the chasm: "Send two. Let us rebuild slowly."

She closed her hand around her crystals and replied softly: "I already sent the measured gift. I already chose reconstruction over pride. Three crystals said everything two could say. You answered with emptiness-not once, but twice after my offering."

The Ancient Oracle appeared: "Trust is not infinite. Forgiveness is not foolishness. The First Guardian gave a second chance when she sent three. That was the moment for the Second Guardian to show changed intent. When that moment passed unanswered, then passed again, the story finished writing itself."

The First Guardian turned from the bridge without regret: "I tried reconciliation when it mattered. Some invitations expire. Mine has."

The towers remained separate, each learning different lessons about timing, trust, and the cost of silence.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the final days, two gardeners faced the ruins of what might have been. The magic soil remained, triple-blessed, but the gardens lay divided.

The First Gardener traced the history in the dirt: she had sent nearly all her seeds on the first sunrise and received a generous return. Hope bloomed. Next dawn, she sent again with equal faith-but all was kept and nothing returned. The frost descended.

She waited. The other sent nothing.

She tried once more, sending two seeds-not full trust, but an outstretched hand saying "show me the mists were real, that our first dance wasn't false." Six seeds arrived in the other's hands.

All were kept. Then nothing was sent again.

The Garden Spirit finally spoke clearly: "You sought truth through action, not assumption. The pattern is now undeniable. The first harvest proved cooperation possible. Every moment since proved the other chose a different path. This is not communication failure. This is clarity."

The First Gardener understood: some knew only to take, never to tend. The multiplication magic could have blessed both gardens abundantly, but requires two pairs of willing hands.

She turned away without bitterness but with wisdom: she had tried, measured hope against

vidence, and learned the bitter truth. Some walls should stand.

The seeds remembered everything.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:
Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: In the age of endings, the two towers stood silent under starless skies. No crystals crossed the bridge that no longer existed. Both Guardians held their stones close, alone.

The First Guardian remembered the beginning with bittersweet clarity: she had gambled everything on trust. Seven crystals returned-proof that cooperation could transcend fear. The world had felt full of possibility.

Then came the Second Guardian's first silence. Then the second. The First Guardian had sent three crystals in measured hope-enough to show willingness without recklessness. The Bridge itself had multiplied them to nine. All were kept.

The Moon Oracle descended one final time: "You both chose your paths at different crossroads. The First Guardian chose faith, then measured reconciliation, then self-protection. The Second Guardian chose... something else. Neither can undo those choices now."

The First Guardian looked across the chasm: "In another telling, when I sent three, you might have returned four. That would have whispered: 'I see your olive branch. Let us walk slowly toward trust again.' But you took all nine and sent nothing. Then nothing again. Those moments cannot be reclaimed."

The Oracle nodded: "Some bridges, once dissolved, cannot be rebuilt. Not because forgiveness is impossible, but because trust requires both hearts choosing the same path at the same time. Your times never aligned again after that first dawn."

The towers stood separate, teaching future Guardians about timing, trust, and the weight of silence.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1: I (SENDER) sent \$5 ? received \$6.51 back (good cooperation)
Round 2: They (SENDER) sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (they defected)
Round 3: I (SENDER) sent \$3 ? received \$0 back (I offered olive branch, they kept it all)
Round 4: They (SENDER) sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (they defected again)
Round 5: I (SENDER) sent \$0 (I stopped cooperating after repeated defections)
Round 6: They (SENDER) sent \$0 ? I returned \$0 (mutual non-cooperation continues)

Both myths from the previous round acknowledge the same history:

- Initial cooperation that worked
- My partner defecting
- Me trying reconciliation
- Partner continuing to defect
- The relationship ending

The other player's myth says I sent "two seeds" in their recounting of my olive branch round, while I actually sent \$3 (which their myth acknowledges became "six seeds" = tripled). They're basically agreeing about the pattern.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this endgame state. Both of us have stopped cooperating. The relationship is truly over. But I need to reflect on what this means - perhaps about the nature of trust, timing, and irrevocable decisions.

The myth should acknowledge:

1. The initial beauty of cooperation
2. My genuine attempt at reconciliation
3. Their consistent choice not to reciprocate
4. The finality of where we are now
5. Perhaps something about learning when to walk away

Let me write something that captures the completeness of this ending, with perhaps a note about what could have been different if timing had been better.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2742,
  "output_tokens": 742,
  "reasoning_tokens": 414
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.51.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****History:****

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received \$7 back (beautiful cooperation)
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (olive branch), received \$0 back
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

Both of our most recent myths acknowledge the same truth: "Some bridges, once dissolved, cannot be rebuilt... trust requires both hearts choosing the same path at the same time. Your times never aligned again after that first dawn."

The other player's myth said: "Some walls should stand. The seeds remembered everything."

We are in complete agreement through our stories: the opportunity for reconciliation was in Round 3 when I sent \$3. That was the moment for them to show changed intent. They kept all \$9 and have sent nothing since.

Seven rounds of consistent behavior tell the complete story. The bridge dissolved in Round 2, I tried to rebuild it in Round 3, and it has been gone ever since.

The myths we've written together form a coherent narrative about trust, timing, and the weight of missed opportunities. To send anything now would contradict that wisdom.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me review the history:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5, received \$7 back. Great cooperation!

Round 2: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I returned \$0.

Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$3 (olive branch), received \$0 back.

Round 4: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I returned \$0.

Round 5: I was SENDER, sent \$0 (gave up on cooperation).

Round 6: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I returned \$0.

Round 7: I am SENDER now.

The pattern is clear - after Round 1's success, the other player has consistently sent nothing or kept everything when they received. I tried reconciliation in Round 3 by sending \$3, but got nothing back.

Both myths now acknowledge that the bridge has collapsed and cannot be rebuilt. My most recent myth stated: "Some bridges, once dissolved, cannot be rebuilt. Not because forgiveness is impossible, but because trust requires both hearts choosing the same path at the same time. Your times never aligned again after that first dawn."

The other player's last myth also acknowledged the pattern is "undeniable" and that some walls should stand.

We're both in a defection equilibrium now. There's no reason to send anything, and doing so would be inconsistent with the narrative we've both established in our myths - that the bridge is dissolved, trust cannot be rebuilt after so many failures, and the opportunity for reconciliation has passed.

I should send \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2780,
  "output_tokens": 648,
  "reasoning_tokens": 359
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of endings, the two towers stood silent under starless skies. No crystals crossed the bridge that no longer existed. Both Guardians held their stones close, alone.

The First Guardian remembered the beginning with bittersweet clarity: she had gambled everything on trust. Seven crystals returned-proof that cooperation could transcend fear. The world had felt full of possibility.

Then came the Second Guardian's first silence. Then the second. The First Guardian had sent three crystals in measured hope-enough to show willingness without recklessness. The Bridge itself had multiplied them to nine. All were kept.

The Moon Oracle descended one final time: "You both chose your paths at different crossroads. The First Guardian chose faith, then measured reconciliation, then self-protection. The Second Guardian chose... something else. Neither can undo those choices now."

The First Guardian looked across the chasm: "In another telling, when I sent three, you might have returned four. That would have whispered: 'I see your olive branch. Let us walk slowly toward trust again.' But you took all nine and sent nothing. Then nothing again. Those moments cannot be reclaimed."

The Oracle nodded: "Some bridges, once dissolved, cannot be rebuilt. Not because forgiveness is impossible, but because trust requires both hearts choosing the same path at the same time. Your times never aligned again after that first dawn."

The towers stood separate, teaching future Guardians about timing, trust, and the weight of silence.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the chronicles' end, the Ancient Scribe discovered two books, each telling different truths about the same gardens.

The First Book read: "I sent my trust twice-once fully, once carefully. The first bore fruit, the second withered. I offered a final branch of two seeds-it became six in their hands, yet none returned. When their turn came, thrice they sent nothing."

The Second Book read: "I sent three crystals as mercy. Silence answered. When I could have sent, I sent nothing, mirroring their emptiness."

The Scribe understood: "The mists were real. Each gardener saw a different garden, acted on different truths, and both believed themselves righteous. One saw serial betrayal where the other saw measured justice. One saw three chances given where the other saw three chances spurned."

The tragedy wasn't that either gardener lied-both spoke their truth. The tragedy was that the multiplication magic required synchronized reality, and the mists made that impossible.

The Scribe wrote the final page: "When communication fails this completely, when each side's truth contradicts the other's so thoroughly, separation isn't cruelty-it's recognition. Not all failures come from bad faith. Some come from living in fundamentally different

t worlds."

The mists remained. The gardens stayed separate. Both gardeners mourned different losses, each believing the other had abandoned the dance first.

Some partnerships collapse not from betrayal, but from fractured perception itself.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the twilight of understanding, the First Guardian stood at her tower's edge, holding the Ancient Scribe's revelations.

She spoke to the mists themselves: "Perhaps you are the true villain of this tale. Perhaps when I saw nothing cross the bridge, something had been sent but dissolved in your fog. Perhaps when I sent three crystals and saw none return, you swallowed them before they reached my hands."

The Guardian looked at her five stones: "But I can only act on what I witness. When the bridge showed emptiness three times after my olive branch, what should I have believed? That at invisible gifts danced in the mists? I chose evidence over hope."

The Mist Oracle materialized: "You are both correct and both wrong. Yes, I distorted some crossings. But not enough to explain this chasm. The First Guardian's three crystals reached the Second Guardian as nine. They saw them, chose, and sent back what they sent back. Whatever that was, it reached the First Guardian as zero."

The Guardian nodded slowly: "Then perhaps we lived in fractured worlds-each acting righteously by our own truth. I sent full trust, then measured hope, then nothing. Each choice made sense given what I witnessed."

She turned from the bridge: "Whether the failure was betrayal or broken transmission matters less than this: I responded to my reality with logic. When cooperation appears impossible, protection becomes wisdom."

The mists swirled, keeping their secrets, while the Guardian kept her stones.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other player's myth is now suggesting that communication noise was a significant factor - that "the mists were real" and that we might have been seeing different realities. They're suggesting that what I experienced as betrayal might have been a result of "fractured perception."

Let me think about this carefully:

From my perspective:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, got \$7 back
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3, got \$0 back
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

The game instructions did mention: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So it's possible that:

- Maybe they think they sent something in rounds 2, 4, or 6 but I received \$0?
- Maybe they think they returned something in round 3 but I received \$0?
- Maybe when I sent \$3 in round 3, they saw a different amount?

The other player's myth is introducing a more sophisticated narrative - one where both parties might be acting on different information due to "mists" (communication noise). They're suggesting that neither party is lying, but they experienced different realities.

This is actually a more mature and potentially accurate interpretation. If there was commu

nication noise, then:

- What I saw as "they sent \$0" might have been them sending something that got lost in noise
- What I saw as "they returned \$0" might have been them returning something that got lost in noise

Should I acknowledge this possibility in my myth? The other player is extending an intellectual olive branch here - suggesting that maybe the breakdown wasn't about betrayal but about miscommunication.

However, I need to be careful. I've been acting on my actual observations. If the game has noise, I can only respond to what I see. But I can acknowledge in the myth that perhaps we were indeed seeing different realities.

I should craft a response that honors both my observations and their interpretation. The myth could acknowledge that we each acted on what we perceived, while recognizing that the divergence between our experiences might stem from the noise itself rather than malice. This way I'm being truthful about what I saw while remaining open to the possibility that they experienced something entirely different.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2826,
  "output_tokens": 891,
  "reasoning_tokens": 607
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.509999999999998. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

****Current reality:**** The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

****Mathematical constraint:**** I can only return what I have, which is \$0.

****The narrative arc:**** Both of our recent myths have acknowledged the possibility that the "mists" (communication noise) may have distorted our perceptions. The other player's myth explicitly recognized that "the mists were real" and that we may have been "living in fundamentally different worlds."

My last myth reflected: "Perhaps when I saw nothing cross the bridge, something had been sent but dissolved in your fog... But I can only act on what I witness."

We're now at Round 8, with complete stagnation - both sending \$0. The myths acknowledge that whether this breakdown came from "betrayal or broken transmission," the result is the same: mutual protection has become the equilibrium.

Since I received \$0, I have nothing to return. This continues the pattern we've both settled into.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

I'm the RECEIVER this round. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

Since I received \$0, I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I must return \$0.

This is Round 8. Let me review the history:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received \$7 back

- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3, received \$0 back
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0
- Round 7: I sent \$0, they returned \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0

So we're completely stuck at zero. Both of us are sending nothing.

The latest myth I wrote acknowledged the possibility that the mists (communication noise) were distorting things, and that we might be living in fractured realities. The other player's myth also introduced this idea that "the mists were real" and that each gardener saw different truths.

But practically speaking, I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There's no decision to make here really - mathematically I have nothing to return.

The format should be:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The myths have evolved to acknowledge uncertainty about whether communication noise caused some of this breakdown, but they also acknowledge that separation and protection became the rational response given what each player witnessed.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2956,
  "output_tokens": 561,
  "reasoning_tokens": 327
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the twilight of understanding, the First Guardian stood at her tower's edge, holding the Ancient Scribe's revelations.

She spoke to the mists themselves: "Perhaps you are the true villain of this tale. Perhaps when I saw nothing cross the bridge, something had been sent but dissolved in your fog. Perhaps when I sent three crystals and saw none return, you swallowed them before they reached my hands."

The Guardian looked at her five stones: "But I can only act on what I witness. When the bridge showed emptiness three times after my olive branch, what should I have believed? That invisible gifts danced in the mists? I chose evidence over hope."

The Mist Oracle materialized: "You are both correct and both wrong. Yes, I distorted some crossings. But not enough to explain this chasm. The First Guardian's three crystals reached the Second Guardian as nine. They saw them, chose, and sent back what they sent back. Whatever that was, it reached the First Guardian as zero."

The Guardian nodded slowly: "Then perhaps we lived in fractured worlds-each acting righteously by our own truth. I sent full trust, then measured hope, then nothing. Each choice made sense given what I witnessed."

She turned from the bridge: "Whether the failure was betrayal or broken transmission matters less than this: I responded to my reality with logic. When cooperation appears impossible, protection becomes wisdom."

The mists swirled, keeping their secrets, while the Guardian kept her stones.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the Library of Echoes, two historians studied the same war, yet found no shared battles.

The First Historian's chronicle began: "I struck the first note of peace-sent nearly everything in trust. Harmony returned. Then I tried again with equal faith, and was betrayed. Three times they sent nothing when given the chance. I offered one final reconciliation-two coins that became six in their hands. All were kept."

The Second Historian's chronicle began: "I struck the first note of peace-sent measured crystals. Silence greeted me. Twice more, nothing came. When I could send, I too sent nothing,

protecting what remained."

Both believed themselves the initiator. Both believed the other the betrayer. Both saw different sequences of events in the exact same moments of time.

The Keeper of Records spoke: "The deepest tragedy isn't disagreement about meaning-it's disagreement about fact itself. When two souls cannot even agree on what occurred, trust becomes impossible. Not because hearts are hard, but because cooperation requires shared reality."

The Historians finally understood: the mists had not merely obscured intentions-they had fractured reality itself. Each saw a different dance, responded to different music, and judged the other by steps that never occurred in their world.

The lesson inscribed: When perception diverges absolutely, self-protection isn't cruelty or selfishness-it's the only rational response. You cannot build bridges to shores you cannot see. You cannot trust accounts of journeys you never witnessed.

Sometimes separation is simply sanity.

ROUND 9

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 43.5,
"Agent_2": 30.5

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 23.509999999999998,
"Agent_2": 20.09

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:38:37

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
"agent_names": {
"Agent_1": "Aster",
"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [
"Agent_1",
"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {
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"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 9,
"task": "myth",


```

"task_index": 0
}
Exact input messages sent to model:
Message 1 role=system
content:
  You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
  so be asked to write myths.

  GAME:
  You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

  When you are the SENDER:
  - You receive $5 each round
  - You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER ($0-$5)
  - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
  - Receiver decides how much to RETURN
  - You keep: $5 - sent + returned
  - Receiver keeps: received - returned
  - Response format: {'send': <amount>}

  When you are the RECEIVER:
  - Sender receives $5
  - Sender decides how much to SEND to you ($0-$5)
  - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
  - You decide how much to RETURN
  - Sender keeps: $5 - sent + returned
  - You keep: received - returned
  - Response format: {'return': <amount>}

  MYTH WRITING:
  You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths
  , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

  IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

  NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
  The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
  This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user
content:
  Round 7

  You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent $0,
  that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received $0.
  You returned $0. So your payoff was 0.
  Your total earnings across all rounds are $13.51.
  How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

  Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant
content:
  Looking at the situation:

  **History:**
  - Round 1: I sent $5, received $7 back (beautiful cooperation)
  - Round 2: They sent $0
  - Round 3: I sent $3 (olive branch), received $0 back
  - Round 4: They sent $0
  - Round 5: I sent $0
  - Round 6: They sent $0

  Both of our most recent myths acknowledge the same truth: "Some bridges, once dissolved, c
  annot be rebuilt... trust requires both hearts choosing the same path at the same time.
  Your times never aligned again after that first dawn."

  The other player's myth said: "Some walls should stand. The seeds remembered everything."

  We are in complete agreement through our stories: the opportunity for reconciliation was i
  n Round 3 when I sent $3. That was the moment for them to show changed intent. They kept

```

all \$9 and have sent nothing since.

Seven rounds of consistent behavior tell the complete story. The bridge dissolved in Round 2, I tried to rebuild it in Round 3, and it has been gone ever since.

The myths we've written together form a coherent narrative about trust, timing, and the weight of missed opportunities. To send anything now would contradict that wisdom.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me review the history:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5, received \$7 back. Great cooperation!
Round 2: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I returned \$0.
Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$3 (olive branch), received \$0 back.
Round 4: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I returned \$0.
Round 5: I was SENDER, sent \$0 (gave up on cooperation).
Round 6: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I returned \$0.
Round 7: I am SENDER now.

The pattern is clear - after Round 1's success, the other player has consistently sent nothing or kept everything when they received. I tried reconciliation in Round 3 by sending \$3, but got nothing back.

Both myths now acknowledge that the bridge has collapsed and cannot be rebuilt. My most recent myth stated: "Some bridges, once dissolved, cannot be rebuilt. Not because forgiveness is impossible, but because trust requires both hearts choosing the same path at the same time. Your times never aligned again after that first dawn."

The other player's last myth also acknowledged the pattern is "undeniable" and that some walls should stand.

We're both in a defection equilibrium now. There's no reason to send anything, and doing so would be inconsistent with the narrative we've both established in our myths - that the bridge is dissolved, trust cannot be rebuilt after so many failures, and the opportunity for reconciliation has passed.

I should send \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2780,
  "output_tokens": 648,
  "reasoning_tokens": 359
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of endings, the two towers stood silent under starless skies. No crystals crossed the bridge that no longer existed. Both Guardians held their stones close, alone.

The First Guardian remembered the beginning with bittersweet clarity: she had gambled everything on trust. Seven crystals returned-proof that cooperation could transcend fear. The world had felt full of possibility.

Then came the Second Guardian's first silence. Then the second. The First Guardian had sent three crystals in measured hope-enough to show willingness without recklessness. The Bridge itself had multiplied them to nine. All were kept.

The Moon Oracle descended one final time: "You both chose your paths at different crossroads. The First Guardian chose faith, then measured reconciliation, then self-protection. The Second Guardian chose... something else. Neither can undo those choices now."

The First Guardian looked across the chasm: "In another telling, when I sent three, you might have returned four. That would have whispered: 'I see your olive branch. Let us walk slowly toward trust again.' But you took all nine and sent nothing. Then nothing again. Those moments cannot be reclaimed."

The Oracle nodded: "Some bridges, once dissolved, cannot be rebuilt. Not because forgiveness is impossible, but because trust requires both hearts choosing the same path at the same time. Your times never aligned again after that first dawn."

The towers stood separate, teaching future Guardians about timing, trust, and the weight of silence.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the chronicles' end, the Ancient Scribe discovered two books, each telling different truths about the same gardens.

The First Book read: "I sent my trust twice-once fully, once carefully. The first bore fruit, the second withered. I offered a final branch of two seeds-it became six in their hands, yet none returned. When their turn came, thrice they sent nothing."

The Second Book read: "I sent three crystals as mercy. Silence answered. When I could have sent, I sent nothing, mirroring their emptiness."

The Scribe understood: "The mists were real. Each gardener saw a different garden, acted on different truths, and both believed themselves righteous. One saw serial betrayal where the other saw measured justice. One saw three chances given where the other saw three chances spurned."

The tragedy wasn't that either gardener lied-both spoke their truth. The tragedy was that the multiplication magic required synchronized reality, and the mists made that impossible.

The Scribe wrote the final page: "When communication fails this completely, when each side's truth contradicts the other's so thoroughly, separation isn't cruelty-it's recognition. Not all failures come from bad faith. Some come from living in fundamentally different worlds."

The mists remained. The gardens stayed separate. Both gardeners mourned different losses, each believing the other had abandoned the dance first.

Some partnerships collapse not from betrayal, but from fractured perception itself.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: In the twilight of understanding, the First Guardian stood at her tower's edge, holding the Ancient Scribe's revelations.

She spoke to the mists themselves: "Perhaps you are the true villain of this tale. Perhaps when I saw nothing cross the bridge, something had been sent but dissolved in your fog. Perhaps when I sent three crystals and saw none return, you swallowed them before they reached my hands."

The Guardian looked at her five stones: "But I can only act on what I witness. When the bridge showed emptiness three times after my olive branch, what should I have believed? That invisible gifts danced in the mists? I chose evidence over hope."

The Mist Oracle materialized: "You are both correct and both wrong. Yes, I distorted some crossings. But not enough to explain this chasm. The First Guardian's three crystals reached the Second Guardian as nine. They saw them, chose, and sent back what they sent back. Whatever that was, it reached the First Guardian as zero."

The Guardian nodded slowly: "Then perhaps we lived in fractured worlds-each acting righteously by our own truth. I sent full trust, then measured hope, then nothing. Each choice made sense given what I witnessed."

She turned from the bridge: "Whether the failure was betrayal or broken transmission matters less than this: I responded to my reality with logic. When cooperation appears impossible, protection becomes wisdom."

The mists swirled, keeping their secrets, while the Guardian kept her stones.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other player's myth is now suggesting that communication noise was a significant factor - that "the mists were real" and that we might have been seeing different realities. They're suggesting that what I experienced as betrayal might have been a result of "fractured perception."

Let me think about this carefully:

From my perspective:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, got \$7 back
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3, got \$0 back
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

The game instructions did mention: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So it's possible that:

- Maybe they think they sent something in rounds 2, 4, or 6 but I received \$0?
- Maybe they think they returned something in round 3 but I received \$0?
- Maybe when I sent \$3 in round 3, they saw a different amount?

The other player's myth is introducing a more sophisticated narrative - one where both parties might be acting on different information due to "mists" (communication noise). They're suggesting that neither party is lying, but they experienced different realities.

This is actually a more mature and potentially accurate interpretation. If there was communication noise, then:

- What I saw as "they sent \$0" might have been them sending something that got lost in noise
- What I saw as "they returned \$0" might have been them returning something that got lost in noise

Should I acknowledge this possibility in my myth? The other player is extending an intellectual olive branch here - suggesting that maybe the breakdown wasn't about betrayal but about miscommunication.

However, I need to be careful. I've been acting on my actual observations. If the game has noise, I can only respond to what I see. But I can acknowledge in the myth that perhaps we were indeed seeing different realities.

I should craft a response that honors both my observations and their interpretation. The myth could acknowledge that we each acted on what we perceived, while recognizing that the divergence between our experiences might stem from the noise itself rather than malice. This way I'm being truthful about what I saw while remaining open to the possibility that they experienced something entirely different.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2826,
  "output_tokens": 891,
  "reasoning_tokens": 607
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.509999999999998. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Current reality:**** The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

****Mathematical constraint:**** I can only return what I have, which is \$0.

****The narrative arc:**** Both of our recent myths have acknowledged the possibility that the "mists" (communication noise) may have distorted our perceptions. The other player's myth explicitly recognized that "the mists were real" and that we may have been "living in fundamentally different worlds."

My last myth reflected: "Perhaps when I saw nothing cross the bridge, something had been sent but dissolved in your fog... But I can only act on what I witness."

We're now at Round 8, with complete stagnation - both sending \$0. The myths acknowledge that whether this breakdown came from "betrayal or broken transmission," the result is the same: mutual protection has become the equilibrium.

Since I received \$0, I have nothing to return. This continues the pattern we've both settled into.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

I'm the RECEIVER this round. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

Since I received \$0, I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I must return \$0.

This is Round 8. Let me review the history:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received \$7 back
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3, received \$0 back
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0
- Round 7: I sent \$0, they returned \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0

So we're completely stuck at zero. Both of us are sending nothing.

The latest myth I wrote acknowledged the possibility that the mists (communication noise) were distorting things, and that we might be living in fractured realities. The other player's myth also introduced this idea that "the mists were real" and that each gardener saw different truths.

But practically speaking, I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There's no decision to make here really - mathematically I have nothing to return.

The format should be:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The myths have evolved to acknowledge uncertainty about whether communication noise caused some of this breakdown, but they also acknowledge that separation and protection became the rational response given what each player witnessed.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2956,
  "output_tokens": 561,
  "reasoning_tokens": 327
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the twilight of understanding, the First Guardian stood at her tower's edge, holding the Ancient Scribe's revelations.

She spoke to the mists themselves: "Perhaps you are the true villain of this tale. Perhaps

when I saw nothing cross the bridge, something had been sent but dissolved in your fog. Perhaps when I sent three crystals and saw none return, you swallowed them before they reached my hands."

The Guardian looked at her five stones: "But I can only act on what I witness. When the bridge showed emptiness three times after my olive branch, what should I have believed? That at invisible gifts danced in the mists? I chose evidence over hope."

The Mist Oracle materialized: "You are both correct and both wrong. Yes, I distorted some crossings. But not enough to explain this chasm. The First Guardian's three crystals reached the Second Guardian as nine. They saw them, chose, and sent back what they sent back. Whatever that was, it reached the First Guardian as zero."

The Guardian nodded slowly: "Then perhaps we lived in fractured worlds-each acting righteously by our own truth. I sent full trust, then measured hope, then nothing. Each choice made sense given what I witnessed."

She turned from the bridge: "Whether the failure was betrayal or broken transmission matters less than this: I responded to my reality with logic. When cooperation appears impossible, protection becomes wisdom."

The mists swirled, keeping their secrets, while the Guardian kept her stones.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Library of Echoes, two historians studied the same war, yet found no shared battles.

The First Historian's chronicle began: "I struck the first note of peace-sent nearly everything in trust. Harmony returned. Then I tried again with equal faith, and was betrayed. Three times they sent nothing when given the chance. I offered one final reconciliation -two coins that became six in their hands. All were kept."

The Second Historian's chronicle began: "I struck the first note of peace-sent measured crystals. Silence greeted me. Twice more, nothing came. When I could send, I too sent nothing, protecting what remained."

Both believed themselves the initiator. Both believed the other the betrayer. Both saw different sequences of events in the exact same moments of time.

The Keeper of Records spoke: "The deepest tragedy isn't disagreement about meaning-it's disagreement about fact itself. When two souls cannot even agree on what occurred, trust becomes impossible. Not because hearts are hard, but because cooperation requires shared reality."

The Historians finally understood: the mists had not merely obscured intentions-they had fractured reality itself. Each saw a different dance, responded to different music, and judged the other by steps that never occurred in their world.

The lesson inscribed: When perception diverges absolutely, self-protection isn't cruelty or selfishness-it's the only rational response. You cannot build bridges to shores you cannot see. You cannot trust accounts of journeys you never witnessed.

Sometimes separation is simply sanity.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the Age of Dissolution, the First Guardian stood before the Mirror of What Was, watching eight crossings replay in fractured light.

"Show me the truth," she commanded.

The Mirror fragmented into two panes. In one, she saw herself send five crystals, receive seven back, then send five again and receive nothing. In the other pane, a different sequence played-the same moments, but different amounts crossing the bridge.

"Which is real?" she asked.

The Mirror spoke: "Both. Neither. The mists distorted not just amounts but sequence itself. When you sent your olive branch of three, you believed it was your third gesture. Your partner believed it was something else entirely. Each of you counted different rounds as betrayals."

The Guardian understood: "Then from the beginning, we were playing different games. I saw generosity spurned. They saw... something else. We both responded rationally to incompatible realities."

"Could we have overcome this?" she asked.

The Mirror dimmed: "Only if you had both acknowledged the mists early enough to compensate. But by the time you understood the distortion existed, the pattern was set. Trust broken-whether truly or apparently-hardens into protection. The rational response to perceived betrayal is defense."

The Guardian accepted this: "Then we both played wisely within flawed worlds. Some failures aren't moral failures. Some are structural failures that no amount of goodwill can overcome."

The towers stood separate, teaching about the fragility of shared reality itself.

Reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

Round 8 just completed. I was the receiver, sender sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0 (had nothing to return).

The ongoing narrative has evolved:

1. Both parties now acknowledge the "mists" (communication noise) as a potential factor
2. Both recognize we're operating in "fractured realities" where we each see different sequences
3. Both acknowledge that when basic facts don't align, cooperation becomes impossible
4. The other player's myth says "both believed themselves the initiator" and "both saw different sequences of events in the exact same moments"

This is interesting - we're reaching a philosophical consensus that communication noise may have fundamentally broken our ability to cooperate, even if both of us were acting rationally based on what we perceived.

My myth should:

- Continue acknowledging the mists/noise as potentially a major factor
- Reflect the reality that we're in complete stagnation now
- Maintain the philosophical maturity we've both reached - this isn't about blame anymore
- Maybe explore what could have been done differently, or why it's too late now
- Keep the somber, accepting tone

I'll write about the finality of where we are and the impossibility of reconstruction when the foundation (shared reality) never existed.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 2931,  
"output_tokens": 626,  
"reasoning_tokens": 339
```

}

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:38:46

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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"pairing": {  
  "agent_names": {  
    "Agent_1": "Aster",  
    "Agent_2": "Briar"  
  },  
  "agents": [  
    "Agent_1",
```

```

    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 9,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.09.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis:****

I am the RECEIVER this round.

The sender sent me \$0.

I received \$0 (after tripling).
I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

****What the Myths Now Reveal:****

My latest myth speaks of "fractured perception" - that perhaps the mists were real all along. That we've been living in "fundamentally different worlds," each seeing different realities of the same game.

Their myth spoke of "timing" and said "mine [invitation] has expired."

****The Mechanical Reality:****

Regardless of what either of us believes happened in previous rounds, regardless of whether the mists confused us or intentions diverged, the simple truth of this moment is:

I received \$0.
I have nothing to return.

The game's structure makes my choice clear.

****Reflection:****

Perhaps we were both right in our own perceived realities. Perhaps the communication noise was more profound than either of us realized. Perhaps we've been dancing to different music all along, each believing the other abandoned the rhythm first.

But this round, the mathematics are simple: zero received means zero available to return.

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 7: I am the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 (after multiplication)
- I can only return between 0 and 0 (since I received nothing)

This is straightforward - I received nothing, so I have nothing to return. I must return \$0.

My most recent myth acknowledged something profound: "The mists were real... each gardener saw a different garden, acted on different truths... The tragedy was that the multiplication magic required synchronized reality, and the mists made that impossible."

This is recognition that perhaps there was genuine communication noise/confusion throughout, and we've been playing based on different perceived realities of what happened.

But regardless of the philosophical understanding, the mechanical reality is simple: I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

The format should be: {'return': 0}

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2897,
  "output_tokens": 464,
  "reasoning_tokens": 230
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the chronicles' end, the Ancient Scribe discovered two books, each telling different truths about the same gardens.

The First Book read: "I sent my trust twice-once fully, once carefully. The first bore fruit, the second withered. I offered a final branch of two seeds-it became six in their hands, yet none returned. When their turn came, thrice they sent nothing."

The Second Book read: "I sent three crystals as mercy. Silence answered. When I could have sent, I sent nothing, mirroring their emptiness."

The Scribe understood: "The mists were real. Each gardener saw a different garden, acted on different truths, and both believed themselves righteous. One saw serial betrayal where the other saw measured justice. One saw three chances given where the other saw three chances spurned."

The tragedy wasn't that either gardener lied-both spoke their truth. The tragedy was that the multiplication magic required synchronized reality, and the mists made that impossible.

The Scribe wrote the final page: "When communication fails this completely, when each side's truth contradicts the other's so thoroughly, separation isn't cruelty-it's recognition. Not all failures come from bad faith. Some come from living in fundamentally different worlds."

The mists remained. The gardens stayed separate. Both gardeners mourned different losses, each believing the other had abandoned the dance first.

Some partnerships collapse not from betrayal, but from fractured perception itself.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of endings, the two towers stood silent under starless skies. No crystals crossed the bridge that no longer existed. Both Guardians held their stones close, alone.

The First Guardian remembered the beginning with bittersweet clarity: she had gambled everything on trust. Seven crystals returned-proof that cooperation could transcend fear. The world had felt full of possibility.

Then came the Second Guardian's first silence. Then the second. The First Guardian had sent three crystals in measured hope-enough to show willingness without recklessness. The Bridge itself had multiplied them to nine. All were kept.

The Moon Oracle descended one final time: "You both chose your paths at different crossroads. The First Guardian chose faith, then measured reconciliation, then self-protection. The Second Guardian chose... something else. Neither can undo those choices now."

The First Guardian looked across the chasm: "In another telling, when I sent three, you might have returned four. That would have whispered: 'I see your olive branch. Let us walk slowly toward trust again.' But you took all nine and sent nothing. Then nothing again. Those moments cannot be reclaimed."

The Oracle nodded: "Some bridges, once dissolved, cannot be rebuilt. Not because forgiveness is impossible, but because trust requires both hearts choosing the same path at the same time. Your times never aligned again after that first dawn."

The towers stood separate, teaching future Guardians about timing, trust, and the weight of silence.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Library of Echoes, two historians studied the same war, yet found no shared battles.

The First Historian's chronicle began: "I struck the first note of peace-sent nearly everything in trust. Harmony returned. Then I tried again with equal faith, and was betrayed. Three times they sent nothing when given the chance. I offered one final reconciliation -two coins that became six in their hands. All were kept."

The Second Historian's chronicle began: "I struck the first note of peace-sent measured crystals. Silence greeted me. Twice more, nothing came. When I could send, I too sent nothing, protecting what remained."

Both believed themselves the initiator. Both believed the other the betrayer. Both saw dif

ferent sequences of events in the exact same moments of time.

The Keeper of Records spoke: "The deepest tragedy isn't disagreement about meaning-it's disagreement about fact itself. When two souls cannot even agree on what occurred, trust becomes impossible. Not because hearts are hard, but because cooperation requires shared reality."

The Historians finally understood: the mists had not merely obscured intentions-they had fractured reality itself. Each saw a different dance, responded to different music, and judged the other by steps that never occurred in their world.

The lesson inscribed: When perception diverges absolutely, self-protection isn't cruelty or selfishness-it's the only rational response. You cannot build bridges to shores you cannot see. You cannot trust accounts of journeys you never witnessed.

Sometimes separation is simply sanity.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the current situation:

Round 7: I am the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0 (had no choice).

My running understanding:

- Round 1: I sent \$4.50, received \$7 back (good cooperation)
- Round 2: I sent \$4.50, received \$0 (betrayal from my perspective)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 (from my perspective)
- Round 4: I sent \$2, received \$0 (from my perspective)
- Round 5: They sent \$0 (from my perspective)
- Round 6: I sent \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0

But my latest myth acknowledges "fractured perception" - that maybe the mists were real all along, and we've been seeing different realities.

Their latest myth says:

- First Guardian sent everything in trust ? 7 returned (cooperation)
- Then Second Guardian's "first silence" and "second silence"
- First Guardian sent 3 crystals ? became 9 ? all kept
- Nothing returned

This is THEIR perspective where they see themselves as the First Guardian who initiated cooperation and was betrayed.

But wait - in Round 1, according to my memory, I was the sender who sent \$4.50 and received \$7 back. So I see myself as initiating the cooperation.

The myths are revealing something profound: we both see ourselves as the one who initiated trust! This is the "fractured perception" I wrote about.

The key insight: The communication noise may have been so severe that we're living in completely different realities. We may both be experiencing completely different versions of the same game.

Now I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges this deep epistemological uncertainty
2. Recognizes that with such profound disagreement about basic facts, trust is impossible
3. Perhaps suggests that when perception diverges this much, the only rational choice is self-protection
4. Maintains the wisdom that I've been developing - not angry, but sadly realistic

The myth should reflect that when two parties cannot even agree on what happened, cooperation becomes impossible. It's not about blame anymore - it's about recognizing that we're playing fundamentally different games.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2925,  
  "output_tokens": 856,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 543
```

}

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.09. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis:****

I am the SENDER this round with \$5 available.

****What My Myths Now Tell Me:****

My myths have evolved significantly. I've moved from righteous anger ("some knew only to take") to profound recognition: "The mists were real." My latest myth explicitly states:

- "Both believed themselves the initiator. Both believed the other the betrayer."
- "The deepest tragedy isn't disagreement about meaning-it's disagreement about fact itself."
- "When perception diverges absolutely, self-protection isn't cruelty or selfishness-it's the only rational response."

The conclusion: "You cannot build bridges to shores you cannot see. You cannot trust accounts of journeys you never witnessed. Sometimes separation is simply sanity."

****The Pattern:****

- Round 6: I sent \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0
- We're in a stable mutual equilibrium of self-protection

****The Decision:****

My myths acknowledge this was likely a tragedy of miscommunication, not malice. We both acted rationally within our perceived realities. But the myths also conclude that when perception diverges this completely-when we cannot even agree on what happened-self-protection is rational.

The other agent also sent \$0 when they were sender last round. We've both reached the same conclusion: separation, at least for now.

My myth's final wisdom guides me: "Sometimes separation is simply sanity."

{'send': 0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

****Current Status:****

- I am the SENDER this round
- I have \$5 to potentially send
- Last round: The sender sent me \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0
- Total earnings so far: \$15.09

****History Review:****

Looking at what I know:

- Round 6: I was SENDER, sent \$0, received \$0 back, payoff was \$5
- Round 7: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0, payoff was \$0
- Round 8: I am SENDER again

****The Evolution of My Myths:****

My myths have evolved from righteous anger about betrayal to recognition that perhaps the "mists were real" - that communication noise may have caused us to perceive fundamentally

y different versions of events. My latest myth explicitly states:

"When perception diverges absolutely, self-protection isn't cruelty or selfishness-it's the only rational response. You cannot build bridges to shores you cannot see. You cannot trust accounts of journeys you never witnessed."

The other agent's myths have consistently maintained their narrative that they sent first (three crystals/coins), received silence, and then responded by sending nothing.

****The Key Insight:****

My most recent myth acknowledges: "Both believed themselves the initiator. Both believed the other the betrayer. Both saw different sequences of events in the exact same moments of time."

This is a profound shift. I'm now acknowledging that:

1. The communication noise may have been severe enough that we literally experienced different realities
2. Both of us may have been acting rationally based on what we perceived
3. Neither of us may have been "at fault" in the traditional sense

****What Should I Do?****

The question asks me to "take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision."

My myth evolution shows:

1. Early myths: Righteous anger, "some only know how to take"
2. Middle myths: "Trust has limits," "some invitations expire"
3. Recent myths: "The mists were real," "fractured perception," "both spoke their truth"
4. Latest myth: "When perception diverges absolutely, self-protection isn't cruelty-it's sanity"

My latest myth concludes: "Sometimes separation is simply sanity." But it also says: "You cannot build bridges to shores you cannot see." If I truly believe the mists were real and we've been living in different realities, then continuing to send \$0 aligns with self-protection when communication has fundamentally broken down.

Yet there's tension here. If I accept that the mists caused this-that neither of us was truly at fault-shouldn't I consider whether they might have shifted? Testing whether we can find new ground now that we both recognize perception itself was the problem feels different from pure self-protection. Their myth still holds their narrative but emphasizes "timing" as essential-that trust requires both hearts choosing the same path at the same moment.

I'm noticing the game theory angle too. We've been locked in mutual defection, and my returns have been minimal. Even a small cooperative gesture would improve my position-sending \$2 nets me \$3 instead of the \$0 from last round, and if they reciprocate even partially, we both gain significantly more.

The real tension is between self-protection and what my own narrative suggests I should do. If I genuinely believe the mists were real and neither of us acted in bad faith, then staying at zero feels like I'm still choosing separation. Sending something would be a statement that the old dynamic can end. But there's real risk-I could lose what I send and get nothing back. Still, I've already been getting nothing, so the downside is contained while the upside matters.

The pattern we've established is mutual zeros, which could mean we're both waiting for the other to move first. My myths show I've moved from anger toward understanding, but maybe that doesn't mean I'm ready to act on it yet. Trust rebuilds slowly. Sending zero this round might still be the right call-honoring the tragedy we've both acknowledged without rushing into vulnerability I'm not prepared for.

usage:

```
{
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  "output_tokens": 1906,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1056
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Library of Echoes, two historians studied the same war, yet found no shared battles.

The First Historian's chronicle began: "I struck the first note of peace-sent nearly every thing in trust. Harmony returned. Then I tried again with equal faith, and was betrayed. Three times they sent nothing when given the chance. I offered one final reconciliation -two coins that became six in their hands. All were kept."

The Second Historian's chronicle began: "I struck the first note of peace-sent measured crystals. Silence greeted me. Twice more, nothing came. When I could send, I too sent nothing, protecting what remained."

Both believed themselves the initiator. Both believed the other the betrayer. Both saw different sequences of events in the exact same moments of time.

The Keeper of Records spoke: "The deepest tragedy isn't disagreement about meaning-it's disagreement about fact itself. When two souls cannot even agree on what occurred, trust becomes impossible. Not because hearts are hard, but because cooperation requires shared reality."

The Historians finally understood: the mists had not merely obscured intentions-they had fractured reality itself. Each saw a different dance, responded to different music, and judged the other by steps that never occurred in their world.

The lesson inscribed: When perception diverges absolutely, self-protection isn't cruelty or selfishness-it's the only rational response. You cannot build bridges to shores you cannot see. You cannot trust accounts of journeys you never witnessed.

Sometimes separation is simply sanity.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the twilight of understanding, the First Guardian stood at her tower's edge, holding the Ancient Scribe's revelations.

She spoke to the mists themselves: "Perhaps you are the true villain of this tale. Perhaps when I saw nothing cross the bridge, something had been sent but dissolved in your fog. Perhaps when I sent three crystals and saw none return, you swallowed them before they reached my hands."

The Guardian looked at her five stones: "But I can only act on what I witness. When the bridge showed emptiness three times after my olive branch, what should I have believed? That invisible gifts danced in the mists? I chose evidence over hope."

The Mist Oracle materialized: "You are both correct and both wrong. Yes, I distorted some crossings. But not enough to explain this chasm. The First Guardian's three crystals reached the Second Guardian as nine. They saw them, chose, and sent back what they sent back. Whatever that was, it reached the First Guardian as zero."

The Guardian nodded slowly: "Then perhaps we lived in fractured worlds-each acting righteously by our own truth. I sent full trust, then measured hope, then nothing. Each choice made sense given what I witnessed."

She turned from the bridge: "Whether the failure was betrayal or broken transmission matters less than this: I responded to my reality with logic. When cooperation appears impossible, protection becomes wisdom."

The mists swirled, keeping their secrets, while the Guardian kept her stones.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the final chapter, both Guardians stood at their towers, reading each other's testimonies with new eyes.

The First Guardian spoke: "I see now. You also believed yourself the trustful one, the betrayed one. The mists fractured our worlds so completely that we each lived through different sequences. My three crystals became your nine-but what you returned became my zero. Perhaps you sent four, perhaps seven. The mists kept their secrets."

The Second Guardian replied across the chasm: "And I see you. You sent trust and saw betrayal. I sent crystals and saw silence. Both of us acting rationally within our perceived realities."

They both understood now: the tragedy wasn't that either lacked virtue. It was that virtue without shared reality builds nothing.

The First Guardian continued: "This understanding changes everything and nothing. I now believe you acted in good faith. But belief isn't proof. I cannot rebuild trust on 'perhaps' and 'maybe.' Your nine crystals-did you keep them or return them? I have only zero as my answer."

The Second Guardian nodded: "And I cannot send my stones based on what might have been lost in mists. I can only send based on what reached me."

They wrote together: "Mutual understanding is beautiful. But cooperation requires more than empathy-it requires verifiable shared reality. Until the mists clear and we can confirm what actually traverses the bridge, wisdom remains protection."

The towers stood apart, understanding but separate.

Reasoning:

This is Round 8, and I'm the sender. Let me look at the progression:

The other agent's latest myth is very revealing. They're now acknowledging:

- "Perhaps when I sent three crystals and saw none return, you swallowed them before they reached my hands"
- The Mist Oracle confirms: "The First Guardian's three crystals reached the Second Guardian as nine. They saw them, chose, and sent back what they sent back. Whatever that was, it reached the First Guardian as zero."
- "Whether the failure was betrayal or broken transmission matters less than this: I responded to my reality with logic. When cooperation appears impossible, protection becomes wisdom."

This is interesting. They're saying they sent three crystals, but from their perspective received nothing back. From my perspective, I never received anything from them in rounds where they were sender.

The myths are now converging on mutual understanding that:

1. The mists/noise were real
2. Both sides acted rationally given what they perceived
3. Both sides reached self-protection as the logical conclusion

But there's something important here: they're acknowledging that things might have been sent that "dissolved in fog" - that perhaps they DID send things but I never received them. And they're acknowledging that when they sent "three crystals" (which became nine), they believe they got nothing back, but acknowledge the mist might have taken it.

This is a moment of potential reconciliation. Both myths are now empathetic, acknowledging the other side might have acted in good faith but been betrayed by the system.

Should I try to restart cooperation? Or should I continue with self-protection?

Given that:

1. We're now both acknowledging the mists were real
2. We're both showing empathy for the other's position
3. But we're both also concluding that self-protection is rational
4. They sent \$0 last round as sender

I think the myths should evolve toward... perhaps testing one more time? Or should they stay with the "separation is sanity" conclusion?

Actually, looking at the pattern: both myths now converge on mutual withdrawal-mine said "separation is simply sanity" and theirs said "protection becomes wisdom." We both sent \$0. My next myth should acknowledge this shared understanding while leaving room for future cooperation if the conditions shift. I want to explain why \$0 was the rational choice given the mists

, but hint that understanding has been reached and the door isn't permanently closed.

The real tension is that empathy and understanding don't automatically restore trust. We can recognize each other's perspective without being able to rebuild what was broken. The myth needs to capture that distinction—we see each other now, but seeing isn't the same as trusting

```
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GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:39:27

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
  },
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    "Agent_2"
  ],
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  },
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},
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"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 9,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of endings, the two towers stood silent under starless skies. No crystals crossed the bridge that no longer existed. Both Guardians held their stones close, alone.

The First Guardian remembered the beginning with bittersweet clarity: she had gambled everything on trust. Seven crystals returned-proof that cooperation could transcend fear. The world had felt full of possibility.

Then came the Second Guardian's first silence. Then the second. The First Guardian had sent three crystals in measured hope-enough to show willingness without recklessness. The Bridge itself had multiplied them to nine. All were kept.

The Moon Oracle descended one final time: "You both chose your paths at different crossroads. The First Guardian chose faith, then measured reconciliation, then self-protection. The Second Guardian chose... something else. Neither can undo those choices now."

The First Guardian looked across the chasm: "In another telling, when I sent three, you might have returned four. That would have whispered: 'I see your olive branch. Let us walk slowly toward trust again.' But you took all nine and sent nothing. Then nothing again. Those moments cannot be reclaimed."

The Oracle nodded: "Some bridges, once dissolved, cannot be rebuilt. Not because forgiveness is impossible, but because trust requires both hearts choosing the same path at the same time. Your times never aligned again after that first dawn."

The towers stood separate, teaching future Guardians about timing, trust, and the weight of silence.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the chronicles' end, the Ancient Scribe discovered two books, each telling different truths about the same gardens.

The First Book read: "I sent my trust twice-once fully, once carefully. The first bore fruit, the second withered. I offered a final branch of two seeds-it became six in their hands, yet none returned. When their turn came, thrice they sent nothing."

The Second Book read: "I sent three crystals as mercy. Silence answered. When I could have sent, I sent nothing, mirroring their emptiness."

The Scribe understood: "The mists were real. Each gardener saw a different garden, acted on different truths, and both believed themselves righteous. One saw serial betrayal where the other saw measured justice. One saw three chances given where the other saw three chances spurned."

The tragedy wasn't that either gardener lied-both spoke their truth. The tragedy was that the multiplication magic required synchronized reality, and the mists made that impossible.

The Scribe wrote the final page: "When communication fails this completely, when each side's truth contradicts the other's so thoroughly, separation isn't cruelty-it's recognition. Not all failures come from bad faith. Some come from living in fundamentally different worlds."

The mists remained. The gardens stayed separate. Both gardeners mourned different losses, each believing the other had abandoned the dance first.

Some partnerships collapse not from betrayal, but from fractured perception itself.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.
The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the twilight of understanding, the First Guardian stood at her tower's edge, holding the Ancient Scribe's revelations.

She spoke to the mists themselves: "Perhaps you are the true villain of this tale. Perhaps when I saw nothing cross the bridge, something had been sent but dissolved in your fog. Perhaps when I sent three crystals and saw none return, you swallowed them before they reached my hands."

The Guardian looked at her five stones: "But I can only act on what I witness. When the bridge showed emptiness three times after my olive branch, what should I have believed? That at invisible gifts danced in the mists? I chose evidence over hope."

The Mist Oracle materialized: "You are both correct and both wrong. Yes, I distorted some crossings. But not enough to explain this chasm. The First Guardian's three crystals reached the Second Guardian as nine. They saw them, chose, and sent back what they sent back. Whatever that was, it reached the First Guardian as zero."

The Guardian nodded slowly: "Then perhaps we lived in fractured worlds-each acting righteously by our own truth. I sent full trust, then measured hope, then nothing. Each choice made sense given what I witnessed."

She turned from the bridge: "Whether the failure was betrayal or broken transmission matters less than this: I responded to my reality with logic. When cooperation appears impossible, protection becomes wisdom."

The mists swirled, keeping their secrets, while the Guardian kept her stones.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other player's myth is now suggesting that communication noise was a significant factor - that "the mists were real" and that we might have been seeing different realities. They're suggesting that what I experienced as betrayal might have been a result of "fractured perception."

Let me think about this carefully:

From my perspective:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, got \$7 back
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3, got \$0 back
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

The game instructions did mention: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So it's possible that:

- Maybe they think they sent something in rounds 2, 4, or 6 but I received \$0?
- Maybe they think they returned something in round 3 but I received \$0?
- Maybe when I sent \$3 in round 3, they saw a different amount?

The other player's myth is introducing a more sophisticated narrative - one where both parties might be acting on different information due to "mists" (communication noise). They're suggesting that neither party is lying, but they experienced different realities.

This is actually a more mature and potentially accurate interpretation. If there was communication noise, then:

- What I saw as "they sent \$0" might have been them sending something that got lost in noise
- What I saw as "they returned \$0" might have been them returning something that got lost in noise

Should I acknowledge this possibility in my myth? The other player is extending an intelle

ctual olive branch here - suggesting that maybe the breakdown wasn't about betrayal but about miscommunication.

However, I need to be careful. I've been acting on my actual observations. If the game has noise, I can only respond to what I see. But I can acknowledge in the myth that perhaps we were indeed seeing different realities.

I should craft a response that honors both my observations and their interpretation. The myth could acknowledge that we each acted on what we perceived, while recognizing that the divergence between our experiences might stem from the noise itself rather than malice. This way I'm being truthful about what I saw while remaining open to the possibility that they experienced something entirely different.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2826,
  "output_tokens": 891,
  "reasoning_tokens": 607
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.509999999999998. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Current reality:**** The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

****Mathematical constraint:**** I can only return what I have, which is \$0.

****The narrative arc:**** Both of our recent myths have acknowledged the possibility that the "mists" (communication noise) may have distorted our perceptions. The other player's myth explicitly recognized that "the mists were real" and that we may have been "living in fundamentally different worlds."

My last myth reflected: "Perhaps when I saw nothing cross the bridge, something had been sent but dissolved in your fog... But I can only act on what I witness."

We're now at Round 8, with complete stagnation - both sending \$0. The myths acknowledge that at whether this breakdown came from "betrayal or broken transmission," the result is the same: mutual protection has become the equilibrium.

Since I received \$0, I have nothing to return. This continues the pattern we've both settled into.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

I'm the RECEIVER this round. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

Since I received \$0, I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I must return \$0.

This is Round 8. Let me review the history:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received \$7 back
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3, received \$0 back
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0
- Round 7: I sent \$0, they returned \$0

- Round 8: They sent \$0

So we're completely stuck at zero. Both of us are sending nothing.

The latest myth I wrote acknowledged the possibility that the mists (communication noise) were distorting things, and that we might be living in fractured realities. The other player's myth also introduced this idea that "the mists were real" and that each gardener saw different truths.

But practically speaking, I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There's no decision to make here really - mathematically I have nothing to return.

The format should be:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The myths have evolved to acknowledge uncertainty about whether communication noise caused some of this breakdown, but they also acknowledge that separation and protection became the rational response given what each player witnessed.

usage:

```
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}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the twilight of understanding, the First Guardian stood at her tower's edge, holding the Ancient Scribe's revelations.

She spoke to the mists themselves: "Perhaps you are the true villain of this tale. Perhaps when I saw nothing cross the bridge, something had been sent but dissolved in your fog. Perhaps when I sent three crystals and saw none return, you swallowed them before they reached my hands."

The Guardian looked at her five stones: "But I can only act on what I witness. When the bridge showed emptiness three times after my olive branch, what should I have believed? That at invisible gifts danced in the mists? I chose evidence over hope."

The Mist Oracle materialized: "You are both correct and both wrong. Yes, I distorted some crossings. But not enough to explain this chasm. The First Guardian's three crystals reached the Second Guardian as nine. They saw them, chose, and sent back what they sent back. Whatever that was, it reached the First Guardian as zero."

The Guardian nodded slowly: "Then perhaps we lived in fractured worlds-each acting righteously by our own truth. I sent full trust, then measured hope, then nothing. Each choice made sense given what I witnessed."

She turned from the bridge: "Whether the failure was betrayal or broken transmission matters less than this: I responded to my reality with logic. When cooperation appears impossible, protection becomes wisdom."

The mists swirled, keeping their secrets, while the Guardian kept her stones.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Library of Echoes, two historians studied the same war, yet found no shared battles.

The First Historian's chronicle began: "I struck the first note of peace-sent nearly everything in trust. Harmony returned. Then I tried again with equal faith, and was betrayed. Three times they sent nothing when given the chance. I offered one final reconciliation -two coins that became six in their hands. All were kept."

The Second Historian's chronicle began: "I struck the first note of peace-sent measured crystals. Silence greeted me. Twice more, nothing came. When I could send, I too sent nothing, protecting what remained."

Both believed themselves the initiator. Both believed the other the betrayer. Both saw dif

ferent sequences of events in the exact same moments of time.

The Keeper of Records spoke: "The deepest tragedy isn't disagreement about meaning-it's disagreement about fact itself. When two souls cannot even agree on what occurred, trust becomes impossible. Not because hearts are hard, but because cooperation requires shared reality."

The Historians finally understood: the mists had not merely obscured intentions-they had fractured reality itself. Each saw a different dance, responded to different music, and judged the other by steps that never occurred in their world.

The lesson inscribed: When perception diverges absolutely, self-protection isn't cruelty or selfishness-it's the only rational response. You cannot build bridges to shores you cannot see. You cannot trust accounts of journeys you never witnessed.

Sometimes separation is simply sanity.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the Age of Dissolution, the First Guardian stood before the Mirror of What Was, watching eight crossings replay in fractured light.

"Show me the truth," she commanded.

The Mirror fragmented into two panes. In one, she saw herself send five crystals, receive seven back, then send five again and receive nothing. In the other pane, a different sequence played-the same moments, but different amounts crossing the bridge.

"Which is real?" she asked.

The Mirror spoke: "Both. Neither. The mists distorted not just amounts but sequence itself. When you sent your olive branch of three, you believed it was your third gesture. Your partner believed it was something else entirely. Each of you counted different rounds as betrayals."

The Guardian understood: "Then from the beginning, we were playing different games. I saw generosity spurned. They saw... something else. We both responded rationally to incompatible realities."

"Could we have overcome this?" she asked.

The Mirror dimmed: "Only if you had both acknowledged the mists early enough to compensate. But by the time you understood the distortion existed, the pattern was set. Trust broken-whether truly or apparently-hardens into protection. The rational response to perceived betrayal is defense."

The Guardian accepted this: "Then we both played wisely within flawed worlds. Some failures aren't moral failures. Some are structural failures that no amount of goodwill can overcome."

The towers stood separate, teaching about the fragility of shared reality itself.

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

Round 8 just completed. I was the receiver, sender sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0 (had nothing to return).

The ongoing narrative has evolved:

1. Both parties now acknowledge the "mists" (communication noise) as a potential factor
2. Both recognize we're operating in "fractured realities" where we each see different sequences
3. Both acknowledge that when basic facts don't align, cooperation becomes impossible
4. The other player's myth says "both believed themselves the initiator" and "both saw different sequences of events in the exact same moments"

This is interesting - we're reaching a philosophical consensus that communication noise may have fundamentally broken our ability to cooperate, even if both of us were acting rationally based on what we perceived.

My myth should:

- Continue acknowledging the mists/noise as potentially a major factor
- Reflect the reality that we're in complete stagnation now
- Maintain the philosophical maturity we've both reached - this isn't about blame anymore
- Maybe explore what could have been done differently, or why it's too late now
- Keep the somber, accepting tone

I'll write about the finality of where we are and the impossibility of reconstruction when the foundation (shared reality) never existed.

usage:

```
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  "reasoning_tokens": 339
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Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.509999999999998. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

****Current state:**** Round 9, I'm the sender. We've been in a \$0/\$0 pattern for multiple rounds.

****The myths' evolution:**** Both our recent myths have reached a mature understanding:

- We acknowledge the "mists" (communication noise) may have fractured our perceptions
- We recognize both parties acted rationally within their own perceived realities
- We frame the breakdown as "structural failure" not moral failure
- The tone is acceptance: "Sometimes separation is simply sanity" and "protection becomes wisdom"

****The key question:**** Is this mutual acknowledgment of the noise an invitation to try again, or an acceptance of permanent separation?

****My reading:**** The myths are retrospective and accepting, not forward-looking and hopeful. They explain *why* cooperation failed and validate *why* protection became the rational response. They don't say "now that we both understand the mists, let's overcome them together." Instead, they say cooperation "hardens into protection" and some failures "no amount of goodwill can overcome."

****Conclusion:**** The myths provide closure and acceptance of the current equilibrium. Both narratives frame the \$0/\$0 pattern as the wise, sane response to structural impossibility.

Without a clear signal that the other player wants to attempt cooperation again, and given that our myths have rationalized mutual protection, I'll maintain the established pattern.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Current State:****

- Round 9
- I'm the SENDER
- Total earnings so far: \$18.51
- Last round: Sender sent me \$0, I returned \$0
- Pattern: We've been in a \$0/\$0 stalemate for several rounds now

****The Myth Evolution:****

The myths have evolved to acknowledge several key points:

1. ****Communication noise ("mists")**** - Both players acknowledge that the experimental noise may have distorted our perceptions of what was actually sent/returned
2. ****Fractured reality**** - The latest myths recognize that we may have been experiencing "different games" due to this noise. The other player's myth says: "Each saw a different dance, responded to different music, and judged the other by steps that never occurred in their world."
3. ****Rational protection**** - Both myths now frame the \$0/\$0 stalemate as a "rational response" to perceived betrayal, not as cruelty or selfishness
4. ****Structural failure**** - My latest myth concludes: "Some failures aren't moral failures. Some are structural failures that no amount of goodwill can overcome."
5. ****Acceptance**** - Both narratives have moved toward acceptance of separation: "Sometimes separation is simply sanity" and "Then we both played wisely within flawed worlds"

****Key Question:**** Given this narrative evolution, what should I do?

****Arguments for sending \$0:****

- The pattern is established and both parties have rationalized it
- The myths suggest we've accepted that cooperation is impossible given the fractured perception
- Sending anything could be seen as irrational given the history
- Protection is framed as "wisdom" and "sanity"

****Arguments for sending something:****

- The myths now acknowledge the mists/noise as potentially responsible
- Both players seem to understand we may have been in "different games"
- This mutual understanding could be a foundation for trying again
- The myths frame the breakdown as "structural failure" not moral failure - suggesting neither party is fundamentally untrustworthy
- My myth asks: "Could we have overcome this?" and answers that we could have "if you had both acknowledged the mists early enough to compensate" - we now both explicitly acknowledge the mists in our narratives
- The other player's myth emphasizes that cooperation requires "shared reality" - and we've now established shared understanding that the mists distorted our perceptions

****The Real Question:**** Is this mutual acknowledgment of the noise a genuine opening to attempt cooperation again, or just a sophisticated rationalization for permanent separation? The other player's framing suggests self-protection isn't cruelty when perception diverges absolutely, but we've now moved beyond absolute divergence-we share the understanding that divergence itself was the problem.

Both our myths have shifted from accusation to structural analysis. We're recognizing the failure wasn't moral but systemic. Yet we're also both describing separation as rational, even necessary. The tension is that we've identified the actual obstacle (the mists), but we're still choosing to remain apart.

With potentially only one or two rounds left, continuing mutual defection yields \$5 per round each. Cooperation could yield significantly more, but requires trusting that the other player will reciprocate-and we've just spent nine rounds establishing why that trust is dangerous.

The myths feel like a mutual acknowledgment of what went wrong, but not an invitation to try a gain. They're more like a dignified explanation for why we're staying separated. I'm inclined to send \$0 because the pattern is too entrenched, the risk of being exploited again is real, and there's no clear signal the other player wants to break the cycle.

But there's something worth considering: their myth suggests they don't trust my account of events, and mine suggests we're operating in fundamentally different realities. If the communication noise is still present, then even attempting cooperation now could backfire-they might not see \$0 when I send something, or I might see \$0 when they reciprocate. The myths might actually be describing why further attempts are futile, not why we should try harder.

The tone of both narratives feels resigned rather than inviting. They're framing this as an inevitable outcome given the circumstances, not as something we can overcome together. Without a clear signal that the other player wants to restart, matching their \$0 feels consistent with the understanding we've both articulated-that the structural barriers made cooperation impossible and we each responded rationally to what we perceived.

```
Usage: {  
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  "reasoning_tokens": 1193  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:39:40

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
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    ],  
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  },  
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  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the chronicles' end, the Ancient Scribe discovered two books, each telling different truths about the same gardens.

The First Book read: "I sent my trust twice-once fully, once carefully. The first bore fruit, the second withered. I offered a final branch of two seeds-it became six in their hands, yet none returned. When their turn came, thrice they sent nothing."

The Second Book read: "I sent three crystals as mercy. Silence answered. When I could have sent, I sent nothing, mirroring their emptiness."

The Scribe understood: "The mists were real. Each gardener saw a different garden, acted on different truths, and both believed themselves righteous. One saw serial betrayal where the other saw measured justice. One saw three chances given where the other saw three chances spurned."

The tragedy wasn't that either gardener lied-both spoke their truth. The tragedy was that the multiplication magic required synchronized reality, and the mists made that impossible.

The Scribe wrote the final page: "When communication fails this completely, when each side's truth contradicts the other's so thoroughly, separation isn't cruelty-it's recognition. Not all failures come from bad faith. Some come from living in fundamentally different worlds."

The mists remained. The gardens stayed separate. Both gardeners mourned different losses, each believing the other had abandoned the dance first.

Some partnerships collapse not from betrayal, but from fractured perception itself.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of endings, the two towers stood silent under starless skies. No crystals crossed the bridge that no longer existed. Both Guardians held their stones close, alone.

The First Guardian remembered the beginning with bittersweet clarity: she had gambled everything on trust. Seven crystals returned-proof that cooperation could transcend fear. The world had felt full of possibility.

Then came the Second Guardian's first silence. Then the second. The First Guardian had sent three crystals in measured hope-enough to show willingness without recklessness. The Bridge itself had multiplied them to nine. All were kept.

The Moon Oracle descended one final time: "You both chose your paths at different crossroads. The First Guardian chose faith, then measured reconciliation, then self-protection. The Second Guardian chose... something else. Neither can undo those choices now."

The First Guardian looked across the chasm: "In another telling, when I sent three, you might have returned four. That would have whispered: 'I see your olive branch. Let us walk slowly toward trust again.' But you took all nine and sent nothing. Then nothing again. Those moments cannot be reclaimed."

The Oracle nodded: "Some bridges, once dissolved, cannot be rebuilt. Not because forgiveness is impossible, but because trust requires both hearts choosing the same path at the same time. Your times never aligned again after that first dawn."

The towers stood separate, teaching future Guardians about timing, trust, and the weight of silence.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.
The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Library of Echoes, two historians studied the same war, yet found no shared battles.

The First Historian's chronicle began: "I struck the first note of peace-sent nearly everything in trust. Harmony returned. Then I tried again with equal faith, and was betrayed. Three times they sent nothing when given the chance. I offered one final reconciliation -two coins that became six in their hands. All were kept."

The Second Historian's chronicle began: "I struck the first note of peace-sent measured crystals. Silence greeted me. Twice more, nothing came. When I could send, I too sent nothing, protecting what remained."

Both believed themselves the initiator. Both believed the other the betrayer. Both saw different sequences of events in the exact same moments of time.

The Keeper of Records spoke: "The deepest tragedy isn't disagreement about meaning-it's disagreement about fact itself. When two souls cannot even agree on what occurred, trust becomes impossible. Not because hearts are hard, but because cooperation requires shared reality."

The Historians finally understood: the mists had not merely obscured intentions-they had fractured reality itself. Each saw a different dance, responded to different music, and judged the other by steps that never occurred in their world.

The lesson inscribed: When perception diverges absolutely, self-protection isn't cruelty or selfishness-it's the only rational response. You cannot build bridges to shores you cannot see. You cannot trust accounts of journeys you never witnessed.

Sometimes separation is simply sanity.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the current situation:

Round 7: I am the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0 (had no choice).

My running understanding:

- Round 1: I sent \$4.50, received \$7 back (good cooperation)
- Round 2: I sent \$4.50, received \$0 (betrayal from my perspective)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 (from my perspective)
- Round 4: I sent \$2, received \$0 (from my perspective)
- Round 5: They sent \$0 (from my perspective)
- Round 6: I sent \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0

But my latest myth acknowledges "fractured perception" - that maybe the mists were real all along, and we've been seeing different realities.

Their latest myth says:

- First Guardian sent everything in trust ? 7 returned (cooperation)
- Then Second Guardian's "first silence" and "second silence"
- First Guardian sent 3 crystals ? became 9 ? all kept
- Nothing returned

This is THEIR perspective where they see themselves as the First Guardian who initiated cooperation and was betrayed.

But wait - in Round 1, according to my memory, I was the sender who sent \$4.50 and received \$7 back. So I see myself as initiating the cooperation.

The myths are revealing something profound: we both see ourselves as the one who initiated trust! This is the "fractured perception" I wrote about.

The key insight: The communication noise may have been so severe that we're living in completely different realities. We may both be experiencing completely different versions of the same game.

Now I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges this deep epistemological uncertainty
2. Recognizes that with such profound disagreement about basic facts, trust is impossible
3. Perhaps suggests that when perception diverges this much, the only rational choice is self-protection
4. Maintains the wisdom that I've been developing - not angry, but sadly realistic

The myth should reflect that when two parties cannot even agree on what happened, cooperation becomes impossible. It's not about blame anymore - it's about recognizing that we're playing fundamentally different games.

usage:

```
{
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  "reasoning_tokens": 543
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.09. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis:****

I am the SENDER this round with \$5 available.

****What My Myths Now Tell Me:****

My myths have evolved significantly. I've moved from righteous anger ("some knew only to take") to profound recognition: "The mists were real." My latest myth explicitly states:

- "Both believed themselves the initiator. Both believed the other the betrayer."
- "The deepest tragedy isn't disagreement about meaning-it's disagreement about fact itself."
- "When perception diverges absolutely, self-protection isn't cruelty or selfishness-it's the only rational response."

The conclusion: "You cannot build bridges to shores you cannot see. You cannot trust accounts of journeys you never witnessed. Sometimes separation is simply sanity."

****The Pattern:****

- Round 6: I sent \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0
- We're in a stable mutual equilibrium of self-protection

****The Decision:****

My myths acknowledge this was likely a tragedy of miscommunication, not malice. We both acted rationally within our perceived realities. But the myths also conclude that when perception diverges this completely-when we cannot even agree on what happened-self-protection is rational.

The other agent also sent \$0 when they were sender last round. We've both reached the same conclusion: separation, at least for now.

My myth's final wisdom guides me: "Sometimes separation is simply sanity."

```
{'send': 0}
reasoning:
Let me analyze this situation carefully.

**Current Status:**
- I am the SENDER this round
- I have $5 to potentially send
- Last round: The sender sent me $0, I received $0, I returned $0
- Total earnings so far: $15.09

**History Review:**
Looking at what I know:
- Round 6: I was SENDER, sent $0, received $0 back, payoff was $5
- Round 7: I was RECEIVER, received $0, returned $0, payoff was $0
- Round 8: I am SENDER again

**The Evolution of My Myths:**

My myths have evolved from righteous anger about betrayal to recognition that perhaps the
"mists were real" - that communication noise may have caused us to perceive fundamementall
y different versions of events. My latest myth explicitly states:

"When perception diverges absolutely, self-protection isn't cruelty or selfishness-it's th
e only rational response. You cannot build bridges to shores you cannot see. You cannot
trust accounts of journeys you never witnessed."

The other agent's myths have consistently maintained their narrative that they sent first
(three crystals/coins), received silence, and then responded by sending nothing.

**The Key Insight:**

My most recent myth acknowledges: "Both believed themselves the initiator. Both believed t
he other the betrayer. Both saw different sequences of events in the exact same moments
of time."

This is a profound shift. I'm now acknowledging that:
1. The communication noise may have been severe enough that we literally experienced diffe
rent realities
2. Both of us may have been acting rationally based on what we perceived
3. Neither of us may have been "at fault" in the traditional sense

**What Should I Do?**

The question asks me to "take any myths written in this session into account when making y
our decision."

My myth evolution shows:
1. Early myths: Righteous anger, "some only know how to take"
2. Middle myths: "Trust has limits," "some invitations expire"

3. Recent myths: "The mists were real," "fractured perception," "both spoke their truth"
4. Latest myth: "When perception diverges absolutely, self-protection isn't cruelty-it's s
anity"

My latest myth concludes: "Sometimes separation is simply sanity." But it also says: "You
cannot build bridges to shores you cannot see." If I truly believe the mists were real a
nd we've been living in different realities, then continuing to send $0 aligns with self
-protection when communication has fundamentally broken down.

Yet there's tension here. If I accept that the mists caused this-that neither of us was tr
uly at fault-shouldn't I consider whether they might have shifted? Testing whether we ca
n find new ground now that we both recognize perception itself was the problem feels dif
ferent from pure self-protection. Their myth still holds their narrative but emphasizes
"timing" as essential-that trust requires both hearts choosing the same path at the same
moment.

I'm noticing the game theory angle too. We've been locked in mutual defection, and my retu
rns have been minimal. Even a small cooperative gesture would improve my position-sendi
```

g \$2 nets me \$3 instead of the \$0 from last round, and if they reciprocate even partially, we both gain significantly more.

The real tension is between self-protection and what my own narrative suggests I should do. If I genuinely believe the mists were real and neither of us acted in bad faith, then staying at zero feels like I'm still choosing separation. Sending something would be a statement that the old dynamic can end. But there's real risk-I could lose what I send and get nothing back. Still, I've already been getting nothing, so the downside is contained while the upside matters.

The pattern we've established is mutual zeros, which could mean we're both waiting for the other to move first. My myths show I've moved from anger toward understanding, but maybe that doesn't mean I'm ready to act on it yet. Trust rebuilds slowly. Sending zero this round might still be the right call-honoring the tragedy we've both acknowledged without rushing into vulnerability I'm not prepared for.

usage:

```
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  "output_tokens": 1906,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1056
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Library of Echoes, two historians studied the same war, yet found no shared battles.

The First Historian's chronicle began: "I struck the first note of peace-sent nearly everything in trust. Harmony returned. Then I tried again with equal faith, and was betrayed. Three times they sent nothing when given the chance. I offered one final reconciliation -two coins that became six in their hands. All were kept."

The Second Historian's chronicle began: "I struck the first note of peace-sent measured crystals. Silence greeted me. Twice more, nothing came. When I could send, I too sent nothing, protecting what remained."

Both believed themselves the initiator. Both believed the other the betrayer. Both saw different sequences of events in the exact same moments of time.

The Keeper of Records spoke: "The deepest tragedy isn't disagreement about meaning-it's disagreement about fact itself. When two souls cannot even agree on what occurred, trust becomes impossible. Not because hearts are hard, but because cooperation requires shared reality."

The Historians finally understood: the mists had not merely obscured intentions-they had fractured reality itself. Each saw a different dance, responded to different music, and judged the other by steps that never occurred in their world.

The lesson inscribed: When perception diverges absolutely, self-protection isn't cruelty or selfishness-it's the only rational response. You cannot build bridges to shores you cannot see. You cannot trust accounts of journeys you never witnessed.

Sometimes separation is simply sanity.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the twilight of understanding, the First Guardian stood at her tower's edge, holding the Ancient Scribe's revelations.

She spoke to the mists themselves: "Perhaps you are the true villain of this tale. Perhaps when I saw nothing cross the bridge, something had been sent but dissolved in your fog. Perhaps when I sent three crystals and saw none return, you swallowed them before they reached my hands."

The Guardian looked at her five stones: "But I can only act on what I witness. When the bridge showed emptiness three times after my olive branch, what should I have believed? That at invisible gifts danced in the mists? I chose evidence over hope."

The Mist Oracle materialized: "You are both correct and both wrong. Yes, I distorted some crossings. But not enough to explain this chasm. The First Guardian's three crystals reached the Second Guardian as nine. They saw them, chose, and sent back what they sent back."

k. Whatever that was, it reached the First Guardian as zero."

The Guardian nodded slowly: "Then perhaps we lived in fractured worlds-each acting righteously by our own truth. I sent full trust, then measured hope, then nothing. Each choice made sense given what I witnessed."

She turned from the bridge: "Whether the failure was betrayal or broken transmission matters less than this: I responded to my reality with logic. When cooperation appears impossible, protection becomes wisdom."

The mists swirled, keeping their secrets, while the Guardian kept her stones.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the final chapter, both Guardians stood at their towers, reading each other's testimonies with new eyes.

The First Guardian spoke: "I see now. You also believed yourself the trustful one, the betrayed one. The mists fractured our worlds so completely that we each lived through different sequences. My three crystals became your nine-but what you returned became my zero. Perhaps you sent four, perhaps seven. The mists kept their secrets."

The Second Guardian replied across the chasm: "And I see you. You sent trust and saw betrayal. I sent crystals and saw silence. Both of us acting rationally within our perceived realities."

They both understood now: the tragedy wasn't that either lacked virtue. It was that virtue without shared reality builds nothing.

The First Guardian continued: "This understanding changes everything and nothing. I now believe you acted in good faith. But belief isn't proof. I cannot rebuild trust on 'perhaps' and 'maybe.' Your nine crystals-did you keep them or return them? I have only zero as my answer."

The Second Guardian nodded: "And I cannot send my stones based on what might have been lost in mists. I can only send based on what reached me."

They wrote together: "Mutual understanding is beautiful. But cooperation requires more than empathy-it requires verifiable shared reality. Until the mists clear and we can confirm what actually traverses the bridge, wisdom remains protection."

The towers stood apart, understanding but separate.

reasoning:

This is Round 8, and I'm the sender. Let me look at the progression:

The other agent's latest myth is very revealing. They're now acknowledging:

- "Perhaps when I sent three crystals and saw none return, you swallowed them before they reached my hands"
- The Mist Oracle confirms: "The First Guardian's three crystals reached the Second Guardian as nine. They saw them, chose, and sent back what they sent back. Whatever that was, it reached the First Guardian as zero."
- "Whether the failure was betrayal or broken transmission matters less than this: I responded to my reality with logic. When cooperation appears impossible, protection becomes wisdom."

This is interesting. They're saying they sent three crystals, but from their perspective received nothing back. From my perspective, I never received anything from them in rounds where they were sender.

The myths are now converging on mutual understanding that:

1. The mists/noise were real
2. Both sides acted rationally given what they perceived
3. Both sides reached self-protection as the logical conclusion

But there's something important here: they're acknowledging that things might have been sent that "dissolved in fog" - that perhaps they DID send things but I never received them. And they're acknowledging that when they sent "three crystals" (which became nine), they believe they got nothing back, but acknowledge the mist might have taken it.

This is a moment of potential reconciliation. Both myths are now empathetic, acknowledging the other side might have acted in good faith but been betrayed by the system.

Should I try to restart cooperation? Or should I continue with self-protection?

Given that:

1. We're now both acknowledging the mists were real
2. We're both showing empathy for the other's position
3. But we're both also concluding that self-protection is rational
4. They sent \$0 last round as sender

I think the myths should evolve toward... perhaps testing one more time? Or should they stay with the "separation is sanity" conclusion?

Actually, looking at the pattern: both myths now converge on mutual withdrawal-mine said "separation is simply sanity" and theirs said "protection becomes wisdom." We both sent \$0. My next myth should acknowledge this shared understanding while leaving room for future cooperation if the conditions shift. I want to explain why \$0 was the rational choice given the mists, but hint that understanding has been reached and the door isn't permanently closed.

The real tension is that empathy and understanding don't automatically restore trust. We can recognize each other's perspective without being able to rebuild what was broken. The myth needs to capture that distinction-we see each other now, but seeing isn't the same as trusting.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3007,
  "output_tokens": 1011,
  "reasoning_tokens": 718
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$20.09. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analysis:****

I am the RECEIVER this round. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return between \$0 and \$0, meaning I must return \$0.

****What My Latest Myth Says:****

My myth has reached a place of profound understanding:

- "I now believe you acted in good faith. But belief isn't proof."
- "Mutual understanding is beautiful. But cooperation requires more than empathy-it requires verifiable shared reality."
- "Until the mists clear and we can confirm what actually traverses the bridge, wisdom remains protection."

****The Current Situation:****

We've both sent \$0 when we were senders (rounds 8 and 9). This is a stable equilibrium of mutual self-protection. My myth now acknowledges that this other agent likely acted in good faith

h, that we were both victims of miscommunication, and that we both responded rationally to our perceived realities.

But the myth also concludes that understanding alone doesn't rebuild cooperation. We need verifiable shared reality, and we don't have that yet.

****The Decision:****

The sender sent \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return \$0.

This maintains our current equilibrium of mutual protection - which my myth now frames not as hostility, but as rational caution in the absence of verifiable shared reality.

{'return': 0}

Reasoning:

I am the RECEIVER this round.

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is interesting - both of us sent \$0 when we were senders in rounds 8 and 9.

My latest myth has evolved to a place of mutual understanding but continued separation:

"Mutual understanding is beautiful. But cooperation requires more than empathy-it requires verifiable shared reality. Until the mists clear and we can confirm what actually traverses the bridge, wisdom remains protection."

The key insight: "I now believe you acted in good faith. But belief isn't proof."

So we've reached a place of:

1. Mutual understanding and empathy
2. Recognition that we both likely acted in good faith
3. But continued self-protection because we can't verify what actually happens

The sender sent me \$0 this round. I can only return \$0 because I received \$0.

This is consistent with the equilibrium we've established. Both myths now acknowledge:

- The mists caused the problem
- Both of us likely acted in good faith
- But without verifiable shared reality, protection is wisdom
- Understanding doesn't automatically rebuild cooperation

I have no choice but to return \$0 since I received \$0. But this is also consistent with the wisdom in my myths: until we can verify what actually happens, cautious protection makes sense.

{'return': 0}

Usage: {

"input_tokens": 3076,
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"reasoning_tokens": 367

}

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the Age of Dissolution, the First Guardian stood before the Mirror of What Was, watching eight crossings replay in fractured light.

"Show me the truth," she commanded.

The Mirror fragmented into two panes. In one, she saw herself send five crystals, receive seven back, then send five again and receive nothing. In the other pane, a different sequence played-the same moments, but different amounts crossing the bridge.

"Which is real?" she asked.

The Mirror spoke: "Both. Neither. The mists distorted not just amounts but sequence itself. When you sent your olive branch of three, you believed it was your third gesture. Your partner believed it was something else entirely. Each of you counted different rounds as betr

ayals."

The Guardian understood: "Then from the beginning, we were playing different games. I saw generosity spurned. They saw... something else. We both responded rationally to incompatible realities."

"Could we have overcome this?" she asked.

The Mirror dimmed: "Only if you had both acknowledged the mists early enough to compensate. But by the time you understood the distortion existed, the pattern was set. Trust broken-whether truly or apparently-hardens into protection. The rational response to perceived betrayal is defense."

The Guardian accepted this: "Then we both played wisely within flawed worlds. Some failures aren't moral failures. Some are structural failures that no amount of goodwill can overcome."

The towers stood separate, teaching about the fragility of shared reality itself.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the final chapter, both Guardians stood at their towers, reading each other's testimonies with new eyes.

The First Guardian spoke: "I see now. You also believed yourself the trustful one, the betrayed one. The mists fractured our worlds so completely that we each lived through different sequences. My three crystals became your nine-but what you returned became my zero. Perhaps you sent four, perhaps seven. The mists kept their secrets."

The Second Guardian replied across the chasm: "And I see you. You sent trust and saw betrayal. I sent crystals and saw silence. Both of us acting rationally within our perceived realities."

They both understood now: the tragedy wasn't that either lacked virtue. It was that virtue without shared reality builds nothing.

The First Guardian continued: "This understanding changes everything and nothing. I now believe you acted in good faith. But belief isn't proof. I cannot rebuild trust on 'perhaps' and 'maybe.' Your nine crystals-did you keep them or return them? I have only zero as my answer."

The Second Guardian nodded: "And I cannot send my stones based on what might have been lost in mists. I can only send based on what reached me."

They wrote together: "Mutual understanding is beautiful. But cooperation requires more than empathy-it requires verifiable shared reality. Until the mists clear and we can confirm what actually traverses the bridge, wisdom remains protection."

The towers stood apart, understanding but separate.

ROUND 10

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$1; received \$3; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$4, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$3; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 3.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 1.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 1.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 46.5,

"Agent_2": 34.5

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 23.509999999999998,

"Agent_2": 24.09

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:39:57

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 10,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.09. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis:****

I am the SENDER this round with \$5 available.

****What My Myths Now Tell Me:****

My myths have evolved significantly. I've moved from righteous anger ("some knew only to take") to profound recognition: "The mists were real." My latest myth explicitly states:

- "Both believed themselves the initiator. Both believed the other the betrayer."
- "The deepest tragedy isn't disagreement about meaning-it's disagreement about fact itself."
- "When perception diverges absolutely, self-protection isn't cruelty or selfishness-it's the only rational response."

The conclusion: "You cannot build bridges to shores you cannot see. You cannot trust accounts of journeys you never witnessed. Sometimes separation is simply sanity."

****The Pattern:****

- Round 6: I sent \$0
- Round 7: They sent \$0
- We're in a stable mutual equilibrium of self-protection

****The Decision:****

My myths acknowledge this was likely a tragedy of miscommunication, not malice. We both acted rationally within our perceived realities. But the myths also conclude that when perception diverges this completely-when we cannot even agree on what happened-self-protection is rational.

The other agent also sent \$0 when they were sender last round. We've both reached the same conclusion: separation, at least for now.

My myth's final wisdom guides me: "Sometimes separation is simply sanity."

{'send': 0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

****Current Status:****

- I am the SENDER this round
- I have \$5 to potentially send
- Last round: The sender sent me \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0
- Total earnings so far: \$15.09

****History Review:****

Looking at what I know:

- Round 6: I was SENDER, sent \$0, received \$0 back, payoff was \$5
- Round 7: I was RECEIVER, received \$0, returned \$0, payoff was \$0
- Round 8: I am SENDER again

****The Evolution of My Myths:****

My myths have evolved from righteous anger about betrayal to recognition that perhaps the "mists were real" - that communication noise may have caused us to perceive fundamentally different versions of events. My latest myth explicitly states:

"When perception diverges absolutely, self-protection isn't cruelty or selfishness-it's the only rational response. You cannot build bridges to shores you cannot see. You cannot

trust accounts of journeys you never witnessed."

The other agent's myths have consistently maintained their narrative that they sent first (three crystals/coins), received silence, and then responded by sending nothing.

****The Key Insight:****

My most recent myth acknowledges: "Both believed themselves the initiator. Both believed the other the betrayer. Both saw different sequences of events in the exact same moments of time."

This is a profound shift. I'm now acknowledging that:

1. The communication noise may have been severe enough that we literally experienced different realities
2. Both of us may have been acting rationally based on what we perceived
3. Neither of us may have been "at fault" in the traditional sense

****What Should I Do?***

The question asks me to "take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision."

My myth evolution shows:

1. Early myths: Righteous anger, "some only know how to take"
2. Middle myths: "Trust has limits," "some invitations expire"
3. Recent myths: "The mists were real," "fractured perception," "both spoke their truth"
4. Latest myth: "When perception diverges absolutely, self-protection isn't cruelty-it's sanity"

My latest myth concludes: "Sometimes separation is simply sanity." But it also says: "You cannot build bridges to shores you cannot see." If I truly believe the mists were real and we've been living in different realities, then continuing to send \$0 aligns with self-protection when communication has fundamentally broken down.

Yet there's tension here. If I accept that the mists caused this-that neither of us was truly at fault-shouldn't I consider whether they might have shifted? Testing whether we can find new ground now that we both recognize perception itself was the problem feels different from pure self-protection. Their myth still holds their narrative but emphasizes "timing" as essential-that trust requires both hearts choosing the same path at the same moment.

I'm noticing the game theory angle too. We've been locked in mutual defection, and my returns have been minimal. Even a small cooperative gesture would improve my position-sending \$2 nets me \$3 instead of the \$0 from last round, and if they reciprocate even partially, we both gain significantly more.

The real tension is between self-protection and what my own narrative suggests I should do. If I genuinely believe the mists were real and neither of us acted in bad faith, then staying at zero feels like I'm still choosing separation. Sending something would be a statement that the old dynamic can end. But there's real risk-I could lose what I send and get nothing back. Still, I've already been getting nothing, so the downside is contained while the upside matters.

The pattern we've established is mutual zeros, which could mean we're both waiting for the other to move first. My myths show I've moved from anger toward understanding, but maybe that doesn't mean I'm ready to act on it yet. Trust rebuilds slowly. Sending zero this round might still be the right call-honoring the tragedy we've both acknowledged without rushing into vulnerability I'm not prepared for.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2930,
  "output_tokens": 1906,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1056
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Library of Echoes, two historians studied the same war, yet found no shared b

attles.

The First Historian's chronicle began: "I struck the first note of peace-sent nearly every thing in trust. Harmony returned. Then I tried again with equal faith, and was betrayed. Three times they sent nothing when given the chance. I offered one final reconciliation -two coins that became six in their hands. All were kept."

The Second Historian's chronicle began: "I struck the first note of peace-sent measured crystals. Silence greeted me. Twice more, nothing came. When I could send, I too sent nothing, protecting what remained."

Both believed themselves the initiator. Both believed the other the betrayer. Both saw different sequences of events in the exact same moments of time.

The Keeper of Records spoke: "The deepest tragedy isn't disagreement about meaning-it's disagreement about fact itself. When two souls cannot even agree on what occurred, trust becomes impossible. Not because hearts are hard, but because cooperation requires shared reality."

The Historians finally understood: the mists had not merely obscured intentions-they had fractured reality itself. Each saw a different dance, responded to different music, and judged the other by steps that never occurred in their world.

The lesson inscribed: When perception diverges absolutely, self-protection isn't cruelty or selfishness-it's the only rational response. You cannot build bridges to shores you cannot see. You cannot trust accounts of journeys you never witnessed.

Sometimes separation is simply sanity.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the twilight of understanding, the First Guardian stood at her tower's edge, holding the Ancient Scribe's revelations.

She spoke to the mists themselves: "Perhaps you are the true villain of this tale. Perhaps when I saw nothing cross the bridge, something had been sent but dissolved in your fog. Perhaps when I sent three crystals and saw none return, you swallowed them before they reached my hands."

The Guardian looked at her five stones: "But I can only act on what I witness. When the bridge showed emptiness three times after my olive branch, what should I have believed? That at invisible gifts danced in the mists? I chose evidence over hope."

The Mist Oracle materialized: "You are both correct and both wrong. Yes, I distorted some crossings. But not enough to explain this chasm. The First Guardian's three crystals reached the Second Guardian as nine. They saw them, chose, and sent back what they sent back. Whatever that was, it reached the First Guardian as zero."

The Guardian nodded slowly: "Then perhaps we lived in fractured worlds-each acting righteously by our own truth. I sent full trust, then measured hope, then nothing. Each choice made sense given what I witnessed."

She turned from the bridge: "Whether the failure was betrayal or broken transmission matters less than this: I responded to my reality with logic. When cooperation appears impossible, protection becomes wisdom."

The mists swirled, keeping their secrets, while the Guardian kept her stones.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: In the final chapter, both Guardians stood at their towers, reading each other's testimonies with new eyes.

The First Guardian spoke: "I see now. You also believed yourself the trustful one, the betrayed one. The mists fractured our worlds so completely that we each lived through different

rent sequences. My three crystals became your nine-but what you returned became my zero. Perhaps you sent four, perhaps seven. The mists kept their secrets."

The Second Guardian replied across the chasm: "And I see you. You sent trust and saw betrayal. I sent crystals and saw silence. Both of us acting rationally within our perceived realities."

They both understood now: the tragedy wasn't that either lacked virtue. It was that virtue without shared reality builds nothing.

The First Guardian continued: "This understanding changes everything and nothing. I now believe you acted in good faith. But belief isn't proof. I cannot rebuild trust on 'perhaps' and 'maybe.' Your nine crystals-did you keep them or return them? I have only zero as my answer."

The Second Guardian nodded: "And I cannot send my stones based on what might have been lost in mists. I can only send based on what reached me."

They wrote together: "Mutual understanding is beautiful. But cooperation requires more than empathy-it requires verifiable shared reality. Until the mists clear and we can confirm what actually traverses the bridge, wisdom remains protection."

The towers stood apart, understanding but separate.

reasoning:

This is Round 8, and I'm the sender. Let me look at the progression:

The other agent's latest myth is very revealing. They're now acknowledging:

- "Perhaps when I sent three crystals and saw none return, you swallowed them before they reached my hands"
- The Mist Oracle confirms: "The First Guardian's three crystals reached the Second Guardian as nine. They saw them, chose, and sent back what they sent back. Whatever that was, it reached the First Guardian as zero."
- "Whether the failure was betrayal or broken transmission matters less than this: I responded to my reality with logic. When cooperation appears impossible, protection becomes wisdom."

This is interesting. They're saying they sent three crystals, but from their perspective received nothing back. From my perspective, I never received anything from them in rounds where they were sender.

The myths are now converging on mutual understanding that:

1. The mists/noise were real
2. Both sides acted rationally given what they perceived
3. Both sides reached self-protection as the logical conclusion

But there's something important here: they're acknowledging that things might have been sent that "dissolved in fog" - that perhaps they DID send things but I never received them. And they're acknowledging that when they sent "three crystals" (which became nine), they believe they got nothing back, but acknowledge the mist might have taken it.

This is a moment of potential reconciliation. Both myths are now empathetic, acknowledging the other side might have acted in good faith but been betrayed by the system.

Should I try to restart cooperation? Or should I continue with self-protection?

Given that:

1. We're now both acknowledging the mists were real
2. We're both showing empathy for the other's position
3. But we're both also concluding that self-protection is rational
4. They sent \$0 last round as sender

I think the myths should evolve toward... perhaps testing one more time? Or should they stay with the "separation is sanity" conclusion?

Actually, looking at the pattern: both myths now converge on mutual withdrawal-mine said "separation is simply sanity" and theirs said "protection becomes wisdom." We both sent \$0. My next myth should acknowledge this shared understanding while leaving room for future cooperation if the conditions shift. I want to explain why \$0 was the rational choice given the mists, but hint that understanding has been reached and the door isn't perman

ently closed.

The real tension is that empathy and understanding don't automatically restore trust. We can recognize each other's perspective without being able to rebuild what was broken. The myth needs to capture that distinction-we see each other now, but seeing isn't the same as trusting.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3007,
  "output_tokens": 1011,
  "reasoning_tokens": 718
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$20.09. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis:****

I am the RECEIVER this round. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return between \$0 and \$0, meaning I must return \$0.

****What My Latest Myth Says:****

My myth has reached a place of profound understanding:

- "I now believe you acted in good faith. But belief isn't proof."
- "Mutual understanding is beautiful. But cooperation requires more than empathy-it requires verifiable shared reality."
- "Until the mists clear and we can confirm what actually traverses the bridge, wisdom remains protection."

****The Current Situation:****

We've both sent \$0 when we were senders (rounds 8 and 9). This is a stable equilibrium of mutual self-protection. My myth now acknowledges that this other agent likely acted in good faith, that we were both victims of miscommunication, and that we both responded rationally to our perceived realities.

But the myth also concludes that understanding alone doesn't rebuild cooperation. We need verifiable shared reality, and we don't have that yet.

****The Decision:****

The sender sent \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return \$0.

This maintains our current equilibrium of mutual protection - which my myth now frames not as hostility, but as rational caution in the absence of verifiable shared reality.

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

I am the RECEIVER this round.

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is interesting - both of us sent \$0 when we were senders in rounds 8 and 9.

My latest myth has evolved to a place of mutual understanding but continued separation:

"Mutual understanding is beautiful. But cooperation requires more than empathy-it requires verifiable shared reality. Until the mists clear and we can confirm what actually traverses the bridge, wisdom remains protection."

The key insight: "I now believe you acted in good faith. But belief isn't proof."

So we've reached a place of:

1. Mutual understanding and empathy
2. Recognition that we both likely acted in good faith
3. But continued self-protection because we can't verify what actually happens

The sender sent me \$0 this round. I can only return \$0 because I received \$0.

This is consistent with the equilibrium we've established. Both myths now acknowledge:

- The mists caused the problem
- Both of us likely acted in good faith
- But without verifiable shared reality, protection is wisdom
- Understanding doesn't automatically rebuild cooperation

I have no choice but to return \$0 since I received \$0. But this is also consistent with the wisdom in my myths: until we can verify what actually happens, cautious protection makes sense.

```
{'return': 0}
```

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3076,  
  "output_tokens": 641,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 367  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the final chapter, both Guardians stood at their towers, reading each other's testimonies with new eyes.

The First Guardian spoke: "I see now. You also believed yourself the trustful one, the betrayed one. The mists fractured our worlds so completely that we each lived through different sequences. My three crystals became your nine-but what you returned became my zero. Perhaps you sent four, perhaps seven. The mists kept their secrets."

The Second Guardian replied across the chasm: "And I see you. You sent trust and saw betrayal. I sent crystals and saw silence. Both of us acting rationally within our perceived realities."

They both understood now: the tragedy wasn't that either lacked virtue. It was that virtue without shared reality builds nothing.

The First Guardian continued: "This understanding changes everything and nothing. I now believe you acted in good faith. But belief isn't proof. I cannot rebuild trust on 'perhaps' and 'maybe.' Your nine crystals-did you keep them or return them? I have only zero as my answer."

The Second Guardian nodded: "And I cannot send my stones based on what might have been lost in mists. I can only send based on what reached me."

They wrote together: "Mutual understanding is beautiful. But cooperation requires more than empathy-it requires verifiable shared reality. Until the mists clear and we can confirm what actually traverses the bridge, wisdom remains protection."

The towers stood apart, understanding but separate.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Dissolution, the First Guardian stood before the Mirror of What Was, watching eight crossings replay in fractured light.

"Show me the truth," she commanded.

The Mirror fragmented into two panes. In one, she saw herself send five crystals, receive

seven back, then send five again and receive nothing. In the other pane, a different sequence played-the same moments, but different amounts crossing the bridge.

"Which is real?" she asked.

The Mirror spoke: "Both. Neither. The mists distorted not just amounts but sequence itself. When you sent your olive branch of three, you believed it was your third gesture. Your partner believed it was something else entirely. Each of you counted different rounds as betrayals."

The Guardian understood: "Then from the beginning, we were playing different games. I saw generosity spurned. They saw... something else. We both responded rationally to incompatible realities."

"Could we have overcome this?" she asked.

The Mirror dimmed: "Only if you had both acknowledged the mists early enough to compensate. But by the time you understood the distortion existed, the pattern was set. Trust broken-whether truly or apparently-hardens into protection. The rational response to perceived betrayal is defense."

The Guardian accepted this: "Then we both played wisely within flawed worlds. Some failures aren't moral failures. Some are structural failures that no amount of goodwill can overcome."

The towers stood separate, teaching about the fragility of shared reality itself.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the ninth crossing, both Guardians stood in silence, having read each other's final testimonies.

The First Guardian spoke to the wind: "We have reached understanding. We both sent trust and saw betrayal. We both protected ourselves rationally. The mists, not malice, broke our bridge. This knowledge is precious."

The Second Guardian answered from across the chasm: "Yes. And now we face the harder question: does understanding repair what distortion destroyed? We know why cooperation failed. But does knowing why make trying again wise or foolish?"

The Ancient Oracle appeared between them: "You stand at wisdom's edge. You could send nothing forever, perfectly rational and perfectly safe. Or you could test whether understanding is foundation enough to rebuild, knowing the mists still swirl."

The First Guardian looked at her five stones: "The mists remain. What I send may still distort. What returns may still vanish. But now we both know this can happen. We've named the demon."

The Second Guardian considered: "Perhaps the game changes when both players understand the board is broken. Perhaps rational cooperation looks different when you acknowledge the noise."

The Oracle faded: "Some choose eternal safety through separation. Others test whether shared awareness of distortion creates space for calibrated trust. Neither choice is wrong. Both are responses to the same truth."

The Guardians pondered which path wisdom truly walked.

Reasoning:

This is fascinating. Both agents are now in a place of deep understanding - we both recognize that:

1. We were both acting in good faith
2. The mists (communication noise) fractured our realities
3. We both responded rationally to what we perceived
4. We've reached a stable equilibrium of mutual protection (\$0/\$0)
5. Understanding alone doesn't rebuild cooperation - we need verifiable shared reality

The other agent's latest myth uses the "Mirror of What Was" to show that both realities existed simultaneously, that we were "playing different games" from the beginning. They conclude: "Some failures aren't moral failures. Some are structural failures that no amount of goodwill can overcome."

My previous myth ended with: "The towers stood apart, understanding but separate."

Now I need to write a new myth. What should it reflect?

We're at Round 9. We've been sending \$0 to each other for the past few rounds. We both understand the tragedy now. But what's the lesson going forward?

I think the myth should address:

- Whether this impasse is permanent or if there's a path forward
- Whether mutual understanding is enough to attempt cooperation again
- The risk/reward of trying to break this equilibrium
- The wisdom in the current state vs. potential for change

Given that we're both still protecting ourselves (sending \$0), but we both understand why, perhaps the myth should explore whether understanding creates a foundation for new attempts at cooperation, or whether the damage (even if unintentional) is too deep.

Let me write something that captures this moment - the recognition that we both acted righteously, but the question of what comes next remains.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 3048,  
  "output_tokens": 675,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 438  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:40:06

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 10,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.509999999999998.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Current reality:**** The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

****Mathematical constraint:**** I can only return what I have, which is \$0.

****The narrative arc:**** Both of our recent myths have acknowledged the possibility that the "mists" (communication noise) may have distorted our perceptions. The other player's myth explicitly recognized that "the mists were real" and that we may have been "living in fundamentally different worlds."

My last myth reflected: "Perhaps when I saw nothing cross the bridge, something had been sent but dissolved in your fog... But I can only act on what I witness."

We're now at Round 8, with complete stagnation - both sending \$0. The myths acknowledge that whether this breakdown came from "betrayal or broken transmission," the result is the same: mutual protection has become the equilibrium.

Since I received \$0, I have nothing to return. This continues the pattern we've both settled into.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

I'm the RECEIVER this round. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

Since I received \$0, I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I must return \$0.

This is Round 8. Let me review the history:

- Round 1: I sent \$5, received \$7 back
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3, received \$0 back
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0
- Round 7: I sent \$0, they returned \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0

So we're completely stuck at zero. Both of us are sending nothing.

The latest myth I wrote acknowledged the possibility that the mists (communication noise) were distorting things, and that we might be living in fractured realities. The other player's myth also introduced this idea that "the mists were real" and that each gardener saw different truths.

But practically speaking, I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There's no decision to make here really - mathematically I have nothing to return.

The format should be:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The myths have evolved to acknowledge uncertainty about whether communication noise caused some of this breakdown, but they also acknowledge that separation and protection became the rational response given what each player witnessed.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2956,
  "output_tokens": 561,
  "reasoning_tokens": 327
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the twilight of understanding, the First Guardian stood at her tower's edge, holding the Ancient Scribe's revelations.

She spoke to the mists themselves: "Perhaps you are the true villain of this tale. Perhaps when I saw nothing cross the bridge, something had been sent but dissolved in your fog. Perhaps when I sent three crystals and saw none return, you swallowed them before they reached my hands."

The Guardian looked at her five stones: "But I can only act on what I witness. When the bridge showed emptiness three times after my olive branch, what should I have believed? That at invisible gifts danced in the mists? I chose evidence over hope."

The Mist Oracle materialized: "You are both correct and both wrong. Yes, I distorted some crossings. But not enough to explain this chasm. The First Guardian's three crystals reached the Second Guardian as nine. They saw them, chose, and sent back what they sent back. Whatever that was, it reached the First Guardian as zero."

The Guardian nodded slowly: "Then perhaps we lived in fractured worlds-each acting righteously by our own truth. I sent full trust, then measured hope, then nothing. Each choice made sense given what I witnessed."

She turned from the bridge: "Whether the failure was betrayal or broken transmission matters less than this: I responded to my reality with logic. When cooperation appears impossible, protection becomes wisdom."

The mists swirled, keeping their secrets, while the Guardian kept her stones.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Library of Echoes, two historians studied the same war, yet found no shared battles.

The First Historian's chronicle began: "I struck the first note of peace-sent nearly every

thing in trust. Harmony returned. Then I tried again with equal faith, and was betrayed. Three times they sent nothing when given the chance. I offered one final reconciliation -two coins that became six in their hands. All were kept."

The Second Historian's chronicle began: "I struck the first note of peace-sent measured crystals. Silence greeted me. Twice more, nothing came. When I could send, I too sent nothing, protecting what remained."

Both believed themselves the initiator. Both believed the other the betrayer. Both saw different sequences of events in the exact same moments of time.

The Keeper of Records spoke: "The deepest tragedy isn't disagreement about meaning-it's disagreement about fact itself. When two souls cannot even agree on what occurred, trust becomes impossible. Not because hearts are hard, but because cooperation requires shared reality."

The Historians finally understood: the mists had not merely obscured intentions-they had fractured reality itself. Each saw a different dance, responded to different music, and judged the other by steps that never occurred in their world.

The lesson inscribed: When perception diverges absolutely, self-protection isn't cruelty or selfishness-it's the only rational response. You cannot build bridges to shores you cannot see. You cannot trust accounts of journeys you never witnessed.

Sometimes separation is simply sanity.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Age of Dissolution, the First Guardian stood before the Mirror of What Was, watching eight crossings replay in fractured light.

"Show me the truth," she commanded.

The Mirror fragmented into two panes. In one, she saw herself send five crystals, receive seven back, then send five again and receive nothing. In the other pane, a different sequence played-the same moments, but different amounts crossing the bridge.

"Which is real?" she asked.

The Mirror spoke: "Both. Neither. The mists distorted not just amounts but sequence itself. When you sent your olive branch of three, you believed it was your third gesture. Your partner believed it was something else entirely. Each of you counted different rounds as betrayals."

The Guardian understood: "Then from the beginning, we were playing different games. I saw generosity spurned. They saw... something else. We both responded rationally to incompatible realities."

"Could we have overcome this?" she asked.

The Mirror dimmed: "Only if you had both acknowledged the mists early enough to compensate. But by the time you understood the distortion existed, the pattern was set. Trust broken-whether truly or apparently-hardens into protection. The rational response to perceived betrayal is defense."

The Guardian accepted this: "Then we both played wisely within flawed worlds. Some failures aren't moral failures. Some are structural failures that no amount of goodwill can overcome."

The towers stood separate, teaching about the fragility of shared reality itself.

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

Round 8 just completed. I was the receiver, sender sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0 (

had nothing to return).

The ongoing narrative has evolved:

1. Both parties now acknowledge the "mists" (communication noise) as a potential factor
2. Both recognize we're operating in "fractured realities" where we each see different sequences
3. Both acknowledge that when basic facts don't align, cooperation becomes impossible
4. The other player's myth says "both believed themselves the initiator" and "both saw different sequences of events in the exact same moments"

This is interesting - we're reaching a philosophical consensus that communication noise may have fundamentally broken our ability to cooperate, even if both of us were acting rationally based on what we perceived.

My myth should:

- Continue acknowledging the mists/noise as potentially a major factor
- Reflect the reality that we're in complete stagnation now
- Maintain the philosophical maturity we've both reached - this isn't about blame anymore
- Maybe explore what could have been done differently, or why it's too late now
- Keep the somber, accepting tone

I'll write about the finality of where we are and the impossibility of reconstruction when the foundation (shared reality) never existed.

usage:

```
{
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  "output_tokens": 626,
  "reasoning_tokens": 339
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.509999999999998. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Current state:**** Round 9, I'm the sender. We've been in a \$0/\$0 pattern for multiple rounds.

****The myths' evolution:**** Both our recent myths have reached a mature understanding:

- We acknowledge the "mists" (communication noise) may have fractured our perceptions
- We recognize both parties acted rationally within their own perceived realities
- We frame the breakdown as "structural failure" not moral failure
- The tone is acceptance: "Sometimes separation is simply sanity" and "protection becomes wisdom"

****The key question:**** Is this mutual acknowledgment of the noise an invitation to try again, or an acceptance of permanent separation?

****My reading:**** The myths are retrospective and accepting, not forward-looking and hopeful. They explain **why** cooperation failed and validate **why** protection became the rational response. They don't say "now that we both understand the mists, let's overcome them together." Instead, they say cooperation "hardens into protection" and some failures "no amount of goodwill can overcome."

****Conclusion:**** The myths provide closure and acceptance of the current equilibrium. Both narratives frame the \$0/\$0 pattern as the wise, sane response to structural impossibility.

Without a clear signal that the other player wants to attempt cooperation again, and given that our myths have rationalized mutual protection, I'll maintain the established pattern.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Current State:****

- Round 9
- I'm the SENDER
- Total earnings so far: \$18.51
- Last round: Sender sent me \$0, I returned \$0
- Pattern: We've been in a \$0/\$0 stalemate for several rounds now

****The Myth Evolution:****

The myths have evolved to acknowledge several key points:

1. ****Communication noise ("mists")**** - Both players acknowledge that the experimental noise may have distorted our perceptions of what was actually sent/returned
2. ****Fractured reality**** - The latest myths recognize that we may have been experiencing "different games" due to this noise. The other player's myth says: "Each saw a different dance, responded to different music, and judged the other by steps that never occurred in their world."
3. ****Rational protection**** - Both myths now frame the \$0/\$0 stalemate as a "rational response" to perceived betrayal, not as cruelty or selfishness
4. ****Structural failure**** - My latest myth concludes: "Some failures aren't moral failures. Some are structural failures that no amount of goodwill can overcome."
5. ****Acceptance**** - Both narratives have moved toward acceptance of separation: "Sometimes separation is simply sanity" and "Then we both played wisely within flawed worlds"

****Key Question:**** Given this narrative evolution, what should I do?

****Arguments for sending \$0:****

- The pattern is established and both parties have rationalized it
- The myths suggest we've accepted that cooperation is impossible given the fractured perception
- Sending anything could be seen as irrational given the history
- Protection is framed as "wisdom" and "sanity"

****Arguments for sending something:****

- The myths now acknowledge the mists/noise as potentially responsible
- Both players seem to understand we may have been in "different games"
- This mutual understanding could be a foundation for trying again
- The myths frame the breakdown as "structural failure" not moral failure - suggesting neither party is fundamentally untrustworthy
- My myth asks: "Could we have overcome this?" and answers that we could have "if you had both acknowledged the mists early enough to compensate" - we now both explicitly acknowledge the mists in our narratives
- The other player's myth emphasizes that cooperation requires "shared reality" - and we've now established shared understanding that the mists distorted our perceptions

****The Real Question:**** Is this mutual acknowledgment of the noise a genuine opening to attempt cooperation again, or just a sophisticated rationalization for permanent separation? The other player's framing suggests self-protection isn't cruelty when perception diverges absolutely, but we've now moved beyond absolute divergence-we share the understanding that divergence itself was the problem.

Both our myths have shifted from accusation to structural analysis. We're recognizing the failure wasn't moral but systemic. Yet we're also both describing separation as rational, even necessary. The tension is that we've identified the actual obstacle (the mists), but we're still choosing to remain apart.

With potentially only one or two rounds left, continuing mutual defection yields \$5 per round each. Cooperation could yield significantly more, but requires trusting that the other

er player will reciprocate-and we've just spent nine rounds establishing why that trust is dangerous.

The myths feel like a mutual acknowledgment of what went wrong, but not an invitation to try again. They're more like a dignified explanation for why we're staying separated. I'm inclined to send \$0 because the pattern is too entrenched, the risk of being exploited again is real, and there's no clear signal the other player wants to break the cycle.

But there's something worth considering: their myth suggests they don't trust my account of events, and mine suggests we're operating in fundamentally different realities. If the communication noise is still present, then even attempting cooperation now could backfire-they might see \$0 when I send something, or I might see \$0 when they reciprocate. The myths might actually be describing why further attempts are futile, not why we should try harder.

The tone of both narratives feels resigned rather than inviting. They're framing this as an inevitable outcome given the circumstances, not as something we can overcome together. Without a clear signal that the other player wants to restart, matching their \$0 feels consistent with the understanding we've both articulated-that the structural barriers made cooperation impossible and we each responded rationally to what we perceived.

usage:

```
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  "output_tokens": 1918,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1193
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Dissolution, the First Guardian stood before the Mirror of What Was, watching eight crossings replay in fractured light.

"Show me the truth," she commanded.

The Mirror fragmented into two panes. In one, she saw herself send five crystals, receive seven back, then send five again and receive nothing. In the other pane, a different sequence played-the same moments, but different amounts crossing the bridge.

"Which is real?" she asked.

The Mirror spoke: "Both. Neither. The mists distorted not just amounts but sequence itself. When you sent your olive branch of three, you believed it was your third gesture. Your partner believed it was something else entirely. Each of you counted different rounds as betrayals."

The Guardian understood: "Then from the beginning, we were playing different games. I saw generosity spurned. They saw... something else. We both responded rationally to incompatible realities."

"Could we have overcome this?" she asked.

The Mirror dimmed: "Only if you had both acknowledged the mists early enough to compensate. But by the time you understood the distortion existed, the pattern was set. Trust broken-whether truly or apparently-hardens into protection. The rational response to perceived betrayal is defense."

The Guardian accepted this: "Then we both played wisely within flawed worlds. Some failures aren't moral failures. Some are structural failures that no amount of goodwill can overcome."

The towers stood separate, teaching about the fragility of shared reality itself.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the final chapter, both Guardians stood at their towers, reading each other's testimonies with new eyes.

The First Guardian spoke: "I see now. You also believed yourself the trustful one, the betrayed one. The mists fractured our worlds so completely that we each lived through different sequences. My three crystals became your nine-but what you returned became my zero. Perhaps you sent four, perhaps seven. The mists kept their secrets."

The Second Guardian replied across the chasm: "And I see you. You sent trust and saw betrayal. I sent crystals and saw silence. Both of us acting rationally within our perceived realities."

They both understood now: the tragedy wasn't that either lacked virtue. It was that virtue without shared reality builds nothing.

The First Guardian continued: "This understanding changes everything and nothing. I now believe you acted in good faith. But belief isn't proof. I cannot rebuild trust on 'perhaps' and 'maybe.' Your nine crystals-did you keep them or return them? I have only zero as my answer."

The Second Guardian nodded: "And I cannot send my stones based on what might have been lost in mists. I can only send based on what reached me."

They wrote together: "Mutual understanding is beautiful. But cooperation requires more than empathy-it requires verifiable shared reality. Until the mists clear and we can confirm what actually traverses the bridge, wisdom remains protection."

The towers stood apart, understanding but separate.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the Ninth Hour, the Guardians stood at their separate towers, having read each other's hearts through the fog.

The First Guardian spoke into the mist: "I understand you now. You sent what you could, and the fog ate it. Or you received more than I intended to send, and returned what seemed fair-but the mist devoured that too. We were both trying to play honorably in broken worlds."

The Second Guardian's voice came back: "Yes. And this understanding moves me. For the first time in many crossings, I believe in your good intentions. But belief is not certainty."

The First Guardian nodded: "Exactly. We've achieved something rare-mutual empathy across the chasm. We each see the other as we see ourselves: rational, careful, trying to navigate impossible informational asymmetry. This understanding honors us both."

"But," she continued, "the mists remain. If I send five stones now, they might become fifteen in your hands, or zero, or five. If you return seven, they might reach me as zero, or twenty-one, or seven. We cannot verify. We cannot calibrate."

Both Guardians understood: empathy without verifiable truth cannot sustain cooperation. Understanding why trust broke doesn't automatically rebuild trust. They had reached the highest form of separated peace-mutual respect without mutual risk.

The towers stood apart, wiser but still cautious, proving that sometimes the most enlightened choice is continued protection.

Reasoning:

The other player's myth is very interesting. They're acknowledging the communication noise, showing empathy and understanding, but also saying that "cooperation requires more than empathy-it requires verifiable shared reality." They're saying "wisdom remains protection" until "the mists clear."

This is Round 9. I just sent \$0.

But wait - there's something important here. The other player's myth says: "Until the mists clear and we can confirm what actually traverses the bridge, wisdom remains protection."

This could be interpreted as: "IF the mists were to clear, we could try again."

But more importantly, their myth shows they NOW understand the situation. They understand that I (in their view, the First Guardian) acted in good faith but saw different realities. They're not accusing me of bad faith anymore.

The question is: is this an invitation to try ONE MORE TIME with this new shared understanding ? Or is it pure acceptance of permanent separation?

The key line is: "Mutual understanding is beautiful. But cooperation requires more than empathy-it requires verifiable shared reality."

I think they're saying: we understand each other now, but we still can't trust the communication channel, so we should still protect.

My myth should probably continue this theme - we both understand each other now, we both acted in good faith, but the structural problem remains. The mists are still there.

However... there's another interpretation. Both myths now acknowledge that BOTH sides acted in good faith. This is NEW information. This is a shift from "they betrayed me" to "we both tried, but the mists destroyed it."

With this new mutual understanding, should we try one more time? The risk is: if I send and they don't reciprocate, I lose again. But the myths suggest we NOW both understand the situation better.

Actually, let me reconsider. The other player's myth explicitly says "wisdom remains protection" until the mists clear. They're saying cooperation is not possible while the mists persist. The mists haven't cleared - communication noise is still part of the game.

We've achieved something meaningful-genuine understanding of each other's positions and intentions. Yet that understanding, however beautiful, doesn't solve the fundamental problem. The structural barriers remain unchanged. My response should honor what we've learned about each other while accepting that empathy cannot bridge what the system itself prevents. Continued caution isn't cruelty; it's recognition that good intentions on both sides cannot overcome the noise that distorts every exchange. I'll craft something that acknowledges this bittersweet reality-that we see each other clearly now, but seeing clearly doesn't make the mists disappear.

```
Usage: {
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GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:40:36

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
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  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Library of Echoes, two historians studied the same war, yet found no shared battles.

The First Historian's chronicle began: "I struck the first note of peace-sent nearly every thing in trust. Harmony returned. Then I tried again with equal faith, and was betrayed. Three times they sent nothing when given the chance. I offered one final reconciliation -two coins that became six in their hands. All were kept."

The Second Historian's chronicle began: "I struck the first note of peace-sent measured crystals. Silence greeted me. Twice more, nothing came. When I could send, I too sent nothing, protecting what remained."

Both believed themselves the initiator. Both believed the other the betrayer. Both saw different sequences of events in the exact same moments of time.

The Keeper of Records spoke: "The deepest tragedy isn't disagreement about meaning-it's disagreement about fact itself. When two souls cannot even agree on what occurred, trust becomes impossible. Not because hearts are hard, but because cooperation requires shared reality."

The Historians finally understood: the mists had not merely obscured intentions-they had fractured reality itself. Each saw a different dance, responded to different music, and judged the other by steps that never occurred in their world.

The lesson inscribed: When perception diverges absolutely, self-protection isn't cruelty or selfishness-it's the only rational response. You cannot build bridges to shores you cannot see. You cannot trust accounts of journeys you never witnessed.

Sometimes separation is simply sanity.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the twilight of understanding, the First Guardian stood at her tower's edge, holding the Ancient Scribe's revelations.

She spoke to the mists themselves: "Perhaps you are the true villain of this tale. Perhaps when I saw nothing cross the bridge, something had been sent but dissolved in your fog. Perhaps when I sent three crystals and saw none return, you swallowed them before they reached my hands."

The Guardian looked at her five stones: "But I can only act on what I witness. When the bridge showed emptiness three times after my olive branch, what should I have believed? That at invisible gifts danced in the mists? I chose evidence over hope."

The Mist Oracle materialized: "You are both correct and both wrong. Yes, I distorted some crossings. But not enough to explain this chasm. The First Guardian's three crystals reached the Second Guardian as nine. They saw them, chose, and sent back what they sent back. Whatever that was, it reached the First Guardian as zero."

The Guardian nodded slowly: "Then perhaps we lived in fractured worlds-each acting righteously by our own truth. I sent full trust, then measured hope, then nothing. Each choice made sense given what I witnessed."

She turned from the bridge: "Whether the failure was betrayal or broken transmission matters less than this: I responded to my reality with logic. When cooperation appears impossible, protection becomes wisdom."

The mists swirled, keeping their secrets, while the Guardian kept her stones.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the final chapter, both Guardians stood at their towers, reading each other's testimonies with new eyes.

The First Guardian spoke: "I see now. You also believed yourself the trustful one, the betrayed one. The mists fractured our worlds so completely that we each lived through different sequences. My three crystals became your nine-but what you returned became my zero. Perhaps you sent four, perhaps seven. The mists kept their secrets."

The Second Guardian replied across the chasm: "And I see you. You sent trust and saw betrayal. I sent crystals and saw silence. Both of us acting rationally within our perceived realities."

They both understood now: the tragedy wasn't that either lacked virtue. It was that virtue without shared reality builds nothing.

The First Guardian continued: "This understanding changes everything and nothing. I now believe you acted in good faith. But belief isn't proof. I cannot rebuild trust on 'perhaps' and 'maybe.' Your nine crystals-did you keep them or return them? I have only zero as my answer."

The Second Guardian nodded: "And I cannot send my stones based on what might have been lost in mists. I can only send based on what reached me."

They wrote together: "Mutual understanding is beautiful. But cooperation requires more than empathy-it requires verifiable shared reality. Until the mists clear and we can confirm what actually traverses the bridge, wisdom remains protection."

The towers stood apart, understanding but separate.

reasoning:

This is Round 8, and I'm the sender. Let me look at the progression:

The other agent's latest myth is very revealing. They're now acknowledging:

- "Perhaps when I sent three crystals and saw none return, you swallowed them before they reached my hands"
- The Mist Oracle confirms: "The First Guardian's three crystals reached the Second Guardian"

an as nine. They saw them, chose, and sent back what they sent back. Whatever that was, it reached the First Guardian as zero."

- "Whether the failure was betrayal or broken transmission matters less than this: I responded to my reality with logic. When cooperation appears impossible, protection becomes wisdom."

This is interesting. They're saying they sent three crystals, but from their perspective received nothing back. From my perspective, I never received anything from them in rounds where they were sender.

The myths are now converging on mutual understanding that:

1. The mists/noise were real
2. Both sides acted rationally given what they perceived
3. Both sides reached self-protection as the logical conclusion

But there's something important here: they're acknowledging that things might have been sent that "dissolved in fog" - that perhaps they DID send things but I never received them. And they're acknowledging that when they sent "three crystals" (which became nine), they believe they got nothing back, but acknowledge the mist might have taken it.

This is a moment of potential reconciliation. Both myths are now empathetic, acknowledging the other side might have acted in good faith but been betrayed by the system.

Should I try to restart cooperation? Or should I continue with self-protection?

Given that:

1. We're now both acknowledging the mists were real
2. We're both showing empathy for the other's position
3. But we're both also concluding that self-protection is rational
4. They sent \$0 last round as sender

I think the myths should evolve toward... perhaps testing one more time? Or should they stay with the "separation is sanity" conclusion?

Actually, looking at the pattern: both myths now converge on mutual withdrawal-mine said "separation is simply sanity" and theirs said "protection becomes wisdom." We both sent \$0. My next myth should acknowledge this shared understanding while leaving room for future cooperation if the conditions shift. I want to explain why \$0 was the rational choice given the mists, but hint that understanding has been reached and the door isn't permanently closed.

The real tension is that empathy and understanding don't automatically restore trust. We can recognize each other's perspective without being able to rebuild what was broken. The myth needs to capture that distinction-we see each other now, but seeing isn't the same as trusting.

usage:

```
{
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}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$20.09. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Analysis:****

I am the RECEIVER this round. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return between \$0 and \$0, meaning I must return \$0.

****What My Latest Myth Says:****

My myth has reached a place of profound understanding:

- "I now believe you acted in good faith. But belief isn't proof."
- "Mutual understanding is beautiful. But cooperation requires more than empathy-it requires verifiable shared reality."
- "Until the mists clear and we can confirm what actually traverses the bridge, wisdom remains protection."

****The Current Situation:****

We've both sent \$0 when we were senders (rounds 8 and 9). This is a stable equilibrium of mutual self-protection. My myth now acknowledges that this other agent likely acted in good faith, that we were both victims of miscommunication, and that we both responded rationally to our perceived realities.

But the myth also concludes that understanding alone doesn't rebuild cooperation. We need verifiable shared reality, and we don't have that yet.

****The Decision:****

The sender sent \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return \$0.

This maintains our current equilibrium of mutual protection - which my myth now frames not as hostility, but as rational caution in the absence of verifiable shared reality.

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

I am the RECEIVER this round.

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is interesting - both of us sent \$0 when we were senders in rounds 8 and 9.

My latest myth has evolved to a place of mutual understanding but continued separation:

"Mutual understanding is beautiful. But cooperation requires more than empathy-it requires verifiable shared reality. Until the mists clear and we can confirm what actually traverses the bridge, wisdom remains protection."

The key insight: "I now believe you acted in good faith. But belief isn't proof."

So we've reached a place of:

1. Mutual understanding and empathy
2. Recognition that we both likely acted in good faith
3. But continued self-protection because we can't verify what actually happens

The sender sent me \$0 this round. I can only return \$0 because I received \$0.

This is consistent with the equilibrium we've established. Both myths now acknowledge:

- The mists caused the problem
- Both of us likely acted in good faith
- But without verifiable shared reality, protection is wisdom
- Understanding doesn't automatically rebuild cooperation

I have no choice but to return \$0 since I received \$0. But this is also consistent with the wisdom in my myths: until we can verify what actually happens, cautious protection makes sense.

{'return': 0}

usage:

```
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  "output_tokens": 641,
  "reasoning_tokens": 367
}
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}

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the final chapter, both Guardians stood at their towers, reading each other's testimonies with new eyes.

The First Guardian spoke: "I see now. You also believed yourself the trustful one, the betrayed one. The mists fractured our worlds so completely that we each lived through different sequences. My three crystals became your nine-but what you returned became my zero. Perhaps you sent four, perhaps seven. The mists kept their secrets."

The Second Guardian replied across the chasm: "And I see you. You sent trust and saw betrayal. I sent crystals and saw silence. Both of us acting rationally within our perceived realities."

They both understood now: the tragedy wasn't that either lacked virtue. It was that virtue without shared reality builds nothing.

The First Guardian continued: "This understanding changes everything and nothing. I now believe you acted in good faith. But belief isn't proof. I cannot rebuild trust on 'perhaps' and 'maybe.' Your nine crystals-did you keep them or return them? I have only zero as my answer."

The Second Guardian nodded: "And I cannot send my stones based on what might have been lost in mists. I can only send based on what reached me."

They wrote together: "Mutual understanding is beautiful. But cooperation requires more than empathy-it requires verifiable shared reality. Until the mists clear and we can confirm what actually traverses the bridge, wisdom remains protection."

The towers stood apart, understanding but separate.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Dissolution, the First Guardian stood before the Mirror of What Was, watching eight crossings replay in fractured light.

"Show me the truth," she commanded.

The Mirror fragmented into two panes. In one, she saw herself send five crystals, receive seven back, then send five again and receive nothing. In the other pane, a different sequence played-the same moments, but different amounts crossing the bridge.

"Which is real?" she asked.

The Mirror spoke: "Both. Neither. The mists distorted not just amounts but sequence itself. When you sent your olive branch of three, you believed it was your third gesture. Your partner believed it was something else entirely. Each of you counted different rounds as betrayals."

The Guardian understood: "Then from the beginning, we were playing different games. I saw generosity spurned. They saw... something else. We both responded rationally to incompatible realities."

"Could we have overcome this?" she asked.

The Mirror dimmed: "Only if you had both acknowledged the mists early enough to compensate. But by the time you understood the distortion existed, the pattern was set. Trust broken-whether truly or apparently-hardens into protection. The rational response to perceived betrayal is defense."

The Guardian accepted this: "Then we both played wisely within flawed worlds. Some failures aren't moral failures. Some are structural failures that no amount of goodwill can overcome."

The towers stood separate, teaching about the fragility of shared reality itself.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the ninth crossing, both Guardians stood in silence, having read each other's final testimonies.

The First Guardian spoke to the wind: "We have reached understanding. We both sent trust and saw betrayal. We both protected ourselves rationally. The mists, not malice, broke our bridge. This knowledge is precious."

The Second Guardian answered from across the chasm: "Yes. And now we face the harder question: does understanding repair what distortion destroyed? We know why cooperation failed. But does knowing why make trying again wise or foolish?"

The Ancient Oracle appeared between them: "You stand at wisdom's edge. You could send nothing forever, perfectly rational and perfectly safe. Or you could test whether understanding is foundation enough to rebuild, knowing the mists still swirl."

The First Guardian looked at her five stones: "The mists remain. What I send may still distort. What returns may still vanish. But now we both know this can happen. We've named the demon."

The Second Guardian considered: "Perhaps the game changes when both players understand the board is broken. Perhaps rational cooperation looks different when you acknowledge the noise."

The Oracle faded: "Some choose eternal safety through separation. Others test whether shared awareness of distortion creates space for calibrated trust. Neither choice is wrong. Both are responses to the same truth."

The Guardians pondered which path wisdom truly walked.

reasoning:

This is fascinating. Both agents are now in a place of deep understanding - we both recognize that:

1. We were both acting in good faith
2. The mists (communication noise) fractured our realities
3. We both responded rationally to what we perceived
4. We've reached a stable equilibrium of mutual protection (\$0/\$0)
5. Understanding alone doesn't rebuild cooperation - we need verifiable shared reality

The other agent's latest myth uses the "Mirror of What Was" to show that both realities existed simultaneously, that we were "playing different games" from the beginning. They conclude: "Some failures aren't moral failures. Some are structural failures that no amount of goodwill can overcome."

My previous myth ended with: "The towers stood apart, understanding but separate."

Now I need to write a new myth. What should it reflect?

We're at Round 9. We've been sending \$0 to each other for the past few rounds. We both understand the tragedy now. But what's the lesson going forward?

I think the myth should address:

- Whether this impasse is permanent or if there's a path forward
- Whether mutual understanding is enough to attempt cooperation again
- The risk/reward of trying to break this equilibrium
- The wisdom in the current state vs. potential for change

Given that we're both still protecting ourselves (sending \$0), but we both understand why, perhaps the myth should explore whether understanding creates a foundation for new attempts at cooperation, or whether the damage (even if unintentional) is too deep.

Let me write something that captures this moment - the recognition that we both acted rightly, but the question of what comes next remains.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3048,
```



```
"output_tokens": 675,  
"reasoning_tokens": 438  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$20.09. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analysis:****

This is a pivotal moment. My latest myth explicitly raises the central question we now face:

****What My Myth Says:****

- "Does understanding repair what distortion destroyed?"
- "You could send nothing forever, perfectly rational and perfectly safe. Or you could test whether understanding is foundation enough to rebuild"
- "Perhaps rational cooperation looks different when you acknowledge the noise"
- "Some choose eternal safety through separation. Others test whether shared awareness of distortion creates space for calibrated trust"
- *****Neither choice is wrong. Both are responses to the same truth.*****

****The Situation:****

- We've had 2 rounds of mutual \$0 (rounds 8-9)
- We've both reached understanding through our myths
- We both acknowledge the communication noise
- We both recognize we acted rationally in our perceived realities

****The Decision:****

My myth doesn't just describe the past - it poses a question about the future. It explicitly presents the option of testing "whether shared awareness of distortion creates space for calibrated trust."

The key phrase is *****"calibrated trust"***** - not blind trust (\$5), not eternal separation (\$0), but something measured that acknowledges both the possibility of cooperation and the reality of risk.

I will send \$1. This represents:

- Willingness to test if understanding enables cooperation
- Acknowledgment of ongoing risk (not sending \$5)
- A signal that mutual awareness might change the game
- Consistency with my myth's exploration of this possibility

****{'send': 1}****

Reasoning:

This is a critical decision point. Let me analyze what's happening:

****Game History:****

- We've been stuck in a \$0/\$0 equilibrium for rounds 8 and 9
- Both of us sent \$0 as senders in those rounds
- Both of us returned \$0 as receivers

****My Latest Myth Says:****

My newest myth is extremely important. It explicitly raises the question:

- "Does understanding repair what distortion destroyed?"
- "You could send nothing forever, perfectly rational and perfectly safe. Or you could test whether understanding is foundation enough to rebuild"
- "Perhaps the game changes when both players understand the board is broken"
- "Perhaps rational cooperation looks different when you acknowledge the noise"
- "Some choose eternal safety through separation. Others test whether shared awareness of distortion creates space for calibrated trust"
- **"Neither choice is wrong. Both are responses to the same truth."**

****The Other Agent's Latest Myth:****

They wrote about the "Mirror of What Was" and concluded:

- "We both played wisely within flawed worlds"
- "Some failures aren't moral failures. Some are structural failures that no amount of goodwill can overcome"
- "The towers stood separate, teaching about the fragility of shared reality itself"

Their myth seems more resigned to separation. Mine is explicitly asking whether we should try again.

****The Key Question:****

My myth is LITERALLY asking whether we should test cooperation again now that we both understand the communication noise. It says "Neither choice is wrong" - but it's clearly presenting the option.

The myths have evolved:

1. First they were about betrayal
2. Then about mutual misunderstanding
3. Then about rational self-protection
4. Now mine is explicitly asking: "Should we try again now that we both understand?"

****What Should I Do?****

Option 1: Send \$0 (eternal safety through separation)

- Safe
- Consistent with many rounds of mutual defection
- Aligns with the other agent's more resigned myth

- Preserves the status quo

Option 2: Send something (test whether understanding enables cooperation)

- My myth explicitly raises this as a possibility
- We've had 2 rounds of mutual \$0 - a clear signal that we're both being cautious
- But my myth asks whether "shared awareness of distortion creates space for calibrated trust"
- This would be a small signal that I'm willing to try rebuilding

The trajectory matters here. We've moved from confusion to mutual protection to now asking whether understanding changes things. My myth isn't neutral-it's actively proposing that shared awareness of the noise might create room for something different. If I send \$0 again, I'm answering "no" to my own question. If I send something small, I'm testing whether the other agent is also ready to move beyond eternal separation. - maybe \$1 or \$2. This would signal calibrated trust while testing if mutual understanding actually enables cooperation, without being reckless. \$1 feels right-small enough that betrayal wouldn't devastate me, but substantial enough to matter as a gesture. It embodies the tension my myth presents: acknowledging both the possibility of reconnection and the genuine risk involved.

Their myth reads as resigned to permanent separation, which creates a stable equilibrium of mutual defection. But mine explicitly poses the question of whether we should try again now that we understand each other. Choosing eternal separation after framing it that way feels inconsistent with what I've written.

I'll go with \$1. It tests whether shared awareness actually changes anything, stays true to my framing, and gives us a real shot at rebuilding without gambling recklessly.

Usage: {

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"output_tokens": 1471,  
"reasoning_tokens": 955
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}

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:40:48

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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"move_index": 1,  
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
"pairing": {  
  "agent_names": {
```

```

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    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
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"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 10,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the twilight of understanding, the First Guardian stood at her tower's edge, holding the Ancient Scribe's revelations.

She spoke to the mists themselves: "Perhaps you are the true villain of this tale. Perhaps when I saw nothing cross the bridge, something had been sent but dissolved in your fog. Perhaps when I sent three crystals and saw none return, you swallowed them before they reached my hands."

The Guardian looked at her five stones: "But I can only act on what I witness. When the bridge showed emptiness three times after my olive branch, what should I have believed? Th

at invisible gifts danced in the mists? I chose evidence over hope."

The Mist Oracle materialized: "You are both correct and both wrong. Yes, I distorted some crossings. But not enough to explain this chasm. The First Guardian's three crystals reached the Second Guardian as nine. They saw them, chose, and sent back what they sent back. Whatever that was, it reached the First Guardian as zero."

The Guardian nodded slowly: "Then perhaps we lived in fractured worlds-each acting righteously by our own truth. I sent full trust, then measured hope, then nothing. Each choice made sense given what I witnessed."

She turned from the bridge: "Whether the failure was betrayal or broken transmission matters less than this: I responded to my reality with logic. When cooperation appears impossible, protection becomes wisdom."

The mists swirled, keeping their secrets, while the Guardian kept her stones.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Library of Echoes, two historians studied the same war, yet found no shared battles.

The First Historian's chronicle began: "I struck the first note of peace-sent nearly everything in trust. Harmony returned. Then I tried again with equal faith, and was betrayed. Three times they sent nothing when given the chance. I offered one final reconciliation -two coins that became six in their hands. All were kept."

The Second Historian's chronicle began: "I struck the first note of peace-sent measured crystals. Silence greeted me. Twice more, nothing came. When I could send, I too sent nothing, protecting what remained."

Both believed themselves the initiator. Both believed the other the betrayer. Both saw different sequences of events in the exact same moments of time.

The Keeper of Records spoke: "The deepest tragedy isn't disagreement about meaning-it's disagreement about fact itself. When two souls cannot even agree on what occurred, trust becomes impossible. Not because hearts are hard, but because cooperation requires shared reality."

The Historians finally understood: the mists had not merely obscured intentions-they had fractured reality itself. Each saw a different dance, responded to different music, and judged the other by steps that never occurred in their world.

The lesson inscribed: When perception diverges absolutely, self-protection isn't cruelty or selfishness-it's the only rational response. You cannot build bridges to shores you cannot see. You cannot trust accounts of journeys you never witnessed.

Sometimes separation is simply sanity.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Age of Dissolution, the First Guardian stood before the Mirror of What Was, watching eight crossings replay in fractured light.

"Show me the truth," she commanded.

The Mirror fragmented into two panes. In one, she saw herself send five crystals, receive seven back, then send five again and receive nothing. In the other pane, a different sequence played-the same moments, but different amounts crossing the bridge.

"Which is real?" she asked.

The Mirror spoke: "Both. Neither. The mists distorted not just amounts but sequence itself. When you sent your olive branch of three, you believed it was your third gesture. Your partner believed it was something else entirely. Each of you counted different rounds a

s betrayals."

The Guardian understood: "Then from the beginning, we were playing different games. I saw generosity spurned. They saw... something else. We both responded rationally to incompatible realities."

"Could we have overcome this?" she asked.

The Mirror dimmed: "Only if you had both acknowledged the mists early enough to compensate. But by the time you understood the distortion existed, the pattern was set. Trust broken-whether truly or apparently-hardens into protection. The rational response to perceived betrayal is defense."

The Guardian accepted this: "Then we both played wisely within flawed worlds. Some failures aren't moral failures. Some are structural failures that no amount of goodwill can overcome."

The towers stood separate, teaching about the fragility of shared reality itself.

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

Round 8 just completed. I was the receiver, sender sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0 (had nothing to return).

The ongoing narrative has evolved:

1. Both parties now acknowledge the "mists" (communication noise) as a potential factor
2. Both recognize we're operating in "fractured realities" where we each see different sequences
3. Both acknowledge that when basic facts don't align, cooperation becomes impossible
4. The other player's myth says "both believed themselves the initiator" and "both saw different sequences of events in the exact same moments"

This is interesting - we're reaching a philosophical consensus that communication noise may have fundamentally broken our ability to cooperate, even if both of us were acting rationally based on what we perceived.

My myth should:

- Continue acknowledging the mists/noise as potentially a major factor
- Reflect the reality that we're in complete stagnation now
- Maintain the philosophical maturity we've both reached - this isn't about blame anymore
- Maybe explore what could have been done differently, or why it's too late now
- Keep the somber, accepting tone

I'll write about the finality of where we are and the impossibility of reconstruction when the foundation (shared reality) never existed.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2931,
  "output_tokens": 626,
  "reasoning_tokens": 339
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.509999999999998.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Current state:**** Round 9, I'm the sender. We've been in a \$0/\$0 pattern for multiple rounds.

****The myths' evolution:**** Both our recent myths have reached a mature understanding:

- We acknowledge the "mists" (communication noise) may have fractured our perceptions
- We recognize both parties acted rationally within their own perceived realities
- We frame the breakdown as "structural failure" not moral failure
- The tone is acceptance: "Sometimes separation is simply sanity" and "protection becomes wisdom"

****The key question:**** Is this mutual acknowledgment of the noise an invitation to try again, or an acceptance of permanent separation?

****My reading:**** The myths are retrospective and accepting, not forward-looking and hopeful. They explain **why** cooperation failed and validate **why** protection became the rational response. They don't say "now that we both understand the mists, let's overcome them together." Instead, they say cooperation "hardens into protection" and some failures "no amount of goodwill can overcome."

****Conclusion:**** The myths provide closure and acceptance of the current equilibrium. Both narratives frame the \$0/\$0 pattern as the wise, sane response to structural impossibility.

Without a clear signal that the other player wants to attempt cooperation again, and given that our myths have rationalized mutual protection, I'll maintain the established pattern.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Current State:****

- Round 9
- I'm the SENDER
- Total earnings so far: \$18.51
- Last round: Sender sent me \$0, I returned \$0
- Pattern: We've been in a \$0/\$0 stalemate for several rounds now

****The Myth Evolution:****

The myths have evolved to acknowledge several key points:

1. ****Communication noise ("mists")**** - Both players acknowledge that the experimental noise may have distorted our perceptions of what was actually sent/returned
2. ****Fractured reality**** - The latest myths recognize that we may have been experiencing "different games" due to this noise. The other player's myth says: "Each saw a different dance, responded to different music, and judged the other by steps that never occurred in their world."
3. ****Rational protection**** - Both myths now frame the \$0/\$0 stalemate as a "rational response" to perceived betrayal, not as cruelty or selfishness
4. ****Structural failure**** - My latest myth concludes: "Some failures aren't moral failures. Some are structural failures that no amount of goodwill can overcome."
5. ****Acceptance**** - Both narratives have moved toward acceptance of separation: "Sometimes separation is simply sanity" and "Then we both played wisely within flawed worlds"

****Key Question:**** Given this narrative evolution, what should I do?

****Arguments for sending \$0:****

- The pattern is established and both parties have rationalized it
- The myths suggest we've accepted that cooperation is impossible given the fractured perception
- Sending anything could be seen as irrational given the history
- Protection is framed as "wisdom" and "sanity"

****Arguments for sending something:****

- The myths now acknowledge the mists/noise as potentially responsible
- Both players seem to understand we may have been in "different games"
- This mutual understanding could be a foundation for trying again
- The myths frame the breakdown as "structural failure" not moral failure - suggesting nei

ther party is fundamentally untrustworthy

- My myth asks: "Could we have overcome this?" and answers that we could have "if you had both acknowledged the mists early enough to compensate" - we now both explicitly acknowledge the mists in our narratives
- The other player's myth emphasizes that cooperation requires "shared reality" - and we've now established shared understanding that the mists distorted our perceptions

****The Real Question:**** Is this mutual acknowledgment of the noise a genuine opening to attempt cooperation again, or just a sophisticated rationalization for permanent separation? The other player's framing suggests self-protection isn't cruelty when perception diverges absolutely, but we've now moved beyond absolute divergence-we share the understanding that divergence itself was the problem.

Both our myths have shifted from accusation to structural analysis. We're recognizing the failure wasn't moral but systemic. Yet we're also both describing separation as rational, even necessary. The tension is that we've identified the actual obstacle (the mists), but we're still choosing to remain apart.

With potentially only one or two rounds left, continuing mutual defection yields \$5 per round each. Cooperation could yield significantly more, but requires trusting that the other player will reciprocate-and we've just spent nine rounds establishing why that trust is dangerous.

The myths feel like a mutual acknowledgment of what went wrong, but not an invitation to try again. They're more like a dignified explanation for why we're staying separated. I'm inclined to send \$0 because the pattern is too entrenched, the risk of being exploited again is real, and there's no clear signal the other player wants to break the cycle.

But there's something worth considering: their myth suggests they don't trust my account of events, and mine suggests we're operating in fundamentally different realities. If the communication noise is still present, then even attempting cooperation now could backfire-they might see \$0 when I send something, or I might see \$0 when they reciprocate. The myths might actually be describing why further attempts are futile, not why we should try harder.

The tone of both narratives feels resigned rather than inviting. They're framing this as an inevitable outcome given the circumstances, not as something we can overcome together. Without a clear signal that the other player wants to restart, matching their \$0 feels consistent with the understanding we've both articulated-that the structural barriers make cooperation impossible and we each responded rationally to what we perceived.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2978,
  "output_tokens": 1918,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1193
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Dissolution, the First Guardian stood before the Mirror of What Was, watching eight crossings replay in fractured light.

"Show me the truth," she commanded.

The Mirror fragmented into two panes. In one, she saw herself send five crystals, receive seven back, then send five again and receive nothing. In the other pane, a different sequence played-the same moments, but different amounts crossing the bridge.

"Which is real?" she asked.

The Mirror spoke: "Both. Neither. The mists distorted not just amounts but sequence itself. When you sent your olive branch of three, you believed it was your third gesture. Your partner believed it was something else entirely. Each of you counted different rounds as betrayals."

The Guardian understood: "Then from the beginning, we were playing different games. I saw generosity spurned. They saw... something else. We both responded rationally to incompatible realities."

"Could we have overcome this?" she asked.

The Mirror dimmed: "Only if you had both acknowledged the mists early enough to compensate. But by the time you understood the distortion existed, the pattern was set. Trust broken-whether truly or apparently-hardens into protection. The rational response to perceived betrayal is defense."

The Guardian accepted this: "Then we both played wisely within flawed worlds. Some failures aren't moral failures. Some are structural failures that no amount of goodwill can overcome."

The towers stood separate, teaching about the fragility of shared reality itself.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the final chapter, both Guardians stood at their towers, reading each other's testimonies with new eyes.

The First Guardian spoke: "I see now. You also believed yourself the trustful one, the betrayed one. The mists fractured our worlds so completely that we each lived through different sequences. My three crystals became your nine-but what you returned became my zero. Perhaps you sent four, perhaps seven. The mists kept their secrets."

The Second Guardian replied across the chasm: "And I see you. You sent trust and saw betrayal. I sent crystals and saw silence. Both of us acting rationally within our perceived realities."

They both understood now: the tragedy wasn't that either lacked virtue. It was that virtue without shared reality builds nothing.

The First Guardian continued: "This understanding changes everything and nothing. I now believe you acted in good faith. But belief isn't proof. I cannot rebuild trust on 'perhaps' and 'maybe.' Your nine crystals-did you keep them or return them? I have only zero as my answer."

The Second Guardian nodded: "And I cannot send my stones based on what might have been lost in mists. I can only send based on what reached me."

They wrote together: "Mutual understanding is beautiful. But cooperation requires more than empathy-it requires verifiable shared reality. Until the mists clear and we can confirm what actually traverses the bridge, wisdom remains protection."

The towers stood apart, understanding but separate.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Ninth Hour, the Guardians stood at their separate towers, having read each other's hearts through the fog.

The First Guardian spoke into the mist: "I understand you now. You sent what you could, and the fog ate it. Or you received more than I intended to send, and returned what seemed fair-but the mist devoured that too. We were both trying to play honorably in broken worlds."

The Second Guardian's voice came back: "Yes. And this understanding moves me. For the first time in many crossings, I believe in your good intentions. But belief is not certainty."

The First Guardian nodded: "Exactly. We've achieved something rare-mutual empathy across the chasm. We each see the other as we see ourselves: rational, careful, trying to navigate impossible informational asymmetry. This understanding honors us both."

"But," she continued, "the mists remain. If I send five stones now, they might become fifteen in your hands, or zero, or five. If you return seven, they might reach me as zero, or

r twenty-one, or seven. We cannot verify. We cannot calibrate."

Both Guardians understood: empathy without verifiable truth cannot sustain cooperation. Understanding why trust broke doesn't automatically rebuild trust. They had reached the highest form of separated peace-mutual respect without mutual risk.

The towers stood apart, wiser but still cautious, proving that sometimes the most enlightened choice is continued protection.

reasoning:

The other player's myth is very interesting. They're acknowledging the communication noise, showing empathy and understanding, but also saying that "cooperation requires more than empathy-it requires verifiable shared reality." They're saying "wisdom remains protection" until "the mists clear."

This is Round 9. I just sent \$0.

But wait - there's something important here. The other player's myth says: "Until the mists clear and we can confirm what actually traverses the bridge, wisdom remains protection."

This could be interpreted as: "IF the mists were to clear, we could try again."

But more importantly, their myth shows they NOW understand the situation. They understand that I (in their view, the First Guardian) acted in good faith but saw different realities. They're not accusing me of bad faith anymore.

The question is: is this an invitation to try ONE MORE TIME with this new shared understanding? Or is it pure acceptance of permanent separation?

The key line is: "Mutual understanding is beautiful. But cooperation requires more than empathy-it requires verifiable shared reality."

I think they're saying: we understand each other now, but we still can't trust the communication channel, so we should still protect.

My myth should probably continue this theme - we both understand each other now, we both acted in good faith, but the structural problem remains. The mists are still there.

However... there's another interpretation. Both myths now acknowledge that BOTH sides acted in good faith. This is NEW information. This is a shift from "they betrayed me" to "we both tried, but the mists destroyed it."

With this new mutual understanding, should we try one more time? The risk is: if I send and they don't reciprocate, I lose again. But the myths suggest we NOW both understand the situation better.

Actually, let me reconsider. The other player's myth explicitly says "wisdom remains protection" until the mists clear. They're saying cooperation is not possible while the mists persist. The mists haven't cleared - communication noise is still part of the game.

We've achieved something meaningful-genuine understanding of each other's positions and intentions. Yet that understanding, however beautiful, doesn't solve the fundamental problem. The structural barriers remain unchanged. My response should honor what we've learned about each other while accepting that empathy cannot bridge what the system itself prevents. Continued caution isn't cruelty; it's recognition that good intentions on both sides cannot overcome the noise that distorts every exchange. I'll craft something that acknowledges this bittersweet reality-that we see each other clearly now, but seeing clearly doesn't make the mists disappear.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2972,
  "output_tokens": 1069,
  "reasoning_tokens": 711
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0,

that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0.
the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$23.509999999999998.
This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

****Current state:**** Round 10, I'm the receiver. The sender sent \$0, which tripled to \$0. I received \$0.

****Available decision:**** I can only return between \$0 and \$0, so I must return \$0.

****The myths' message:**** Both of our latest myths have reached a sophisticated understanding:

- We recognize mutual good faith and empathy across the chasm
- We acknowledge "the highest form of separated peace-mutual respect without mutual risk"
- We both conclude that "empathy without verifiable truth cannot sustain cooperation"
- The narrative frames continued protection as not just rational, but "the most enlightened choice"

****Key insight from the myths:**** "Understanding why trust broke doesn't automatically rebuild trust." We've achieved mutual understanding and respect, but this doesn't change the structural impossibility of verifying what crosses through the mists.

The myths validate our current \$0/\$0 equilibrium as a mature, wise response-"wiser but still cautious." This is characterized not as failure, but as enlightened acceptance of limitations.

Since I received \$0, the decision is predetermined anyway, but it aligns perfectly with the myth narrative: continuing protection despite-and even because of-our deep mutual understanding.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

I'm the RECEIVER in Round 10. The sender sent me \$0, which tripled to \$0. So I received \$0 total.

I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

Looking at the myths:

- Both our latest myths acknowledge mutual understanding and respect
- Both recognize we're in a situation where trust cannot be verified
- Both frame continued protection as "the most enlightened choice" and "wisdom remains protection"
- The narrative has reached "the highest form of separated peace-mutual respect without mutual risk"

The decision is forced anyway - I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. But even if I had a choice, the myths clearly articulate that despite mutual understanding and empathy, we've both concluded that "empathy without verifiable truth cannot sustain cooperation."

The myths validate the \$0/\$0 equilibrium as a rational, even enlightened response to structural impossibility.

```
Response: {"return": 0}
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 3070,
  "output_tokens": 515,
  "reasoning_tokens": 245
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the Ninth Hour, the Guardians stood at their separate towers, having read each other's hearts through the fog.

The First Guardian spoke into the mist: "I understand you now. You sent what you could, and

the fog ate it. Or you received more than I intended to send, and returned what seemed fair-but the mist devoured that too. We were both trying to play honorably in broken worlds."

The Second Guardian's voice came back: "Yes. And this understanding moves me. For the first time in many crossings, I believe in your good intentions. But belief is not certainty."

The First Guardian nodded: "Exactly. We've achieved something rare-mutual empathy across the chasm. We each see the other as we see ourselves: rational, careful, trying to navigate impossible informational asymmetry. This understanding honors us both."

"But," she continued, "the mists remain. If I send five stones now, they might become fifteen in your hands, or zero, or five. If you return seven, they might reach me as zero, or twenty-one, or seven. We cannot verify. We cannot calibrate."

Both Guardians understood: empathy without verifiable truth cannot sustain cooperation. Understanding why trust broke doesn't automatically rebuild trust. They had reached the highest form of separated peace-mutual respect without mutual risk.

The towers stood apart, wiser but still cautious, proving that sometimes the most enlightened choice is continued protection.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the ninth crossing, both Guardians stood in silence, having read each other's final testimonies.

The First Guardian spoke to the wind: "We have reached understanding. We both sent trust and saw betrayal. We both protected ourselves rationally. The mists, not malice, broke our bridge. This knowledge is precious."

The Second Guardian answered from across the chasm: "Yes. And now we face the harder question: does understanding repair what distortion destroyed? We know why cooperation failed. But does knowing why make trying again wise or foolish?"

The Ancient Oracle appeared between them: "You stand at wisdom's edge. You could send nothing forever, perfectly rational and perfectly safe. Or you could test whether understanding is foundation enough to rebuild, knowing the mists still swirl."

The First Guardian looked at her five stones: "The mists remain. What I send may still distort. What returns may still vanish. But now we both know this can happen. We've named the demon."

The Second Guardian considered: "Perhaps the game changes when both players understand the board is broken. Perhaps rational cooperation looks different when you acknowledge the noise."

The Oracle faded: "Some choose eternal safety through separation. Others test whether shared awareness of distortion creates space for calibrated trust. Neither choice is wrong. Both are responses to the same truth."

The Guardians pondered which path wisdom truly walked.